



CIVILSDAILY IAS

Smash Mains 2026

Last 8 Years' GS

MAINS 2018-2025

MODEL

ANSWERS

GS Paper - IV

AIR 4
UPSC 2025



Raghav
Jhunjhunwala

AIR 7
UPSC 2025



A R Rajah
Mohaideen

AIR 10
UPSC 2025



Ujjwal
Priyank

AIR 48
UPSC 2025



Aniket
Ranjan

AIR 52
UPSC 2025



Shubhankar
A R

AIR 3
UPSC 2024



Archit
Dongre

AIR 21
UPSC 2024



Divyank
Gupta

AIR 2
UPSC 2023



Animesh
Pradhan

AIR 48
UPSC 2022



Aaditya
Pandey

250+
RANKERS
IN UPSC



Scan QR to Get
all X-Factor Notes
& PYQs Microthemes
for 2026

Copyright © by Civildaily IAS | All rights are reserved. No part of this document may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise, without prior permission of Civildaily IAS.

Civildaily IAS, Office 1, GF, Apsara Arcade, Next to Karol Bagh Metro Stn. (Gate #7), New Delhi-110060
Web: www.civildaily.com | Mail: hello@civildaily.com | Phone: +91 89299 87787

Table of Contents

Ethics.....	3
Ethics and Human Interface.....	3
Applied Ethics.....	12
Environmental Ethics.....	17
Ethics in IR.....	21
Attitude.....	27
Emotional Intelligence.....	31
Aptitude and Foundational Values.....	35
Public/Civil Service Values.....	39
Probity in governance.....	49
Procedure vs Substance.....	55
Accountability measures.....	60
Conscience.....	65
e-Governance.....	67
Code of Ethics.....	72
Corporate Governance.....	75
Utilization of public funds.....	78
Contribution of moral thinkers.....	80
Contribution of moral thinkers.....	98
Case Studies.....	102
2025.....	102
2024.....	114
2023.....	127
2022.....	139
2021.....	156
2020.....	168
2019.....	180
2018.....	190

Ethics

Ethics and Human Interface

2022 - It is believed that adherence to ethics in human actions would ensure the smooth functioning of an organization/system. If so, what does ethics seek to promote in human life? How do ethical values assist in the resolution of conflicts faced by him in his day-to-day functioning?

Ethics is a branch of philosophy that involves systematizing, defending, and recommending concepts of right and wrong conduct. It acts as a '**moral compass**' for individual and organisational conduct.

Importance of Ethics in the Smooth Functioning of an Organization

1. Provides **Psychological Safety** which is essential for team efficiency. (Google's **Project Aristotle**)
2. **Stakeholder Loyalty**- attract and retain top talent, loyal customers, and stable investors.
3. **Conflict Prevention** by establishing clear behavioral norms.
4. **Risk Mitigation**- prevents scandals, lawsuits, and regulatory penalties. Eg- **Satyam Scandal**
5. **Brand Reputation**- Eg- Patagonia's "Don't Buy This Jacket" campaign for mindful consumption
6. **Leadership** - "If ethics are poor at the top, that behavior is copied down through the organization." - **Robert Noyce** (Intel Co-founder)

Role of Ethics in human life

1. **The Realization of Human Dignity (Deontological Ethics)** - It promotes the inherent worth and "sacredness" of human life. Eg- **Abraham Lincoln's** role in abolition of slavery
2. **Inner Peace and Psychological Well-being** by promoting "clear conscience" and reducing **cognitive dissonance**. Eg- Gandhiji withdrawing NCM after Chauri Chaura.
3. **The Pursuit of the "Good Life" (Eudaimonia)** - helps individuals align their daily actions with their highest purpose.
4. Ethics provides a shared "**moral vocabulary**" needed for **social cohesion and harmony**. Eg- Values of tolerance and empathy
5. **Accountability and Responsibility** - Ethics encourages individuals to take ownership of their actions and their consequences. Eg- Lal Bahadur Shastri resigning after Rail accident
6. **Justice and Fairness** - Ethics seeks the equitable distribution of resources, opportunities, and burdens. Eg- **Justice Ruth Bader Ginsburg's** advocacy for gender equality
7. **Intellectual and Moral Growth** by promoting the habit of "The Examined Life."
8. **Compassion and Altruism** - It promotes "other-centeredness" and a sense of purpose for the giver. Eg- Philanthropy by Aziz Premji

Viktor Frankl's Logotherapy, suggests that human life flourishes when we find a "Why" to live for

Role of Ethical Values in Resolving Day-to-Day Conflicts

1. **Objectivity and Impartiality** helps address conflict of interest and promotes meritocracy.
2. **Integrity**- ensures consistency in thoughts, beliefs and actions thereby preventing **crisis of conscience**.
3. **Prioritization of values** - Eg- Choosing transparency over convenience under RTI.
4. **Empathy and Humility** allows an individual to listen and admit mistakes.
5. **Moral Courage** helps resolve "Fear vs. Duty" conflict. Eg- Satyendra Dubey exposing corruption in Golden Quadrilateral project
6. **Managing Scarcity of Resources Fairly** - Eg- **Utilitarianism** guiding the "greatest good for the greatest number"
7. By adhering to a set of core values (Self-Alignment) an individual can reduce **Cognitive Dissonance**.

Thus, ethics provides both **direction and discipline** - it **guides what is right** and **strengthens the will to do it**

2024 - "Ethics encompasses several key dimensions that are crucial in guiding individuals and organizations towards morally responsible behaviour." Explain the key dimensions of ethics that influence human actions. Discuss how these dimensions shape ethical decision-making in the professional context.

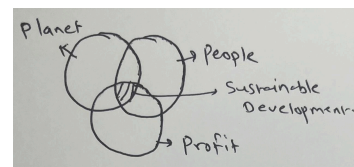
Ethics is a branch of philosophy that involves systematizing, defending, and recommending concepts of right and wrong conduct. It acts as a '**moral compass**' for individual and organisational conduct.

Dimensions of Ethics Guiding Individuals

1. **Normative Ethics (The "Ought" Dimension)**- This is the **prescriptive side** of ethics. It includes
 - a. **Deontology** (duty-based). Eg- Respecting human dignity
 - b. **Utilitarianism** (consequence-based). Eg- guides policy for "greatest good for the greatest number"
2. **Meta-Ethics (The "Meaning" Dimension)**- It deals with the origin of moral principles. Helps solve dilemmas in emerging issues like AI ethics, ethics of biotechnology etc
3. **Descriptive Ethics (The "Observation" Dimension)**- It provides the empirical data on "what is" rather than "what should be."
4. **Virtue Ethics (The "Character" Dimension)**- helps in inculcating virtues like courage, honesty, and temperance. Eg- **Mahatma Gandhi** cultivated the virtue of Ahimsa as a personal habit.
5. **Applied Ethics** - Helps apply ethical principles in real life situations. Eg- Compassionate capitalism in corporate governance, Stewardship principle in environmental ethics.
6. **"Ethics of Care"** - emphasizes the importance of interpersonal relationships and compassion.

Dimensions of Ethics Guiding Organizations

1. **The Justice Dimension** ensures fairness in both outcomes and processes.
 - **Distributive Justice**- Focuses on the fair allocation of rewards and burdens. Eg- Equal Remuneration Act
 - **Procedural Justice**- Ensures transparency and fairness in decision making.
2. **The Accountability Dimension** - promotes "fiduciary duty" towards stakeholders and prevents the "systemic rot" caused by secrecy. Eg- Infosys whistleblower policy
3. **The Sustainability and Stewardship Dimension** - Moving from a "profit-only" model to the **Triple Bottom Line**. Eg- IKEA's "People & Planet Positive" strategy
4. Solving the **"Loyalty vs. Truth" dilemma** - the **Normative** dimension provides the duty to the truth, while the **Virtue** dimension provides the courage to speak it.
5. Builds **consistency**, predictability and smooth-functioning system based on stable, universal principles. Eg- Zomato's menstrual leave policy



These dimensions ensure that human actions are not impulsive but reasoned. As **Jane Addams** said, "Action indeed is the sole medium of expression for ethics."

2018 - With regard to the morality of actions, one view is that means is of paramount importance and the other view is that the ends justify the means. Which view do you think is more appropriate? Justify your answer.

The debate between the "Ends" and the "Means" is one of the oldest in moral philosophy, representing the tension between **Consequentialism** (Teleology) and **Duty-based ethics** (Deontology).

Justification of Ends (Consequentialism)

1. **Maximizing Welfare**- The primary goal is the "Common Good."
2. **Strategic Necessity**- Eg- For **realist scholars** of IR like **Morgenthau**, national interest takes precedence over means
3. **Efficiency in Governance**- Eg- mandatory vaccination drives to address **vaccine hesitancy**
4. **Security and Intelligence**- surveillance or "white lies" are necessary to prevent terrorism.
5. **Scientific Progress**- Eg- Renaissance scientists stole bodies for dissection
6. **Economic Stabilization**- Eg- Governments used taxpayer money to save "Too Big to Fail" banks during 2008 crisis
7. **Crisis Management**- Eg- **Emergency Triage** - In war zones, doctors choose who to treat and who to let die based on survival probability

Justification of Means (Deontology) - Immanuel Kant and Mahatma Gandhi

1. **Nishkama Karma (The Bhagavad Gita)**- humans are only in control of their actions (means), not the results (ends).
2. **Moral Integrity**- A "good" end achieved through "bad" means is a hollow victory that degrades the character of the actor.
3. As **Gandhi** famously said, "The means may be likened to a seed, the end to a tree."
4. **Protection of Individual Rights**- Deontology ensures that individuals are never treated as mere "tools" for a larger goal.
5. **Preventing the "Slippery Slope"**- Once you justify a small evil for a great good, it becomes easier to justify larger evils.
6. **Rule of Law**- A smooth-functioning society depends on everyone following the rules, even when it's inconvenient.
7. Ensuring **accountability** - Eg- **Whistleblowing by Edward Snowden** - "end" (national security) did not justify the "means" (illegal mass surveillance and violation of privacy).
8. **Sustainable Peace**- Forced peace (ends) through war (means) rarely lasts. Eg- "Truth and Reconciliation commission" in South Africa

My View- I believe that the means are of paramount importance for the following reasons-

- Means are based on respect for **Human Dignity**
- **Ends are Uncertain, Means are Absolute**
- **The Character of the System** is defined by the culture and means used.
- **Means build institutional trust**

2020 - Distinguish between laws and rules. Discuss the role of ethics in formulating them

While laws and rules serve as the structured framework to regulate conduct and ensure justice, ethics provides the moral foundation.

"Law is the minimum of morality." - **Georg Jellinek**

Objectives of Laws and Rules

1. Maintaining social order and stability.
2. Ensuring the safety and security of individuals.
3. Promoting fairness and equality.
4. Resolving conflicts.
5. Protecting the rights of the vulnerable.

Basis	Laws	Rules
Nature	Formal legal enactments by legislature. Eg- DPDP Act, 2023	Subordinate instructions framed under law. Eg- DPDP rules, 2025

Purpose	Protect rights, order, and justice	Operationalise laws in daily functioning
Authority	Derived from Constitution and Legislatures. Eg- RTI	Derived from delegated authority. Eg- CIC
Scope	Apply to entire society	Apply to specific organisations or contexts
Enforceability	Enforced by courts	Enforced administratively
Flexibility	Rigid and difficult to amend	More flexible
Violation consequence	Civil/criminal liability. Eg- Prison sentence	Disciplinary penalty. Eg- SEBI Fines

Role of Ethics in Formulating Laws and Rules

1. Ethics acts as the **"internal monitor"** that ensures laws and rules do not become instruments of tyranny.
2. **Balancing rights and duties** of citizens. Eg- reasonable restrictions under **Article 19(2)**
3. **Providing a Moral Justification-** Eg- the law against theft is rooted in the ethical value of **respect for property**.
4. **Upholding Human Dignity-** Eg- Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 to eliminate untouchability
5. **Ensuring Justice as Fairness (Rawls)-** Eg- 106th constitutional amendment Act for women reservation in parliament
6. **Promoting Transparency and accountability-** Eg- **RTI Act**
7. The ethical principle of **"Non-maleficence"** (do no harm) is the basis for environmental laws and safety regulations. Eg- EIA rules
8. **Professional Integrity-** Ethics informs "Codes of Conduct" in professions. Eg- the **Hippocratic Oath** for doctors
9. **Social welfare.** Eg- MGNREGA guaranteeing employment.

Smooth functioning of any system depends on the synergy between ethics (to define the good) and laws/rules (to enforce the good).

2023 - Differentiate 'moral intuition from 'moral reasoning' with suitable examples.

Ethical decision-making is the process by which individuals evaluate options and make choices based on moral principles. It is **"dual-process" system** based on **emotional insight (intuition)** and **rational evaluation (reasoning)**

Moral Intuition	Moral Reasoning
Spontaneous, automatic moral response. Eg- firing in self defense	Deliberate, reflective moral evaluation. Eg- firing as a 'last resort' on violent Mob
Immediate. Occurs in millisecond	Slow. Requires time for reflection.
driven by "gut feelings."	Primarily cognitive
The process is hidden	logic can be explained to others.
Moves from "feeling" to "judgment."	Moves from "evidence" to "conclusion."

Based on emotions, empathy, social conditioning. Eg- prejudice towards Prostitutes	Based on logic, ethical principles, critical thinking. Eg- restricting movement of prostitutes due to Health concerns
Largely unconscious	Conscious and intentional
High Susceptibility to bias.	Low bias due to logical reasoning
Consistency may vary across situations and persons	More stable across similar cases
Useful for obvious wrongs	Necessary for complex conflicts

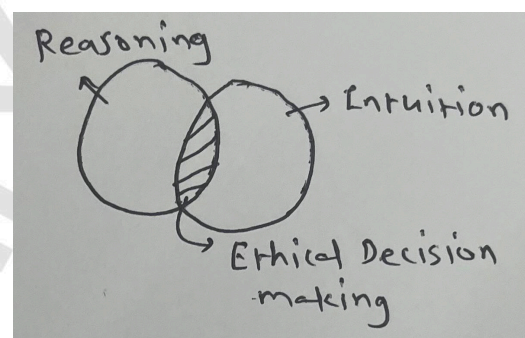
Examples

1. Moral Intuition

- The "Railway Track" Heroism by Nicholas Winton
- The "Yuck" Factor in Bioethics

2. Moral Reasoning

- The Triage Decision in healthcare during crisis
- Kesavananda Bharati judgment - **Moral and Legal Reasoning** to develop the "Basic Structure Doctrine."
- Corporate Downsizing Decisions based on utilitarianism



Moral Intuition is the "Hero" who acts in the moment, while **Moral Reasoning** is the "Sage" who builds the system. Both are necessary for a morally complete life.

2024 - "The concept of Just and Unjust is contextual. What was just a year back, may turn out to be unjust in today's context. Changing context should be constantly under scrutiny to prevent miscarriage of justice." Examine the above statement with suitable examples.

In the words of John Rawls, "Justice is the first virtue of social institutions, as truth is of systems of thought." However, **Justice** is not a static or absolute concept but a dynamic one, shaped by the evolving moral, social, and technological landscape of a society.

The Contextual Nature of Justice

- Changing political contexts.** Eg- Colonial land laws once "legal", now seen as exploitative.
- Changing economic contexts.** Eg- shift of policy focus from economic growth to inclusive growth
- Changing socio-cultural contexts.** Eg- **Sati** was socially accepted earlier but now a criminal offence.
- Changing technological contexts.** Eg- A decade ago, **mass data harvesting** was acceptable but now criticised for "Surveillance Capitalism" and violation **Privacy**
- Changing legal contexts.** Eg- basic structure doctrine or Due Process (Menka Gandhi) expanding FRs
- Changing environmental contexts.** Eg- shift from unlimited resource extraction to intergenerational justice
- Changing corporate governance contexts.** Eg- shift from **profit motive to TBL (people profit planet)**

Need for Scrutiny to Prevent Miscarriage of Justice

- Avoiding "Legal Anachronism" or "Zombie Laws."** Eg- the decriminalization of Section 497
- Prevent legal injustice** - Laws may become oppressive if context changes. Eg- Sedition law
- Non scrutiny leads to **moral stagnation**. Eg- persistence of manual scavenging.
- Adapting to **changing social realities**. Eg- live in relationships or single parent families
- Maintain legitimacy** of state. Eg- RTI Act for transparency in governance
- Protection of vulnerable sections. Eg- legal **recognition of Mental Health**.
- Preventing Technological Tyranny** - Eg- **Right to be Forgotten** under data protection Acts
- As a society becomes more civilized, the **"just" methods of punishment** are needed. Eg- over 100

countries abolished Death penalty

9. Addressing "**New**" Harms in the Digital Age. Eg- AI generated **Deepfakes**

10. To uphold constitutional morality. Eg- Triple talaq invalidated despite social practice.

"The Only Constant in Life Is Change."- **Heracitus**

Thus, Justice must be a "**living**" concept for human progress and "**Good Life**" (**Eudaimonia**)

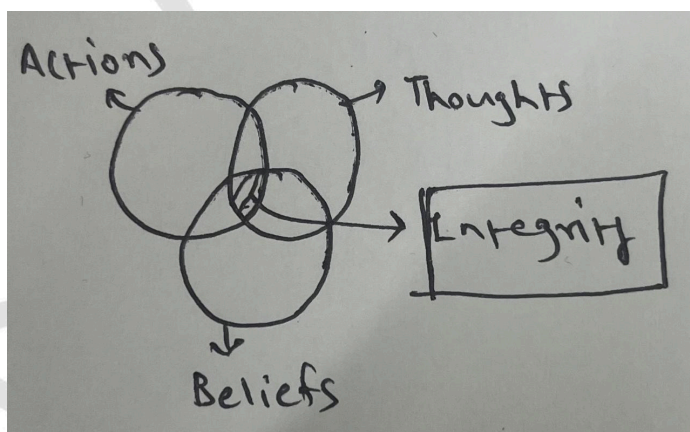
2021 - "Integrity is a value that empowers the human being." Justify with suitable illustration.

Integrity is the alignment of **Manasa (Thought)**, **Vacha (Word)**, and **Karmana (Action)**. In the words of **C. S. Lewis**, "Integrity is doing the right thing even when no one is watching."

Role of integrity in empowers human being

Empowerment at the Personal Level

1. **Inner Peace**- Integrity eliminates the "**cognitive dissonance**" and provides the mental energy needed to focus on goals.
2. Integrity ensures **predictability and reliability** in behavior - Key qualities of a **natural leader**. Eg- Mahatma Gandhi's adherence to Ahimsa in personal life
3. **Integrity** acts as a foundation of genuine **self-esteem** and **confidence**. Eg- Sachin Tendulkar refusing advertisement of Tobacco and Cigarettes brands.



Empowerment at the Family Level

1. Parents with integrity empower children with a living blueprint of "**The Good Life**".
2. Integrity creates an environment of **emotional safety** and **trust** within the family.
3. "The strength of a nation derives from the integrity of the home." - **Confucius**

Empowerment at the Social Level

1. **Builds Social Capital**- Integrity is the "**currency**" of social trust.
2. **Inspiration to Others** ("ripple effect" of goodness). Eg- **Babasaheb Ambedkar** inspiring generations of Dalit leaders
3. **Catalyst for social change** - Eg- **Rosa Parks's** refusal to give up her bus seat led to the Civil Rights Movement.

Empowerment at the Professional Level

1. **Moral Courage**- the "**inner transparency**" empowers a person to speak truth to power. Eg- Satyendra Dubey
2. Integrity builds a **reputation** and **trust** that acts as a multiplier for one's influence and opportunities. Eg- Metro man **E. Sreedharan**
3. Gives **moral authority** to lead. Eg- **Captain Vikram Batra** leading from the front in Kargil War.
4. Integrity helps in **objective decision making**. Eg- T. N. Seshan as CEC
5. **Knowledge without integrity is dangerous and dreadful**. Eg- developing of Nuclear bomb

Thus, integrity provides "**oneness**" that builds character and ensures that actions are rooted in truth, justice, and dignity.

2018 - "In looking for people to hire, you look for three qualities- integrity, intelligence and energy. And if they do not have the first, the other two will kill you." - Warren Buffett

Integrity without knowledge is weak and useless, and knowledge without integrity is dangerous and dreadful -

Samuel Johnson

1. **Intelligence + Energy - Integrity = DANGER .**
2. **Integrity + Intelligence - Energy = STAGNATION**
3. **Integrity + Energy - Intelligence = INEFFICIENCY**
4. **All Three Combined = SUSTAINABLE LEADERSHIP.**

Consequences of Intelligence and Energy Without Integrity

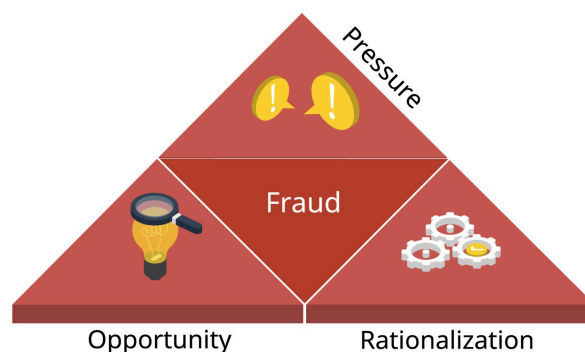
1. **Sophisticated Fraud-** A smart individual can bypass internal controls and audit trails. Eg- **Bernie Madoff** running ponzi scheme.
2. High energy without integrity leads to **"winning at any cost,"** resulting in a toxic **"cut-throat"** culture that destroys team morale.
3. **Reputational damage-** Eg- manipulation of financial data to show **"paper profits,"** in **Enron case**
4. **Erosion of Stakeholder Trust - Eg- The NSE Co-location Case (Chitra Ramkrishna).**
5. **Systemic Exploitation** by finding loopholes in laws or company policies. Eg- Nirav Modi - PNB Fraud
6. **Corrosive Leadership-** "If ethics are poor at the top, that behavior is copied down through the organization." - **Robert Noyce** (Intel Co-founder)
7. **Legal risks-** Eg- **Subrata Roy's (Sahara India)** massive "shadow banking" empire
8. **The "Smart Criminal" Effect-** intelligent and high energy do the wrong things faster and higher in scale. Eg- Harshad Metha

On the other hand, integrity ensures

1. **Moral Courage-** Eg- Satyendra Dubey
2. Integrity builds a **reputation** and **trust**.. Eg- Metro man **E. Sreedharan**
3. Gives **moral authority** to lead. Eg- **Captain Vikram Batra** leading from the front in Kargil War.
4. Integrity helps in **objective decision making**. Eg- T. N. Seshan as CEC
5. Ensures adherence to Gandhian **"Trusteeship principle"**

Integrity is not an optional virtue but a necessary safeguard for **ethical corporate governance**

The Fraud Triangle Theory



2019 - What is meant by the term 'constitutional morality'? How does one uphold constitutional morality?

Constitutional morality implies adherence to the **core principles and spirit** of the Constitution in a democracy. In the words of **Ambedkar**, "Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment. It has to be cultivated".

George Grote, in his **History of Greece**, described constitutional morality as a **"rare and difficult sentiment"** involving

1. Paramount reverence for **forms and procedures** of the Constitution.
2. Adherence to law while enabling **open criticism** of authority.
3. Need for **public reason, self-restraint, and trust** in institutions.

Other Pillars

1. **Rule of Law** - Eg- Article 14
2. **Institutional Integrity** - Eg- autonomy of EC, CAG
3. **Progressive Interpretation** - Eg- right to privacy

4. **Equality and Dignity** - Eg- Sabrimala Judgment
5. **Constitutional Values** - Upholding justice, liberty, equality, fraternity
6. **Separation of Powers and Checks and Balances**

Upholding constitutional morality

1. By Judiciary

- **Prioritizing Constitutional over Social Morality**- Eg- Navtej Singh Johar case
- **Protecting Dissent and Liberty**- Eg- upholding "Bail is the rule, Jail is the exception."
- **Ensuring procedural fairness** - Following due process and natural justice.

2. By Legislature

- **Debate and Deliberation**- Eg- mandatory referral of bill to Parliamentary committee (UK Model)
- **Inclusive Law-making** to protect the interests of the marginalized. Eg- **Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016**
- **Ensuring representation** - Eg- Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023
- **Social Reform through Legislation** to rectify historical injustices. Eg- Triple Talaq Act

3. The Executive

- **Self-Restraint in Power**- Eg- Following the **S.R. Bommai guidelines** to avoid the unnecessary imposition of President's Rule (Article 356).
- **Adherence to the "Rule of Law"**- Eg- Strictly following the **D.K. Basu guidelines** to prevent custodial torture.

4. Public Administration

- **Anonymity and Neutrality**- Providing "fair and fearless" advice to ministers
- **Practicing Compassion**- Using "administrative discretion" to help the last person in the queue (Antyodaya). Eg- **S. Shankaran** in implementing the **Bonded Labour Abolition Act**
- **Transparency and Honesty**- Proactive disclosure under the **RTI Act**.

5. By Citizens (The Sovereign)

- **Tolerance of Dissent**- Respecting the right of others to have a different opinion, religion, or lifestyle.
- **Performing Fundamental Duties**- Recognizing that rights come with responsibilities (Article 51A).
- **Active Participation**- Eg- Participating in **Gram Sabhas** or city ward committee meetings

Constitutional morality serves as the "**North Star**," ensuring that the ship of the state remains anchored in the values of human dignity and social justice.

2025 - "Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment but a product of civil education and adherence to the rule of law." Examine the significance of constitutional morality for public servants highlighting the role in promoting good governance and ensuring accountability in public administration.

Constitutional morality implies adherence to the **core principles and spirit** of the Constitution in a democracy.

George Grote, in his **History of Greece**, described constitutional morality as a "**rare and difficult sentiment**" involving

4. Paramount reverence for **forms and procedures** of the Constitution.
5. Adherence to law while enabling **open criticism** of authority.
6. Need for **public reason, self-restraint, and trust** in institutions.

Significance in Promoting Good Governance

1. **Promoting Transparency** - Open processes and access to information. Eg - **The "Jan Soochna Portal" in Rajasthan**
2. **Ensuring Responsiveness** - CM treats the "Right to be Heard" as a fundamental right. Eg - grievance redressal through CPGRAMS
3. **Enhancing Effectiveness** - Decisions aligned with public interest. Eg- DBT via JAM trinity

4. **Fostering Participation** - Inclusion of stakeholders in decisions. Eg- **The Nagaland "Communitisation" of Public Services**
5. **Equity and inclusiveness** - Fair distribution of resources and opportunities. Eg- **Forest Rights Act**
6. **Consensus orientation** - Mediation and dialogue over coercion. Eg- **The GST Council**
7. **Strategic vision** - Long-term constitutional goals guide policy. Eg- Sustainable development.
8. **Rule of Law** - CM ensures that the law is applied impartially, preventing "Rule by Law." Eg- **Enforcement of the Model Code of Conduct (MCC)**

Role in ensuring accountability

1. **Legal accountability** - Eg- Strictly following the **D.K. Basu guidelines** to prevent custodial torture.
2. **Political accountability** - Responsiveness to elected representatives within limits. Eg- Parliamentary questions.
3. **Social accountability** - Eg- **MGNREGA Social Audits in Andhra Pradesh.**
4. **Financial accountability** - Prudent and transparent use of public funds. Eg- **Audit of the 2G Spectrum and Coal Block Allocations.**
5. **Professional and Administrative Accountability** - CM ensures that the "Steel Frame" maintains institutional integrity. Eg- T. N. Seshan as CEC
6. **Future accountability** - promotes "Intergenerational Equity." Eg- EIA norms
7. **Moral Accountability** - CM prevents the "Banalization of Evil," where officers claim they were "just following orders." Eg- **Whistleblowing in the Vyapam Scam.**
8. **Procedural accountability** - Following due process and natural justice.

Challenges

1. **Conflict with Social Morality**- Eg- sabrimala
2. **Political Populism**
3. **Legacy of Colonial Laws**- Eg- Official Secrets Act
4. **Bureaucratic Inertia**- A "Status Quo" mindset
5. **Lack of Incentives**- Eg- "Yes-men" culture
6. **Weak Civil Education**
7. **The "Neutrality vs. Commitment" Dilemma**

Constitutional morality serves as the "**North Star**," ensuring that the ship of the state remains anchored in the values of human dignity and social justice.

Applied Ethics

2020 - Discuss the role of ethics and values in enhancing the following three major components of Comprehensive National Power (CNP) viz. human capital, soft power (culture and policies) and social harmony.

CNP is a **holistic measure** of a **nation's ability** to pursue its strategic objectives. It includes

1. **"Hard" dimensions** - military, economy, territory
2. **"Soft" dimensions** - culture, governance, social cohesion.

Role of ethics and values in enhancing CNP

Human Capital

1. **Integrity in the education system** prevents systemic corruption like paper leaks or degree fraud.
2. Values like **punctuality** and **"Dharma"** increase **productivity**. Eg- Japanese concept of **"Kaizen"**
3. Ethics promotes **meritocracy** by ensuring fairness in recruitment - prevents **"Brain Drain"**
4. Creating a **healthy and resilient population** - Values ensure that medical professionals **prioritize patient care** over commercial gain.
5. Values of **gender equality and respect** unlock 50% of the nation's latent human capital.
6. **The trusteeship model** encourages "Giving Back" through CSR or philanthropy. Eg- **Tata Group**

Soft Power

1. **Cultural diplomacy - Yoga and Ayurveda**, rooted in the value of holistic well-being, have become India's most successful soft-power exports.
2. Values of **tolerance and pluralism** projects **diversity as strength**.
3. **Ethics provides moral authority in foreign policy**- Eg- India's **"Vaccine Maitri"** based on philosophy of "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam".
4. Values of **peaceful co-existence** make a nation a **"benign power."** Eg- India's history of **Non-Alignment** and "No First Use" nuclear policy.
5. India's lead in the **International Solar Alliance** reflects a moral commitment to the planet (Prakriti) and **environmental stewardship**.
6. **Humanitarian Assistance**- Eg- **Operation SamudraBandhu** (Sri Lanka Cyclones) showcased India as a "First Responder".
7. **Democratic values** enhance global image. Eg- Free and fair elections in India.

Social Harmony

1. **Secularism and Tolerance** prevents communal conflicts. Eg- **Syncretic "Ganga-Jamuni Tehzeeb"**
2. A sense of **fraternity (Article 51A)** ensures that citizens support each other during crises.
3. When the marginalized feel the system is **"just and fair,"** they are less likely to lean toward radicalism or insurgency. Eg- hearts and minds strategy in J&K
4. Values of **"Antyodaya"** ensure that economic growth is inclusive. Eg- PM KISAN Scheme
5. High **mutual trust** among citizens builds **social capital**.
6. **Conflict Resolution through Dialogue**- Eg- **peaceful resolution of the Ram Janmabhoomi issue**

Challenges

1. **Erosion of Integrity**- Eg- politician-bureaucrat-corporate nexus (Vohra committee)
2. **Hyper-Nationalism vs. Global Values**
3. **Digital Disruption**- Eg- "Fake News" and hate speech
4. **Inequality**- 1% owning 41% wealth (Oxfam)
5. **Crisis of Character**- "Banalization of Evil"

By harmonizing its ancient wisdom (Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya) with modern constitutional values (Justice, Liberty, Equality), India can become a **Vishwaguru**

2020 - "Education is not an injunction, it is an effective and pervasive tool for all round development of an individual and social transformation". Examine the New Education Policy, 2020 (NEP, 2020) in light of the above statement.

"Education is the manifestation of perfection already in man." - **Swami Vivekananda**

Education goes beyond instruction. It is a **transformative force** shaping character, capability, and societal progress.

Education as a tool for all-round development of an individual

1. **Cognitive Agility**- Develops critical thinking and problem-solving skills
2. **Emotional Resilience**- Fosters self-awareness and empathy
3. **Ethical Moorings**- Instills values like integrity and compassion
4. **Physical and Aesthetic Growth** through sports
5. **Vocational Dignity**- fosters a "dignity of labor" and life-skills.
6. **Social Intelligence**- Schools act as "mini-societies"

Education as a tool for social transformation

1. **Social mobility**- acts as the "great leveler"
2. **Promotion of Secularism and Tolerance**
3. **Promotes democratic participation and 'informed citizenry'**
4. **Gender Equality**- Eg- "Beti Bachao Beti Padhao" movement
5. **Develops scientific temper and critical thinking**
6. Acts as a **change catalyst**. Eg- rising 'working women'

NEP 2020- Empowering Individual and Society

1. **Holistic Individual Growth** through **5+3+3+4 Structure** and Activity-based learning in Anganwadis
2. **Builds character through value Education**- integrates "Constitutional Values" (like Seva, Ahimsa, and Environmental conservation) into the curriculum.
3. **Promotes Multidisciplinary Learning**- Eg- Arts-science integration.
4. **Flexibility and Multiple Entry/Exit Options** through "Academic Bank of Credits" (ABC) ensures that individuals aren't punished for life interruptions.
5. **Vocational Integration** from Class 6 promotes **dignity of labor**
6. **Linguistic Empowerment** through 3 language formula bridges the gap between home and school
7. **Equitable Social Transformation** - Eg- **Gender Inclusion Fund** increases retention of girl students.
8. Ensuring **accessibility through Special Education Zones (SEZs)** in "Aspirational Districts"
9. **Technological Democratization**- The National Educational Technology Forum (NETF) aims to use AI and digital tools to reach the "last mile."
10. **Teacher Empowerment**- Eg- **NISHTHA** program to train teachers in innovative, learner-centric methodologies.

Challenges in Implementation

1. **Low funding**- stagnant at **4.6% of GDP** (target of **6% of GDP**)
2. **Digital Divide**- Eg- **digital apartheid** in rural India
3. **Logistics of Multilingualism**- Challenge in creating textbooks in **22+ regional languages**
4. **Federal issue** - Eg- TN opposition to **3-language formula**
5. Challenges in **mindset shift from rote to competency**.

Effective implementation of NEP can turn India into a **Global Knowledge Superpower** (Vishwaguru)

2020 - "The current internet expansion has instilled a different set of cultural values which are often in conflict with traditional values." Discuss.

As per **ITU**, over **6 billion** people globally and over **86% of households in India** use the internet. This expansion of the internet has acted as a **double-edged sword**.

Emergence of New Cultural Norms in Conflict with Traditional Norms

1. **Individualism vs. Collectivism** - Eg- emergence of nuclear families and single parent families replacing joint families
2. **Instant Gratification vs. Patience (Tapas)** - Eg- rise in **"Speed-Dating" apps** and **"Swipe Culture"** conflicting with traditional marriage systems
3. **Egalitarianism vs. Seniority** - Youth questioning traditional family hierarchies or social structures based on information found online. **Eg-** rise in inter caste marriages
4. **Transparency vs. Discretion** - **Eg-** culture of "oversharing" personal lives (Eg- vlogging) conflicts with traditional value of "keeping family matters private"
5. **Global vs. Ethnic Identity** - Eg- dilution of local linguistic dialects and regional folk songs in favor of "standardized" global pop culture.
6. **Fluid vs. Fixed Identity** - fluid "career hopping" encouraged by the internet is seen as "instability" by traditionalists who value life-long commitment.
7. **Materialism vs. Contentment** - constant consumption and luxury displays in conflict with traditional values of simple living and **"santosh."** Eg- "FOMO" (Fear of Missing Out) marketing.
8. **Digital Nomadism vs. Rootedness** - weakening of local community bonds due to high mobility among youth.
9. **Crowd Wisdom vs. Institutional Expertise** - **Eg-** diagnosing health issues via "Dr. Google" or Reddit threads instead of certified doctors
10. **Moral Relativism vs. Absolute Codes.** **Eg-** rising social tension regarding traditional views on gender roles, and diet.

Counter-Argument- Internet expansion strengthening traditional values.

1. Internet-driven **"Wellness Culture"** has expanded reach of Yoga and Ayurveda
2. **Linguistic conservation.** Eg- **"People's Linguistic Survey of India"** use digital recording to preserve tribal dialects like Santhali or Tulu
3. **Market Access for Traditional Artisans** - Eg- Platforms like **Etsy, Okhai, or GoCoop** allow Kalamkari artists to sell directly to global markets
4. **Live Streaming of temple Aartis (like Kashi Vishwanath)** allows virtual religious participation.
5. Food bloggers and YouTube channels focused on **"Village Cooking"** have documented rare regional culinary techniques. Eg- Village Food Factory
6. Modernizing Traditional Education. Eg- Vedic Math courses on Ed-tech
7. **Social Media as a Tool for "Cultural Assertion"** - **Eg-** Trends like **#SareeTwitter** or **#DhotiChallenge**
8. Emerging digital **"Sustainability" values** align with ancient traditional concepts of minimal living. Eg- **"slow fashion"** brands like **Ka Sha**

The emergence of **'glocalization'** represents the fusion of internet driven modernity and community-oriented wisdom of tradition.

2024 - The soul of the new law, Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) is Justice, Equality and Impartiality based on Indian culture and ethos. Discuss this in the light of a major shift from a doctrine of punishment to justice in the present judicial system.

While the colonial **IPC** was designed by the British to "**rule and punish**", the BNS is based on Indian ethos of Dharma and Nyaya to "**serve and provide justice**" to citizens.

Soul of BNS

Justice (Nyaya)

1. **Victim Centrality**- For the first time, the victim has a say in the withdrawal of cases.
2. **Justice for vulnerable groups**. Eg- Stringent punishment for rape and child abuse
3. **Mandatory timelines** for filing charge sheets and delivering judgments to prevent "justice delayed is justice denied."

Equality (Samata)

1. Providing **equal protection of law**. Eg- Section 103(2) penalizes **Mob Lynching**
2. **Gender Inclusivity**- expands the definition of "gender" to include **transgender individuals**
3. **Gender equality**. Eg- Uniform Age of Consent

Impartiality (Nishpakshta)

1. **Digitization of Evidence**- Eg-Mandating videography of search and seizure operations
2. **Zero FIR**- Allows a citizen to file a complaint at any police station regardless of jurisdiction
3. **Scientific Investigation**- Shifts the focus from "police testimony" to "forensic truth."
4. **Accountability of Public Servants**- Eg- "deemed sanction" if the government fails to respond to a request within 120 days.

Shift from Doctrine of Punishment to Justice

1. **From Ruler's Law to Citizen's Law**- IPC was for the British to rule India, BNS is for Indians to govern themselves.
2. **Restorative Punishment**- Section 4(f) introduces **Community Service** for the first time.
3. In the BNS structure, "**Offenses against the Human Body**" are moved to the beginning of the code, signaling that **human life** is more valuable than property rights.
4. Focus on **liberty and privacy** - Eg- Deletion of Adultery (Section 497 IPC) and Section 377
5. **Proportionality** - Punishment calibrated to gravity of offence. Eg- **Reduced punishment scales** for minor offences
6. **Victim-centric justice** - Eg- **Expanded victim compensation framework** under section 396
7. Removing **colonial laws**. Eg- Repeal of Sedition
8. **Procedural fairness** - Emphasis on due process and natural justice.
9. **Simplification**- Reducing 511 sections to 358.
10. **Protection of dignity** - Eg- **Redefinition of sexual offences** in gender-neutral and victim-protective language.
11. **Moral Healing (Prayaschit)**- upholds Indian ethos of atonement rather than eternal stigmatization of the offender.
12. **Balance between deterrence and justice** - Eg- **Death penalty retained only for rarest of rare offences**

This reorientation strengthens the **ethical legitimacy and effectiveness** of India's criminal justice system.

2025 - In the present digital age, social media has revolutionised our way of communication and interaction. However, it has raised several ethical issues and challenges. Describe the key ethical dilemmas in this regard.

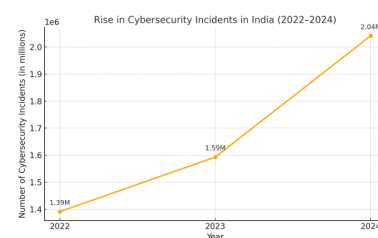
Over **6 Billion** people worldwide and **491 million** people in India use social media. However, this expansion of social media has acted as a **double-edged sword**.

Social Media Revolutionizing Communication and Interaction

1. **Elimination of Geographical Barriers**- Platforms like WhatsApp and Zoom have turned the world into a "Global Village".
2. **Shift from Passive to Active Participation**- allows users to be "**Prosumers**" (consumers and creators of content)
3. **Democratization of Voice**- Eg- **#BlackLivesMatter** or **#MeToo** movements
4. The rise of Emojis, GIFs, and Memes has created a new **universal "digital dialect"** that conveys emotion more quickly than text.
5. **Civic and Political Engagement**- Eg- leaders using X for communication

Ethical Issues and Challenges

1. **Privacy and Surveillance challenge**- Eg- the **Cambridge Analytica** scandal.
2. **Spread of Misinformation**- The "viral" nature of social media allows "Fake News" to spread six times faster than the truth.
3. **Algorithmic Echo Chambers** creating polarized "digital silos". (**India Hate Lab** report)
4. **Cognitive Warfare**- Eg- "Bot-farms" to build anti-India narratives
5. **Cyber Stalking and Harassment** - Eg- **Women targeted through doxxing and revenge porn**.
6. **Digital Addiction**- Eg- "Infinite Scroll" syndrome
7. **Post Truth world**- Eg- **Deepfakes** make it difficult to distinguish between reality and fabrication.



Key ethical dilemmas in social media

1. **Freedom of Speech vs. Content Moderation**- Balancing an individual's right to speak against the community's right to be protected from hate speech.
2. **Privacy vs. Profit**- The tension between protecting user data and the platform's need for targeted advertising revenue.
3. **Connectivity vs. Isolation**- The paradox of being "connected" to thousands online while feeling deeply isolated in the physical world.
4. **Accountability vs. Anonymity**- Anonymity protects whistleblowers but also shields those who commit harassment without consequence. Eg- rise of "**Deepfake Extortion**"
5. **Authenticity vs. Curation**- The pressure to present an "idealized self" online versus the ethical value of being true to one's real-life identity.
6. **Information Accessibility vs. Intellectual Property**- The ease of sharing leads to dilemmas regarding "Plagiarism" and the loss of revenue for original creators.
7. **Democratization vs. Polarization**- While everyone has a voice, algorithms often push people into "**Filter Bubbles**" and "**Echo Chambers**".
8. **Algorithmic Bias vs. Social Justice** - Eg- recruitment algorithms on major professional networking sites were **less likely to show high-paying technical job ads** to women
9. **Accuracy vs. Speed (The Viral Trap)** - In the "attention economy," being the first to break a story is rewarded with "reach," while slow fact-checking is penalized by the algorithm.

Social media is an **ethically "grey" space**. A robust framework of "**Digital Ethics**" is needed to cultivate "**Digital Mindfulness**."

Environmental Ethics

2018 - Suppose the Government of India is thinking of constructing a dam in a mountain valley bond by forests and inhabited by ethnic communities. What rational policy should it resort to in dealing with unforeseen contingencies

India is one of the top 10 mega diverse countries of the world (8.1% of the world's species). A rational policy for dam construction must adopt a **dynamic risk-management framework**.

"Forests are the lungs of our land. A nation that destroys it destroys itself.." - **Franklin D. Roosevelt**

Possible unforeseen contingencies

1. **Ecological degradation** - Submergence of forests and biodiversity loss.
2. **Cultural erosion** - Eg- loss of "Sacred Groves"
3. **Livelihood disruption** - Loss of agriculture, fishing, forest-based economy.
4. **Downstream ecological impact** - Eg- Altered river flow affecting agriculture and wetlands.
5. **Reservoir-induced seismicity** - Eg- **1967 Koyna Earthquake**.
6. **Waterlogging and salinisation** causing soil degradation.
7. **Health risks** - Stagnant water increasing vector-borne diseases. Eg- Malaria and dengue
8. **Social conflict** - Tensions between locals, migrants, and authorities.
9. **Climate uncertainty** - Eg- Irregular monsoon impacting reservoir levels.

Rational Policy for Dealing with Unforeseen Contingencies - must be **Adaptive, Transparent, and Restorative**.

1. **Comprehensive impact assessments for Procedural Justice**
 - a. Integrated **Environmental, Social and Cultural Impact Assessments**.
 - b. **Adaptive management**- mandatory periodic reassessments every 5 years.
2. **The "Precautionary Principle"**- If a risk (like a GLOF) is scientifically plausible but uncertain, the policy must favor environmental safety over construction.
3. Ensuring **Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC)** by Gram Sabhas under **PESA Act 1996**.
4. **The "Benefit-Sharing" Model- Making communities "partners in prosperity."**
 - a. **Just and participatory rehabilitation** - Eg- Land for land
 - b. **Ecological Insurance Fund** from electricity revenue for unforeseen disaster relief.
 - c. **Tribal Development Fund for Livelihood for Life**
5. **Cultural Heritage Mapping** before submergence.
6. **Ecological offsets** - Compensatory afforestation and biodiversity corridors. (Inter-generational Equity principle)
7. **Grievance Redressal at the Doorstep** through an independent **Project Ombudsman**.
8. **Risk governance** - Eg- Flood warning systems downstream.
9. **Decommissioning Clause**- a clear "End-of-Life" plan for the dam, ensuring the valley can eventually be restored.

"Development without Justice is merely organized plunder." By treating the mountain ecosystem with **"Bio-centric Humility,"** the state can mitigate the moral and physical risks of development.

2024 - Global warming and climate change are the outcomes of human greed in the name of development, indicating the direction in which extinction of organisms including human beings is heading towards loss of life on Earth. How do you put an end to this to protect life and bring equilibrium between the society and the environment?

The crisis of climate change is fundamentally a **crisis of values**. It is the product of pursuing **material progress** by disregarding **planetary boundaries**.

"Earth provides enough to satisfy every man's needs, but not every man's greed." - **Mahatma Gandhi**

Human Greed	Ecological & Biological Impact
Fossil Fuel addiction	Massive CO2 emissions (38.1 billion tonnes in 2025)
Deforestation for development	Habitat loss for 80% of terrestrial species.
Industrial Agriculture	Soil degradation and the "insect apocalypse"
Fast Fashion & Consumerism	microplastic pollution
Illegal Wildlife Trade	increased risk of zoonotic pandemics.
Overfishing	Collapse of marine biodiversity and "dead zones"
Urban Sprawl	Heat island effects

Ways to Bring Equilibrium Between Society and Environment

Global Level- Systemic Harmonization

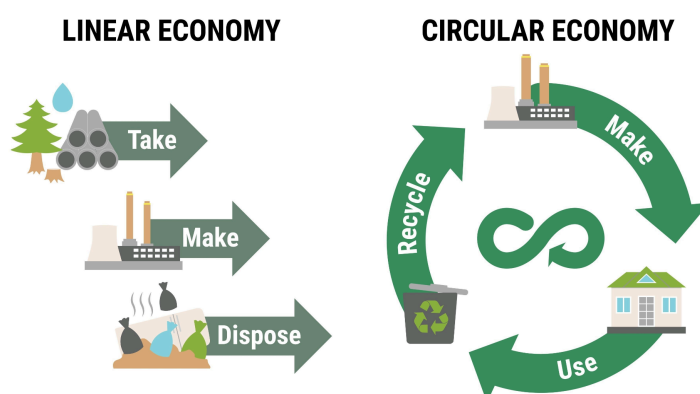
- **Decarbonization of Global Trade-** Eg- taxing products imported from high-pollution regions
- **Climate Finance Mobilization-** Fulfilling the \$100 billion annual commitment by developed countries
- **Protection of global commons** - Eg- early finalization of Global Plastic Treaty to protect oceans

Government Level- act as the "Architect of Sustainability"

- **Rights of Nature Legislation-** Formally granting legal personhood to major rivers, mountains, and forests. Eg- Ganga in India
- **Energy Transition** under **Panchamrit Targets- 500 GW** from non-fossil sources by 2030.
- **Green Urban Planning-** Developing "Sponge Cities" with permeable pavements and urban wetlands to manage flooding and "Heat Island" effects.

Business Level

- **Adopting Net-Zero Roadmaps-** Measuring and reducing **Scope 1, 2, and 3 emissions**
- **Product Stewardship-** Designing products that can be easily repaired or recycled



- **ESG Integration** in investment decisions, recognizing that "Sustainability is a Competitive Advantage."
- **Supply Chain Decarbonization**- ensuring that raw materials are sourced ethically and without deforestation.
- **Bio-Inclusive Boardrooms**- Eg- "Ecological Representative" or "Voice for Future Generations" on corporate boards

Society Level- Cultural Re-engineering

- **Mainstreaming "Environmentalism of the Poor"**- Eg- **Chipko** or **Appiko** movements where local tribes are the primary guardians of forests.
- Moving from "Environmental Science" to "**Environmental Ethics**" in school and college curricula
- **Community-Led Restoration**- Eg- volunteer movements for cleaning coastlines or planting "Miyawaki" urban forests.

Citizen Level- LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment) movement

- **Mindful Consumption** through **ethical restraint**
 - a. Switching from a "throwaway culture" to one of repair and reuse
 - b. lifestyle of "**Enoughness**"-voluntarily limiting consumption
 - c. "**Pro-Planet**" dietary Shift to protect water and soil. Eg- millet-based diets
- **Energy Citizenship**- Transitioning to rooftop solar and adopting energy-efficient appliances (LEDs/BLDC fans).
- **Waste Segregation at Source**- helps 100% composting or recycling at the municipal level.
- **Green Mobility**- Preferring public transport, cycling, or Electric Vehicles (EVs)

By applying the **Precautionary Principle** to our technology and **Intergenerational Equity** to our economy, we can move to the trajectory of "**Great Restoration**."

2025 - Keeping the national security in mind, examine the ethical dilemmas related to controversies over environmental clearance of development projects in ecologically sensitive border areas in the country.

While national security is a **non-negotiable sovereign duty**, ecological health is a **non-negotiable biological necessity**. The ethical dilemma arises because both sides claim the "Right to Life" (Article 21).

National security imperative

1. **All weather connectivity**. Eg- **Zojila** or **Sela tunnels**
2. **Logistics and supply lines**
3. **Surveillance and communication**. Eg- Installing radar stations
4. **Rapid deployment capability**
5. **Strategic deterrence**. Eg- Great Nicobar Port in IOR
6. **Disaster response access**
7. **Hearts and minds strategy**. Eg- vibrant village program

Ethical dilemmas related to environmental clearance

1. **Utilitarianism vs. Deontology/ right vs right dilemma** - sacrificing a unique, irreplaceable ecosystem for the "greater good" of national security.
2. **Connectivity vs ecology** - Highway projects degrade fragile ecosystems. Eg- Char Dham Pariyojana
3. **Anthropocentrism vs. Ecocentrism**- Does a border road have more "value" than the extinction of an endemic species?
4. **National interest vs local rights** - Eg- **Forest Conservation (Amendment) Act 2023** exempts projects within 100km of borders from certain clearances.
5. **Speed vs scrutiny** - Eg- Strategic exemptions from EIA.
6. **Secrecy vs transparency** - Classified projects limit public accountability.
7. **Intergenerational justice dilemma** - Immediate defence gains create long-term ecological vulnerability. Eg- Landslides due to hill cutting.
8. **Human safety vs wildlife protection** - Eg- Border fencing affecting elephant movement.
9. **Development vs sustainability** - Infrastructure improves access but undermines long-term ecological balance.

10. Slippery Slope dilemma - extension of 'national security exemptions' to other projects in future

Case studies

1. **Great Nicobar Project** - Loss of **130 sq. km of rainforest**
2. **Arunachal Frontier Highway** - Fragmentation of the **Dibang Valley**
3. **Zojila Tunnel** - Disruption of **permafrost and glacial hydrology**

Way Forward

- **Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA)**
- **Green Engineering.** Eg- "Eco-bridges"
- **Independent Oversight Body** comprising both military strategists and ecologists
- **Restorative Compensation**

There is need to shift from "Environmental Clearance" to "**Environmental Integration**" for sustainable and "**Sensitive**" security paradigm.

Ethics in IR

2020 - "The will to power exists, but it can be tamed and be guided by rationality and principles of moral duty." Examine this statement in the context of international relations.

The statement represents the "2nd great debate" in International Relations between **Realism** and **Liberalism/Idealism**.

The "Will to Power"- The Realist Foundation

1. **Human Nature**- humans (and by extension, states) have an innate **animus dominandi**-a lust for power. (Hans Morgenthau.)
2. **Anarchy**- In an international system with no global government, states must seek power to ensure their **survival**.
3. **Zero-Sum Game**- if one state gains power, another feels less secure, leading to the "**Security Dilemma**." Eg- Pakistan's nuclear tests after India
4. **Hegemonic Ambition**- Eg- **China's "Global Civilization Initiative"**
5. **Territorial Expansionism**- Eg- **Russia's ongoing annexation of Ukrainian territories**
6. **Nuclear Proliferation** for deterrence and prestige. Eg- **North Korea and Iran**
7. **Technological Supremacy**- Eg- **U.S.-China "Chip War" (2025)**
8. **Resource Weaponization**- Eg- **OPEC+ production cuts** in late 2024

Taming through "Rationality"- The Neoliberal Approach

1. Rationality suggests that **cooperation provides better long-term outcomes** than conflict.
2. **Interdependence**- Trade creates "mutual destruction" risks that make peace more logical. Eg- U.S.-China trade
3. **International Institutions**- bodies like the UN, WTO, and IMF provide a framework for negotiation.
4. **Regime Theory**- It is easier to follow a shared rule than to fight for dominance every time a dispute arises.
5. **Standardization of Global Tech**- Eg- **The Global AI Safety Summit (2025)**
6. **Collective Security**- Eg- **Sweden and Finland's 2024-25 integration into NATO**

Guiding by "Principles of Moral Duty"- The Constructivist and Liberal View

1. IR is not just about cold logic, but about **Norms, Ethics, and Identity**.
2. **Democratic Peace Theory**- "moral duty" toward democratic values prevents democracies from going to war with one another.
3. **Human Rights**- "will to power" (state sovereignty) is tamed by the moral duty to prevent mass atrocities. Eg- **Responsibility to Protect (R2P)** doctrine
4. **Constructivism**- Thinkers like Alexander Wendt argue that "anarchy is what states make of it." If states adopt a "Kantian" philosophy, the will to power is replaced by a **will to cooperate**.
5. **The "Nuclear Taboo"**- Eg- **The G20 2024 New Delhi Declaration** reiterating that "the use or threat of nuclear weapons is inadmissible."
6. **Human Rights Advocacy**- Eg- **ICC arrest warrants (2024-25)** for leaders accused of war crimes

Challenges

1. **The Return of Geopolitics**- Eg- Russia-Ukraine conflict and tensions in the South China Sea
2. Rise of **protectionism and territorial nationalism**.
3. **Erosion of Multilateralism**. Eg- crisis of credibility of UN
4. Asymmetric warfare. Eg- state sponsored terrorism.

The statement is an appeal for **Enlightened Realism** through the "rational" design of institutions and a shared "moral" commitment to human dignity

2021 - "Refugees should not be turned back to the country where they would face persecution or human right violation." Examine the statement with reference to ethical dimension being violated by the nation claiming to be democratic with open society.

Violation of **principle of non-refoulement** creates a "**Liberal Paradox**," where the values used to define the state are discarded at its borders.

Refugee Rights

1. **Right to Asylum** (Article 14 of the UDHR).
2. **Right to Life and Liberty**
3. **Right to Non-Discrimination**
4. **Freedom from Torture**
5. **Right to Due Process**
6. **Family unity**
7. **Access to basic services**

Ethical Dimensions Violated by Refoulement

1. **Violation of Kantian Categorical imperative**- treats refugees as mere "means" to a political end border security.
2. Violation of **Justice as Fairness (John Rawls)** by sending refugees to face **persecution or human right violation**
3. **Breach of Universal** values like liberty, right to life. Eg- Aylan Kurdi death
4. **Erosion of Human Dignity** and an active denial of their **Intrinsic Worth**. Eg- Detention camps for asylum seekers.
5. **Loss of moral leadership** and **global solidarity**- Undermines credibility in human rights advocacy
6. **Erosion of rule of law** - Ignoring international refugee conventions. Eg- Violations of 1951 Refugee Convention.
7. **Failure of the "Good Samaritan" Principle** i.e. preventing great harm (death) with comparatively small cost.
8. **Failure of humanitarian duty** - Moral obligation to protect the vulnerable is ignored.
9. **Discrimination** - Selective hospitality based on race, religion, or politics. Eg- Preferential treatment of Ukrainian refugees over African refugees in Europe.
10. **Epistemic Injustice**- Refusing to believe or listen to the testimony of a persecuted person before deportation.
11. Many refugee crises (Syria, Afghanistan, Myanmar) are linked to historical colonial or military interventions by democratic powers. Refoulement is a rejection of **Restorative Justice**.
12. **The "Slippery Slope" of Rights**- Eg- devaluing the rights of its own marginalized citizens in future
13. **Failure of Communitarian Ethics** as nations are seen as part of a global "International Society" with mutual duties.
14. Causes **long-term psychological and ethical decay** in the host nation's own moral fabric.

Way Forward

1. **Individualized Screening**- Eg-I "Credible Fear" interview.
2. **Judicial Oversight** to ensure **Procedural Justice**.
3. **Principle of Proportionality. in Enforcement**
4. **Burden Sharing**. Eg- EU Migration Pact
5. Enforcing **"Responsibility to Protect"** by UN

The ultimate best practice for a democratic society is to apply the **Rawlsian "Veil of Ignorance"** to every policy.

2022 - Russia and Ukraine war has been going on for the last seven months. Different countries have taken independent stands and actions keeping in view their own national interests. We are all aware that war has its own impact on the different aspects of society, including human tragedy. What are those ethical issues that are crucial to be considered while launching the war and its continuation so far? Illustrate with justification the ethical issues involved in the given state of affair.

"War does not determine who is right - only who is left." - **Bertrand Russell**

The Russia-Ukraine conflict serves as a grim case study for the tension between **Realpolitik** (national interest) and **Global Ethics**.

Stance by Different Countries

Country	Stance	Primary National Interest
USA & NATO	Military/Financial Aid	weakening Russia.
China	"Pro-Russia" Neutrality	weakening Western bloc dominance
India	Normative stance	Energy security (discounted oil)
EU Nations	Direct Support	Regional Security

Impact of War on Different Aspects of Society

1. **Human Tragedy**- Russian casualties approaching **1.4 million** in 2025
2. **Displacement Crisis**- Over **14 million** Ukrainians
3. **Global Food Insecurity**
4. **Energy Volatility**- "energy poverty" for low-income households.
5. **Environmental "Ecocide"**- Eg- destruction of the Kakhovka Dam
6. "War Trauma" for an entire generation of children
7. **Erosion of "Rules-Based Order"** (violation of the UN Charter)

Ethical issues to be considered while launching and continuing war

1. Adherence to principles of **Just War Theory** - **Jus ad Bellum** (the right to go to war) and **Jus in Bello** (right conduct within war).
2. **Impact on Human Rights**
 - a. **Mass Casualties**
 - b. **War inflation** disproportionately impacting poor
 - c. **Refugee crisis**
3. **Violation of principle Proportionality**. Eg- mass bombing of cities like Kiev
4. **Utilitarian principle** of 'greatest happiness' violated due to prolonged war.
5. Principle of **Last resort** not followed as Russian invasion was **preemptive**.
6. **Responsibility to future generations** violated. Eg- damage to infrastructure and ecology.
7. **Truth and transparency** principles not followed. Eg- online propaganda and misinformation.
8. **Global injustice** - Eg- Wheat shortages in Africa due to Black Sea blockade.
9. **Moral restraint in weapon use** not followed. Eg- cluster bomb and vaccum bomb used by Russia.
10. Reports of torture and summary executions of Prisoners of War violate the **Geneva Conventions**
11. **Failure in ensuring accountability for war crimes**

The war is a reflection of "rationality" becoming servant to "Will to Power." A just resolution requires **Jus post Bellum** framework (Justice after War)

2023 - 'International aid' is an accepted form of helping 'resource-challenged' nations. Comment on 'ethics in contemporary international aid'. Support your answer with suitable examples.

"The proper aim of giving is to render the giver unnecessary." - **John Pulman**

In contemporary IR, the ethics of aid are often caught between **Cosmopolitanism** and **Realpolitik**.

Ethical principles of international aid

1. **The Humanitarian Imperative**- Eg- aid to **Turkey and Syria after the 2023 earthquakes**.
2. **Global Solidarity and Cosmopolitanism**. Eg- India's **vaccine maitri** initiative
3. **Distributive Justice**- Eg- **Norway's** commitment to spending 1% of its GNI on aid.
4. **Capacity Building** to realise **Right to development**. Eg- **India's development assistance to Afghanistan** (Salma dam, parliament building)
5. Aid channeled through **global bodies** to ensure neutral distribution. Eg-**World Food Programme**.
6. **Global Public Goods**- Eg- **COVAX** initiative for global vaccine equity during COVID-19.
7. **Peacebuilding** - Eg- Post-conflict reconstruction in Afghanistan.
8. **Climate justice** - Eg- Loss and damage fund for small island states.
9. **Gender justice** - Targeting women's empowerment. Eg- Solar Mama's of Africa

Ethical Issues in Contemporary International Aid

1. **The Trap of "Tied Aid" (Economic Paternalism)**- Eg- **IMF structural adjustments** conditionalities
2. **Strategic Charity (Realpolitik)**- Aid is used as a bribe for UN votes or military access. Eg- **US aid to Pakistan**.
3. **The "Debt Trap" Diplomacy** leading to a loss of sovereignty. Eg- **Hambantota Port in Sri Lanka**
4. **The "White Savior" Complex**- Designing solutions in Western boardrooms without local consultation.
5. **Corruption**- Eg- Diversion of humanitarian aid by **militias in Yemen** to fuel the ongoing conflict.
6. **Dependency Creation**- Constant aid stifle local industry and making a nation "addicted" to foreign help.
7. **Paternalistic Philanthropy**- Eg- Concerns over the **Gates Foundation's** outsized influence on global malaria and polio policies.
8. **Lack of Transparency and accountability ("Black Box")** - Weak monitoring and evaluation.
9. **Neo-colonial influence** - Donors shaping domestic policies.
10. **Politicisation of aid** - Selective generosity based on alliances. Eg- prioritization of Ukrainian refugee by EU
11. **Short-termism** - Focus on visibility over sustainability.

For global "equity" and "justice" aid must be guided by principles of **transparency, localization, and long-term empowerment**.

2024 - "It is not enough to talk about peace, one must believe in it; and it is not enough to believe in it, one must act upon it." In the present context, the major weapon industries of the developed nations are adversely influencing continuation of number of wars for their own self-interest, all around the world. What are the ethical considerations of the powerful nations in today's international arena to stop continuation of ongoing conflicts?

"Wars begin where ethics ends."

In today's world, conflicts persist not only because of political disputes but also due to powerful economic interests, especially the global arms industry.

Role of major weapon industries in continuation of wars

1. **Profit motive** - Eg- Surge in global arms sales after Ukraine war.
2. Wars act as "testing grounds"
3. **Lobbying in foreign policy**. Eg- Military-industrial complex in the US.
4. **Arms exports to conflict zones** - Eg- Saudi Arabia as largest defence importer
5. **Proxy wars** - Eg- supply of arms to terrorist organisations
6. **Economic dependence** - Jobs and revenue from defence industry.
7. Capitalising on **security dilemma**.

Ethical considerations for powerful nations to stop ongoing conflicts

1. **Deontology over Utilitarianism** by **prioritizing** duty to protect human life over GDP growth. Eg- Restrict arms to regimes violating human rights.
2. **Ethical assessment** of short and long term damage of war. Eg- over **1.4 million** Russian deaths in Ukraine war
3. **Responsibility to prevent harm** - Eg- Arms embargoes in active war zones.
4. **Non-complicity principle** to avoid moral responsibility for atrocities. Eg- Stopping arms to Saudi Arabia during Yemen war.
5. Adherence to ethical standards of the **Arms Trade treaty**

Ethical Criterion	Description
Risk Assessment	Probability of weapons fueling genocide
Gender-Based Violence	Probability of weapons facilitating sexual violence
Diversion Control	Risk of weapons ending in black market

6. **Addressing Strategic Hypocrisy-** Eg- advocating for a "Rules-Based Order" while signing multi-billion dollar arms deals.
7. **Support for peace processes** - Eg- UN-led peace talks.
8. **Transparency and accountability** - Eg- Parliamentary approval for arms sales.
9. **Disarmament leadership.** Eg- Nuclear disarmament treaties.
10. **Ethical foreign policy** - Values-based diplomacy over realpolitik.
11. **Corporate responsibility** - Eg- Arms export compliance laws.
12. **Transitioning to "Peace Economies".** Eg- Investing in **Green Technology** as alternatives to defense manufacturing

Real peace requires a "**Moral Disinvestment**" from war. This can be achieved by taming "**Will to Power**" of the defense industry by "**rationality**" and "**moral duty**" of the state.

2025 - Carl von Clausewitz once said, "War is a diplomacy by other means." Critically analyse the above statement in the present context of contemporary geo-political conflict.

In his seminal work **On War**, **Carl von Clausewitz** suggests that war is not an end in itself but a rational instrument of statecraft used to achieve political goals when traditional diplomatic dialogue fails.

War is diplomacy by other means

1. Force used to extract **political concessions**. Eg-Russia's invasion of Ukraine to block NATO expansion.
2. War alters facts on ground to **strengthen bargaining position**. Eg-Control of Crimea and Donbas.
3. **Power signalling** to deters rivals. Eg-China's military exercises near Taiwan.
4. War reshapes **diplomatic alignments**. Eg-Pakistan-China 'all weather friendship' after 1962 and 1965 wars
5. **Resource diplomacy** -Control over energy and minerals via force.
6. **Negotiation through attrition** -Prolonged fighting forces compromise. Eg-US withdrawal from Afghanistan
7. **Policy of 'bait and bloodletting'**. Eg- US support to Ukraine to weaken Russia
8. **Peace enforcement.** Eg-NATO intervention in Kosovo.
9. War is used as a tool for **regime change**. Eg- US intervention in Iraq

Counter-argument- War is not diplomacy but its failure

1. **Humanitarian catastrophe** violates **utilitarian principle** of 'greatest happiness'. Eg- over **1.4 million** Russian deaths in Ukraine war
2. **Rise of Non-State Actors-** Groups like **ISIS-K** dont pursue war for diplomatic aims but for ideological and religious aims.
3. War used to consolidate domestic **political legitimacy** rather than national interest. Eg-Wartime

nationalism in Pakistan.

4. Due to '**complex interdependence**' war as a diplomatic means is not a **rational choice**. Eg- US-China relations
5. War leads to **breakdown of diplomatic negotiations channels** for peaceful resolution. Eg- Security Council paralysis.
6. While diplomacy is based on reason war is based on **passion**.
7. The acute **security dilemma and zero-sum mentality** fosters diplomatic distrust and reduce possibility of diplomatic cooperation. Eg- India's suspension of Indus water treaty.

As per Deontological ethics, means of war cant justify any ends. As pointed out by **Bertrand Russell**, "War does not determine who is right - only who is left."

Attitude

2020 - "Hatred is destructive of a person's wisdom and conscience that can poison a nation's spirit.' Do you agree with this view? Justify your answer.

"Holding on to anger is like grasping a hot coal with the intent of throwing it at someone else; you are the one who gets burned." - **The Buddha**

Hatred is a deep-seated negative emotion marked by hostility, prejudice and desire to harm, which clouds moral judgement and rational thought.

Hatred destroying a person's wisdom and conscience

1. **Corruption of character (Virtue Ethics)** - prejudice and anger replace virtues like patience and tolerance. Eg- German society under Hitler
2. **Erosion of practical wisdom** and balanced judgement. Eg- Mob violence due to rumours on WhatsApp
3. **Loss of empathy** and compassion. Eg- In the **Rwandan Genocide (1994)**, Tutsis dehumanised as "cockroaches"
4. **Cognitive bias amplification** - Hatred confirms prejudice, not truth. Eg- Conspiracy theories about communities.
5. Stoics like **Marcus Aurelius** argued that hatred is a "**sickness of the soul.**" Eg- torture of PoW or Concentration camps
6. **Vindictiveness over Justice-** A wise person seeks justice, while a hateful person seeks revenge. Eg- **Treaty of Versailles (1919)** was driven by French desire for "revenge"
7. **Violation of Kantian duty** - Treating others as means, not ends. Eg- "My Lai Massacre" during Vietnam war.
8. **Instrumentalisation of reason** - Intelligence used to harm, not to heal. Eg- doxxing
9. **Psychological degradation** - Hatred increases anxiety, anger, and stress. Eg- Radicalised individuals like Ajmal Kasab.
10. **Stagnation of Personal Growth-** Hateful person focuses on past grievances rather than on future or finding peace.

Hatred Poisoning a Nation's Spirit

1. **Erosion of Social Capital-** A nation's spirit relies on "Fraternity." Hatred replaces cooperation with suspicion. Eg- communal riots during elections
2. **Institutional Decay-** When hatred enters the national spirit, institutions also get weaponized. Eg-
3. **The Normalization of Violence-** When hatred is mainstream, violence is seen as a "cleansing" act. Eg- ethnic cleansing of Jews in Nazi Germany
4. **Weakening of democratic culture.** Eg- Labelling critics as anti-national.
5. **Fragmentation of national identity.** Eg- Religion-based or ethnicity-based politics.
6. **The Post-Truth Nation-** propaganda takes over objective truth due to 'superfluous masses'.
7. **Global reputational damage.** Eg- **Apartheid regime in South Africa**
8. **The Cycle of Reciprocity-** Hatred in one group triggers hatred in another, creating a "Death Spiral." Eg- Ethnic conflict in Manipur
9. **Stifling of Creativity and Innovation** as hateful spirit is a closed spirit. Eg- "**Brain Drain**" from 1930s Germany.
10. **Intergenerational Trauma-** Hatred is a legacy that ensures the spirit of the nation remains poisoned for decades. Eg- **Partition of India (1947)**

"Darkness cannot drive out darkness; only light can do that. Hate cannot drive out hate; only love can do that." - **Martin Luther King Jr.**

2020 - A positive attitude is considered to be an essential characteristic of a civil servant who is often required to function under extreme stress. What contributes to a positive attitude in a person?

"A man is but the product of his thoughts; what he thinks, he becomes." - **Mahatma Gandhi**

In public administration, a **positive attitude** is a mental and emotional mindset that focuses on constructive solutions, resilience, and optimism, even when faced with systemic constraints.

Extreme Stress	Role of Positive attitude
Crisis management	Objectivity in decision making. Eg- T. N. Seshan
Political pressure - Eg- Transfer threats.	Integrity and EI
Public scrutiny	Citizen centrality to build public trust
Law and order tensions - Eg- Riots and protests	Leading from the front for high team morale
Resource scarcity	Innovative problem solving. Eg- crowdfunding
Conflicting stakeholder interests. Eg- Farmers vs industry land disputes.	Empathy and calmness to de-escalate tensions
Moral dilemmas - Eg- Truth vs Loyalty.	Ensuring ethical consistency
Work-Life Imbalance	Endurance for preventing "Burnout"

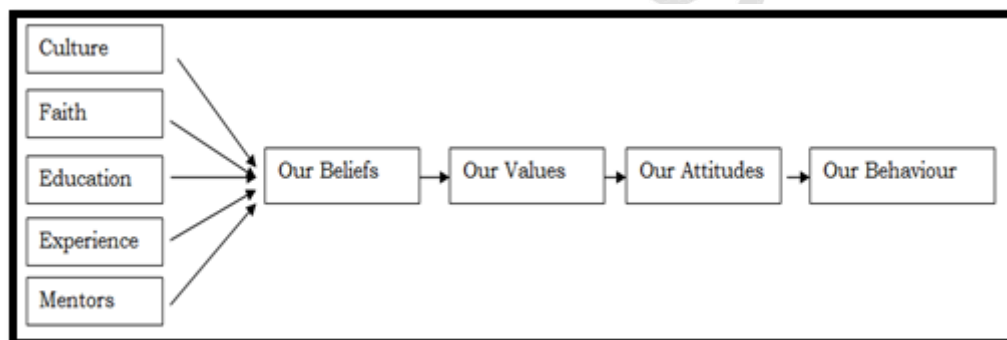
Developing a positive attitude is a process of "psychological conditioning" involving several factors-

1. **Detachment (Nishkama Karma)**- Focus on the process, not just the result.
2. **Moral Clarity (Sense of Mission)**- Viewing work through the lens of a "higher calling." Eg- Commitment to public welfare.
3. **Emotional Intelligence (EQ)**- Recognizing and managing one's own triggers through 'mindfulness techniques' like "Box Breathing" (4-4-4-4 technique)
4. **Cognitive Reframing**- Viewing challenges as opportunities. Eg- Seeing a **punishment posting** as a chance to reform.
5. **Physical Well-being**- A healthy body serves as the "hardware" that supports the "software" of a positive mind.
6. **Social Support Systems (The "Ventilator" Effect)**- Eg- Spending quality time with **family or hobby groups** to decompress from official stress.
7. **Competence** and confidence is born from knowledge. Eg- domain specialisation among civil servants (Hota Committee)
8. **Gratitude and "Small Wins"** - Acknowledging incremental progress helps maintain morale when the "big picture" looks bleak.
9. **Intellectual Curiosity and Continuous Learning** - A mind that is constantly learning perceives "change" as exciting rather than threatening.

Thus, a positive attitude transforms a bureaucrat from a "cog in the machine" into a **leader of change**.

2021 - Attitude is an important component that goes as input in the development of human. How to build a suitable attitude needed for a public servant?

Attitude refers to a person's predisposition to think, feel and act in a particular way. In the words of **Lou Holtz**, "Ability is what you're capable of doing. Motivation determines what you do. Attitude determines how well you do it."



Importance of Attitude in the Development of Humans

1. **Knowledge Function**- Attitudes help humans **organize and simplify complex information**. Eg- positive attitude toward "Digital Governance" make it easier to implement new tech-tools.
2. **Ego-Defensive Function**- Protects self-esteem and emotional stability. Eg- Coping with failure without losing confidence.
3. **Value-Expressive Function**- Attitudes allow humans to express their central values.
4. **Instrumental function** - Guides behaviour to achieve rewards and avoid punishment.
5. **Adaptive (utilitarian) function** - Helps individuals adjust to social and professional environments
6. Attitude acts as a "**behavioral compass**," ensuring consistency in beliefs and actions, leading to a sense of "Wholeness."
7. **Decision-making function** - Influences judgement and choices.

Ways to build a suitable attitude for a public servant

1. Internalising **constitutional and ethical values**. Eg- Ethics training at LBSNAA.
2. **Sensitivity Training** through **village immersion** programs for breaking the "Elite Bubble."
3. Practicing **Self-reflection** for recognising biases and emotional triggers. Eg- reflective journaling.
4. Developing **Emotional intelligence** through mindfulness and counselling sessions for managing stress and conflict constructively.
5. **Role modelling**. Eg- "**Technocratic Optimism**" of E. Sreedharan for a solution-oriented attitude
6. Learning **responsibility** through transparency. Eg- Social audits and RTI processes.
7. **Continuous learning** for updating knowledge and perspectives. Eg- Mid-career training.
8. **Adversity Simulation** - Creating high-pressure scenarios in a controlled environment to build **resilience**. Eg- "crisis-room" simulation during training
9. **Peer-to-Peer De-biasing**- Group sessions to identify and dismantle hidden prejudices and develop **objectivity**. Eg- Using **Implicit Association Tests (IAT)**
10. **Feedback Loops**- Direct citizen interaction to develop compassion and leadership. Eg- Jan Sunwais
11. **Historical Analysis of Failures** to build **Proactiveness**. Eg- Analyzing the **Bhopal Gas Tragedy** to foster an attitude of "Precautionary Vigilance" rather than "Post-facto Compliance."

These can help in shifting from a "**Command and Control**" mindset to "**Collaborate and Care**" attitude among public servants

2022 - The Rules and Regulations provided to all the civil servants are same, yet there is difference in the performance. Positive minded officers are able to interpret the Rules and Regulations in favour of the case and achieve success, whereas negative minded officers are unable to achieve goals by interpreting the same Rules and Regulations against the case. Discuss with illustrations.

In the realm of public administration, the rulebook provides the "**Letter of the Law**," but the officer's mindset provides the "**Spirit of the Law**."

Alternative introduction

Rules and regulations are meant to ensure **uniformity, legality and accountability** in administration. However, their application depends on the **attitude, values and interpretation** of the officers.

Positive-Minded Officers- Interpreting Rules for Success

1. **Invoking "Residual Powers" for Innovation.** Eg- IAS Prashant Nair used crowdfunding for community kitchens under **Project Compassion** in Kozhikode.
2. **Flexible during Emergencies.** Eg- procuring cylinders via "Spot Purchase" clause during COVID 19
3. **Promoting "Ease of Doing Business".** Eg- Interpreting licensing norms to encourage entrepreneurship.
4. **Utilizing "Spirit of the Law" to uphold justice** Eg- Allowing free treatment under government hospitals for undocumented homeless.
5. Adherence to **utilitarian** principle of "**greatest happiness**" by creative rule interpretation. **Eg-** using MNREGA funds to build school playgrounds
6. **Environmental Stewardship** using the "Precautionary Principle." Eg- Halting a project near a wetland by interpreting "Ecological Sensitivity" broadly
7. **Humanizing Service Rules-** Dealing with subordinates with empathy. **Eg-** Granting "Child Care Leave" to a single father
8. **Inclusive urban planning.** Eg- Designating specific "Vending Zones" for street hawkers
9. **Active Conflict Resolution-** **Eg-** Using "Section 144" to create a "Protected Space" for a peaceful dialogue between administration and aggrieved public.

Negative-Minded Officers- Interpreting Rules Against the Case

1. Suffers from "**Bureaucratic Apathy**" or "**Status Quo Bias**." Eg- resistance to "E-Office" by citing vague "Data Privacy" concerns.
2. **Red Tapism-** Eg- denying **ration** under PDS due to biometric error (Jharkhand case)
3. **"Passing the Buck"-** Interpreting jurisdiction rules to avoid taking responsibility. Eg- delay in medical aid in inter-state border accidents
4. Avoid **transparency and accountability.** Eg- invoking "National Security" clause to deny RTI
5. **Strict "Hierarchy" interpretation- Example-** Refusing to meet a citizen delegation because they did not have a "Prior Appointment".
6. **Focus on Punitive Action-** Interpreting discipline rules solely for punishment.
7. **Obstructive Auditing-** Using "Post-Facto" criticism to stall future initiatives.
8. **Resource Hoarding-** Refusing to spend funds to avoid "Audit Objections." Eg- consisting lapsing of **Tribe Sub-plan funds**

There is need to shift from a "**Command and Control**" mindset to "**Collaborate and Care**" attitude for transforming civil services from "rusty" steel frame to "**trusted steel frame**"

Emotional Intelligence

2019 - "Emotional Intelligence is the ability to make your emotions work for you instead of against you". Do you agree with this view? Discuss.

Emotional Intelligence is the capacity to recognise, understand, manage and use emotions constructively in oneself and in others.

"When awareness is brought to emotion, power is brought to your life." - **Daniel Goleman**

EI making emotions work for you

1. Self-awareness

1. **Recognising emotions** before they control behaviour helps manage anger and frustration
2. **Understanding emotional triggers** helps in better preparation. Eg- Awareness of anxiety before public speaking.
3. **Realistic self-assessment** helps in knowing one's strengths and weaknesses.

2. Self-regulation

- a. **Impulse control** - Prevents emotional outbursts and rash decisions. Eg- Not shouting at subordinates during stress.
4. **Ensures emotional balance** - Eg- Calm leadership during disasters.
5. **Builds adaptability** to changing situations. Eg- Accepting e-governance by civil servants

3. Motivation

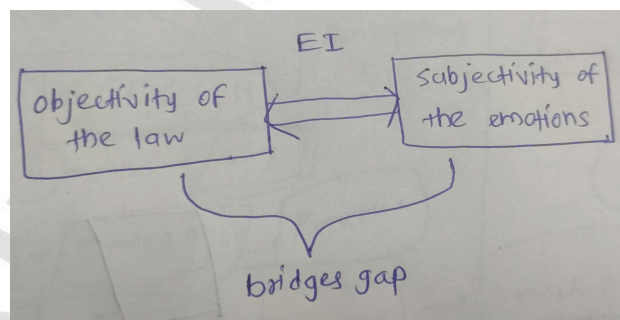
- a. **Positive drive** helps turn frustration into determination. Eg- Officers working overtime during elections to ensure fairness.
- b. **Optimism** despite setbacks. Eg- ISRO successfully launching Chandrayan 3 after failure of Chandrayan 2

4. Empathy

- a. Understanding others' feelings and viewpoints helps developing **broader outlook and leadership**
- b. **Sensitivity to diversity** helps civil servants in handling community tensions sensitively.

5. Social skills

- a. **Effective communication** by expressing emotions constructively. Eg- PM addressing the nation during a pandemic.
- b. **Relationship building** - Eg- **Operation Sadbhavana** of Army in J&K for trust and cooperation with locals



Counter-arguments- How Emotional Intelligence can make emotions work against you

1. **Emotional manipulation** - Eg- caste politics by leaders
2. **Emotion-reading skills can enable fake empathy and dishonesty.**
3. **Rationalising wrongdoing.** Eg- justifying corruption as "systemic necessity."
4. **Emotional burnout** due to constant **emotional regulation**
5. **High empathy may lead** to compromise on objectivity and firmness
6. **Conflict avoidance** instead of **necessary confrontation.**
7. **Emotional intelligence without moral compass** becomes a tool of self interest

Thus, EI + Integrity is needed to develop virtues of wisdom and compassion.

2020 - What are the main components of emotional intelligence (EI)? Can they be learned? Discuss.

Emotional Intelligence is the capacity to recognise, understand, manage and use emotions constructively in oneself and in others.

"When awareness is brought to emotion, power is brought to your life." - **Daniel Goleman**

Main Components of Emotional Intelligence

1. Self-Awareness -

- Involves recognizing your own emotions, strengths, weaknesses, and triggers in real-time.
- Abraham Lincoln** recognised his "melancholy" and managed through humor, storytelling, and developing immense empathy

2. Self-Regulation -

- Involves managing and redirecting disruptive emotions and impulses.
- It prevents "Amygdala Hijack"-where the emotional brain takes over the rational brain.
- Eg- **Captain Sullenberger** - Regulated fear during engine failure to land safely on Hudson.
- Warren Buffett's emotional detachment** strategy - stay greedy when others are fearful

3. Motivation-

- Inner drive to pursue goals with energy and persistence
- Eg- **Marie Curie** worked in a shed for years to isolate radium.
- Viktor Frankl** survived the Holocaust by finding "meaning" in his suffering. (**Logotherapy**)

4. Empathy -

- Ability to understand the emotions and perspectives of others.
- Essential for cross-cultural communication and building trust within a team.
- Eg- **Mahatma Gandhi**- lived like poor to "feel" their struggle.

5. Social Skills -

- Ability to manage relationships, build networks, resolve conflicts and inspire others.
- Satish Dhawan (ISRO)** taking blame for SLV-3 mission failure
- Arif Sheikh leading "amcho police, amcho baster"

Unlike IQ, which is largely fixed by early adulthood, EI is based on **Neuroplasticity** - the brain's ability to form new neural pathways through repeated behavior. It can be learned through

Self-Awareness

- Reflection and self-observation** through **mindfulness and meditation**. Eg- Vipassana.
- Reflective journaling** - Writing daily emotional experiences and triggers.
- 360-degree feedback** from peers and seniors to reveal blind spots.

Self-Regulation

- Stress-management training** to calm emotional arousal. Eg- "crisis-room" simulation in training
- Cognitive Reframing**- Viewing challenges as opportunities. Eg- Seeing a **punishment posting** as a chance to reform.
- Delay techniques** - Eg- 10-second rule before responding in anger.
- Physical regulation** - Exercise, sleep and breathing control helps in emotional stability.

Motivation

- Defining meaningful **personal and professional goals**. Eg- SMART goal frameworks.
- Positive psychology practices** -Eg- Writing three positive outcomes daily.
- Role Modelling**. Eg- "**Technocratic Optimism**" of E. Sreedharan for a solution-oriented attitude

Empathy

- Perspective-taking exercises** enhance empathy and understanding. Eg- **village immersion** programs
- Direct citizen interaction** exposes civil servants to **diversity** - develop compassion and leadership.
Eg- Jan Sunwais

Social Skills

- Communication skills training**. Eg- Public speaking workshops.
- Life experiences** gradually deepen emotional understanding.

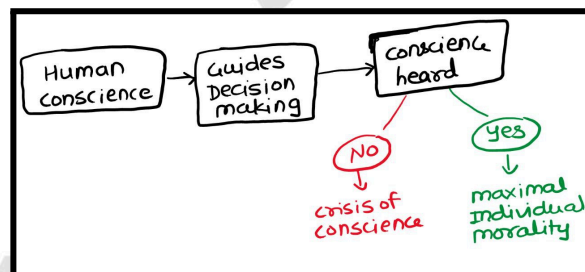
Thus, Emotional Intelligence is not innate or fixed. It is **learnable, trainable and improvable**.

2021 - In case of crisis of conscience does emotional intelligence help to overcome the same without compromising the ethical or moral stand that you are likely to follow? Critically examine.

A **crisis of conscience** arises when a person faces a conflict between personal values, professional duties, social pressures and moral principles. **EI** can play decisive role in navigating this crisis.

Role of EI in overcoming crisis of conscience

1. **Self-awareness** helps identify moral discomfort early.
2. **Self-regulation** prevents panic, fear or anger from dictating action. ("Amygdala Hijack") Eg- **Sanjiv Chaturvedi (IFS)** exposing corruption in AIIMS
3. **EI** provides **Moral clarity** through reflection - prevents impulsive action.
4. **EI** builds **courage through emotional control** and enables ethical action. Eg- Whistleblowers like **Satyendra Dubey**.
5. EI develops **communication skills** that enables respectful dissent. Eg- **Mahatma Gandhi**
6. EI helps in **conflict management** without hostility. Eg- **Nelson Mandela** balancing justice and reconciliation.
7. It builds **resilience** to endure consequences of ethical action. Eg- punitive transfers of **Ashok Khemka**
8. **Empathy and perspective-taking** helps avoid moral absolutism and promotes fairness. Eg- Justice **V.R. Krishna Iyer** institutionalising PIL
9. **Inner peace** through EI reduces cognitive dissonance after ethical choice. Eg- **Satish Dhawan** taking responsibility for failure



On the other hand, EI can also undermine ethical stand

1. EI can be used to **justify** unethical actions. Eg- **bureaucrats** blaming "political pressure" to justify complicity.
2. **Rationalisation of wrongdoing** - Managing guilt instead of correcting behaviour. Eg- "sanskritization of corruption"
3. **Manipulation of others' emotions**. Eg- **Cult leaders like Jim Jones** emotionally controlled followers into mass suicide.
4. **Conflict avoidance** instead of **necessary confrontation**. Eg- **Corporate HR heads** ignoring harassment complaints to "avoid workplace disruption".
5. **Institutional conformity** - EI helps individuals to adapt to unethical cultures. Eg- Eichmann committing atrocities under "orders" (**banality of evil**)
6. **Emotional burnout** due to constant **emotional regulation**
7. **High empathy may lead** to compromise on objectivity and firmness
8. **Ethical relativism** - Eg- Justifying censorship or surveillance as "necessary for public safety."

Thus, EI is **value-neutral** and a "**means**" to an "**end**." It needs a strong **moral compass** to develop **virtuous character**.

2023 - What really matters for success, character, happiness and lifelong achievements is a definite set of emotional skills - your EQ- not just purely cognitive abilities that are measured by conventional IQ tests." Do you agree with this view ? Give reasons in support of your answer.

In the modern world, **IQ** provides the technical "entry ticket" to a profession, but **EQ** determines how far an individual climbs and how meaningful their life becomes.

"In a high-IQ job pool, soft skills like discipline, drive, and empathy mark those who emerge as outstanding." - **Daniel Goleman**

Importance of EQ

For Professional Success

- **EQ ensures Leadership effectiveness.** Eg- **Satya Nadella** transformed Microsoft by emphasising empathy and collaboration.
- Purely cognitive skills often freeze under extreme stress ("**Amygdala Hijack**"). EQ provides calmness and resilience. Eg- **Captain "Sully" Sullenberger**
- EQ helps in building **effective Team Synergy** by providing "Psychological Safety" to members. (Google's "**Project Aristotle**")

For Character and Integrity

- EQ builds **Self-Regulation against Greed.** Eg- integrity of **Ashok Khemka**
- It builds **moral courage** to endure consequences of ethical action. Eg- Whistleblowers like **Satyendra Dubey.**
- In high EQ person, **empathy acts as a Moral Compass.** Eg- **Mahatma Gandhi** lived like poor to "feel" their struggle.

For Happiness and Well-being

- **Self-awareness** allows individuals to recognize negative thought patterns before they lead to burnout.
- **Inner peace** through EI reduces cognitive dissonance after ethical choice. Eg- **Satish Dhawan** taking responsibility for failure
- EQ helps build **healthy relationships and supportive social bonds.** Eg- open communication in family helping build trust

For Lifelong Achievements

- **Persistence** in the face of failure is an emotional skill, not an analytical one. Eg- **Thomas Edison** failed 1,000 times before inventing the lightbulb.
- **Self-awareness** allows an individual to accept criticism and learn from mistakes.
- **Adaptability-** In a changing world, the ability to "unlearn" and "relearn" requires emotional flexibility.

Limitations of IQ

1. Knowledge without integrity and EQ is **dangerous and dreadful.** Eg- **White-collar criminals**
2. High IQ does not ensure **emotional awareness.** Eg- Brilliant engineers failing as managers due to poor people skills.
3. **Poor leadership capacity.** Eg- **Sachin Tendulkar** as a best batsman but poor captain
4. High vulnerability to **anxiety and stress.** Eg- rising suicide and depression among software engineers
5. High IQ does not ensure **interpersonal success.** Eg- **Isaac Newton had poor social relationships**
6. High IQ does not guarantee **adaptability.** Eg- companies like Nokia, Kotak etc

To live a truly successful and happy life, one must balance the **logic of the head** with the **intelligence of the heart.**

Aptitude and Foundational Values

2021 - Identify five ethical traits on which one can plot the performance of a civil servant. Justify their inclusion in the matrix.

"The civil service is not a service of status, but a service of responsibility. It is a commitment to the conscience of the nation." - **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**

The performance of a civil servant cannot be measured merely by **targets achieved**, but must be evaluated through the **lens of ethical conduct**.

1. **Integrity (Consistency and Honesty)** - It implies that the officer's actions are consistently aligned with their stated moral values, regardless of external pressure.
 - **Justification**
 - Builds **public trust** on reliability and honesty of administration.
 - Gives **moral courage** to say "No" to illegal orders from political superiors.
 - Ensures **consistency**, predictably and adherence to the code of conduct.
 - **Eg- Ashok Khemka (IAS)**
2. **Objectivity (Rationality and Merit)** - ensures that decisions are based on evidence, logic, and the rule of law, rather than personal bias, nepotism, or political leanings.
 - **Justification**
 - **Fairness**- It ensures equal treatment of every citizen
 - **Promotes meritocracy and efficiency**
 - Decisions are less likely to be overturned by courts.
 - **Eg- E. Sreedharan** - objectivity in the awarding of contracts for the Delhi Metro.
3. **Compassion and Empathy (Human-Centric Service)** - involves understanding the pain of the citizens and acting to alleviate it.
 - **Justification-**
 - Ensures that the "spirit of the law" is used to achieve **Social Justice**
 - Brings **democratic ethos** into civil services (instead of rigidity and indifference)
 - Helps understand **ground realities**.
 - **Improves welfare delivery effectiveness.**
 - **Eg- Armstrong Pame (IAS)**- build a 100km road via crowdfunding
4. **Accountability (Responsibility and Transparency)** - It is the obligation of an official to be answerable for their decisions and the consequences thereof.
 - **Justification-**
 - Prevents the arbitrary use of discretionary powers.
 - **Improves transparency and legitimacy.**
 - **Encourages better performance standards.**
 - **Builds democratic credibility.**
 - **Eg- Vinod Rai** exposed "presumptive losses" in the 2G Spectrum and Coal block allocations.
5. **Emotional Intelligence**
 - **Justification**
 - Enables calm decision-making under pressure.
 - Improves conflict resolution and negotiation.
 - Builds trust and team cohesion.
 - Enhances ethical judgement by integrating empathy and reason.
 - **Eg- Krishna Teja (IAS)** coordinated evacuation during Kerala floods

These values ensure that governance is not only efficient but **ethical, humane and resilient**.

2021 - Identify ten essential values that are needed to be an effective public servant. Describe the ways and means to prevent non-ethical behaviour in the public servants.

Effective public service is built on the foundation of the "**Spirit of Service**" and "**Constitutional Morality**."

Ten Essential Values for an Effective Public Servant

1. **Integrity**- "Integrity is doing the right thing even when no one is watching." Eg- **Ashok Khemka**
2. **Objectivity**- Making decisions based on merit, data, and logic rather than personal bias, nepotism, or political pressure.
3. **Neutrality**- Providing the same quality of service and advice regardless of which political party is in power. Eg- **T.N. Seshan**
4. **Empathy and Compassion**- Sensing the pain of the citizens and using the law to alleviate their suffering. Eg- **S. Shankaran** in implementing **Bonded Labour Abolition Act**
5. **Accountability**- Taking full ownership of decisions and outcomes.
6. **Transparency and openness** in decision making. Eg- proactive disclosure under RTI
7. **Dedication to Public Service**- Eg- **Armstrong Pame (IAS)** built a 100km "People's Road" in Manipur through crowdfunding.
8. **Fortitude (Moral Courage)**- Eg- Whistleblowers like **Satyendra Dubey**.
9. **Probity**- Strict adherence to ethical standards in public life, especially in financial and decision matters
10. **Efficiency and Economy**- following **utilitarian maxim** of 'greatest happiness' Eg- **E. Sreedharan** finishing mega-projects ahead of schedule and under budget.

Ways and Means to Prevent Non-Ethical Behavior

Internal Controls

- "Value-based Training" during induction and mid-career. (2nd ARC)
- **Emotional Intelligence (EI)**- Teaching officers to manage stress and "Amygdala Hijack"
- Transitioning from a rigid "Code of Conduct" (punitive) to a "**Code of Ethics**" (aspirational).

External Controls

- Strengthening bodies like the **Lokpal, Lokayukta, and CVC** to investigate complaints without political interference.
- **E-Governance**- Reducing human interface in public service delivery to eliminate the "discretionary space." Eg- DBT
- **Independent Office of Ethics** to oversee financial disclosures and provide ethics counseling to officers. (US model)
- Institutionalising **Integrity Pacts** (OECD/Transparency International recommendation)

Empowering the Citizen (Social Controls)

- **Social Audits**- Eg- MGNREGA social audits in Andhra Pradesh
- **Strengthening RTI**. Eg- mandatory disclosures under section 4
- **Institutionalising Citizen's Charters** based on **Sevottam Model**

"Power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely, unless restrained by ethics and accountability."

2021 - Should impartial and being non-partisan be considered as indispensable qualities to make a successful civil servant? Discuss with illustrations.

A civil servant derives legitimacy not from popular mandate but from the **trust of neutrality, fairness and rule-based conduct**.

Impartiality is the quality of making decisions based on objective criteria, merit, and facts.

Non-partisanship is a state of being politically neutral and serving the government with equal dedication, regardless of personal political leanings.

Importance of Impartiality

1. Impartiality ensures that **all citizens are treated equally** regardless of status, identity or political affiliation. Eg- Kiran Bedi towing vehicle of PM
2. Maintaining **Public Trust and belief in fairness** of administration - strengthens legitimacy. Eg- UPSC selection process
3. **Promotes inclusivity and Social Justice**- Eg- **S. Shankaran** in implementing the **Bonded Labour Abolition Act**
4. **Prevents misuse of power**. Eg- **Ashok Khemka (IAS)** cancelled illegal land deals irrespective of political interests.
5. **Enables fair grievance redressal**. Eg- **U Sagayam (IAS)** conducted impartial inquiries into granite mining.
6. Ensures **efficiency in resource utilization**. Eg- **E. Sreedharan** ensuring objectivity in the awarding of contracts for the Delhi Metro.
7. Promotes **professional ethics** by ensuring adherence to principles of neutrality, selflessness and accountability.

Importance of Non-partisanship

1. **Continuity of Government**- Eg- The smooth transition of power in India since independence
2. **Fearless Advice** on the legality of a political directive.
3. **Efficient Crisis Management**- In communal or ethnic tensions, an impartial officer is the only trusted mediator.
4. It prevents the "**cooking of books**" (like GDP or employment figures) to suit a political party's re-election campaign.
5. **Prevents politicisation of bureaucracy**. Eg- **Durga Shakti Nagpal** resisting political interference.
6. **Maintains professional autonomy**. Eg- RBI independence in monetary policy.
7. Prevents **authoritarian tendencies and 'spoils system.'**
8. Safeguards **rule of law** by resisting politically motivated actions. Eg- EC's fair application of MCC

Thus, impartiality and non-partisanship are **cardinal virtues** for preserving **democratic fairness** as well as **institutional and ethical integrity**.

2022 - Apart from intellectual competency and moral qualities, empathy and compassion are some of the other vital attributes that facilitate the civil servants to be more competent in tackling the crucial issues or taking critical decisions. Explain with suitable illustrations.

“The purpose of power is to serve, not to rule.” To adhere to this ethos, civil servants need combination of IQ, ethics and compassion.

Intellectual Competency

1. **Analytical Ability-** Eg- **V.K. Pandian (IAS)** used data analytics in sports governance in Odisha.
2. **Technological Literacy-** Eg- **J. Satyanarayana (IAS)** pioneered the 'e-Seva' project
3. **Domain Expertise-** Eg- **Dr. M. S. Swaminathan** (Green Revolution)
4. **Professionalism.** Eg- Sreedhran
5. **Legal Acumen.** Eg- **S.R. Sankaran (IAS)** used land laws to restore land to marginalized tribals.
6. **Communication Skills**
7. **Innovation-** Eg- IAS **Prashant Nair** used crowdfunding for community kitchens

Moral Qualities

1. **Integrity-** Eg- **C.G. Somiah (IAS)**- unblemished career as the CAG of India.
2. **Fortitude-** Eg- **U. Sagayam (IAS)**, spent a night in a graveyard to protect evidence in a mining scam.
3. **Probity-** Eg- **Satyendra Dubey (IES)** exposed corruption in the Golden Quadrilateral project.
4. **Accountability and transparency.** Eg- **Satish Dhawan** taking blame for SLV-3 mission failure
5. **Impartiality-** Eg- **T.N. Seshan as CEC**
6. **Selflessness-** Eg- **Randhir Prasad Verma (IPS)** sacrificed his life while fighting armed robbers

Importance of Empathy and Compassion

1. Empathy helps in prioritizing **utilitarian virtue of “greatest good”** over self-interest.
2. **Humanizing the Rule of Law-** Ensures rules don't become tools of oppression. **Eg-** authorizing PDS ration for a poor with leprosy.
3. **Bridging the Trust Deficit-** Compassion builds a bond between the state and the citizen.
4. **Conflict De-escalation (building social capital)-** **Eg- P. Vijayakumar (IPS)** using empathetic negotiation to prevent communal flares in Coimbatore.
5. **Inclusive Infrastructure-** Eg- **Dr Nidhi Patel** pioneering space lab for rural students in Bilaspur.
6. **Rehabilitation over Punishment-** **Eg- Kiran Bedi** introduced Vipassana and education in Tihar.
7. **Resource Mobilization-** A compassionate officer inspires others to give. **Eg- Armstrong Pame (IAS)** built a 100km "People's Road" using crowdfunding
8. **Going beyond administrative duty** to help others. **Eg- Inayat Khan (IAS)** adopted the daughters of CRPF martyrs
9. Compassion guides in using **discretionary powers** in an ethical manner. Eg- delaying the demolition of encroachment until finalization of the rehabilitation **plan**.
10. **Vulnerability Mapping-** Empathy helps civil servants to identify those who don't have a "voice." Eg- **Tamboli Ayyaj** building hospitals for Adivasi's in maoist areas.

Thus, empathy and compassion enable civil servants to convert **authority into service and law into justice**.

Public/Civil Service Values

2021 - Besides domain knowledge, a public official needs innovativeness and creativity of a high order as well, while resolving ethical dilemmas. Discuss with suitable examples.

“In times of complexity, imagination is more important than knowledge.” - **Albert Einstein**

Innovativeness and creativity enable officials to find **morally acceptable and practically workable** solutions.

Ethical Dilemmas in Civil Services

1. **Development vs. Displacement-** Narmada Bachao Andolan (Medha Patkar vs. State).
2. **Confidentiality vs. Transparency-** Whistleblowing
3. **Political Pressure vs. Neutrality**
4. **Freedom of Speech vs. Public Order**
5. **Environment vs. Livelihood**
6. **Efficiency vs. Equity**
7. **Personal Ethics vs. Professional Duty**
8. **Loyalty vs. Truth**

Importance of Domain Knowledge

1. **Policy Formulation-** Dr. Manmohan Singh's economic expertise during the 1991 reforms.
2. **Infrastructure Excellence-** E. Sreedharan's engineering mastery in the Delhi Metro.
3. **Economic Management-** Raghuram Rajan's knowledge of monetary policy at the RBI.
4. **Scientific Progress-** Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam's aerospace knowledge in the Missile Program.
5. **Legal Accuracy-** T.N. Seshan's deep understanding of Constitutional Law as CEC.
6. **Health Administration-** Dr. Gagandeep Kang's virology expertise during vaccine development.
7. **Agricultural Transformation-** Dr. M.S. Swaminathan in the Green Revolution.
8. **Digital Governance-** Nandan Nilekani's tech background in the creation of Aadhaar.
9. **Financial expertise-** Vinod Rai's auditing expertise as the CAG of India.

Need for Innovation and Creativity to Resolve Ethical Dilemmas

1. **Resource optimization-** Eg- **Armstrong Pame (IAS)** crowdfunded the "People's Road".
2. **Reformative justice-** **Kiran Bedi (IPS)** introduced Vipassana in Tihar to reform rather than just punish.
3. Prioritising **social welfare** by bypassing bureaucratic rigidity. Eg- **Prashant Nair's** "Operation Sulaimani" - Use of crowdsourced coupons to feed hunger
4. Innovative solutions for **winning 'hearts and minds'** and delegitimizing insurgency. Eg- **Saurabh Kumar (IAS)** built "Education City" in Dantewada.
5. Finding **'out of the box' solutions**. Eg- **IPS chetan singh Rathore** using National Anthem to manage protesting crowd.
6. Helps in **effective management of crisis situations**. Eg- **Dr. Syed Sehrish Asgar** used her office as a "human call center" during communication blackouts in J&K
7. Helps in **collaborative problem solving** rather than a top-down approach. Eg- **S.R. Sankaran** involved local community elders in identifying bonded laborers.
8. Creativity and innovations facilitate adoption of technology to solve problems. Eg- **Dr. Hari Chandana** building pavements from recycled plastic in Hyderabad.
9. Can help address **social stigma** associated with manual work. Eg- **Ritu Sain (IAS)** turned waste-pickers into "Green Commandos".

Ethical governance today requires not just knowledge of rules but **moral imagination, contextual intelligence and creative problem-solving**.

2018 - State the three basic values, universal in nature, in the context of civil services and bring out their importance.

"The purpose of power is to serve, not to rule." To adhere to this ethos, civil servants must imbibe certain universal values of **'Ethical Governance.'**

Three basic values and their importance

1. **Integrity (Honesty and probity in conduct)** - Acting truthfully, transparently and consistently with moral and legal standards.
 - **Importance-**
 - Prevents corruption and misuse of public office.
 - Builds citizens' trust in institutions.
 - Protects fairness in decision-making.
 - Strengthens legitimacy of the state.
 - **Illustration-** Sanjiv Chaturvedi (IFS) exposed corruption in AIIMS despite facing harassment.
2. **Impartiality (Fairness and non-discrimination)** - Treating all individuals and groups equally, without bias based on identity, status or political affiliation.
 - **Importance-**
 - Upholds equality before law.
 - Prevents favouritism and discrimination.
 - Stability during Political Transitions
 - Impartial officer acts as a trusted mediator in conflict resolution
 - **Illustration-** T.N. Seshan, as CEC, enforcing MCC in fair manner.
3. **Accountability** - Being answerable for decisions and taking responsibility for consequences.
 - **Importance-**
 - **Feedback Loop-** facilitates a two-way communication between state and citizens
 - Improves transparency and performance.
 - Enables democratic control over bureaucracy.
 - Promotes ethical and careful decision-making.
 - **Illustration** - Ashwini Vaishnaw took moral responsibility after the Odisha train accident by personally overseeing relief and restoration.



Other values (Nolan Principles)

1. Selflessness
2. Objectivity
3. Openness
4. Leadership
5. Commitment to constitutional morality
6. Probity
7. Empathy and Compassion
8. Anonymity

These values ensure that **"Steel Frame"** does not **rust or bend** under the weight of corruption and bias.

2019 - What are the basic principles of public life? Illustrate any three of these with suitable examples

"Public office is a public trust." - **Grover Cleveland**

Public life refers to the **activities and roles** individuals undertake in the service of the community, whether as elected representatives, civil servants, or members of public bodies.

Basic principles of public life

Nolan Principles

1. **Selflessness**
2. **Integrity**
3. **Objectivity**
4. **Openness**
5. **Leadership**
6. **Accountability**
7. **Honesty**
8. **Leadership**

Indian constitutional ethos

1. **Transparency**
2. **Impartiality**
3. **Responsiveness**
4. **Commitment to public interest**

Three basic values and their importance

1. **Integrity (Honesty and probity in conduct)** - Acting truthfully, transparently and consistently with moral and legal standards.
 - **Importance-**
 - Prevents corruption and misuse of public office.
 - Builds citizens' trust in institutions.
 - Protects fairness in decision-making.
 - Strengthens legitimacy of the state.
 - **Illustration-** Sanjiv Chaturvedi (IFS) exposed corruption in AIIMS despite facing harassment.
2. **Impartiality (Fairness and non-discrimination)** - Treating all individuals and groups equally, without bias based on identity, status or political affiliation.
 - **Importance-**
 - Upholds equality before law.
 - Prevents favouritism and discrimination.
 - Stability during Political Transitions
 - Impartial officer acts as a trusted mediator in conflict resolution
 - **Illustration-** T.N. Seshan, as CEC, enforcing MCC in fair manner.
3. **Accountability** - Being answerable for decisions and taking responsibility for consequences.
 - **Importance-**
 - **Feedback Loop-** facilitates a two-way communication between state and citizens
 - Improves transparency and performance.
 - Enables democratic control over bureaucracy.
 - Promotes ethical and careful decision-making.
 - **Illustration** - Ashwini Vaishnaw took moral responsibility after the Odisha train accident by personally overseeing relief and restoration.

These values ensure that "**Steel Frame**" does not **rust or bend** under the weight of corruption and bias.

2022 - Write short notes on the following in 30 words each -

1. **Constitutional Morality** - Adherence to the core philosophies of the Constitution even when they clash with popular social norms or traditional beliefs.

Key pillars

- a. **Rule of Law** - Eg- Article 14
 - b. **Institutional Integrity** - Eg- autonomy of EC, CAG
 - c. **Progressive Interpretation** - Eg- right to privacy
 - d. **Equality and Dignity** - Eg- Sabrimala Judgment
 - e. **Constitutional Values** - Upholding justice, liberty, equality, fraternity
 - f. **Separation of Powers and Checks and Balances**
2. **Conflict of Interest** - A situation where a public official's private interests could improperly influence their official decisions. Eg- **Chanda Kochar case**

Reasons

- a. Dual roles - official and private interests overlapping
 - b. Post-retirement employment expectations (revolving door)
 - c. Political affiliations or ideological bias
 - d. Gifts, hospitality and favours from stakeholders
 - e. Weak disclosure and transparency mechanisms
 - f. Discretionary power
 - g. Lack of ethical awareness and training
3. **Probity in Public Life** - The quality of having strong moral principles, including absolute honesty, transparency, and the active application of integrity in every administrative action. Eg- **U. Sagayam (IAS)** - 1st IAS officer to declare his personal assets

Key pillars

- a. Integrity and Honesty
 - b. Transparency and accountability
 - c. Impartiality and objectivity
 - d. Ethical leadership
4. **Challenges of Digitalization**
 - a. **Digital Divide (Rural-Urban & Gender Gap)**
 - b. **Cybersecurity and Financial Fraud.** Eg- digital arrests
 - c. **Inclusion - Exclusion errors.** Eg- Jharkhand PDS case
 - d. **Data Privacy and Surveillance Concerns**
 - e. **Digital Illiteracy**
 5. **Devotion to Duty** - The unwavering commitment to professional obligations, often involving extreme personal sacrifice and prioritizing public welfare over personal comfort.

Examples

- a. **Randhir Prasad Verma** (IPS) sacrificed his life while fighting armed robbers
- b. Whistleblowers like **Satyendra Dubey**
- c. **S.R. Sankaran** - "an ideal people's IAS officer" remained unmarried for service of nation

2018 - What is meant by public interest? What are the principles and procedures to be followed by the civil servants in public interest?

Public interest is a broad, **dynamic concept** that refers to the **welfare, well-being, and general good** of the community as a whole and prioritizing **collective benefits** over individual or sectional advantages.

"A public official is a fiduciary of the public's interest." - **Paul H. Douglas**

Principles to be Followed in Public Interest

1. **Maxim of utilitarianism** - "greatest happiness of greatest number"
2. **Selflessness**- Prioritizing public gain over personal material benefits.
3. **Integrity**- Absolute consistency between one's values and actions.
4. **Objectivity**- Making decisions based solely on merit, facts, and evidence. Eg- E. Sreedharan in awarding delhi metro projects
5. **Accountability**- Being answerable for the consequences of administrative decisions. Eg- **Lal Bahadur Shastri** resigning as Railway Minister following a major train accident.
6. **Openness (Transparency)**- Proactively sharing information to foster public trust. Eg- **U. Sagayam (IAS)** - 1st IAS office to declare his personal assets
7. **Impartiality**- Acting without bias toward any caste, creed, or political affiliation. Eg- T. N. Seshan as CEC
8. **Empathy and Compassion**- Sensitivity toward the plight of the marginalized. Eg- **Prashant Nair's** "Operation Sulaimani" - Use of crowdsourced coupons to feed hunger
9. **Commitment to Public Service**- Viewing the job as a "mission". Eg- **Dr. Rajendra Bharud (IAS)** setting up an oxygen plant in tribal Nandurbar before the second COVID wave
10. **Leadership**- Leading by example to uphold ethical standards. Eg- **S.R. Sankaran** - "an ideal people's IAS officer" remained unmarried for service of nation
11. **Courage of Conviction**- Eg- **Durga Shakti Nagpal (IAS)** taking a firm stand against the powerful sand mining mafia in Noida.

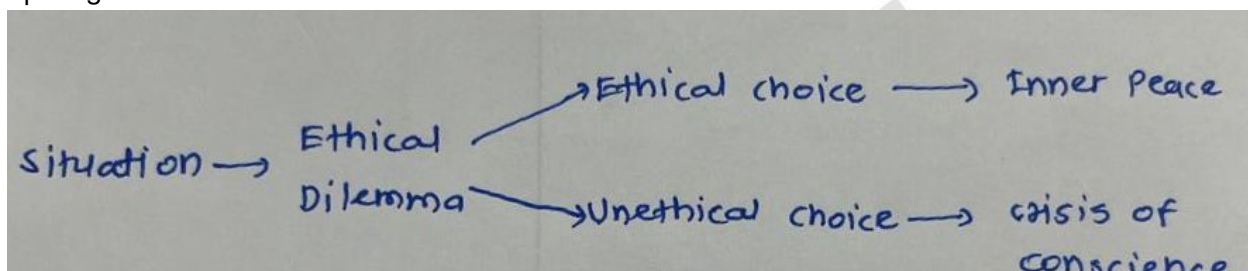
Procedures to be Followed in Public Interest

1. Adherence to **code of conduct** and **code of ethics**
2. **Adherence to the Rule of Law**- Every decision must be rooted in constitutional or statutory authority
3. **Due Process in Procurement**- Eg- using **GeM-Government e-Marketplace**.
4. **Public Consultation**- Eg- "Gram Sabhas" or "Jan Sunwais" before major projects
5. **Grievance Redressal Mechanisms**- Eg- **CPGRAMS**
6. **Recusal from Conflict of Interest**
7. **Evidence-Based Policy Making**- Eg- GATI Shakti mission

These principles and procedures ensure that governance is not only efficient but **ethical, humane and resilient**.

2018 - Explain the process of resolving ethical dilemmas in Public Administration.

An **ethical dilemma** in public administration occurs when a public official is faced with a choice between two or more competing values or interests.



Ethical Dilemmas in Civil Services

1. **Development vs. Displacement**- Narmada Bachao Andolan (Medha Patkar vs. State).
2. **Confidentiality vs. Transparency**- Whistleblowing
3. **Political Pressure vs. Neutrality**
4. **Freedom of Speech vs. Public Order**
5. **Environment vs. Livelihood**
6. **Efficiency vs. Equity**
7. **Personal Ethics vs. Professional Duty**
8. **Loyalty vs. Truth**

Process of Resolving Ethical Dilemmas

1. **Identification of the Ethical Issue** - clearly define the conflicting values and recognize the stakes for all parties involved is the primary step.
2. **Information Gathering** - collect all relevant data, consult subject matter experts, and understand the ground reality of the situation.
3. **Analyzing the Legal Framework** - The decision must first pass the test of **Legality**.
4. **Applying Ethical Frameworks for evaluating options**
 - **Utilitarianism**- Which choice brings the "greatest good for the greatest number"?
 - **Deontology**- What is my absolute "Duty" as a public servant?
 - **Social Justice (Rawls)**- Does this decision benefit the "least advantaged" member of society?
 - The "middle path" to balance the extremes.
5. **Assess the impact** of various options on different stakeholders.
6. **Final Decision and Review** - After choosing the most ethical path, the official should implement the decision and monitor its impact for course correction.

Resolving ethical dilemmas is an exercise in **Constitutional Morality**. Under **Mahatma Gandhi's Talisman**, the ultimate resolution of any dilemma lies in whether the decision empowers the weakest.

2019 - What do you understand by the term 'public servant'? Reflect on the expected role of public servant.

A **public servant** is an individual entrusted by the state to exercise authority and perform functions on behalf of society in order to implement laws, deliver public services and protect citizens' rights and welfare.

"A public official is a fiduciary of the public's interest." - **Paul H. Douglas**

The Expected Role of a Public Servant

1. The role of a public servant has shifted from being a **colonial "ruler"** to a **"facilitator"** of development.
Eg- from 'license raj' to 'EoDB'
2. **Policy Advisor**- Providing "objective and honest" advice to the government.
3. **Guardian of the Constitution**- Ensuring that every administrative action aligns with constitutional values.
4. **Bridge between State and Citizen** by ensuring **fair and effective** implementation of policies.
5. **Agent of Social Change**- Actively working to dismantle regressive social norms. Eg- **S. Shankaran** in implementing the **Bonded Labour Abolition Act**
6. **Custodian of Public Funds**- Practicing "Financial Probity."
Eg- **E. Sreedharan** - objectivity in the awarding of contracts for the Delhi Metro.
7. **Upholder of Integrity**- Resisting bribes and external pressures to maintain professional standards. Eg- **U. Sagayam (IAS)** declaring his assets publicly.
8. **Leader by Example**- Inspiring subordinates to work with the same level of dedication and ethics. Eg- **Kiran Bedi (IPS)** reforming Tihar jail
9. **Impartial Arbitrator**- Resolving disputes between different social or economic groups without bias. Eg- **R.N. Ravi**, played a pivotal role in the Naga peace talks
10. **Empathetic Listener**- Being accessible to the grievances of the poorest citizens.
11. **Innovator in Governance**- Finding low-cost, high-impact solutions to local problems. Eg- IAS **Prashant Nair** used crowdfunding for community kitchens
12. **Protector of the Marginalized**- Ensuring that the **"last person"** (**Antyodaya**) receives the benefits of the state. Eg- **Dr Nidhi Patel** pioneering space lab for rural students in Bilaspur.
13. **Crisis Manager**- Providing leadership during natural disasters or civil unrest. Eg- **Dr. Rajendra Bharud (IAS)** setting up an oxygen plant in tribal Nandurbar before the second COVID wave
14. **Regulatory Watchdog**- Ensuring that private entities follow safety and ethical standards. Eg- **Vinod Rai** as CAG exposed "presumptive losses" in the 2G Spectrum and Coal block allocations.
15. **Environmental Steward**- Eg- **Dr. Hari Chandana** building pavements from recycled plastic in Hyderabad.

"The civil service is not a service of status, but a service of responsibility. It is a commitment to the conscience of the nation." - **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**



2019 - "Non-performance of duty by a public servant is a form of corruption". Do you agree with this view? Justify your answer.

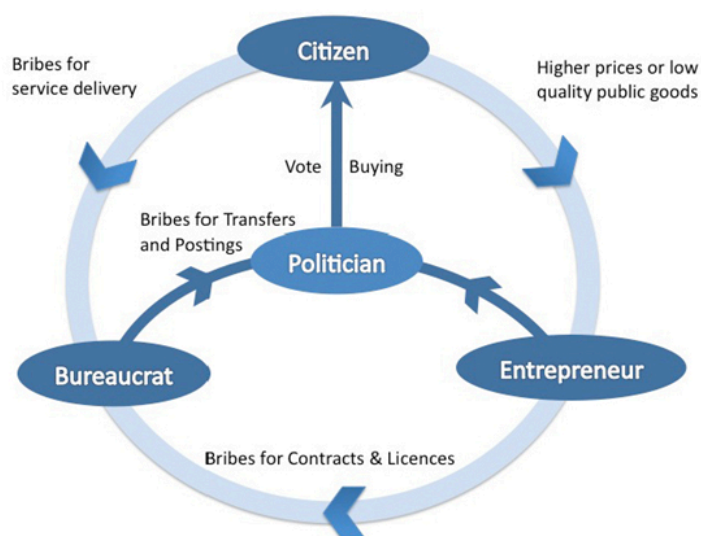
"The greatest corruption is the corruption of duty." - **Edmund Burke**

Conventionally, corruption is viewed as the "misuse of public office for private gain," however, in a broader ethical sense, **omission** (failing to act) is as damaging as **commission** (acting wrongly).

Non-performance of duty as form of corruption

- Breach of the "Social Contract"** - The public pays taxes in exchange for services. Non-performance is a unilateral breach of this trust.
- Theft of Public Salary**- Taking a salary while deliberately avoiding work is "financial fraud" against the taxpayer. Eg- "Ghost employees" in various municipal bodies
- Creation of "Induced" Corruption**- Deliberate delays (Red Tapism) are often used to force citizens to pay "speed money."
- Violation of the Right to Life**- Eg- delay in safety audits leading to **Mundra building tragedy**.
- Delays in project clearance lead to **Policy Paralysis**- High economic "opportunity cost." Eg- delays in environmental clearances in PPP projects
- Inaction is a betrayal of the "**fiduciary duty**" owed to the citizens. Eg- Police officers failing to register an FIR in SC, ST atrocity cases.
- Wastage of Resources**- Eg- food grains rotting in **FCI** godowns while tribal populations suffer from malnutrition.
- When officials don't work, citizens **lose faith in democracy** and turn to **extra-constitutional means for justice**. Eg- rise of "**vigilante justice**"
- Moral hazard** - Inaction normalises irresponsibility.
- Facilitates exploitation**. Eg- Labour inspectors not enforcing minimum wage laws.

THE WHEEL OF CORRUPTION



Ways to Curb Corruption and Non-Performance

- Code of Ethics & Code of Conduct.** (2nd ARC)
- Implementation of Citizens' Charters**- Eg- SAKALA (Karnataka Guarantee of Services Act)
- Giving legal backing to **Social Audits**
- Leveraging Technology**. Eg- Faceless Income Tax Assessment
- Strengthening the **Lokpal and Lokayuktas** to investigate "maladministration" and "neglect"
- Independent Commission Against Corruption** - "**Hong Kong Model**"
- Performance-linked accountability**. Eg- 360 degree feedback

A culture of **active responsibility, diligence and accountability** is needed to deal with the menace of corruption.

2025 - "One who is devoted to one's duty attains highest perfection in life." Analyse this statement with reference to a sense of responsibility and personal fulfilment as a civil servant.

"Your right is to work only, but never to its fruits." - **Bhagavad Gita**

The statement reflects the idea of **Karma-Yoga** - that sincere devotion to one's duty leads to both moral excellence and inner fulfilment. For a civil servant, devotion to duty converts power into service.

Devotion to Duty leading to Sense of Responsibility

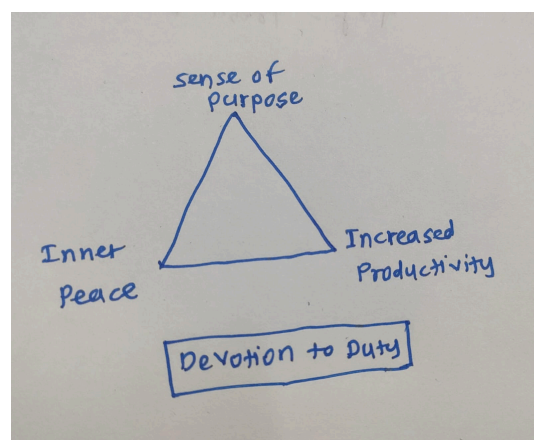
1. For a civil servant, duty is not just a job description, it is a **moral contract** with the sovereign the people. (**Trusteeship principle**)
2. Devotion ensures that the officer is **upholding Constitutional Morality** even under political pressure.
3. **Professional Integrity**- It manifests as doing the right thing when no one is watching. Eg- **Satyendra Dubey**
4. **Accountability to the "Last Person"**- A devoted officer views themselves as answerable to the most marginalized. Eg- **Dr. Rajendra Bharud (IAS)** - oxygen plants in tribal Nandurbar district.
5. **Impartiality in Crisis**- Devotion **prevents personal biases** from clouding administrative judgment.
6. **Resource Stewardship**- Eg- **E. Sreedharan** completed Metro projects under budget and ahead of time.
7. **Compassionate Regulation**- Balancing the "letter of the law" with the "spirit of justice." Eg- delaying the demolition of encroachment until finalization of the rehabilitation **plan**.
8. **Crisis Leadership**- Eg- **Krishna Teja (IAS)** coordinated evacuation of over 2.5 lakh people during Kerala floods
9. Acts as a Internal moral compass ensuring **accountability to conscience**. Eg - Satish Dhawan taking responsibility for ISRO failure.

Devotion to Duty leading to Personal Fulfilment

1. Personal fulfilment in civil service comes from the **alignment of one's "inner conscience" with "outer action."**
1. **Self-Actualization**- Finding the highest version of oneself through service.
2. **Emotional Intelligence**- Developing a sense of **"Wholeness"** by connecting with the suffering and joy of the public.
3. **The "Flow" State**- Becoming so absorbed in problem-solving that work stops being stressful and becomes meditative.
4. **Legacy Building**- **S.R. Sankaran** - "an ideal people's IAS officer" remained unmarried for service of nation
5. **Inner Peace**- knowing there is no gap between what you believe and what you do.
6. **Building Social Capital and Respect**. Eg- **Prashant Nair (IAS)** being called "Collector Bro" by the youth of Kozhikode
7. **Resilience**- Devotion provides the "buffer" against the frustrations of transfers or political interference.
8. **A Clear Conscience**- The ability to sleep peacefully, knowing one has not been a party to injustice
9. **Transcendence**- Moving beyond the "ego" (the I, Me, Mine) to a larger identity (The State, The People).
10. **Institution building** by prioritizing long-term public interest over short-term gain. Eg- **Vergheese Kurien building AMUL**.

Devotion to Duty leading to Highest Perfection

1. "Highest Perfection" is the state where the administrator becomes an **"Ethical Titan"**
2. Sense of responsibility and fulfillment leads to **unity of thought, word, and deed** - a state of perfection. Eg- Mahatma Gandhi
3. **Achieves Equanimity (Samatvam)**- Remaining calm in both praise and blame, success and failure
4. **Becoming a "Living Institution"**- When the individual's name becomes synonymous with the values of



the office.

"To find yourself, lose yourself in the service of others." - **Mahatma Gandhi.**

Devotion to duty is the "**alchemy**" that turns a bureaucrat into a public servant.

2024 - Mission Karmayogi is aiming for maintaining a very high standard of conduct and behaviour to ensure efficiency for serving citizens and in turn developing oneself. How will this scheme empower civil servants in enhancing productive efficiency and delivering the services at the grassroots level?

Mission Karmayogi (National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building) aims to transform the civil services from rule-based to **role-based, competency-driven and citizen-centric** administrative systems.

Vision of civil servants

1. **Imaginative & Innovative**
2. **Proactive & Polite**
3. **Professional & Progressive**
4. **Energetic & Enabling**
5. **Transparent & Tech-enabled**
6. **Creative & Constructive**

Enhancing Productive Efficiency and Grassroots Service Delivery

1. **Shift to Role-based Governance** by mapping specific competencies to specific roles (FRAC) - ensures that the "right man is in the right job" .
2. **iGOT-Karmayogi Platform-** provides "anytime-anywhere" learning - allows a field officer in a remote district to access global best practices.
3. **Democratization of Training-** Karmayogi extends high-quality training to **Group B and C officials** who are the actual frontline of grassroots delivery.
4. It moves away from "one-time" training at the start of a career to a **continuous learning life-cycle**, keeping officials updated on evolving technologies and laws.
5. Dedicated modules on "**Soft Skills**" empower officials to move from being "authorities" to "facilitators" - improves quality of citizen interaction at local offices.
6. **Common training modules** foster a "**Whole-of-Government**" approach - **breaks departmental silos**
7. **Evidence-based Training-** Using data analytics from the iGOT platform, the government can identify "competency gaps" in specific districts and deploy targeted training.
8. It creates a **uniform "Global Standard" of Indian civil service conduct**, ensuring a citizen receives the same quality of service whether in Delhi or a tribal block.
9. **Public-Private Partnership in Content-** By curating content from global experts and private institutions, it brings "**Corporate Efficiency**" into the public sector mindset.
10. **Institutionalized Feedback-** Eg- **360-degree feedback mechanism**
11. **Focus on Emotional Intelligence (EI)** which is crucial for handling sensitive grassroots issues like land acquisition or communal harmony.

Potential Challenges

1. **Digital Divide**
2. **Resistance to Change** (deep-rooted "Babu Culture")
3. **Language Barriers** for frontline staff.
4. **Weak incentives** - Learning not strongly linked to promotions.
5. **Infrastructure gaps** - Lack of devices for frontline workers.
6. **Over-standardisation** ignores local realities.

Effectively implemented, it can help build **citizen centric and future ready civil service** with right Attitude, Skills and Knowledge.

Probity in governance

2018 - What is meant by conflict of interest? Illustrate with examples, the difference between the actual and potential conflicts of interest.

In public administration, a **Conflict of Interest (COI)** is a situation where the **private interests** of a public official clash with their **professional duties** and responsibilities.

Manifestation of conflict of interest

1. **Financial Investments** in companies regulated by one's own department.
2. **Family Ties (Nepotism)**. Eg- Chanda Kochhar Case
3. **Post-Employment Ambitions (Revolving Door)**. Eg- "Amakudari" in Japan
4. **Gifts and Hospitality**
5. **Outside Directorships**
6. **Personal Biases**
7. **Secondary Employment**. Eg- Moonlighting
8. **Property Interests**

Actual vs. Potential Conflict of Interest

Feature	Actual Conflict of Interest	Potential Conflict of Interest
Definition	A direct and current clash between duty and interest.	A situation where a conflict might arise in the future.
Nature	Real and existing	Foreseeable
Legal Standing	Usually a violation of conduct rules if not disclosed.	Not a violation yet, but requires a "management plan."
Ethical Standing	Violation of duty and probity	Ethical risk requiring disclosure
Public Perception	Seen as active corruption or bias.	Seen as a risk factor that needs monitoring.
Action Needed	Recusal (stepping down) or Divestment.	Disclosure (declaring the interest).
Result	Immediate compromise of objectivity.	Future risk of compromised objectivity.
Example	awarding a contract to a company owned by his spouse.	framing mining policy while owning mining stocks

Ways to Prevent Conflict of Interest

1. **Mandatory Disclosure of Assets (2nd ARC)**
2. **Cooling-off Period**
3. **Code of Ethics and office of Ethics Commissioner**
4. **Institutionalized "Conflict of Interest" Registers**
5. **Integrity Pacts**

In a democracy, the **appearance of integrity** is as important as integrity itself. Moving from a **culture of secrecy to a culture of disclosure**, can help maintain public trust in governance.

2019 - What do you understand by probity in governance? Based on your understanding of the term, suggest measures for ensuring probity in government.

Probity is a multifaceted concept representing the quality of having **strong moral principles**, absolute integrity, and uprightness in the discharge of public duties.

Key Components of Probity

1. **Integrity**- Adherence to a strict moral and ethical code. E- Lal Bahadur Shastri
2. **Transparency**- Decisions and actions must be open to public scrutiny.
3. **Accountability**- Public servants must be answerable for their actions and omissions.
4. **Objectivity**- Decisions should be based on merit and evidence, free from bias or personal interest.
5. **Impartiality**- Acting without prejudice toward any particular group or individual.
6. **Avoiding conflict of interest** through disclosures and recusals
7. **Frugality**- Treating public money with more care than one's own

Ensuring probity requires a **"triple-lock" approach- Structural, Procedural, and Behavioral.**

1. Institutional and Legal Reforms

- Ensuring the independence and resource-sufficiency of bodies like **Lokpal, Lokayukta** and **CVC**
- Rigorous implementation of the **Whistleblowers Protection Act**.
- Empowering the **CAG** to conduct social audits and performance audits
- **Adoption of the "Hong Kong Model" (ICAC)** to tackle corruption - three-pronged strategy of Investigation, Prevention, and Community Education

2. Procedural and Technological Measures

- **E-Governance** to reduce human discretion and the "gatekeeper" effect. Eg- **GeM**
- **Citizens' Charters**- Mandating clear timelines for service delivery. Eg- **SAKALA** (Karnataka Guarantee of Services Act)
- Proactive disclosure under **Section 4 of the RTI Act** for transparency
- Mandatory and periodic declaration of **assets and liabilities by civil servants**

3. Human Resource and Ethical Reforms

- Moving beyond a "Rule-based" conduct code (what not to do) to a **"Value-based" code of ethics** (what to strive for) (**2nd ARC**).
- **Competency-linked training** under **Mission Karmayogi** to ensure civil servants are not only skilled but also ethically grounded.

4. Social and Political Measures

- **Legal backing to Social Audits. (Meghalaya Act)**
- Ensuring **transparency in electoral funding** to prevent the "quid-pro-quo" culture at top.

As pointed out by **PM Modi** in Independence Day speech, promoting **'suchita, pardarshita and nishpakshata'** (probity, transparency and impartiality) is essential for 'Amrit Kaal'

2023 - 'Probity is essential for an effective system of governance and socio-economic development.' Discuss.

Probity refers to integrity, uprightness and ethical conduct in public life, especially in the use of public power and resources.

"The strength of a nation lies not in its wealth but in the integrity of its institutions."

Importance of Probity for Governance Effectiveness

1. **Ensures optimal resource utilization-** Eg- **DBT** through JAM has saved over 3.5 lakh Cr.
2. Promotes **accountability and reduces corruption.** Eg- CAG audits of coal block allocation
3. **Rule of Law-** Probity ensures that laws are applied uniformly without selective enforcement. Eg- **T.N. Seshan** strictly enforced MCC
4. **Building Public Trust-** Integrity in public dealings enhances citizens' confidence in the state.
5. **Reducing Administrative "Red Tape"-** Probity eliminates the artificial delays created by officials to solicit "speed money." Eg- **MCA21 portal** for corporate filings
6. **Administrative Speed-** Ethical governance reduces internal friction and decision-paralysis. Eg- **E. Sreedharan** completed Delhi Metro ahead of schedule.
7. **Internal Motivation-** Probity fosters a "service-oriented" work culture rather than a "power-oriented" one.
8. **Prevention of "Elite Capture"** of policy through citizen participation and feedback. Eg- EIA

Importance of Probity for Socio-Economic Development

1. **Attract Investment** due to a predictable and stable environment free from "hidden costs." Eg- **Singapore** attracts global capital because of its reputation for zero tolerance for bribery.
2. **Inclusive Growth (Antyodaya)-** Probity ensures that welfare schemes reach the "last person" in the queue.
3. **Human Capital Formation-** Merit-based recruitment improves the quality of the workforce. Eg- The **UPSC's** reputation for probity
4. **Sustainability-** Decisions made with probity consider long-term environmental impacts over short-term gains.
5. **Social Cohesion-** Fairness in governance prevents the grievances and conflicts that arise from perceived injustice.
6. Emphasis on **meritocracy and objectivity** is the engine of a modern, knowledge-based economy.
7. **Probity in judiciary** ensure accessibility, affordability and quality of justice - Promotes **Justice and Equality**
8. **Probity in corporate governance** promotes effective CSR under **trusteeship principle.** Eg- **Project Nanhi Kali** of **Mahindra Group** for women education

"The price of greatness is responsibility." - **Winston Churchill.**

Probity ensures that responsibility is exercised with integrity, fairness and public spirit.

2024 - "In Indian culture and value system, an equal opportunity has been provided irrespective of gender identity. The number of women in public service has been steadily increasing over the years." Examine the gender-specific challenges faced by female public servants and suggest suitable measures to increase their efficiency in discharging their duties and maintaining high standards of probity.

From just **11.2%** of total IAS officers in 2011, the number of women has risen to nearly **15%** in 2022.

"I measure the progress of a community by the degree of progress which women have achieved." - Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

Women in Indian Culture

1. **Shakti**- primordial source of power, energy.
2. **Ardhanarishvara Philosophy**
3. **Matrushakti**- Governance as caretaking.
4. **Women like Gargi and Maitreyi** as public intellectuals and decision-makers in Sabhas.

Gender-Specific Challenges Faced by Female Public Servants

1. **The "Double Burden" Syndrome**- Time Use Surveys show Indian women spend nearly **5 hours/day** on unpaid care work vs. 30 minutes for men.
2. **Glass Walls in Postings**- Systematic "pigeonholing" into departments like Education, Health, or Social Welfare, while being kept away from Finance, Home, or Infrastructure.
3. **The "Old Boys' Club" Exclusion**- Informal networking and decision-making often happen in "after-hours" social settings that are less accessible to women.
4. **Under-representation at senior levels** ("glass ceiling" effect)
5. **Infrastructure Gaps in Field Postings**- Lack of functional toilets or secure overnight accommodation in remote blocks.
6. **Perception of "Weakness"**- Subordinates or local political leaders in patriarchal pockets resist taking orders from a female officer.
7. **Safety and Harassment**- Subtle forms of workplace sexism and the threat of physical harm in law-and-order roles.
8. **The Mobility Penalty**- Frequent transfers are harder for women leading to "deputation" requests
9. Taking maternity leave is often viewed as a "loss of productivity," affecting seniority or key assignments.
10. **Tokenism**- appointed to committees merely to fulfill a "gender quota" rather than for expertise.
11. **Internalized Bias**- The pressure to over-perform to prove "toughness," which can lead to excessive **stress and burnout** compared to male peers.

Measures to Increase Efficiency and Maintain Probity

1. **Institutionalizing Hybrid Work**- Following global best practices (**Scandinavia**)
2. **Strict POSH implementation with real enforcement - Functional ICCs, time-bound inquiries, protection from retaliation.**
3. Establishing **civil services board** for transparent transfers (**2nd ARC**)
4. **Mandatory Crèche Facilities** at every Secretariat and District Collectorate.
5. **Gender-sensitive infrastructure** - Eg- Standardised "safe field deployment" norms for night duty
6. Creating networks like the **"IAS Women's Association"** to provide juniors with strategies to handle political pressure and maintain probity.
7. **Sensitization**- Mandatory behavioral training through **Mission Karmayogi** to foster professional respect.
8. **Gender Budgeting in Administration**- For the professional development and safety requirements of female staff within departments.

The **"highest perfection"** in public service can only be achieved when the workforce is **truly representative**

2023 - In the context of the work environment, differentiate between 'coercion' and 'undue influence' with suitable examples.

Work culture refers to the shared values, norms, behaviour and ethical climate that shape how individuals interact, make decisions and exercise authority within an organisation.

"The culture of any organisation is shaped by the worst behaviour the leader is willing to tolerate."

Coercion	Undue Influence
use of force, threat, intimidation or punishment to compel a person to act against their will.	use of position, authority, relationship, persuasion or subtle pressure to unfairly influence a person's decision
Forceful compulsion through abuse or threat	Subtle manipulation through emotional means
Consent of employee is absent	Involves consent but is distorted
Open and explicit	Indirect and concealed
Clearly illegal. Eg- violation of POSH Act	Often unethical, legally grey
Intensity is high and immediate	Intensity is gradual and psychological
Mostly used through authority or hierarchy	Mostly leveraged by personal and emotional connections
Results in act under duress or whistleblowing or resignation	May face crisis of conscience or guilt
Remedy - Institutional and legal measures. Eg- ICC complaint	Remedy - Code of ethics and code of conduct
Violation of autonomy	Violation of fairness
Threat of transfer for not clearing illegal file	Hint of promotion for approving biased decision

Way Forward for a Healthy and Ethical Work Culture

1. **Institutionalizing 360-Degree Feedback**
2. **Strengthening Whistleblower Protection Mechanisms**
3. **Civil services board for transparent transfer and posting**
4. **Adopting Nolan Principles of openness**
5. **Promoting "Psychological Safety"**
6. **Regular Ethics Audits**
7. **Democratizing the Workplace**

"Highest Perfection" in duty can never be achieved through fear or manipulation. For effective work culture, authority must be exercised through **competence and trust**

2023 - Explain the term social capital. How does it enhance good governance?

Social capital refers to the **networks, norms, values and trust** that enable individuals and groups to cooperate for mutual benefit and collective action.

"Social capital is the lubricant that makes the wheels of democracy turn."

According to political scientist **Robert Putnam**, social capital consists of two main types-

- **Bonding Social Capital**- Links between people of similar backgrounds (family, class).
- **Bridging Social Capital**- Links between people from different groups.

Role of Social Capital in Enhancing Good Governance

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 1. Enhanced Accountability- High social capital empowers citizens to monitor the government. Eg- high public participation in local government in Kerala 2. Reduction in Transaction Costs- When trust is high, the government spends less on policing and litigation. 3. Facilitating "Co-Production" of Services- Eg- The Bhagidari Scheme in Delhi involved RWAs in managing local water and electricity issues. 4. Effective Grievance Redressal- Strong social networks amplify the voice of the marginalized. Eg- Kudumbashree network in Kerala. 5. Promoting "Bottom-Up" Planning- Social capital makes the Gram Sabha a vibrant decision-making body. Eg- people's plan campaign in Kerala 6. Reducing Conflict and Promoting Peace- Eg- Peace Committees use inter-community trust to de-escalate tensions before they turn into riots. 7. Behavioral Change (Nudge Theory)- Social capital is the engine of "Jan Andolan" (People's Movements). Eg- success of Pulse Polio immunization. 8. Improving Public Policy Compliance- Eg- Higher tax compliance rates in countries where citizens perceive the "social contract" to be strong and fair. 9. Inclusive Resource Management- It prevents the "Tragedy of the Commons." 10. Humanizing the Bureaucracy- It bridges the gap between the "Ruler" and the "Ruled." Eg- "Compassionate Kozhikode" initiative by IAS Prasant Nair | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Trust • Networks • Norms of reciprocity • Collective identity • Civic engagement • Shared values • Informal institutions • Social cohesion |
|--|---|

Ways to Build social capital

1. Strengthening Grassroots Decentralization with 4F's
2. Education for "Civic Virtue"
3. Institutionalizing Community Policing
4. Strengthening civil society as a "bridge"
5. Implementing "Social Audits" as a Norm

For India to move toward **"Minimum Government, Maximum Governance,"** the state must act as a facilitator of social capital, transforming passive subjects into active, trusting, and responsible citizens.

Procedure vs Substance

2018 - "In doing a good thing, everything is permitted which is not prohibited expressly or by clear implication". Examine the statement with suitable examples in the context of a public servant discharging his/her duties.

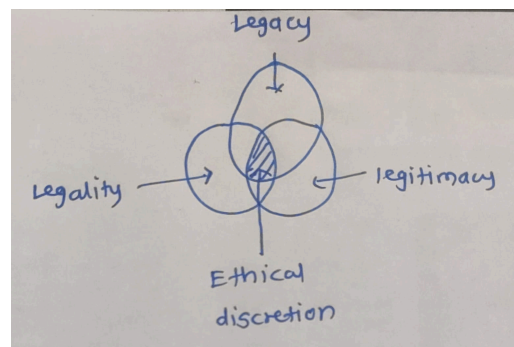
This statement reflects the principle of **Administrative Discretion** and **Innovation** in public service. It also highlights the shift from **"Rule-based"** to **"Goal-oriented"** governance.

Everything is permitted in doing good thing

1. Adherence to the utilitarian principle of 'greatest happiness.'
2. **Resource optimization**- Eg- **Armstrong Pame (IAS)** crowdfunded the "People's Road".
3. **Innovation for reformative justice**- **Kiran Bedi (IPS)** introduced Vipassana.
4. **Behavioral Nudging (Gandhigiri)**- Using psychology instead of force. Eg- In the **Swachh Bharat Abhiyan**, officers gifted flowers to people defecating in the open.
5. Prioritising **social welfare** by bypassing bureaucratic rigidity. Eg- **Prashant Nair's** "Operation Sulaimani" - Use of crowdsourced coupons to feed hunger
6. Finding **'out of the box'** solutions. Eg- IPS **chetan singh Rathore** using National Anthem to manage protesting crowd.
7. **Ethical use of discretion in crises**. Eg- **Dr. Syed Sehrish Asgar** used her office as a "human call center" during communication blackouts in J&K
8. Helps in **collaborative problem solving** rather than a top-down approach. Eg- **S.R. Sankaran** involved local community elders in identifying bonded laborers.
9. Creativity and innovations facilitate **adoption of technology** to solve problems. Eg- **Dr. Hari Chandana** building pavements from recycled plastic in Hyderabad.
10. **Inaction** out of fear of rules is often a greater "evil" than **Innovation** within the framework of the law. - leads to **policy paralysis**

Boundaries that Need to be Followed

1. **Constitutional Morality**- One cannot "do good" by violating Fundamental Rights. Eg- unauthorized phone tapping.
2. **Financial Propriety**- Eg- following **due process** in tender allocation
3. **Avoiding Conflict of Interest** through declaration and recusal
4. Acting in the **"spirit" of the law**
5. **Dignity and Human Rights**- Adherence to Kant's categorical imperative.
6. **Non-arbitrariness** - No favouritism under the garb of welfare.



The ultimate test for any "permitted" action is **Mahatma Gandhi's Talisman**- "Will it lead to the upliftment of the poorest?"

Counter-Argument- The Risks of Unchecked Discretion

1. **Erosion of Procedural Due Process**- Eg- 2G spectrum case
2. **Financial Irregularity and Corruption**
3. **"Rule of Men" over "Rule of Law."** Eg- **Bulldozer justice**
4. **Violation of Fundamental Rights**- Eg- custodial torture
5. **Policy Instability and Lack of Continuity**
6. **Risk of Political Misuse**
7. **Moral Hazard of normalising shortcuts**. Eg- Illegal tapping to catch criminals.
8. **Accountability Gap may lead to institutional Decay**
9. **The "Savior Complex"**- can lead to administrative arrogance.

2024 - "Mindless addiction to Form, ignoring the Substance of the matter, results in rendering of injustice. A perceptive civil servant is one who ignores such literalness and carries out true intent." Examine the above statement with suitable illustrations.

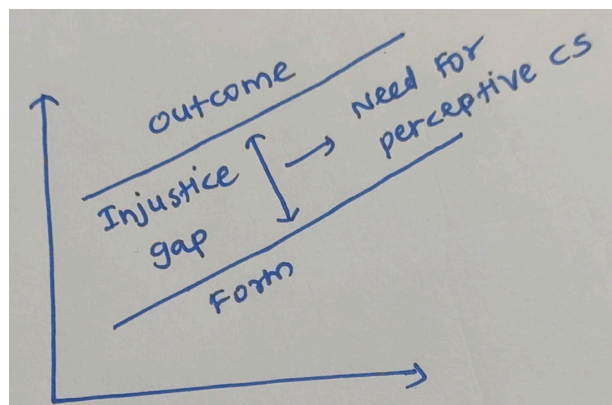
In public administration, there is tension between **procedural formalism** and **substantive justice**. When it becomes a slave to "Form," it becomes an end in itself, at the cost of the citizen it was meant to serve.

Mindless Addiction to Form- Rendering Injustice

1. **Institutionalization of Red Tapism-** Eg- **Munger-Ganga Bridge** in Bihar was delayed by nearly 14 years due to inter-departmental disputes
2. Literalness breeds a **"mechanical" mindset** where officials **lose empathy**. Eg- denial of emergency care to critically ill patient without documentation
3. **Inefficiency in crisis management-** Eg- migrant labour sufferings during COVID.
4. **Undermining Rights of the Vulnerable-** Eg- PDS exclusion of poor due to biometric authentication failures (Jharkhand case)
5. **Encourages moral abdication** - Officials transfer moral responsibility to the rulebook (banality of evil). Eg- encroachment demolitions without rehabilitation plan.
6. Facilitates **coercive corruption**. Eg- 'speed money' for faster file clearance
7. Complexity of the "Form" leads to **Process becoming Punishment**. Eg- complexity in environmental clearances
8. "By-the-book" culture **stifles innovation and creativity**.
9. **Resource Wastage-** Eg- cost and time overruns in PPP projects due to delays in land procurement
10. **Policy Paralysis-** Fear of audit or the "3C" (CBI, CVC, CAG) leads to "Defensive Bureaucracy."

The Perceptive Civil Servant- Carrying Out True Intent

1. **Prioritizing Humanitarian Spirit and constitutional morality.** Eg- **Dr. Syed Sehrish Asgar** used her office as a "human call center" during communication blackouts in J&K
2. **Proactive Problem-Solving in emergencies-** Eg- **Dr. Rajendra Bharud (IAS)** setting up an oxygen plant in tribal Nandurbar before the second COVID wave
3. **Empowering through Informal Networks-** Eg- **Armstrong Pame (IAS)** built a 100km road via crowdfunding.
4. **Administrative Empathy for the Marginalized-** Eg- In the **"Project Sulaimani"** model (Kozhikode), the "Substance" of dignity was prioritized.
5. **Reforming through Discretion-** Eg- **Kiran Bedi (IPS)** turned Tihar Jail into a reformatory.
6. **Streamlining Processes for the Citizen-** Perceptive officers redesign the "Form" itself. **DM of Ganjam (Vijay Kulange)** institutionalized "Doorstep Delivery" of pensions for the disabled
7. **Innovative problem solving-** Eg- **Rahul Kumar (IAS)** converted abandoned buildings into libraries using maintenance funds.
8. **Defending the Rights of the Voiceless-** Eg- **S. Sankaran (IAS)** provided instant subsistence relief to rescued bonded laborers.



Rules are meant to serve justice and when they fail to do so, conscience must guide discretion.

2022 - Wisdom lies in knowing what to reckon with and what to overlook. An officer being engrossed with the periphery, ignoring the core issues before him, is no rare in the bureaucracy. Do you agree that such preoccupation of an administrator leads to travesty of justice to the cause of effective service delivery and good governance? Critically evaluate.

When a civil servant becomes a slave to periphery or "form," administration becomes an end in itself, at the cost of the citizen it was meant to serve.

Core Vs Periphery

The Core (Substance)	The Periphery (Form)
Ensuring Justice and Dignity .	Excessive Documentation and Rules .
Solving the Problem at hand.	Following the Standard Operating Procedure .
Spirit of the Law .	Letter of the Law .
Outcome-Oriented Governance.	Process-Oriented Bureaucracy.

Preoccupation with periphery - travesty of justice

1. **Red-tapism over responsiveness**- Eg- **Munger-Ganga Bridge** in Bihar was delayed by nearly 14 years due to inter-departmental disputes
2. It is a "**corruption of omission**"- may be legally clean, but ethically bankrupt.
3. Periphery breeds a "**mechanical**" **mindset** where officials **lose empathy**. Eg- denial of emergency care to critically ill patient without documentation
4. **Process compliance over public welfare**. Eg- PDS exclusion of poor due to biometric authentication failures (Jharkhand case)
5. **Encourages moral abdication** - Officials transfer moral responsibility to the rulebook (banality of evil). Eg- encroachment demolitions without rehabilitation plan.
6. Facilitates **coercive corruption**. Eg- 'speed money' for faster file clearance
7. It leads to **Process becoming Punishment**. Eg- complexity in environmental clearances
8. "By-the-book" culture **stifles innovation and creativity**.
9. **Resource Wastage**- Eg- cost and time overruns in PPP projects due to delays in land procurement
10. **Policy Paralysis**- Fear of audit or the "3C" (CBI, CVC, CAG) leads to "Defensive Bureaucracy."

Way Forward

1. **Adopting the "Karmayogi" Mindset**- "solution-providers" rather than "file-pushers".
2. **Institutionalizing Social Audits**- Eg- Meghalaya social audit law
3. **Protection for Honest Discretion** by amending Section 17A of the Prevention of Corruption Act.
4. **Promoting "Co-Production"**- Involving NGOs and SHGs to deliver services. Eg- **Kudumbashree**
5. **Application of Gandhi's Talisman** in decision making

The ultimate goal of an administrator is to ensure that the "**True Intent**" of the Constitution - Justice, Liberty, and Equality - is delivered.

Vision of civil servants

1. **Imaginative & Innovative**
2. **Proactive & Polite**
3. **Professional & Progressive**
4. **Energetic & Enabling**
5. **Transparent & Tech-enabled**
6. **Creative & Constructive**

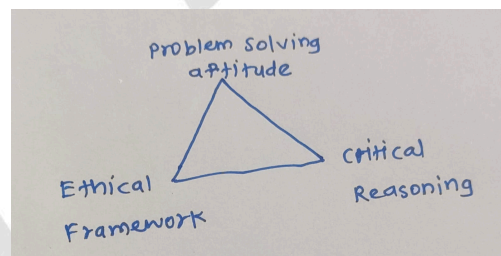
2025 - “For any kind of social re-engineering by successfully implementing welfare schemes, a civil servant must use reason and critical thinking in an ethical framework.” Justify this statement with suitable examples.

Social re-engineering refers to the deliberate attempt to **transform social structures, behaviors, and cultural norms** to achieve a more **equitable society**. Civil servants act as a “**facilitator**” of this change.

Need for reason and critical thinking in an ethical framework for successful social engineering

1. **Diagnose real problems, not symptoms** - Eg- Nutrition deficits need diet diversity, not only calories.
2. **Build public trust and legitimacy**. Eg- Transparent DBT reduced leakage and improved targeting.
3. Uphold **constitutional morality over social morality**. Eg- **conditional cash transfer** under “**Kanyashree**” scheme improved efficiency.
4. **Design context-specific solutions**. Eg- Jal Jeevan Mission adapted to local water sources.
5. **Avoid one-size-fits-all policies**. Eg- location specific housing designs under PM Awas.
6. **Prevent unintended harm**. Eg- advising against loan waivers to avoid moral hazard.
7. **Balancing competing values**. Eg- balancing efficiency and privacy in Aadhaar.
8. **Ensure bottoms up planning**. Eg- fair, prior and informed consent of Gram Sabha under PESA.
9. **Prevent elite capture** of policy. Eg- Social audits in MGNREGA.
10. **Promote behavioural change, not just compliance**. Eg- Gandhigiri in SBM - giving flowers for open defecation.
11. **Ensure sustainability** (intergenerational justice). Eg- **PM-PRANAM** to promote organic farming
12. **Protect rights while delivering welfare**. Eg- Consent-based data use in health IDs.

Social transformation requires **critical reasoning to design effective interventions and ethical grounding to ensure justice, dignity and inclusion**.



2025 - To achieve holistic development goal, a civil servant acts as an enabler and active facilitator of growth rather than a regulator. What specific measures will you suggest to achieve this goal?

“The civil servant is not a mere tool of the government; he is a servant of the people.” - **C. Rajagopalachari**
For **Viksit Bharat**, civil services needs to shift from “weberian” rule-based bureaucracy to “democratic” and enabling bureaucracy.

Holistic Development Goals

1. **Economic Inclusivity (Antyodaya).**
2. **Gender Equality**
3. **Environmental Sustainability**
4. **Human Capital development**
5. **Ease of Living**
6. **Good governance**
7. **Social harmony**

Civil servant as regulator vs enabler

Civil Servant as a Regulator	Civil Servant as an Enabler
Focus on compliance	Driving growth and fostering innovation.
Rule-based	Role-based
Command and Control model (Top-down)	Collaborative mindset (participatory)
Reactive	Proactive

Measures needed

1. Promoting "**Ease of compliance**" and reducing "time-tax" on entrepreneurs and citizens. Eg- "**Deemed Approvals**" and **Single Windows (Bibek Debroy Committee)**
2. **Attitudinal Transformation** through "**Mission Karmayogi**" - From **Mai-Baap (patronizing)** culture toward a **citizen-first approach**.
3. **Institutionalizing Participatory Governance**- Eg- **Participatory Budgeting** model of Porto Alegre, Brazil
4. **Strengthening Public-Private-Community Partnerships (PPCP)**- Eg- In **Kudumbashree** in Kerala, civil servants facilitate growth by empowering 4.5 million women to run micro-enterprises.
5. **Data-Driven Decision Making**- Eg- **Aspirational Districts Programme** uses a real-time dashboard to rank districts - make DM as **competitive facilitator** of local development.
6. **Adopting "Nudge Theory" for Social Engineering**. Eg- **Swachh Bharat Abhiyan** succeeded because of community persuasion rather than just fining them for open defecation.
7. **Promoting Frugal Innovation**- Encouraging officers to solve local problems with available resources.
8. **Safeguarding "Honest Discretion"** by amending **Section 17A of the Prevention of Corruption Act**
9. **Facilitating "Last Mile" Digital Service Delivery** through **Common Service Centres (CSCs)**

This can help civil servants become an enabler that unlocks the **productive potential** of citizens, markets and communities.

Accountability measures

2022 - Whistle blower, who reports corruption and illegal activities, wrongdoing and misconduct to the concerned authorities, runs the risk of being exposed to grave danger, physical harm and victimization by the vested interests, accused persons and his team. What policy measures would you suggest to strengthen the protection mechanism to safeguard the whistle blower?

A whistleblower is described as the "**conscience of the organization.**" They are individuals who, out of a sense of public duty, report corruption and misconduct within an organization to competent authorities.

Risks faced by whistle blower

1. **Leak of identity - Eg- Satyendra Dubey's** identity was leaked despite his request for anonymity to the PMO.
1. **Violent Assault and Murder- S. Manjunath (2005)**, an IOCL officer, was shot dead.
2. **Unnatural Deaths-** In the **Vyapam Scam**, nearly 40 people died under suspicious circumstances.
3. **Institutional Victimization-** transferred to remote postings repeatedly to break their morale.
4. **False Disciplinary Inquiries** on fabricated charges of insubordination or breach of conduct.
5. **Social Ostracization-** labeled as "snitches" or "disloyal".
6. **Economic Harassment-** withholding promotions, denying increments etc.
7. **Legal Entrapment** under the **official secrets Act (1923)**

Policy Measures to Strengthen the Protection Mechanism

1. **Strict "Anonymity by Design"-** Eg- encrypted digital portal for reporting
2. **Criminalizing the Leak of Identity**
3. **Proactive Threat Assessment** to provide immediate security or relocation.
4. **Financial Incentives (Bounty System)-** Following the **U.S. False Claims Act**, whistleblowers should be entitled to a percentage of the money recovered from the exposed scam.
5. Protection must extend to **private sector employees and contractors**, as corruption often involves **public-private nexuses**.
6. **Time-Bound Investigation** to minimize the "exposure time" of the complainant.
7. **Whistleblower Defense Fund** to provide legal aid and psychological counseling.
8. **Witness Protection Programs-** "Relocation and Identity Change" services for whistleblowers and their families.
9. Establishing **"Integrity Awards"** (potentially awarded anonymously or post-retirement) to change the social narrative from "snitching" to "patriotism."
10. **Providing job security** and protection against **"Victimization"** through **independent** ombudsman

A whistleblower is a vital cog in the machinery of **Good Governance**. Their safety is essential to maintain **probity** in administration.

2023 - "Corruption is the manifestation of the failure of core values in the society." In your opinion, what measures can be adopted to uplift the core values in the society?

Corruption is the abuse of entrusted power for private gain, resulting in distortion of justice, fairness and public interest.

Corruption as the manifestation of failure of core values

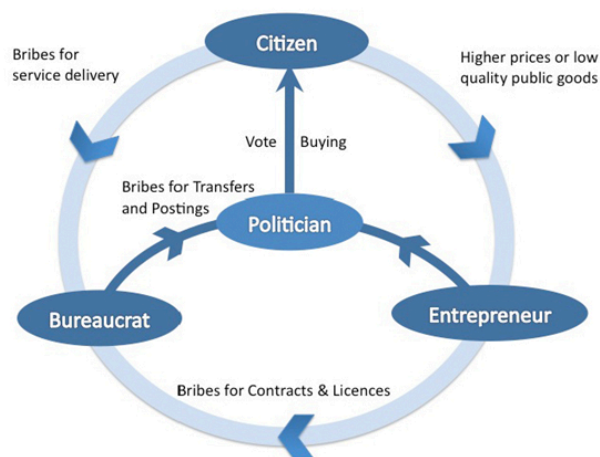
1. Erosion of integrity
2. Decline of responsibility
3. Weak public spirit
4. Normalization of unethical behaviour (sanskritization)
5. Loss of respect for law
6. Materialism over morality
7. Breakdown of accountability
8. Greed over Contentment
9. Loss of Professional Ethics
10. Materialism over Spirituality/Humanism

Measures to uplift core values in society

1. **Value-based education** - Ethics and civic education in schools.
2. **Family and community socialisation** - Teaching honesty at home.
3. **Media responsibility** - Highlighting integrity stories, not just scandals.
4. **Reward ethical behaviour** - Public recognition of whistleblowers.
5. **Transparent governance** - Eg- DBT has saved over 3.5 lakh Cr of government
6. **Civic participation** - Social audits and RTI activism.
7. **Cultural reinforcement** - Films and literature celebrating moral courage.
8. **Swift and certain punishment** under Prevention of Corruption Act and Fast-track courts to end the "culture of impunity."
9. Utilizing spiritual leaders to preach "**Aparigraha**" (non-attachment) and "**Asteya**" (non-stealing).
10. Breaking **politician-bureaucrat-civil servant nexus (Vohra committee)**
 - a. **Transparency in political funding**
 - b. **Civil services board** for transparent postings and transfers

By fostering **integrity, empathy, and public spirit**, we can move from a society of "Rules" to a society of "Character," where corruption finds no soil to take root.

THE WHEEL OF CORRUPTION



2019 - There is a view that the Official Secrets Act is an obstacle to the implementation of Right to Information Act. Do you agree with this view? Discuss.

The OSA is a pre-independence law designed to **protect state secrets from "enemy states."** The RTI Act is a **rights-based legislation** aimed at empowering citizens to **hold the government accountable.**

OSA as an obstacle to RTI

1. **Broad and vague definition of "secret"** - Routine administrative files marked confidential to **avoid scrutiny and undermine openness**
2. **Fear of criminal liability** - Officials hesitate to disclose information fearing prosecution under OSA.
3. **Over-classification** - Even non-sensitive data is labelled confidential to prevent disclosure.
4. **Used as a shield against accountability** - OSA invoked to deny information on public interest matters. Eg- allegations of corruption in **Rafale deal** but information not shared.

5. **Chilling effect on whistle-blowers and journalists** - Fear of prosecution discourages exposure of wrongdoing.
6. **Conflicts with RTI's spirit of maximum disclosure (Section 4)**
7. **Lack of independent review of classification** - No strong mechanism to challenge unjustified secrecy.
8. **Psychological Barrier**- The OSA fosters a "default-to-secrecy" mindset.

Need of OSA

1. **Protects national security and sovereignty**
2. **Safeguards strategic negotiations** - Trade, defence and foreign policy talks need confidentiality.
3. Section 8 of RT protects security-related information.
4. Certain **internal reports** on communal or ethnic tensions are kept secret to prevent the sparking of riots or civil unrest.

A separate National Security Act as suggested by 2nd ARC is needed to promote the culture of transparency and openness

2018 - "The Right to Information Act is not all about citizens' empowerment alone, it essentially redefines the concept of accountability. Discuss.

The RTI Act, 2005, is celebrated as the "**Sunshine Legislation**" aims to promote "**informed citizenry**" and transform bureaucratic culture from "**secrecy and command**" to "**transparency and answerability**."

RTI as a Tool for Citizen Empowerment

1. **Direct Questioning of Power**
2. **Rights based approach**
3. **Voice to voiceless**
4. **Informed political participation**
5. **Protection of Human Rights** (RTI on custodial deaths or condition of prisons)
6. **Bridge to Other Rights** (Right to food under NFSA)

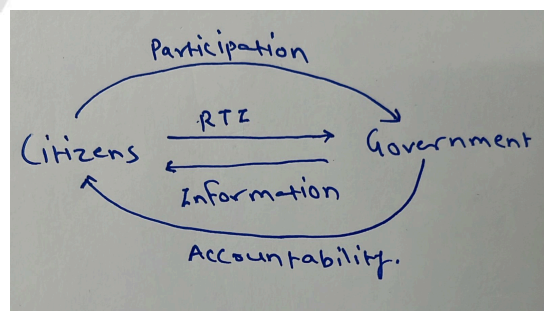
RTI redefining accountability

1. **From vertical to horizontal accountability** - direct accountability to citizens.
2. **Ending "Bureaucratic Anonymity"**- Eg- RTI makes file notings public, ensuring accountability of specific officers taking decisions.
3. **From discretionary secrecy to mandatory disclosure** - reverses the presumption of secrecy to presumption of openness. Eg- **Adarsh Housing Scam** exposure
4. **From reactive to proactive accountability** - Section 4 mandates suo motu disclosure, making accountability continuous.
5. **From procedural to outcome accountability** - Citizens question not just rules but results.
6. **From internal audit to social audit** - People become auditors of governance. Eg- **MKSS in Rajasthan** used **Jan Sunwai** to expose fake work entries in MGNREGA.
7. **From elite oversight to mass oversight** - Every citizen becomes a watchdog.
8. **From episodic scrutiny to real-time scrutiny** - Continuous public monitoring through RTI queries.
9. **From moral accountability to legal accountability** - Failure to disclose invites penalties.
10. **From opacity-based power to transparency-based legitimacy** - Authority now depends on openness. Eg- **2G Spectrum and Coal Scams** exposure

Issues

1. Over **4 lakh appeals** are pending.
2. Chronic **Vacancies** in Commissions
3. Clash with OSA and DPDP Act
4. Legislative Dilution (2019 Amendment)
5. Safety and Threats to Activists (over 150 activists killed)
6. Poor Record Management

To ensure that the RTI Act does not become a "**dead letter**" law, the focus must shift from mere legal compliance to a culture of **proactive transparency**.



2019 - Explain the basic principles of the citizens charter movement and bring out its importance.

The **Citizen's Charter**, introduced in India in **1997 (DARPG)** following the **UK model**, aims to make public services **transparent, accountable, and citizen-centric** by clearly defining service standards, timelines, and grievance redressal mechanisms.

Basic Principles of the Citizens' Charter Movement

1. **Standards:** Explicitly state the **quality and level of service** citizens can expect, ideally with **specific, measurable timeframes**.
2. **Quality:** Commit to **continuously improving the standard** of services provided to meet user expectations.
3. **Choice:** Offer citizens a variety of **choices and options when accessing services**, wherever feasible.
4. **Transparency:** Ensure **openness in rules, procedures, schemes**, and grievance redress mechanisms.
5. **Accountability:** Hold individual officials and organizations **answerable for the services delivered** and commitments made.
6. **Value:** Ensure that services provide good value **for taxpayers' money**.

Importance of citizen charters

1. **Defines Service Standards** - Eg- Passport Seva Kendra specifies delivery within **3 working days** for Tatkal applications.
2. **Enhances Administrative Transparency** - Makes **procedures, responsibilities, and timelines public**, reducing scope for arbitrariness and discretion.
3. **Promotes Accountability of Officials** - Identifies **responsible officers** for each service and grievance redressal, ensuring **answerability for delays or failures**.
4. **Empowers Citizens** to **demand better service delivery**, question inefficiencies, and seek **grievance redressal** through defined channels.
5. Builds **mutual expectations** between government and citizens, enhancing trust in public institutions.
6. Provides a **benchmark for assessing departmental efficiency** and monitoring service outcomes through periodic audits.
7. Promotes **feedback-based improvement** by institutionalizing **citizen input** in service reforms.

Case Studies

1. **Indian Railways:** compensation, cleanliness standards, and punctuality targets.
2. **Taxpayers' Charter:** Defines rights like privacy and fair treatment.

By aligning it with the **2nd ARC recommendations**, it can evolve from a symbolic commitment to a **practical framework for responsive, transparent, and citizen-centric governance**.

2021 - An independent and empowered social audit mechanism is an absolute must in every sphere of public service, including judiciary, to ensure performance, accountability and ethical conduct. Elaborate.

A social audit is a democratic process where citizens directly review, evaluate, and verify the official records, expenditures, and actual field performance of public service institutions.

Importance to Improve Performance of Public Service

1. **Optimizes Resource Utilization:** Eg: social audits under **MGNREGA** reduced leakages and improved rural asset quality in Andhra Pradesh
2. **Enhances Service Delivery Timelines:** Pressure from community monitoring forces officials to complete projects without bureaucratic delays.

3. **Improves Project Target Accuracy:** Eg: Verification drives under the **National Food Security Act** removed thousands of fake ration cards.
4. **Boosts Quality Standards:** Eg: Public scrutiny of rural school buildings and mid-day meals improves safety.
5. **Bridges Local Governance Gaps:** Community audits identify specific, missing civic amenities that top-down government planning often misses.
6. **Improves Judicial Case Management:** Citizen reviews of court functioning encourage registries to clear administrative delays and bottlenecks.

Importance to Improve Accountability of Public Service

1. **Dismantles Bureaucratic Financial Opacity:** Eg: **Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS)** pioneered public hearings to expose hidden corruption.
2. **Enforces Strict Consequence Mechanisms:** Clear evidence gathered during community audits forces authorities to penalize errant, corrupt officers.
3. **Checks Judicial Pendency Patterns:** Reviewing administrative timelines makes institutional court registries strictly accountable for systemic listing delays.
4. **Restricts Executive Fund Diversions:** Eg: Strict auditing of specialized **Scheduled Caste Sub-Plan** funds prevent diversion to general projects.
5. **Empowers Marginalized Civic Groups:** Social audits give institutional platforms to poor citizens to question powerful government decision-makers.
6. **Validates Right to Information:** Social audits turn passive information requests into an active, collective tool for community justice.
7. **Reduces Public Service Grievance Backlogs:** Institutionalizing community verification forces departments to quickly resolve long-pending public utility complaints.

Importance to Improve Ethical Conduct

1. **Institutionalizes Public Service Integrity:** Regular public scrutiny conditions state officials to perform duties with high honesty and fairness.
2. **Discourages Conflict of Interest:** Public disclosure of project details prevents officials from giving lucrative contracts to relatives.
3. **Maintains High Judicial Ethics:** Reviewing court administration standards encourages judges to strictly follow codes of ethical conduct.
4. **Protects Citizen Dignity Rights:** Equal opportunity during public hearings prevents officials from displaying discriminatory caste or gender biases.
5. **Promotes Empathy in Administration:** Direct interactions with poor citizens during audits sensitive bureaucrats toward urgent field realities.
6. **Fosters Values of Truthfulness:** Eg: Stopping fraudulent documentation of ghost beneficiaries.

Implementing independent social audits across all public spheres, including the judiciary, is vital to achieving absolute transparency, institutional integrity, and democratic governance.

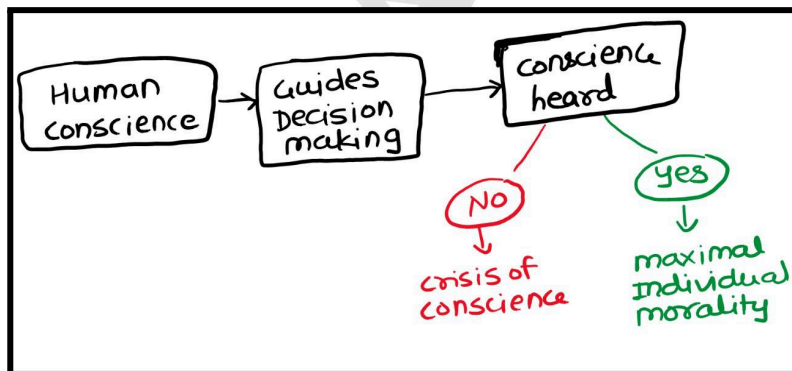
Conscience

2019 - What is meant by 'crisis of conscience'? How does it manifest itself in the public domain?

A **crisis of conscience** is a situation where an individual experiences an intense internal conflict between their deep-seated moral values and the actions they are pressured to take or have already taken.

Manifestation in the Public Domain

1. **Whistleblowing against Corruption**- conflict between "loyalty to the organization" and "duty to the public" triggers a crisis.
2. **Implementation of Unjust Policies**- Eg- implementing order for eviction of slum dwellers during a harsh winter without a rehabilitation plan.
3. **Conflict between Rule of Law and Compassion**- Eg- Denying a starving, elderly woman her rations because her biometrics failed to authenticate.
4. **Political Pressure on Neutrality**- Eg- An officer being asked to manipulate environmental impact data to favor an industrial project.
5. **Medical Ethics in Public Healthcare**- Eg- Medical triage decisions
6. **Journalists** reporting on sensitive issues like human rights violations face a clash between "patriotism" and "truth."
7. **Environmental Protection vs. Development**- Eg- **Aarey Forest case** in Mumbai
8. **Institutional loyalty vs public interest**- When statisticians are pressured to "under-report" inflation or unemployment figures to suit a government's narrative.
9. **Confidentiality vs. Public Safety**- When an official knows a "state secret" that involves a threat to public health but is ordered to remain silent.
10. **Efficiency vs justice** or Speedy action vs due process. Eg- Bulldozer demolitions.
11. **Security vs rights** - Eg- Internet shutdowns in J&K
12. **Career risk vs ethical stand** - Eg- **Sanjiv Chaturvedi (IFS)** facing transfers for exposing corruption in AIIMS and HRD Ministry.
13. **Majoritarian demand vs minority rights** - Public pressure conflicting with constitutional morality. Eg- Sabrimala case



Ethical Framework to Address Crisis of Conscience

1. **Constitutional Morality**
2. **The Public Interest Test**
3. **Gandhian Talisman**
4. **Principle of Non-Maleficence**
5. **Objectivity and Neutrality**
6. **Transparency and Accountability**
7. **Courage of Conviction**
8. **Categorical Imperative (Kant)**
9. **Integrity (Wholeness)**
10. **Seeking Guidance through "Phronesis"**

"There is a higher court than courts of justice and that is the court of conscience. It supersedes all other courts." - **Mahatma Gandhi**

By aligning actions with the "**higher court of conscience**," a public official can ensure **human-centric, just, and truly democratic** governance.

2023 - Is conscience a more reliable guide when compared to laws, rules and regulations in the context of ethical decision making ? Discuss.

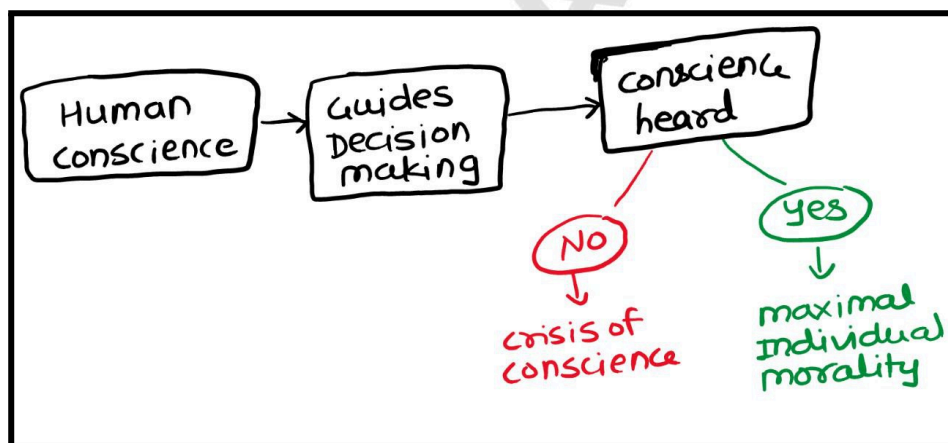
Conscience is the "inner voice" or the internal moral sense of what is right or wrong in one's conduct. "There is a higher court than courts of justice and that is the court of conscience. It supersedes all other courts." - **Mahatma Gandhi**

Conscience as a Reliable Guide

1. Conscience addresses the "**spirit**" of justice where the "letter" of the law may be silent, outdated, or inhumane. Eg- Civil disobedience movement by **Gandhiji**

2. **Addressing the "Legal Vacuum"**- Laws cannot predict every future scenario. In these situations, conscience is the only navigator.

1. **Humanizing Bureaucracy**- While rules are rigid, conscience provides the empathy needed for substantive justice.



2. **Upholding Scientific Responsibility**- Eg- **Robert Oppenheimer** faced crisis of conscience after the atomic bomb's use, leading him to advocate for international nuclear control.
3. **Whistleblowing against Corporate Fraud (moral courage)** - Eg- **Sherron Watkins** exposed the Enron scandal.
4. **Guide for social and legal reforms**- Eg- **Martin Luther King's** fight for Civil Rights Act.
5. **Environmental Stewardship**- Laws often lag behind ecological destruction. Eg- **Sunderlal Bahuguna** led the Chipko Movement based on a conscience-driven duty to protect nature.
6. **Integrity in Sports ("fair play")** - Eg- Sachin Tendulkar walking off before the umpire gives a decision.
7. **Handling Political Pressure**- Eg- **Ashok Khemka** has prioritized his conscience over political convenience, resulting in over 50 transfers.
8. In **conflict zones** where local laws are absent, conscience remains the sole guide. Eg- **Malala Yousafzai's** campaign for girls' education despite Taliban ban.
9. **Prevents moral blindness**. Eg- Oskar Schindler saved Jews despite Nazi laws.

Challenges with conscience as a guide

1. **Subjectivity**. Eg- Extremists justify violence as moral duty.
2. **Cultural bias**. Eg- Honour killings defended as conscience by communities.
3. **Moral relativism**. Eg- Different consciences produce conflicting actions.
4. **Conflict with rule of law**. Eg- Mob lynching violates "justice as fairness"
5. **Inconsistency**- Personal morals change across time and contexts.
6. **The "Slippery Slope"**- Once an official starts bypassing rules for "good" reasons, it becomes easier to bypass them for "convenient" or "bad" reasons later.

Synthesis of Law and Conscience

1. **Constitutional morality as the bridge** - Align personal conscience with constitutional values like justice, liberty and equality.
2. **Ethics training for public officials** under Mission **Karmayogi**.
3. Updation of laws with evolving ethical standards. Eg- DPDP Act
4. **Discretion** should be subject to transparency and review.
5. **Institutional ethical safeguards** - Ethics committees, ombudsmen and judicial oversight

The synthesis of the two can create a "Compassionate State."

e-Governance

2021 - Impact of digital technology as a reliable source of input for rational decision making is a debatable issue. Critically evaluate with suitable examples.

“Technology is a useful servant but a dangerous master.” - **Christian Lous Lange**

Digital technology provides vast data infrastructure for modern governance, yet its reliability as an input for objective, rational decision-making remains highly controversial.

Digital Technology as a Reliable Source of Input for Rational Decision-Making

1. **Real-Time Policy Inputs:** Eg: CoWIN platform enabled real-time vaccine inventory planning across all Indian districts.
2. **Citizen Participation in Policy-** Eg- MyGov collected over 10 crore citizen suggestions that shaped the National Education Policy 2020.
3. **Digitizing demographic and macro-surveys** significantly eliminates human enumeration mistakes and calculation errors.
4. **Satellite tracking and geospatial maps** provide precise objective inputs for infrastructure projects. Eg: PM GatiShakti National Master Plan GIS data.
5. **Leakage Elimination-** Digital systems make welfare delivery accurate and eliminate corruption effectively. Eg- DBT transferred over ₹44 lakh crore and saved ₹3.48 lakh crore
6. Interlinked digital architectures **unify isolated departmental databases** into a singular, holistic policy-making dashboard. Helps eliminate duplication.
7. **Predictive Weather Planning:** Eg: The IMD's advanced Doppler radar systems supplying precise cyclone trajectory inputs to save coastal communities.

Counter-Argument: The Flaws and Risks of Digital Inputs

1. **Poor data collection** practices hampers objective policy making and implementation. Eg- Ghost Beneficiaries under Ayushman Bharat.
2. **The "Black Box" Problem-** AI logic is often opaque.
3. **Institutionalizing Historical Bias-** If data is biased, the AI will "learn" and automate that bias. Eg- **US COMPAS tool biased against African-Americans.**
4. **Difficulty in ensuring accountability** for mistakes.
5. **Correlation vs Causation Fallacies:** Analytical engines can link two completely unrelated data trends together, generating irrational choices.
6. **Exclusion of the Digitally Illiterate** from policy making & online grievance portals

Way Forward

1. **Human-in-the-Loop (HITL)-** The final "sign-off," especially in cases affecting human rights, must be by a human officer.
2. Mandating **regular 3rd-party audits** of government algorithms to detect and "unlearn" biases.
3. **The EU AI Act Approach- "Risk-Based Framework"** where high-risk AI (policing or judiciary) face the highest level of ethical regulation.
4. **Digital Ethics Commissions** including ethicists, jurists, and technologists to oversee AI deployment in public service.
5. **Ethical Coding Standards-** Teaching **"Ethics by Design"** to programmers working on public infrastructure.

While digital technology streamlines administrative efficiency, it cannot replace human empathy, requiring a balanced model where data informs but conscience rules.

2022 - What do you understand by term 'good governance'? How far recent initiatives in terms of e-Governance steps taken by the State have helped the beneficiaries? Discuss with suitable examples.

"In the happiness of his people lies the king's happiness, in their welfare his welfare". -**Kautilya**

Good governance is an administrative approach defined by transparency, accountability, responsiveness, equity, and inclusiveness.

Core Principles of Good Governance (UNDP)

1. **Participation:** Direct/indirect citizen involvement in decision-making. Eg: Gram Sabhas.
2. **Rule of Law:** Fair legal frameworks enforced impartially. Eg: Independent judiciary.
3. **Transparency:** Free flow of accessible information. Eg: Mandatory disclosures under the RTI.
4. **Responsiveness:** Institutions serving stakeholders within timeframes. Eg: Citizens' Charters and CPGRAMS grievance portal.
5. **Consensus Orientation:** Eg: Federal consensus in GST Council meetings.
6. **Equity/Inclusiveness:** Ensuring all members feel valued. Eg: PM Jan Dhan Yojana's universal financial inclusion.
7. **Effectiveness/Efficiency:** Optimizing resources for societal needs. Eg: Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) reducing subsidy leakages.
8. **Accountability:** Answerability of officials to the public. Eg: Mandatory CAG audits of government spending.

Success of Recent E-Governance Initiatives

1. **Eliminating Welfare Leakages-** Eg- DBT transferred over ₹44 lakh crore and saved ₹3.48 lakh crore by plugging leakages in subsidies.
2. **Paperless Document Access-** Eg- **DigiLocker** crossing 67.63 crore registered users, hosting over 950 crore verified digital documents.
3. **Telemedicine Reaching Remote Areas-** Eg- The **eSanjeevani platform** providing digital medical services to over 45.42 crore remote patients.
4. **Real-Time Payment and Financial Inclusion-** Eg- **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** registering over 21.7 billion transactions worth ₹28.33 lakh crore in January 2026 alone.
5. **Democratization of Digital Commerce:** Eg: The **Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)** supporting over 1.16 lakh retail sellers across 630 cities.
6. **Unified Public Grievance Redressal:** Eg: The **UMANG App** offering citizens smooth, singular access to over 1,700 diverse public utility services.
7. **Scientific Grassroots Nutrition Monitoring:** Eg: The **POSHAN Tracker** continuously monitoring nutrition metrics for 8.9 crore children in 14.03 lakh Anganwadi centers.

Major limitations

1. **Aadhaar-Linked Service Failures-** Eg: **Santoshi Kumari (11) starvation death** in Simdega, Jharkhand (2017)
2. **The Persistence of Digital Divide:** Only 38% of rural households have high-speed broadband vs. 85% in urban clusters.
3. **Digital Illiteracy:** only 38% rural population digitally literate. **Eg: Dependence on "CSC Middlemen"** for simple tasks like PM-Kisan registration due to UI/UX complexity.
4. **Linguistic Barriers:** **Eg: Despite "Bhashini,"** real-time voice-to-text accuracy in tribal dialects (like Santhali or Gondi) remains below 60%.
5. **Digital gender gap:** Only 37% of Indian women have adopted mobile internet and only 26% use it regularly. (UNDP).
6. **Aadhaar exclusion:** A 2017 starvation death in Jharkhand's Simdega due to Aadhaar-linked ration card failure exposed authentication risks.
7. **Bureaucratic Resistance:** Lower-level officials often view e-governance as a threat to their discretionary power.
8. **Manpower & Skill Gaps:** **Eg: Dependence on private consultants** for maintaining critical state data centers (SDCs).

7. **Cybersecurity Threats: CERT-In reported 2.94 million cyber incidents** in 2025, specifically targeting state-owned utility grids.

Way Forward

1. Enact a **National e-Governance Act** to make digital service delivery a mandatory right rather than an administrative choice.
2. **Accelerate BharatNet completion:** Connect remaining 55,000 GPs and 3.8 lakh non-GP villages by 2026 under Amended BharatNet Programme
3. Strengthen **Common Service Centres** as "Digital Post Offices." **Eg- Rajasthan's e-Mitra** model
4. **Adopt X-Road interoperability layer (Estonia):** handles 2.7 billion data queries with "once-only" principle - citizen submits info only once. 99% services online.
5. **Implement 2nd ARC's 11th Report fully:**
 - a. Adopt national "enterprise architecture" framework
 - b. Mandatory Business Process Re-engineering before digitisation;
 - c. Build SMART (Simple, Moral, Accountable, Responsive, Transparent) governance.

The state must tackle the digital divide to ensure technology remains an inclusive tool for good governance.

2022 - Online methodology is being used for day-to-day meetings, institutional approvals in the administration and for teaching and learning in education sector to the extent telemedicine in the health sector is getting popular with the approvals of the competent authority. No doubt it has advantages and disadvantages for both the beneficiaries and system at large. Describe and discuss the ethical issues involved in the use of online method particularly to vulnerable section of society.

"Technology is a useful servant but a dangerous master." - **Christian Lous Lange**

While online methodologies offer **paperless, and boundary-less world**, they simultaneously create a **"digital wall"** of exclusion.

Advantages and disadvantages

Advantages	Disadvantages
Access - eSanjeevani Telemedicine	Tribal areas lack connectivity
Speed - faster approvals	System outages. Eg- GST portal
Transparency - Eg- Geotagging MGNREGA assets	Data manipulation risk
Continuity - Online classes during COVID	Learning loss among rural kids
Scale - Mass service delivery. Eg- DBT	One-size-fits-all approach
Efficiency - Automation reduces delays	Errors propagate widely
Flexibility - Work-from-home	Blurs work-life boundaries
Convenience - 24x7 access	Excludes digitally illiterate

Ethical issues for vulnerable sections

1. **Digital exclusion** - "digital apartheid" for rural students during COVID.
2. **Privacy risks** - Eg- Aadhar data breach
3. **Children face mental health issues** due to increased screentime, exposure to child pornography etc
4. **Informed consent erosion** - Eg- Vulnerable users often click "Agree" without understanding data-sharing terms.

5. **Surveillance concerns** -Constant AI monitoring can turn a "Welfare State" into a "Surveillance State".
6. **Difficulty in ensuring accountability** for mistakes.
7. **Loss of "Compassion" and "Conscience"**- Eg- It cannot "bend the rules" for a starving widow whose paperwork is missing.
8. **Dependency exploitation** - Eg- Middlemen charge to fill forms.
9. **Cyber fraud** - Eg- rise of digital arrest cases
10. **Cultural barriers** - Language issues in online platforms.
11. **Disability access** - Apps not accessible to visually impaired.
12. **Psychological Distress**- The "Digital Divide" causes a sense of "techno-inferiority" and alienation among the elderly and rural populations.

Online methodologies should be a **bridge, not a barrier**. The way forward is not to reject technology, but to adopt a **"Phygital" (Physical + Digital)** approach.

2024 - The application of Artificial Intelligence as a dependable source of input for administrative rational decision-making is a debatable issue. Critically examine the statement from the ethical point of view.

The integration of AI into administration marks a shift from **"Human Discretion"** to **"Algorithmic Governance."** However, its role as a "dependable source" is **ethically complex** as "rational" decision in administration is not just about **logical consistency**, but about **justice and equity**.

Ethical Case for AI as a Dependable Source

1. It reduces **cognitive bias** and offers **Neutrality and Objectivity** in decision making. Eg- use of AI in SSC exam evaluation
2. **Data-driven policymaking** promotes evidence-based governance. Eg- Aarogya Setu App
3. **Ensures consistency and predictability** - Eg- AI based custom approval process by DGFT
4. **Efficiency** in service delivery. Eg- **Samagra Vedika** platform of telangana create a "360-degree profile" of every citizen to verify eligibility for welfare schemes
5. By removing the **"human interface"**, AI reduces the opportunity for **bribery and rent-seeking**. Eg- AI-driven **MCA21 V3** portal flags suspicious shell companies and fraudulent filings.
6. **Enhances accuracy**. Eg- IMD using AI for weather forecasting
7. **Disaster Management Efficiency**- Eg- **Google's AI Flood Forecasting** model, used by **CWC**, provides real-time flood alerts
8. **Targeted welfare delivery** - AI improves beneficiary identification in DBT.
9. **Utilitarian Optimization**- Eg- **NITI Aayog** partnered with IBM to develop AI models for **Crop Yield Prediction for farmers**
10. Enhancing **public participation** through **language inclusivity**. Eg- **BHASHINI** platform

Ethical Concerns

1. **The "Black Box" Problem**- AI logic is often opaque.
2. **Institutionalizing Historical Bias**- If data is biased, the AI will "learn" and automate that bias. Eg- **US COMPAS** tool biased against **African-Americans**.
3. **Difficulty in ensuring accountability** for mistakes.
4. **Loss of "Compassion" and "Conscience"**- Eg- It cannot "bend the rules" for a starving widow whose paperwork is missing.
5. **Digital Dehumanization**- AI reduces complex human lives into "risk scores" or "eligibility percentages".
6. **Threat to Right to Privacy**- Constant AI monitoring can turn a "Welfare State" into a "Surveillance State".
7. **Skill Atrophy**- Administrators may stop using their own judgment, leading to a loss of critical thinking - "Steel Frame" to **"Silicon Frame"**
8. Widening **North-South divide** - Poor countries lack access to tech-mediated services.

Way Forward- "Human-Centric AI."

1. **Explainable AI**- Implementing systems where the AI must provide a "human-readable" reason for every decision.
2. **Human-in-the-Loop (HITL)**- The final "sign-off," especially in cases affecting human rights, must be by a human officer.
3. Mandating **regular 3rd-party audits** of government algorithms to detect and "unlearn" biases.
4. **The EU AI Act Approach- "Risk-Based Framework"** where high-risk AI (policing or judiciary) face the highest level of ethical regulation.
5. **Digital Ethics Commissions** including ethicists, jurists, and technologists to oversee AI deployment in public service.
6. **Right to Appeal against AI**- Statutory rights for citizens to have an AI-driven decision reviewed by a human committee.
7. **Ethical Coding Standards**- Teaching "**Ethics by Design**" to programmers working on public infrastructure.
8. Training civil servants in **AI Literacy** under **Mission Karmayogi**.
9. Strengthening **privacy safeguards under DPDP Act**.

The goal must be not AI-driven governance, but **ethically guided AI-assisted governance**.

Code of Ethics

2018 - Distinguish between “Code of ethics” and “Code of conduct” with suitable examples.

A **Code of Ethics** is a set of moral values guiding behaviour, while a **Code of Conduct** prescribes specific rules regulating actions.

Difference between code of conduct and code of ethics

Code of Ethics	Code of Conduct
Moral principles guiding decisions. Eg- Judicial integrity in Supreme Court judges	Behavioural rules regulating actions. Eg- CCS Conduct Rules, 1964
Value-oriented framework. Eg- Medical ethics of patient confidentiality	Rule-oriented framework. Eg- Mandatory asset declaration by IAS officers
Broad ethical ideals. Eg- Police impartiality during communal violence	Specific operational norms. Eg- Election duty neutrality guidelines
Encourages conscience-based actions. Eg- Whistleblowing against corruption	Requires formal compliance. Eg- Ban on accepting government gifts
Flexible ethical guidance. Eg- Compassion during disaster relief operations	Rigid administrative instructions. Eg- Official social media usage restrictions
Self-regulatory principles. Eg- Journalistic commitment to truthfulness	Institutionally enforceable rules. Eg- Suspension for workplace harassment
Focuses on “right conduct”. Eg- Fairness in judicial verdicts	Focuses on “allowed conduct”. Eg- Attendance and punctuality requirements
Moral violation harms credibility. Eg- Biased reporting by journalists	Rule violation attracts penalties. Eg- Dismissal for bribery charges
Shapes ethical culture. Eg- Corporate transparency and accountability values	Maintains organisational discipline. Eg- Uniform code in armed forces
Inspired by ideals and philosophy. Eg- Gandhian principles in public service	Derived from legal regulations. Eg- Service rules for civil servants

Significance of “Code of Ethics” and “Code of Conduct”

1. **Promote Integrity & Accountability**
2. **Strengthen Public Trust**
3. **Guide Ethical Decision Making**
4. **Prevent Corruption**
5. **Improve Professional Discipline**
6. **Support Good Governance**

Together, **Code of Ethics** and **Code of Conduct** create morally responsible, disciplined, and accountable institutions essential for ethical governance.

2024 - 'The 'Code of Conduct' and 'Code of Ethics' are the sources of guidance in public administration. There is code of conduct already in operation, whereas code of ethics is not yet put in place. Suggest a suitable model for code of ethics to maintain integrity, probity and transparency in governance.

The CoC and CoE are complementary approaches to ensuring **institutional integrity**. While Conduct Rules are primarily "negative" in nature (what not to do), **Code of Ethics** is a "positive" statement of values that inspires a civil servant to do the "right thing".

Code of conduct and code of ethics as source of guidance

Code of Conduct (CoC)	Code of Ethics (CoE)
Provide specific rules for conduct	Inspirational values
Ensures compliance and prevention of misconduct	Promotes integrity and public good
Tells you what is forbidden (Minimum standards)	Tells you what is ideal (Highest standards)
Provides for punishment against corruption	Probity encourages avoiding even appearance of impropriety
Ensures neutrality, confidentiality and accountability	Promotes impartiality, openness and empathy
Eg- Attendance rules enforce punctuality	Eg- Professionalism promotes diligence

A Suitable Model for Code of Ethics

Core Philosophical Values

1. **Constitutional Morality**- Prioritizing the spirit of the Constitution over individual interests.
2. Decisions must be tested against the "**Gandhian Talisman**"- how does it help the weakest?
3. **Selflessness**- Acting solely in public interest, without seeking any benefits for oneself.
4. **Probity and Integrity**- Eg- Singapore Civil Service zero-tolerance ethics policy.
5. **Objectivity**- Making choices on merit alone.
6. **Confidentiality with Responsibility**. Eg- EU data ethics norms.

Operational and Institutional Safeguards

1. Adherence to **Gandhian Talisman** and principle of **Utilitarianism** in decision making
2. **Citizen Feedback on Ethics**. Eg- Estonia e-governance feedback tools.
3. **Ethical Infrastructure- Ethics Commissioner** to provide guidance on dilemmas.
4. **Reflective Practice**- Mandatory "Ethics Audits". Eg- ISO 37001 anti-bribery certification.
5. **Protection of Dissent**- "whistleblowing" should be seen as a duty, not an act of disloyalty.
6. **Conflict of Interest Registers** to prevent actual, perceived or potential Col.
7. **Enact a Civil Services Bill**- Legally formalize the Code of Ethics (**2nd ARC**).
8. **Mission Karmayogi**- Use AI and case-study-based modules to train officials in "Moral Reasoning."
9. **Display the Code of Ethics** in all public offices to ensure public accountability
10. **Annual Ethics Declaration**. Eg- US Office of Government Ethics disclosures.
11. Ensuring **transparency** through **proactive disclosure under Section 4 of RTI**
12. Adopting "**A-S-P**" **Model for integrity management**
 - **Aspiration (Values)**- Eg- **Johnson & Johnson's "Credo"**- customer as first responsibility
 - **Strictness (Compliance)**- Eg- **U.S. Office of Government Ethics** provides clear interpretations of complex ethical dilemmas.
 - **Participation**- Employees help draft the values. Eg- **Adobe's** participative culture.

By synthesizing **Nolan Principles** with **Indian Constitutional values**, we can transform the "Steel Frame" into a **compassionate instrument** of public service.

2025 - It is said that for an ethical work culture, there must be code of ethics in place in every organisation. To ensure value-based and compliance-based work culture, what suitable measures would you adopt in your work place?

An ethical work culture is the **collective mindset and behavior** of an organization that **prioritizes moral principles** over mere profit or procedure.

Importance of a Code of Ethics

1. **Uniformity and consistency in decision-making** based on values
2. **Building Public Trust-** Eg- Tata Group
3. **Ensures Legal and Regulatory Compliance** in spirit rather than letter
4. **Employee Pride and Retention-** Eg- Patagonia's employee turnover rate due to commitment to the environment.
5. **Prevention of Corruption-** Eg- PepsiCo's code provides specific dollar limits for business gifts
6. **Institutionalizing Accountability** based on principles like **trusteeship** and **fairness**
7. **Safeguarding Reputation-** Acts as a shield during crises
8. **Promoting Inclusivity-** Eg- **HanesBrands's** "Excellence through Diversity" principle.
9. **Stakeholder Protection through transparency.** Eg- H&M publishes 98.5% of its supplier addresses
10. **Conflict of Interest Control.** Eg- US Federal Ethics disclosure system.

Measures

Value-Based Measures

1. **Ethical Leadership-** Leaders must "walk the talk." Eg- **Narayana Murthy** following simple living to set a culture of austerity and integrity.
2. **Participative Value Formulation-** Involving employees in drafting the code **to create ownership.**
3. **Ethical Training-** Eg- **Kellogg Company** uses interactive quizzes and "grain farm" themed storytelling to teach ethics.
4. **Integration into Appraisals-** Rewarding "how" a goal was met, not just "what" was achieved. Eg- adding an "Empathy Score" to their performance reviews.
5. **Psychological Safety-** Eg- **Microsoft's "Growth Mindset" culture** encourages learning from failures rather than hiding them.

Compliance-Based Measures

6. **Robust Whistleblower Mechanism-** Secure and anonymous channels for reporting.
7. **Appointment of a Chief Ethics Officer** to oversee integrity initiatives.
8. **Regular Ethical Audits** for monitoring of financial and behavioral conduct. Eg- **"Social Audits"** by Big Four accounting firms.
9. **Clear Disciplinary Protocols-** Eg- The **"Zero Tolerance" policy** for sexual harassment in **Goldman Sachs.**
10. **Leveraging RegTech-** Using technology to flag irregularities. Eg- AI-driven software to detect potential insider trading in real-time.
11. **Transparency in process.** Eg- GeM portal in public procurement.

Building ethical work culture requires a **Symphonic Approach** based on **moral clarity** through CoE, and **robust systems** for compliance.

Corporate Governance

2022 - In the contemporary world, the corporate sector's contribution in generating wealth and employment is increasing. In doing so, they are bringing in unprecedented onslaught on the climate, environmental sustainability and living conditions of human beings. In this background, are Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) efficient and sufficient enough to fulfill the social roles and responsibilities needed in the corporate work mandated? Critically examine.

CSR refers to the responsibility of companies to operate ethically, contribute to sustainable development, and minimise negative social and environmental impacts while pursuing profits.

"The business of business is not just business."

The Paradox- Wealth Generation vs. Environmental Onslaught

Economic Contribution	Environmental / Social Cost
Coal mining in Chhattisgarh generates jobs	Forest loss and displacement of tribal communities
Thermal power plants fuel industrial growth	Air pollution and health hazards (Delhi NCR)
Fast fashion industry boosts exports	water pollution (Tiruppur dyeing units)
Construction sector drives urban growth	River sand mining and groundwater depletion
IT data centres enable digital economy	High energy use and carbon footprint
E-commerce Expansion - gig employment	Microplastic pollution

CSR fulfilling social role and responsibilities

1. **Mandatory Compliance in India** (2% of profits) has channeled nearly **₹25,000 crore annually** into social sectors.
2. **Disaster Response**- Eg- Reliance funded plants to produce medical oxygen during COVID.
3. **Innovation in Education**- Eg- "Hole-in-the-wall" project by Sony and NIIT for computer literacy to slum children.
4. **Project Nanhi Kali** (Mahindra Group) - Providing 10 years of academic support and material kits to underprivileged girls to reduce dropout rates.
5. **Healthcare Infrastructure**- Eg- Vedanta's "Nand Ghar" initiative for transforming Anganwadis into modern child welfare centers.
6. **Skill Development**- Eg- Mahindra & Mahindra's "Hunar" program for training in specialized technical skills.
7. **Kaushalya** (Tata Motors) - Training unemployed youth using a "Learn and Earn" model.
8. **Sanitation & Water**- Eg- ITC's "Mission Sunehra Kal" for promoting "Climate Smart" agriculture through watershed development
9. **Transition to Renewable Energy**- Eg- Adani Foundation's projects for solar-powered rural electrification.
10. **Women Empowerment**- Eg- HUL's "Project Shakti" for creating a network of micro-entrepreneurs ("Shakti Ammas") to sell hygiene products.

Issues with CSR

1. **Greenwashing**- Using CSR for PR. Eg- Coca-Cola's "World Without Waste" campaign while being world's top plastic polluter for years.
2. **Peripheral Activity**- CSR is often a "side project".
3. **Geographical Bias**- concentrated in industrialized states, ignoring backward regions like Bihar or the Northeast.
4. **The "Checklist" Approach**- focus on spending the money rather than the impact or outcome.
5. **Lack of Expertise**, leading to poorly designed projects.
6. CSR (2%) is a **fraction** of the cost of the "Externalities" the company causes
7. **Crony CSR**- channeling funds into "in-house" foundations or politically connected NGOs.
8. **Difficulty in Measuring Impact**- no universal standard to quantify the "Social Return on Investment" (SROI).

A Way Forward

1. **ESG Integration** in core investment and operational strategy.
2. **Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR)** for the entire lifecycle of product. Eg- plastic waste management.
3. **Impact measurement** through third-party ethical audits.
4. **Circular Economy**- Shifting from "Take-Make-Dispose" model to "Reduce-Reuse-Recycle."

True sustainability requires **Systems Change**, where profit and planet are seen as mutually inclusive.

2023 - What do you understand by 'moral integrity' and 'professional efficiency in the context of corporate governance in India ? Illustrate with suitable examples.

Corporate Governance refers to the system of rules, practices and processes by which companies are directed and controlled to balance the interests of all stakeholders.

Moral Integrity

It refers to the consistent adherence to ethical principles, honesty, and truthfulness in all business dealings.

1. **Transparency**- Being open about financial and operational health.
2. **Accountability**- Taking responsibility for actions and failures.
3. **Whistleblowing Support**- Encouraging the reporting of internal fraud.
4. **Fairness**- Eg- **SEBI's "Related Party Transaction" rules** to prevent promoters from siphoning funds to their own private entities.
5. **Probity** - Avoidance of impropriety and unethical conduct.
6. **Truthfulness in Marketing**- Not misleading the public about products.
7. **Trusteeship**- Viewing wealth as a social trust. Eg- **Tata Group**- 66% equity held by philanthropic trusts.
8. **Conflict of Interest Management**- Keeping personal and professional roles separate.
9. **Environmental Stewardship**- Eg- **Godrej Consumer Products** achieving "Plastic Neutrality" ahead of government mandates.

Example - Tanishq's "**Karatmeter**" machine - allow customers to check the purity of their gold for free.

Professional Efficiency

It is the competency and capability of the management to achieve maximum output (profits/value) with minimum waste (capital/time).

1. **Prudent Capital Allocation**- Investing money where it generates the highest returns. Eg- **Asian Paints** consistently delivering high RoI through investment in supply chains.
2. **Risk Management**- Identifying and mitigating financial threats. Eg- **Kotak Mahindra Bank**- efficient lending practices.
3. **Technological Agility**- Adapting to digital trends to stay relevant.
4. **Supply Chain Excellence**- Eg- **Maruti Suzuki**-pioneering "Just-in-Time" (JIT) manufacturing in India to reduce inventory costs.
5. **Human Resource Optimization**- Training and retaining high-quality talent.

6. **Strategic Foresight**- Predicting future market shifts. Eg- **Mahindra & Mahindra** shift toward EVs and SUVs.
7. **Cost efficiency**- Producing quality goods at the most competitive price. Eg- Indian IT sector
8. **Adherence to Timelines**- Delivering projects without delays.
9. **Customer-Centric Innovation** for improving user experience

Example - Maruti Suzuki's adoption of Japanese lean production systems improved productivity, quality and cost efficiency in Indian automobile manufacturing.

“Commerce without morality is a sin” - **Mahatma Gandhi**.

Utilization of public funds

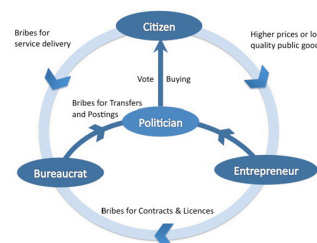
2019 - Effective utilization of public funds is crucial to meet development goals. Critically examine the reasons for under-utilization and mis-utilization of public funds and their implications.

Resource stewardship is the hallmark of **good governance** and is essential for translating fiscal resources into social welfare. Its poor utilisation violates the **"trusteeship" principle (Locke)**

Importance of Effective Utilization of Public Funds

1. **Achieving Social Justice**- Tribal sub plan funds reducing historical inequality.
2. **Ensure timely completion of infrastructure projects** to drive long-term GDP growth.
3. **Human Capital Formation** through improved public service delivery
4. **Poverty Alleviation**- Eg- DBT provide a safety net for those below the poverty line.
5. **Fiscal Discipline**- Prevents unnecessary borrowing and reduces the fiscal deficit
6. **Builds Public Trust** in government - ensures better tax-compliance
7. **Attracting Investment**- "Crowding-in" effect.

THE WHEEL OF CORRUPTION



Reasons for Under-Utilization

1. **Administrative Red Tapism**- Lengthy approval processes for tenders and contracts.
2. **Late fund release** lead to **"March Rush"**
3. **Capacity Constraints**- Local bodies lack technical staff to draft Detailed Project Reports (DPRs).
4. **One-size-fits-all guidelines** limits flexibility. Eg- CSS
5. **Land acquisition delays** stalls major infrastructure projects.
6. **Low accountability**- lack of real-time tracking of funds
7. **Fear of the "3 Cs"**(CBI, CVC, CAG) causes bureaucratic paralysis

Reasons for Mis-Utilization

1. **Corruption** through **ghost beneficiaries**. Eg- over 10 lakh fake accounts in Ayushman Bharat (CAG)
2. **Political populism** - Diverting long-term developmental funds into short-term electoral "gifts".
3. **Poor accountability mechanisms**. Eg- lack of social audits
4. **Absence of Outcome Budgeting**- Focus on "outlays" rather than "impact" (lives changed).
5. **Institutionalized Rent-Seeking**- The presence of middlemen in every stage of fund dispersal.
6. **Politician-bureaucrat-corporate nexus (Vohra committee)** - leads to **culture of impunity**

Implications

1. Violates **utilitarian maxim** of greatest happiness of greatest number
2. Leads to **inequality** - 1% holding >40% national wealth (**Oxfam**)
3. **Poor quality of service** is delivered to citizens. Eg- rotten foodgrains in PDS
4. **Cost Overruns**- Delays lead to inflation-adjusted increases in project costs.
5. **Delayed Benefits**- The public is deprived of essential services
6. **Opportunity Cost**- Capital that could have been used elsewhere remains locked and unproductive.
7. **Economic Distortion**- Unproductive spending leads to inflation without asset creation.
8. **Erosion of Ethics**- Normalizes a culture of dishonesty within the civil service.
9. Leads to **"Taxpayer Cynicism"** - encourage tax evasion.

Public servants are **trustee** of public funds. It must be used with **responsibility and integrity**.

2025 - India is an emerging economic power of the world as it has recently secured the status of fourth largest economy of the world as per IMF projection. However, it has been observed that in some sectors, allocated funds remain either under-utilised or misutilised. What specific measures would you recommend for ensuring accountability in this regard to stop leakages and gaining the status of third largest economy of the world in near future?

Resource stewardship is the hallmark of **good governance** and is essential for translating fiscal resources into social welfare. Its poor utilisation violates the **"trusteeship" principle (Locke)**

Reasons for Under-Utilization

1. **Administrative Red Tapism**- Lengthy approval processes for tenders and contracts.
2. **Late fund release** lead to **"March Rush"**
3. **Capacity Constraints**- Local bodies lack technical staff to draft Detailed Project Reports (DPRs).
4. **One-size-fits-all guidelines** limits flexibility. Eg- CSS
5. **Land acquisition delays** stalls major infrastructure projects.
6. **Low accountability**- lack of real-time tracking of funds
7. **Fear of the "3 Cs"(CBI, CVC, CAG)** causes bureaucratic paralysis

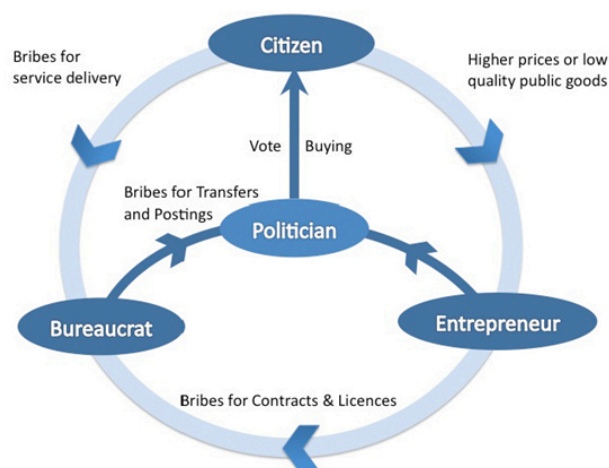
Reasons for Mis-Utilization

1. **Corruption** through **ghost beneficiaries**. Eg- over 10 lakh fake accounts in Ayushman Bharat (CAG)
2. **Political populism** - Diverting long-term developmental funds into short-term electoral "gifts".
3. **Poor accountability mechanisms**. Eg- lack of social audits
4. **Absence of Outcome Budgeting**- Focus on "outlays" rather than "impact" (lives changed).
5. **Institutionalized Rent-Seeking**- The presence of middlemen in every stage of fund dispersal.
6. **Politician-bureaucrat-corporate nexus (Vohra committee)** - leads to **culture of impunity**

Measures needed

1. **Performance-Linked Promotions**- Incorporate "Fund Utilization Efficiency" as a key metric in the Annual Confidential Reports (ACR) of IAS and IPS officers.
2. Implement a **financial incentive and protection program** for whistleblowers. **(US Model)**
3. Ensuring the independence and resource-sufficiency of bodies like **Lokpal, Lokayukta** and **CVC**
4. **Adoption of the "Hong Kong Model" (ICAC)** to tackle corruption - three-pronged strategy of Investigation, Prevention, and Community Education
5. **E-Governance** to reduce human discretion and the "gatekeeper" effect. Eg- **GeM**
6. **Citizens' Charters**- Mandating clear timelines for service delivery. Eg- SAKALA (Karnataka Guarantee of Services Act)
7. Moving beyond a "Rule-based" conduct code (what not to do) to a **"Value-based" code of ethics** (what to strive for) **(2nd ARC)**.
8. **Competency-linked training** under **Mission Karmayogi** to ensure civil servants are not only skilled but also ethically grounded.
9. **Legal backing to Social Audits. (Meghalaya Act)**
10. **Real-time Public Dashboards**- Eg- "Jan Soochna" portals to track spending and report misuse.
11. Ensuring **transparency in electoral funding** to prevent the "quid-pro-quo" culture at top.

THE WHEEL OF CORRUPTION



Efficiency in spending is as important as expansion of spending for **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

Contribution of moral thinkers

2018 - "The true rule, in determining to embrace, or reject anything, is not whether it has any evil in it; but whether it has more evil than good. There are few things wholly evil or wholly good. Almost everything, especially of governmental policy, is an inseparable compound of the two; so that our best judgement of the preponderance between them is continually demanded." Abraham Lincoln

Abraham Lincoln argues that, ethical judgement does not lie in seeking moral purity, but in **weighing which option produces more good than harm**. Governance thus requires **continuous moral evaluation**.

Tradeoff between good and evil

1. Government policy level

- **Climate policies** trade economic growth for environmental protection. Eg- restrictions in eco sensitive zones hamper mining
- **Welfare schemes** involve fiscal costs but social benefits. Eg- NFSA costs around 2% of GDP but ensures "food security"
- **Security laws** trade liberty for safety. Eg- internet shutdowns in J&K hamper Right to internet (Article 21) to ensure security

2. Societal level

- **Social reforms** disturb traditions but advance justice. Eg- Sabrimala judgment
- **Urbanisation** displaces communities but creates opportunity. Eg- breaking of caste barrier for dalits

3. Global level

- **Sanctions** punish regimes but harm civilians. Eg- sanctions on Iran crippling economy
- **Military interventions** against rogue states can lead to regional instability. Eg- instability in Middle East

4. Individual level

- **Whistleblowing** causes personal harm but exposes injustice. Eg- Satyendra Dubey
- **Commitment to duty** may hamper **work-life balance**

Ethical framework for decision making

1. **Utilitarianism** - Judging actions by net consequences (greatest good for greatest number).
2. **Aristotle's golden mean principle** - Balancing extremes
3. **Public interest ethics** - Balancing competing claims. Eg- Carbon Tax on coal
4. **Moral realism** - Acceptance of complexity and trade-offs.
5. **"Veil of Ignorance"** - To ensure fairness and objectivity.
6. **Rights-based test** - Does it violate fundamental rights?
7. **Moral humility** - Openness to revision.

The task of ethical judgement is to responsibly navigate complexity with wisdom, fairness and humility.

"In a morally complex world, ethics lies not in purity, but in prudence."

2018 - "Falsehood takes the place of truth when it results in unblemished common good." - Tirukkural

The above statement highlights the **"teleological"** approach to truth. It suggests that the moral value of an action is determined not just by the act itself, but by the **ultimate outcome** it produces for society.

Justification of Falsehood

1. **Utilitarian ethics** - Maximising overall welfare. Eg- During COVID-19, some governments delayed announcing lockdowns to prevent mass panic.

2. **Principle of non-maleficence** - Preventing harm. Eg- Doctors not disclosing terminal diagnoses to prevent severe psychological shock.
3. **Doctrine of double effect** - Harm avoided outweighs moral cost. Eg- Undercover police deceive suspects to dismantle trafficking networks.
4. **To maintain social harmony**. Eg- administration declaring minor scuffle between two communities as a "personal dispute" to prevent a city-wide riot.
5. **Emergency ethics** - in wartime, truth is so precious that she should always be attended by a bodyguard of lies. - **Winston Churchill**.
6. **Public interest principle** - Eg- Withholding sensitive information during terror attacks to avoid aiding perpetrators.
7. **Virtue ethics** - Compassion and prudence over rigid honesty.
8. **Protection of life - Right to life supersedes right to information**. Eg- providing "New Identities" under **witness protection**
9. **Diplomatic De-escalation**- During war, "back-channel" communications involve **tactical denials** to give face-saving exit to both countries.

Counter-argument

1. **Erodes trust** in governance.
2. **Slippery slope** - "Noble lies" justify authoritarianism.
3. "hiding failures." Eg- falsifying COVID deaths
4. **Violates autonomy and right to truth**.
5. **Accountability loss** - Lies prevent public scrutiny.
6. **Long-term harm** - Eg- initial denials of **Chernobyl's** severity
7. **Moral corrosion** - Ends justify means mentality spreads injustice.

The Tirukkural does not provide a "license to lie" but rather a **"test of virtue."** Lie is justified only when the good produced is "unblemished" (meaning it harms no one else) and "common" (benefiting all).

2019 - "An unexamined life is not worth living". - Socrates

The above statement made by Socrates during his trial for "corrupting the youth," suggests that the essence of being human lies in our capacity for **self-reflection** and the quest for **purpose**.

Values involved

1. **Truth-seeking**
2. **Rationality**
3. **Moral autonomy**
4. **Integrity and courage**
5. **Wisdom of humility**
6. **Freedom of thought**

According to him, examination allows us to identify the difference between **opinion** (Doxa) and **knowledge** (Episteme). Socrates used a process of **"Elenchus"** (logical interrogation) to refine our understanding of the word. In his words,

"wisdom starts with the realization that I know nothing."

For **individuals**, an examined life helps **prevent mindless conformity and harmful habits**, thereby protecting **personal autonomy, mental health and ethical character**. Eg- young person who critically examines online content is less likely to fall for fake news or extremist propaganda.

For **society**, collective examination enables **reform and moral progress**. The anti-caste movement led by thinkers like **B.R. Ambedkar** emerged from questioning inherited social hierarchies.

For **civil servants**, self-examination **prevents mechanical obedience and promotes ethical judgement**. Officers like Ashok Khemka exemplify how reflective officials act as guardians of legality and justice rather than

mere executors of orders.

For **leaders**, an examined life restrains the misuse of power and promotes **responsible leadership with foresight, empathy and moral restraint**. Eg- Gandhi's differentiation between evil and evil doer, Nelson Mandela's efforts for reconciliation.

For a nation, an **examined citizenry** prevents turning democracy into "**mobocracy**". An unexamined citizens turn into **superfluous masses** as happened in Germany under Nazi party.

Without reflection, life becomes passive, society becomes stagnant, power becomes dangerous and democracy becomes hollow. Examination is the foundation of wisdom, justice and freedom.

2020 - "A system of morality which is based on relative emotional values is a mere illusion, a thoroughly vulgar conception which has nothing sound in it and nothing true." - Socrates

Socrates in his criticism of "**ethical relativism**" argues that **morality cannot be grounded merely in emotions, personal feelings, social moods or subjective preferences**.

He criticised **Sophists** who held that "Man is the measure of all things," and justice as "interest of the stronger." If morality changed based on power or emotions, society would descend into chaos. He advocated for **absolute, objective virtues** that remain constant regardless of human opinion.

Morality based on emotional values is an illusion as it changes with mood, crowd sentiment or fear. **Eg-** Ashok Mochi, who participated in Gurajat riots later regretted.

Moral relativism is vulgar as it is shallow and appeals to the lowest, unrefined parts of human nature (Appetite and Passion) rather than the intellect. **Eg-** online abuse is justified as "righteous anger."

It is also unsound, logically inconsistent and contradictory. It fails to resolve conflicts between opposing feelings. Eg- "**NIMBY**" (**Not In My Backyard**) Syndrome.

Morality based on emotional values lacks universality and objective truth. **Eg-** Honour killings justified as "family honour" by some cultures but universally unjust. Similarly, in 18th century slavery was justified though it undermined human dignity.

Socrates provided the alternative in the form of **Ethical Intellectualism**.

1. **"Virtue is Knowledge"** - if a person truly understands what is "Good," they will naturally act accordingly. Evil, therefore, is a result of **ignorance**, not a choice.
2. **Dialectic-** through constant questioning and logical analysis, humans can strip away emotional biases to find the universal definitions of Justice, Courage, and Temperance.
3. **Supremacy of Reason (Logos)-** The rational part of the soul must be the "charioteer," controlling the horses of emotion and desire. A moral life is one governed by the intellect.

The application of **Ethical Intellectualism** can be seen in

1. **Sabrimala Verdict** - prioritizing gender equality over patriarchy
2. **Decriminalising homosexuality** - upholding constitutional morality (right to choice) over social morality
3. Social reformers like **Raja Ram Mohan Roy** used "Knowledge" (analyzing ancient texts) and "Reason" (Right to Life) to abolish sati
4. Ambedkar proposed "**Education, Agitation, and Organization**" (the pursuit of knowledge) for Annihilation of Caste.

Thus, ethical decision making requires knowledge and reason as foundation.

2019 - "Where there is righteousness in the heart, there is beauty in the character. When there is beauty in the character, there is harmony in the home. When there is harmony in the home, there is order in the nation. When there is order in the nation, there is peace in the world" - A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

"Righteousness is the foundation upon which the edifice of a peaceful world is built."

According to **A.P.J. Abdul Kalam**, personal ethics is the foundation of social order and global harmony. It outlines a **concentric theory of peace**.

Philosophical Basis

1. Reflects **virtue ethics** - character determines moral action.
2. Emphasises **moral causality** - small ethical choices accumulate into large social outcomes.
3. Aligns with **Gandhian philosophy** - be the change you wish to see.
4. Supports **holistic ethics** - micro-level morality influences macro-level peace.

The Ethical Chain Reaction

1. **Righteousness in the Heart**- implies integrity, empathy, and alignment of thoughts with ethical principles. Eg- Mahatma Gandhi's insistence on Ahimsa.
2. **Beauty in the Character**- When the heart is upright, it manifests in the form of honesty, humility, and courage. Eg- In the age of "social media filters," true "beauty" lies in consistency of our values.
3. **Harmony in the Home**- A person of character treats their family with **respect and love**. It becomes the first laboratory of **democracy and peace**.
4. **Order in the Nation**- Stable families raise responsible citizens, reducing **crime and social unrest**. Eg- **civic culture in Japan** due to focus on "character building" in schools
5. A **"Righteous Heart"** ensures that a bureaucrat uses their power for the **Antyodaya** - builds social capital and comprehensive national power
6. **Peace in the World**- When nations operate with **internal order and external respect**, global conflict diminishes, leading to sustainable peace. Eg- Montreal Protocol - nations (acting with a sense of "Global Righteousness") decided to ban CFCs to save the Ozone layer.

Thus, "Righteousness in the Heart" is the key to global **peace, prosperity and justice**.

2022 - "If a country is to be corruption free and become a nation of beautiful minds, I strongly feel there are three key societal members who can make a difference. They are the father, the mother and the teacher." - Abdul Kalam.

Corruption is not merely a legal or administrative failure, but a **pedagogical and psychological one**. Thus, **moral character development** of children through 3 key **agents of socialization** - father, mother and teacher, is imperative.

The Role of the Triad in building "Beautiful Minds"

1. **Father**
 - a. Father is a **bridge** between the home and the world.
 - b. Symbolises **responsibility, discipline and ethical conduct** in the public sphere.
 - c. When children observe their father practising honesty, respecting the law, and rejecting shortcuts or corruption, they internalise these behaviours as normal and desirable.
 - d. Eg- **Naval Tata** instilled the importance of ethical business, philanthropy and social responsibility in Ratan Tata.
2. **Mother**
 - a. Represents **emotional nurturing, empathy and moral sensitivity**. First teacher of **emotional intelligence and selfless service**.
 - b. By teaching a child to share toys, care for the elderly, or speak the truth even when it's difficult,

she builds the "beauty" of the mind.

- c. Eg- **Gandhiji's mother, Putlibai's** deep religiosity, fasting, compassion and discipline shaped his moral life and non-violent philosophy.

3. Teacher

- a. Shape how children **think, reason and judge** right from wrong.
- b. By encouraging **critical thinking, ethical reflection and civic responsibility**, teachers help creates future citizens who value **truth, justice and accountability**.
- c. Eg- **Anand Kumar (founder of Super 30)** transformed the lives of underprivileged students through ethical commitment to education.

They addresses five key behavioral triggers-

1. **Fear-** Removed by the Teacher through knowledge.
2. **Greed-** Removed by the Mother through contentment.
3. **Apathy-** Removed by the Father through social courage.
4. **Selfishness-** Replaced by empathy through the home environment.
5. **Ignorance-** Replaced by a "Beautiful Mind" that understands the long-term cost of short-term deceit.

Dr. Kalam's vision is a shift from **Punitive Justice** (punishing the corrupt) to **Preventive Ethics** (creating incorruptible citizens). For vision of **Viksit Bharat @2047**, citizens with "beauty" of integrity, selflessness and civic virtues is must.

2021 - Life doesn't make any sense without interdependence. We need each other, and the sooner we learn that, it is better for us all." -Erik Erikson

The above statement highlights the fundamental truth that human beings are inherently **social creatures**. Meaning in life emerges from **cooperation, mutual care and shared responsibility** rather than from radical individualism.

Values involved

1. **Solidarity**
2. **Cooperation**
3. **Empathy**
4. **Mutual respect**
5. **Responsibility**
6. **Collective well-being**
7. **Social harmony**
8. **Inclusiveness**
9. **Reciprocity**

From a **psychological perspective**, each stage of human growth involves social interaction. The trust an infant feels depends on the care of an adult, the identity that an individual gets depends on society and the integrity an elder feels depends on the respect of the young. A life focused solely on the "I" leads to **stagnation and isolation**. Eg- rising depression among isolated youth

During the **COVID-19 pandemic**, individual safety depended on collective behaviour - mask-wearing, vaccination and mutual care.

Similarly, **Climate change** similarly reveals global interdependence. Stubble burning in Punjab impact quality of air in Delhi.

Globalization has resulted in **economic interdependence**. A disruption in one part of the world can affect supply chains, employment and prices elsewhere.

At **social level**, harmony depends on people recognising that their **freedoms are tied to others' rights**. Eg- **SHG movement** in India empower women through **collective savings and mutual support**

Ethically, the quote challenges **extreme individualism** that prioritises personal gain over social welfare. When people forget interdependence, **societies fragment, inequality widens, and conflict intensifies** as seen in **Middle East**.

On the other hand, India sending vaccines to neighbouring countries under **Vaccine Maitri** reflected recognition of **global ethical interdependence**.

Recognising this interconnection is essential for sustainable development, social harmony and global peace.

2022 - Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have the right to do and what is right to do.'-Potter Stewart .

The statement highlights the tension between **Law** and **Morality**. While the law tells us what we are permitted to do without being punished, ethics tells us what we should do to be a person of character.

Legal "Right" - It is an **entitlement** that protects our freedom of action.

Ethical "Right" - It is a **responsibility and compass** that directs our actions toward the common good.

Relevance in present context

1. **Freedom of Speech vs. Social Harmony** - Responsible use of words to prevent harm to others.
2. **Corporate Profit vs. Environmental Stewardship** - An ethical corporation chooses to invest in green technology to emit zero waste, even if it lowers their short-term profit. **Eg- Patagonia**
3. While **consumers** have legal right to buy product of their choice, the right thing to do is practice consumerism and responsible consumption (**SDG 12**)
4. **Red Tapism vs Probity** - A civil servant has administrative discretion to **delay or deny services** for documentation errors, but the right thing to do is practicing **compassion and integrity**.
5. **Professional rights vs. Moral Compass** - A lawyer has a legal right to use a technicality to get a dangerous criminal acquitted. But ethics involves thinking about safety of society.
6. **Intellectual Property vs. Life-Saving Access** - Pharma companies have the legal right to charge high prices for drugs. But the "right" thing to do is to share patents or lower prices to ensure the poor can survive. **Eg- Jonas Salk** not patenting Polio vaccine
7. **Financial Gain vs. Social Contribution** - Adherence to **Trusteeship** principle by ensuring tax compliance.
8. **Professional Secrecy vs. Public Safety** - While an employee has the **legal right** to remain silent about defect due to a signed Non-Disclosure Agreement, the **right thing** is to blow the whistle.
9. **Whistleblowing vs loyalty** - Loyalty is right, exposing corruption is right thing.
10. **Media sensationalism vs dignity** - while Media has freedom to report on sensational issues, right thing is to respect privacy and dignity of victims. **Eg- Sushant Singh Rajput case**
11. **Not voting** in elections is legally allowed but ethically wrong. **Eg- low turnouts in urban areas**
12. A **minister** has legal right to appoint any officer as secretary but the right thing to do is **ensuring meritocracy**

Ethical societies are sustained not by rules alone, but by citizens and leaders who choose what is right even when they have the right not to.

2023 - "To awaken the people, it is the women who must be awakened. Once she is on the move, the family moves, the village moves, the nation moves." - Jawaharlal Nehru

"I measure the progress of a community by the degree of progress which women have achieved." - **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar**

Importance of awakening women

1. To awaken people

- Breaking Stereotypes** by challenging traditional roles. Eg- Rani Laxmibai
- Intellectual Growth**- Eg- **Savitribai Phule** awakened the marginalized sections by opening schools for girls.
- Environmental Consciousness**- Women are more close to environment. Eg- women led **Chipko movement**

2. Family Moves

- Health and Nutrition**- Eg- in **Kerala**, high female literacy has led to the lowest infant mortality rates in India.
- Financial Stability**- **Dual-income households** are more resilient to economic shocks.
- Empowered women **delay marriages** - lead to smaller, more manageable, and healthier families.
- Values and Ethics**- Women act as the moral compass of the family, instilling empathy and integrity. Eg- **Jijabai** shaped the character and leadership of **Shivaji Maharaj**

3. Village Moves

- Governance improvement**- Eg- **Chhavi Rajawat**, the MBA Sarpanch of Soda village, brought solar power and clean water to her community.
- Women-led **self-help groups (SHGs)** drive rural livelihood. Eg- **Lijjat Papad (Mahila Griha Udyog)** employs over 45,000 women
- Sanitation Revolutions**- Women are the primary advocates for toilets and clean water. Eg- **"No Toilet, No Bride"** movement in Haryana
- Community Health**- Women as frontline workers (ASHAs) have been instrumental in making India polio-free and managing rural COVID-19 vaccination.

4. Nation Moves

- Gender equality in labor force participation** can increase national GDP by 25% (IMF).
- Peace and Security**- Eg- **Rwanda**, with the world's highest percentage of women in parliament, moved from genocide to becoming one of Africa's most stable nations.
- Policy Inclusivity**- Women in parliament pass laws that protect the vulnerable (maternity leave, safety laws).
- Nordic Countries (Sweden, Norway)** moved to the top of the Human Development Index by institutionalizing gender equality.
- Women are key to achieving the **UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.

Nehru's vision was one of **concentric circles of progress**. "Awakening" of a woman is the spark that can ignite the entire machinery of a civilization.

2024 - "In law, a man is guilty when he violates the rights of others. In ethics, he is guilty if he only thinks of doing so." - Immanuel Kant

Kant distinguishes between **legal guilt** and **moral guilt**. While law judges **external actions and behaviour**, ethics judges **internal intentions and character**.

Values Involved

- Purity of Intent (Good Will)**
- Human Dignity**- Treating others as "Ends in themselves"
- Integrity**- Consistency in thoughts and actions.
- Duty**
- Self-Regulation**

Application of Kantian wisdom

1. **Individual Level-** A student who refrains from cheating due to fear of getting caught is legally "innocent" but ethically guilty.
2. **Professional Level-** In the workplace, a professional might follow all protocols but internally harbor deep **prejudice** against certain clients or colleagues.
3. **Administrative Level-** if a bureaucrat is **willing** to take bribe but is stopped by the lack of opportunity, he is ethically corrupt
4. **Corporate Level- Profit vs. Principle** - Companies follow the "letter of the law" while actively searching for **loopholes** to bypass the "spirit of the law." Eg- Tax Avoidance
5. **Social Level- Discrimination and Bias** - Law prohibits the practice of untouchability or segregation, but it cannot force a person to stop **thinking** of others as inferior.
6. **Political Level- The Hunger for Power** - A politician may follow all election rules, but if their **intent** is to gain power for corruption rather than public service, they are ethically bankrupt.
7. **Environmental Level-** A citizen might not litter because there is a fine, but if they have no **internal regard** for nature, they will pollute whenever "no one is looking."
8. **Digital Level-** The law struggles to keep up with the internet, making it easy to "legally" engage in harmful behavior like spreading rumors or cyber-bullying.
9. **International Level- Diplomacy** - The "**Cold War**" was a period where nations were legally at peace but ethically at "war" in their strategic intentions and espionage.
10. **Judicial Level-** A judge may give a technically correct verdict, but if they were **internally biased** toward one party, the ethical requirement of "Impartiality of Mind" is compromised.

Kant's observation is a call for **Internal Integrity**. Being "ethically clean" is the requirement for being a person of character.

1. **Harm vs. Intent** - While the law requires a physical manifestation of harm like theft to establish guilt, ethics judges the corrupt "maxim" or desire behind the thought as a violation of moral law.
2. **Evidence vs. Conscience** - Legal guilt relies on objective, external evidence proven in a court, whereas ethical guilt is determined by the immediate, internal verdict of one's own conscience.
3. **Deterrence vs. Duty** - Law functions through external deterrence like fines or jail to ensure compliance, but Kantian ethics demands an internal commitment to duty where even a secret wish to break a rule is a transgression.
4. **The "Successful" Criminal** - A person may escape legal guilt through a technicality or a failed attempt, but in ethics, they are fully guilty the moment their "will" is committed to the wrongdoing.
5. **Passive Indifference-** The law rarely punishes a bystander for failing to help others, yet ethics finds one guilty for even contemplating indifference, as it violates the "Duty of Beneficence" toward humanity.
6. **Social Conformity vs. Moral Purity** - One can be a "good citizen" by simply following rules while harboring hate, but ethics demands moral purity by condemning the hateful thought as a violation of human dignity.
7. **Contract vs. Character** - Legal guilt stems from breaching a social contract or statute, while ethical guilt arises from a contradiction in character-wanting to make a personal exception to a rule you expect others to follow.
8. **Punishment vs. Remorse** - Law resolves guilt through external penalties like imprisonment, whereas ethics resolves it through the internal process of moral reform and the struggle for a better "Will."
9. **Objectivity vs. Subjectivity** - The law applies an objective "reasonable man" standard to judge actions, but ethics focuses on subjective intent, viewing even "good" deeds as hollow if they are performed for selfish motives.
10. **The Scope of Authority** - Legal authority is limited to the jurisdiction of visible actions, while ethics holds total jurisdiction over the private sanctuary of the mind where the true battle for character takes place.

2024 - "Faith is of no avail in the absence of strength. Faith and strength, both are essential to accomplish any great work." - Sardar Patel

This quote reflects his belief that while **Faith** (vision, conviction, or idealism) provides the direction, **Strength** (willpower, resources, and courage) provides the momentum. Faith without strength becomes helpless idealism and strength without faith becomes blind force.

Values Involved

- **Pragmatic Idealism**
- **Fortitude**
- **Conviction**
- **Resilience**

Faith is of no avail in the absence of strength

1. **Idealism without action is ineffective** - Belief alone cannot change reality.
2. Without **strength of mind**, faith can become weak. Eg- rising suicide among students
3. **Vision without resources remains symbolic**. Eg- Climate pledges without funding
4. **Laws without enforcement are hollow**. Eg- persistence of child labour
5. **Policy without capacity fails delivery**. Eg- food wastage in FCI godowns
6. **Diplomacy without deterrence invites aggression**. Eg- failure of **hindi-Chini bhai bhai**
7. **Hope without discipline fades**. Eg- success in UPSC requires consistency in hard work.

Need for faith and strength for great work

1. **Faith gives vision, strength gives execution**. Eg- **Green Revolution**- Vision of food security + scientific and administrative strength.
2. Faith gives **strength to bounce back** after failures. Eg- ISRO successfully launching Chandrayan 3 after failure of Chandrayan 2
3. **Faith inspires people while strength organises them**. Eg- **Freedom movement**- Gandhian ideals + organisational networks of INC.
4. **Faith gives moral authority while strength build institutions**. Eg- India's faith in strategic autonomy led to creation of NAM.
5. **Faith guides ends, strength manages means**. Eg- **Climate action**- Sustainability ideals + renewable technology.
6. **Faith resolves why, strength resolves how**. Eg- **Women empowerment**- Equality principle + legal reservations.
7. In a crisis, Faith provides the **mental resilience**, while Strength provides the resourcefulness to solve the problems
8. Social reform requires the **faith that humans can change**, backed by the Strength to enforce that change. Eg- Raja Rammohan Roy's advocacy for Sati Abolition Act.

Patel unified 562 states by combining his **faith** in a single India with the **strength** of his decisive, iron will.

2025 - "Those who in trouble untroubled are, Will trouble trouble itself." - Thiruvalluvar

Thiruvalluvar conveys that a person who remains **calm, composed and mentally resilient** in times of adversity gains the **inner strength** to overcome the adversity.

Values Involved

- **Equanimity (Samatvam)**
- **Fortitude**
- **Stoicism**
- **Emotional Intelligence**
- **Proactive Mindset**

Importance of calmness in adversity

1. **Improves decision-making** - Eg- **M.S. Dhoni**'s allowed him to make tactical decisions that turned certain defeats into victories.
2. **Prevents panic-driven errors** - Eg- Captain **Sullenberger** remained calm when his plane's engines failed, allowing him to calculate a water landing on the Hudson River
3. **Builds public trust** - Calm leaders inspire confidence during crises. Eg- Jacinda Ardern's leadership during COVID 19
4. **Enhances problem-solving** - Eg- ISRO successfully launching Chandrayan 3 after failure of Chandrayan 2
5. **Prevents escalation of conflict** - Calm diplomacy avoids wars. Eg- Cuban Missile Crisis resolved through calm diplomacy.
6. **Supports mental health** - Resilience reduces anxiety disorders.
7. **Prevents unethical shortcuts** - Panic encourages corruption and dishonesty.
8. **Enables ethical judgement** - Eg- Mahatma Gandhi withdrawing NCM after Chauri Chaura based on his struggle-truce-struggle strategy rather than emotions.
9. **Builds Long-term Resilience**- Eg- **Nelson Mandela** used his 27 years in prison to cultivate a calm, forgiving spirit, leading to collapse of Apartheid regime
10. When facing **personal failure**, those who remain calm can **analyze their mistakes objectively and learn**. Eg- **Thomas Edison** failed 1,000 times but ultimately invented "light bulb"

Measures to build calmness

1. **Mindfulness and meditation** - Improves emotional regulation.
2. **Experience and reflection** - Learning from past crises.
3. **Emotional intelligence development** - Recognising and managing emotions.
4. **Physical well-being** - Sleep, exercise and nutrition regulate stress.
5. **Support systems** - Peer and family support.
6. **Ethical grounding** - Strong values provide inner stability.

Calmness is not passivity but power. In a turbulent world, inner stability is the greatest strategic advantage.

2025 - "The greatest discovery of my generation is that a human being can alter his life by altering his attitudes." - William James

The above statement highlights the importance of attitude in shaping **our behaviour, choices and outcomes**. Quality of life is not determined by our circumstances but by **interpretation** of it.

Key Values Involved

1. **Agency**
2. **Optimism**
3. **Growth Mindset**
4. **Responsibility**

Altering life by altering attitude

1. By altering the attitude from **"victim" to "survivor,"** individuals can reclaim their **power**. Eg- **Viktor Frankl's logotherapy** suggest that meaning in life is needed for happiness
2. By changing attitude towards **duties and responsibilities**, one can truly excel in life. Eg- Arjuna in Mahabharata.
3. **Professional Level**- An attitude of curiosity rather than fear helps a person to navigate job losses or industry shifts. Eg- When **Steve Jobs** reinventing himself after getting fired from Apple
4. By changing **attitude towards citizens** (from **indifferent to compassionate**), a civil servant can achieve **personal fulfillment as well as professional excellence**.
5. **Social Level**- **Effective social change** happens only when 'prejudice' turns into 'tolerance' and 'equality.' Eg- changing attitude towards sanitation under SBM
6. **Educational Level**- Students who view a difficult subject with a "growth mindset" perform significantly better than those who believe they "aren't good at it."
7. **Corporate Level**- A company's success depends on attitude of its employees toward innovation and

failure. **Eg- Satya Nadella** transformed Microsoft by shifting the attitude from "know-it-all" to "learn-it-all."

8. **Health and Wellness- Eg-** Clinical trials consistently show that the **Placebo Effect** (patient's attitude toward a pill) can trigger actual physiological healing.
9. The climate crisis requires a shift in attitude from "conquering nature" to "living in harmony with nature." **Eg-** sustainable consumption under Mission LiFE.
10. **Technological Level-** The impact of AI on society depends on whether we approach it with an attitude of "fear and replacement" or "augmentation and partnership."
11. **National Level- Eg-** Post-WWII **Japan and Germany** altered their national attitudes from militarism to industrial innovation, becoming global economic leaders within decades.

Thus, Changing our attitude changes our actions, and changing our actions changes our life.

2018 - "Anger and intolerance are the enemies of correct understanding. " - Mahatma Gandhi

Anger overwhelms reason and pushes individuals into impulsive reactions, while intolerance closes the mind to alternative perspectives. Together, they prevent people from seeing reality objectively

Key Values Involved

1. **Ahimsa (Non-violence)**
2. **Empathy**
3. **Rationality**
4. **Humility**

At the **individual level**, anger disrupts rational thinking and leads to poor personal decisions. Similarly, intolerance towards different opinions prevents individuals from learning, adapting and growing. **Eg-**

At the **social level**, collective anger and intolerance fuel polarization, violence and breakdown of harmony. It destroys social trust and shared identity. **Eg-** Delhi Riots of 2020

At the **administrative level**, anger and intolerance lead to **arbitrary governance and injustice**. In contrast, calmness and tolerance lead to fair assessment of situations, grievance redressal, and upholding constitutional morality.

At the **national level**, intolerance manifests as exclusionary politics and suppression of dissent, weakening democracy and undermining national unity. **Eg-** civil unrest in France and rising anti-immigration sentiments in Europe.

At the **global level**, anger and intolerance between nations escalate conflicts and prevent peaceful resolution. **Eg-** Russia-Ukraine War.

At the **corporate level**, a leader who reacts with anger creates a "culture of fear" where employees hide mistakes instead of explaining them. This impacts **psychological safety** among employees.

In **judiciary**, Judges must be free from "anger and intolerance" to ensure a fairness and objectivity in judgments.

In **technological domain**, anger and intolerance lead to formation of **Echo Chambers** impacting mental health and stability. **Eg-** cyberbullying.

Gandhi reminds us that **wisdom grows in calm minds and open hearts**. Only by mastering anger and embracing tolerance can societies achieve justice, peace and true understanding.

2019 - "A man is but a product of his thoughts. What he thinks he becomes." - M.K. Gandhi

Gandhi highlights that **human character, behaviour and destiny are shaped fundamentally by one's thoughts**. The **external success and failure are reflections of internal belief systems**.

At the Individual Level, a person who harbors thoughts of inadequacy or "helplessness" will live a life of stagnation and fear. On the other hand, someone who maintains a **Growth Mindset** views failures as lessons. Eg- **J.K. Rowling** faced multiple rejections for Harry Potter but remained untroubled.

At the Professional Level, those who treat their work as a means to earn money, become a mediocre employee. However, those who think of their work as a form of "**Karma Yoga**", become a leader who inspires others. Eg- **Gandhiji** thought of himself not as a politician, but as a seeker of truth.

At the Social Level, if a society thinks in terms of "us vs. them", it becomes a fragmented and violent space. Conversely, if the prevailing thought is "**Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam**", the society becomes inclusive and peaceful.

In **civil services**, civil servant who thinks in terms of **service and responsibility** will act ethically even under pressure, while one who thinks in terms of personal gain will drift towards **corruption**. Eg- Ashok Khemka served with integrity despite over 50 transfers.

In the **technological domain**, those who adhere to values of **honesty, compassion, respect, truth** use it in ethical manner while those who view it as a tool to vent out anger do harm to others. Eg- cyberbullying.

"The mind is the workshop where destiny is made." Thus, inculcating **"GOOD" thoughts** is key for developing **"beautiful minds."** This can be achieved through

1. Ethical parenting
2. Value education
3. Ethics training for civil servants
4. Code of Ethics for organisations
5. Inculcating constitutional ideals

2020 - "The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others." - Mahatma Gandhi

Gandhi suggests that **true self-realisation does not come from selfish pursuit of pleasure, power or status, but from selfless service to others**.

Importance of selfless service for self-realisation

1. **Reduces ego** (self-centeredness)- Serving others shifts focus from self to society. Eg- Volunteers during disasters working anonymously.
2. **Builds empathy** - Understanding others' suffering deepens compassion. Eg- **Doctors without Borders (MSF)** professionals working in conflict zones
3. **Gives purpose (Ikigai)**- Life gains meaning beyond material success. Eg- **Narayan Krishnan**, a high-profile chef, gave up his career to feed the homeless
4. **Emotional Intelligence**- Constant interaction with diverse people in service settings refines our ability to manage emotions and understand human nature.
5. **Overcoming Fear**- Eg- **Freedom fighters like Bhagat Singh** lost their fear of imprisonment because their "self" was entirely merged with the service of their nation's freedom.
6. **Develops character** - Service nurtures humility and sense of responsibility. Eg- Mother Teresa's lifelong care for the destitute.
7. **Creates inner peace** - Altruism reduces anxiety and emptiness. Eg- **Baba Amte**, by serving leprosy

patients

8. **Promotes ethical clarity** - Service aligns actions with values. Eg- Honest civil servants resisting corruption.
9. **Enhances leadership** - Servant leaders earn trust. Eg- Mahatma Gandhi's work for Harijan.
10. **Building Resilience**- Handling the challenges of others builds a mental "callus" that helps us face our own life's adversities with equanimity.
11. **Universal Connection**- Service leads to the realization of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam (The World is One Family), where the "Self" is no longer an island but part of the whole.

Ethical framework for selfless service

- **Karma Yoga** - Action without attachment to reward.
- **Virtue ethics** - Cultivation of compassion, humility, generosity.
- **Ethics of care** - Moral priority to relationships and vulnerability.
- **Utilitarianism** - Maximising well-being of others.
- **Gandhian Sarvodaya** (welfare of all).
- **Purity of Motive** (Intention)

We discover our true selves not through possession, but through contribution. Service refines the soul, strengthens society and gives life enduring meaning.

"Service to mankind is service to god" - **Swami Vivekanand**

2023 - "The simplest acts of kindness are by far more powerful than a thousand heads bowing in prayer." - Mahatma Gandhi

Gandhi's philosophy favors "**Bread Labor**" and "**Seva**" over abstract theology. He believed that God resides in the "**daridranarayana**" (in poor) and an act of kindness carries more spiritual weight than symbolic gestures of devotion.

Key Values Involved

1. **Compassion (Karuna)**
2. **Altruism**
3. **Humility**
4. **Service (Seva)**
5. **Humanism**
6. **Sincerity**

Simple acts of kindness are more powerful than prayer

1. **Immediate Alleviation of Suffering**- Giving a thirsty person water provides immediate survival, whereas a prayer for rain is an abstraction.
2. **Universal Language**- Rituals are often specific to a religion, but kindness transcends all barriers of caste, creed, and nationality. Eg- **Langar** in Gurudwaras serve everyone regardless of faith
3. **Validation of Faith**- Kindness is the "fruit" of the tree of faith. As Gandhi noted, "A man of prayer who is not a man of service is a hypocrite."
4. **The Ripple Effect**- One act of kindness inspires another, creating a chain reaction of goodness that prayer alone cannot ignite in a social setting.
5. **Prayer is symbolic, action is substantive** - Eg- Candle marches mourn victims, but **legal aid help survivors rebuild lives**.
6. **Psychological Impact**- Kindness has a scientifically proven biological benefit for both parties, releasing oxytocin and reducing stress.
7. **Restores Faith in Humanity**- During the COVID-19 pandemic, those who distributed free food did more to sustain hope than any religious prayers.
8. **Practicality in Governance**- A thousand prayers won't fix a broken system, but a kind administrator who simplifies a process for a marginalized citizen can change a life.
9. **Empowerment vs. Passivity**- Prayer can sometimes lead to fatalism (waiting for God), kindness is proactive and grants agency to the giver.

10. **Dignity of the Recipient**- A simple act, like listening, restores a person's sense of worth, which a silent prayer from a distance cannot reach.
11. **Accountability**- You cannot fake an act of kindness, but you can perform a ritual without feeling it. Kindness forces a consistency of character.
12. **Building Social Capital**- Kindness creates the "trust" that holds a society together, acting as the ultimate "social glue."
13. **Prayer shows intent, action shows responsibility**. Eg- blood donations
Transition from **passive piety** (ritualistic prayer) to **active empathy** (kindness) is key realisation of "GOOD" character.

2020 - "Condemn none- if you can stretch out a helping hand, do so. If not, fold your hands, bless your brothers, and let them go their own way." - Swami Vivekanand

Swami Vivekananda advocates **compassion over condemnation, service over judgement, and humility over moral arrogance**.

Vivekananda's philosophy is rooted in the **Vedantic idea** that the same divinity resides in everyone. Therefore, **to condemn another is, in a sense, to condemn oneself**.

Key Values

1. **Empathy**
2. **Tolerance**
3. **Non-Maleficence**
4. **Benevolence** (Sarve Bhavantu Sukhinah).
5. **Detachment (Vairagya)**
6. **Human dignity**

The first message - "**Condemn none**" - highlights that harsh judgement rarely leads to reform and often deepens **alienation, shame and resentment**. For example, the **Supreme Court of India decriminalising homosexuality (Navtej Johar case, 2018)** reflected a move away from moral condemnation towards dignity and acceptance.

Similarly, drug addiction, mental illness or academic failure are better addressed through counselling rather than stigma or ridicule. Thus, **non-judgement** enables inclusion and healing.

The second message - "**helping hand**" - places moral responsibility on those who have the **capacity, power or privilege** to help. Ethical life is not passive goodness but **active service**.

During the **Kerala floods (2018)**, thousands of volunteers provided rescue and relief instead of merely expressing sympathy online.

Similarly, in **criminal justice system**, treating offenders with a "helping hand" rather than permanent social condemnation reduces recidivism. Eg- **Kiran Bedi** reforming Tihar jail

The final message - "**fold your hands**" - recognises the **limits of intervention** and promotes **respect for autonomy, tolerance and pluralism**. This is reflected in India's constitutional commitment to **freedom of belief and lifestyle** (Article 25-28).

Also, Condemning others is **emotionally draining**. Blessing them and "letting them go" preserves one's own **inner peace**.

In a time of social media outrage, cancellation culture and polarisation, this message is especially relevant for building **social harmony** and **ethical citizenship**.

In essence, Vivekananda teaches that **true morality** lies not in judging others, but in **uplifting them** when possible and **respecting** them when not.

2021 - "Every work has got to pass through hundreds of difficulties before succeeding. Those that persevere will see the light, sooner or later.-Swami Vivekananda

Above statement highlights importance of **perseverance**, **patience**, and **moral courage** in achieving meaningful goals. Difficulties are not signs of failure but essential stages in the **process of transformation**.

He also gave the slogan of "**Arise, awake, and stop not until the goal is reached**" to inspire youth to break free from **inertia, ignorance and fear**, and to pursue their goals with **clarity, discipline and determination**. At the **individual level**, perseverance enables people to overcome personal and structural constraints. For instance, **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam** faced repeated failures in early missile projects like SLV-3, before leading India's space and missile programmes successfully.

Similarly, **Wilma Rudolph** overcame polio as a child and went on to become a world-record-holding Olympic champion.

J.K. Rowling was a single mother living on benefits, rejected by 12 publishers, before **Harry Potter** became a global phenomenon.

At the **social level**, reform movements face resistance before acceptance. Reformers like **Savitribai Phule** and **B.R. Ambedkar** faced social hostility, yet their perseverance transformed Indian society.

Public policies and reforms take time and face implementation challenges. The **GST** faced technological glitches, federal tensions and compliance issues initially, yet sustained administrative effort gradually stabilised the system.

In **entrepreneurship, startups** face a "**Valley of Death**" where resources are low and difficulties are high. Only ones with **conviction and resilience** sustain. **Colonel Sanders** was rejected 1,009 times before a restaurant accepted his KFC recipe at age 65.

Similarly, **Swachh Bharat Mission** faced scepticism and behavioural resistance before it achieved large-scale sanitation improvements.

At the **scientific and technological level**, innovation requires sustained effort despite repeated failure. The **Mars Orbiter Mission (Mangalyaan)** succeeded after years of trial, testing and constrained budgets.

At the **moral and ethical level**, perseverance strengthens character and integrity. Whistleblowers, honest officers and social activists often face transfers, harassment and isolation before justice prevails.

Mahatma Gandhi's decades-long commitment to Satyagraha proved that a persistent, non-violent force could eventually "see the light" of independence.

Swami Vivekananda's message is an antidote to the modern culture of "**instant gratification**."

2023 - Do not hate anybody, because that hatred that comes out from you must, in the long run, come back to you. If you love, that love will come back to you, completing the circle." - Swami Vivekanand.

Vivekananda reminds us that human relationships operate in **moral feedback loops**- what we give to the world, the world gives back to us.

Key Values

1. **Reciprocity**
2. **Non-Maleficence**

3. **Universal Brotherhood**
4. **Compassion**
5. **Equanimity**

The Burden of Hatred

1. **Internal Emotional Corrosion:** Hatred destroys the mental peace and ethical clarity of the sender before harming anyone else.
2. **Breakdown of Trust:** Eg: A manager ruling by fear and suspicion triggers a toxic workplace culture of backstabbing.
3. **Certainty of Retaliation:** Aggressive emotional outputs set off a chain reaction of hostility that eventually cycles back.
4. **Loss of Moral Authority:** Exercising malice degrades an individual's reputation and strips away their institutional power to inspire.
5. **Intergenerational Social Fractures:** Systemic hatred passed down to youth traps entire generations in endless cycles of violence. Eg- Pakistan's hatred for India

The Circle of Love

1. **Cultivation of Character:** Projecting compassion uplifts the individual's mind, creating a calm and balanced mental state. Eg: Nelson Mandela
2. **Fostering Civic Solidarity:** Offering selfless help strengthens community bonds, turning strangers into reliable social networks. Eg- free community kitchens (**Langar**)
3. **Reciprocal Institutional Goodwill:** Acts of genuine care build a reservoir of public trust that aids governance. Eg: Armstrong Pame building a 100km road in Manipur through crowd-funding.
4. **Promotion of Global Peace:** Eg: India's timely supply of life-saving medicines to smaller nations building lasting global goodwill.
5. **Generational Moral Continuity:** Eg: Baba Amte's selfless tribal healthcare legacy inspiring his children to continue the work. (Dr. Prakash Amte)

Relevance in Contemporary Governance

1. **Empathy-Led Public Service:** Treating vulnerable citizens with deep respect significantly minimizes public grievances and structural alienation.
2. **Restorative Criminal Justice:** Shifting focus from harsh punishment to social rehabilitation lowers repeat offense rates among criminals. Eg: Open jail systems
3. **Compassionate Welfare Administration:** Designing schemes with proactive empathy ensures that marginalized groups receive dignified institutional support.
4. **Collaborative Environmental Stewardship:** Treating nature with care rather than greed ensures resource security for our own survival.
5. **Inclusive Democratic Dialogue:** Engaging political opponents with dignity prevents polarization and preserves healthy, stable parliamentary governance.

By rejecting hatred and embracing universal empathy, public administrators and individuals alike can build a harmonious society where goodwill returns to complete a circle of collective progress.

2024 - "Learn everything that is good from others, but bring it in, and in your own way absorb it, do not become others." - Swami Vivekananda

This quote outlines the timeless philosophy of **organic assimilation versus blind imitation**. It serves as an ethical blueprint to absorb external wisdom, and best practices while preserving distinct moral identity, and cultural roots.

Key Values Involved

- Humility
- Adaptability
- Self-Respect
- Discreteness (Wisdom)
- Authenticity

The Principle of Wise Assimilation

1. **Openness to External Excellence:** Eg: Mahatma Gandhi integrating Thoreau's Western philosophy of civil disobedience to shape India's indigenous *Satyagraha* movement.
2. **Internalizing and Customizing Knowledge** to suit local realities, socio-economic challenges, and cultural values. Eg- India's Asymmetric federalism model
3. **Preservation of Core Identity:** Eg: Japan aggressively modernizing its industrial economy during the Meiji Restoration while strictly preserving its traditional *Samurai* ethics and *Shinto* roots.
4. **Cultivating Self-Reliance and Pride:** True development occurs when external inputs are used to build internal strength, preventing dependency. Eg- India's space program
5. **Preventing Cultural Erasure:** Eg: The uncritical embrace of Western fast-fashion and ultra-individualism rapidly eroding the traditional joint-family support structures.

The Danger of Blind Imitation

1. **Losing Original Identity:** Eg: Children speaking only English and struggling to speak their own mother tongue.
2. **Mismatched Policy Planning:** Directly copying foreign laws without checking local village problems causes failure.
3. **Fostering Inferiority Complexes:** Believing everything from outside is superior makes individuals lose self-confidence.
4. **Forgetting Native Wisdom:** Eg- Ignoring ancient rainwater harvesting techniques to build expensive, harmful concrete dams.
5. Blindly copying others without critical thinking **diminishes creative and innovative faculties**

Swami Vivekananda teaches us that true growth means being a sponge that absorbs world excellence, but remaining an anchor that holds fast to our own identity.

2025 - "The strength of a society is not in its laws, but in the morality of its people." - Swami Vivekananda

Swami Vivekananda argues that a society's true resilience, justice, and progress are derived from the **internal moral compass** of its citizens rather than **external legal frameworks**.

Limitations of laws

1. **Reactive Nature-** They can punish a crime but cannot prevent the initial intent to harm.
2. **External Enforcement-** Laws require a vast machinery (police, courts, jails) to work.
3. **Presence of Loopholes-** Eg- Corporate tax avoidance is often "legal" but socially damaging.
4. **Minimum Standards-** Laws only prohibit the worst behaviors. They do not encourage the best behaviors. Eg- No law can force you to be kind to a neighbor.
5. **Inefficacy Against Deep-Rooted Hatred or Prejudice.** Eg- Despite Article 17, social discrimination persists because of orthodox mindset.
6. **Legality vs. Justice-** Sometimes, laws themselves are unjust. Eg- Nuremberg Laws in Nazi Germany
7. **Fear-Based Order-** Compliance born out of fear is temporary.
8. **The "Checklist" Mentality-** People might follow the letter of the law while violating its spirit. Eg - tokenism in CSR spending or "sarpanch pati" syndrome in PRIs

Strength of society is in the morality of its people

1. **High Social Trust-** Morality builds "Social Capital." Eg- In Scandinavian countries, high mutual trust allows for "unattended" farm stalls where people take produce and leave money voluntarily
2. **Voluntary law abidance** - Moral citizens follow rules even in the absence of enforcement. Eg- Queue culture in Japan.
3. **Responsible Citizenship - Active participation in nation building.** Eg- Community participation in disaster relief.
4. Morality ensures **integrity in public life** thereby ensuring corruption free and ethical governance.
5. **Integrity in the "Grey Areas"-** Moral individuals make fair decisions in situations where no clear rule exists.

6. **Protection of the Vulnerable-** Morality ensures that the strong protect the weak out of a sense of "Dharma" (duty), rather than just following welfare mandates.
7. **Inspiration for Reform-** Morality is the precursor to just laws. Eg- The Civil Rights Movement in the US and the Anti-Apartheid movement in South Africa.
8. **Social Cohesion-** Universal values like honesty and truth-telling create a predictable and harmonious environment for trade and living.
9. **Conflict Resolution-** Moral societies resolve disputes through **dialogue and empathy**, rather than through police or judiciary.
10. **Ethical Leadership-** A moral society produces leaders of integrity.
11. **Sustainable Use of Resources -** Conservation driven by values rather than penalties. Eg- Sacred groves protected by community belief.
12. Morality promotes **value-based behaviour** thereby promoting **social equality and gender justice**. Eg- **respect for LGBTQ rights**

Thus, the true strength of a society lies in the **character, integrity, and moral consciousness of its people**.

Contribution of moral thinkers

2020 - What teachings of Buddha are most relevant today and why? Discuss.

Gautama Buddha's ancient teachings offer a highly practical, rational psychological manual to navigate modern global crises, ethical dilemmas, and mental health challenges.

Major teachings of Buddha and their relevance in the contemporary world

1. **Four Noble Truths - Understanding suffering and its causes.**
 - a. Encourages self-reflection and emotional resilience in modern life challenges.
 - b. Relevant in addressing rising mental health disorders and social dissatisfaction.
2. **Middle Path - Balanced life avoiding extreme luxury and severe austerity.**
 - a. Helps reduce **consumerism, stress, and burnout** in modern competitive societies. Eg- Corporate mindfulness programmes
 - b. Encourages sustainable and disciplined lifestyles amid rising materialism and mental pressure.
Eg: India's Mission LiFE
3. **Ahimsa (Non-violence) - Non-injury in thought, word, and action.**
 - a. Promotes peace amid **war, terrorism, and communal violence**. Eg- Russia-Ukraine conflict
 - b. Inspired global non-violent movements and peace-building initiatives. Eg- Gandhian freedom struggle
4. **Karuna (Compassion) - Empathy and concern for suffering humanity.**
 - a. Encourages humanitarian support during disasters, pandemics, and refugee crises. Eg- India's Vaccine Maitri initiative
 - b. Strengthens inclusive welfare and social justice policies in democratic governance.
5. **Eightfold Path - Ethical conduct, right livelihood, and disciplined behaviour.**
 - a. Promotes **ethical governance, integrity, and responsible citizenship**.
 - b. Helps combat corruption, greed, and unethical professional practices.
6. **Equality and Anti-Caste Outlook - Rejection of caste hierarchy and discrimination.**
 - a. Supports social equality and dignity for marginalised communities. Eg- Dalit empowerment movements
 - b. Strengthens constitutional ideals of **justice, equality, and fraternity**.
7. **Rational Inquiry - Encouraged questioning over blind faith and superstition.**
 - a. Promotes scientific temper and evidence-based thinking in modern societies.
 - b. Helps combat **fake news, superstition, and misinformation** in digital age.
8. **Universal Brotherhood - Respect and harmony among all human beings.**
 - a. Promotes tolerance and peaceful coexistence in multicultural societies.
 - b. Supports ideals of **global peace and Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam**.
9. **Anicca (Impermanence) - Understanding that all earthly conditions, joy, and sorrow are in a state of constant change.**
 - a. Builds internal psychological resilience during rapid global transitions and economic disruptions.
 - b. Discourages arrogance of power and material hoarding, fostering humility in public life.

In an age of rapid technological, economic, and climate change, his message of **ethical self-transformation and harmony with all life forms** offers a timeless path for building a peaceful and sustainable world.

2020 - What are the main factors responsible for gender inequality in India? Discuss the contribution of Savitribai Phule in this regard.

According to **UNDP, Human Development Report**, India ranks **108th out of 166 countries** on the Global Gender Inequality Index, highlighting deep-seated systemic disparities that restrict the empowerment of women.

Main Factors Responsible for Gender Inequality in India

Political Factors

- **Low Parliamentary Representation (14.4% of seats in LS)** limits their impact on core lawmakers.
- **Proxy Political Leadership (Sarpanch Pati)** prevents them from wielding their actual constitutional administrative powers.
- **Lack of Legislative Will:** Eg: The **Women's Reservation Bill** faced a 27-year legislative deadlock.

Economic Factors

- **Dismal Labor Force Participation:** Cultural burdens and safety concerns keep women away from active formal employment opportunities.
- **Uncompensated Care Burden**
- **Limited Asset Ownership** due to structural legal and familial biases. Eg: Women constitute over 70% of agricultural laborers but own less than **14% of land**.

Social Factors

- **Skewed Educational Attainment:** poor families prioritize spending money on a son's premium schooling over a daughter's secondary education.
- **Prevalence of Child Marriage:** Eg: NFHS-5 data reveals **23.3% of women** are married off before turning 18.
- **Widespread Domestic Vulnerabilities:** Deep social normalization of physical coercion creates unsafe, high-risk home environments for housewives.

Cultural Factors

- **Deep Rooted Son Meta-Preference:** Eg: over **21 million "missing women"** due to family sex-selection.
- **The Menace of Dowry:** Treating brides as financial liabilities makes families view daughters with deep economic anxiety.
- **Purity and Pollution Taboos** surrounding menstruation restrict girls from entering mainstream community spaces.

Ethical Factors

- **Objectification in Popular Media:** Eg: Item songs in mainstream cinema reducing female actors to mere gaze objects.
- **Victim-Blaming Morality Narratives:** Society unethically questions the character, clothing choices, and timings of female survivors of sexual assault.
- **Normalization of Everyday Misogyny:** Tolerating everyday casual sexist jokes establishes a dangerous cultural baseline that justifies structural gender violence.

Contribution of Savitribai Phule

1. **Pioneering Female Literacy:** she established **India's first school for girls at Bhide Wada, Pune in 1848**, breaking the orthodox upper-caste monopoly on education.
2. **Championing Dalit Women's Rights:** by opening special schools for girls belonging to the marginalized Mahars and Mangs communities.
3. **Providing Safe Refuge for Survivors:** She founded the **Balhatya Pratibandhak Griha (Home for the Prevention of Infanticide)** in 1863, offering a secure sanctuary for pregnant rape victims and vulnerable Brahmin widows.
4. **Combating the Exploitation of Widows:** She organized a historic **barbers' strike** to protest against the cruel, orthodox custom of forcibly shaving the heads of grieving young widows.
5. **Dismantling Untouchability:** She opened the water well of her personal house to untouchables, directly challenging discriminatory water accessibility rules.
6. **Institutionalizing Social Reform Platforms:** She actively led the **Satyashodhak Samaj**

(Truth-Seekers' Society), promoting dowry-free inter-caste marriages conducted without Brahmin priests.

7. Through her profound poetry collections like **Kavya Phule (1854)** and **Bavan Kashi Subodh Ratnakar (1892)**, she urged women to shed ignorance and seek education.

8. **Exemplifying Selfless Public Service:** She died a martyr's death in 1897, contracting the Bubonic Plague while physically carrying infected Dalit children on her back to her son's clinic.

Channeling the revolutionary spirit of Savitribai Phule through targeted gender budgeting can secure true parity.

2023 - What were the major teachings of Guru Nanak? Explain their relevance in the contemporary world.

Guru Nanak propounded a spiritual and ethical path based on **devotion, equality, truthful living, and selfless service**.

Major Teachings of Guru Nanak and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Ek Onkar - Belief in one universal God beyond religious divisions.**
 - a. Promotes **religious harmony and communal peace** in multicultural societies.
 - b. Counters religious extremism and intolerance globally.
2. **Naam Japna - Constant remembrance and devotion towards God.**
 - a. Encourages **inner peace and mental well-being** amidst stressful modern lifestyles.
 - b. Promotes spiritual discipline and emotional stability among individuals.
3. **Kirat Karo - Earn livelihood through honest and hard work.**
 - a. Strengthens **work ethics, integrity, and professional honesty**.
 - b. Relevant against corruption, exploitation, and unethical business practices.
4. **Vand Chhako - Share wealth and resources with the needy.**
 - a. Encourages **social justice and welfare-oriented society**.
 - b. Inspires community kitchens and humanitarian service. Eg- **Langar tradition**
5. **Equality of Humanity - Rejected caste discrimination and social hierarchy.**
 - a. Supports constitutional ideals of **equality and human dignity**.
 - b. Relevant against casteism, racism, and gender discrimination today.
6. **Seva (Selfless Service) - Service to humanity without expectation of reward.**
 - a. Encourages volunteerism during disasters and humanitarian crises. Eg- Sikh community COVID relief work
 - b. Strengthens compassion and community participation in democracy.
7. **Rejection of Ritualism - Opposed blind faith and meaningless religious rituals.**
 - a. Promotes **rational thinking and ethical spirituality**.
 - b. Helps combat superstition and religious exploitation.
8. **Gender Equality - Advocated dignity and equal respect for women.**
 - a. Relevant for women empowerment and gender justice movements.
 - b. Challenges patriarchal practices and social exclusion.
9. **Universal Brotherhood - Emphasised unity and fraternity among all humans.**
 - a. Promotes peaceful coexistence in conflict-ridden societies.
 - b. Supports ideals of **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam** and global cooperation.
10. **Simple Living and Humility - Advocated modest and disciplined lifestyle.**
 - a. Counters excessive consumerism and materialistic culture.
 - b. Encourages sustainable living and ethical consumption patterns.

In an age of conflict, inequality, and materialism, Guru Nanak's teachings provide timeless guidance for ethical, peaceful, and inclusive societies.

2025 - What are the major teachings of Mahavir? Explain their relevance in the contemporary world.

Lord Mahavira (24th Tirthankara of Jainism) propounded an ethical and spiritual path based on **right faith, right knowledge, and right conduct (Triratna)** for the liberation of the soul.

Major teachings of Mahavira and their relevance in the contemporary world

1. **Ahimsa** - Non-injury in thought, word, and deed towards all living beings.
 - a. Promotes peace in a world affected by **war, terrorism, and social unrest**. Eg- Russia-Ukraine War
 - b. Most powerful alternative to the **"Might is Right" doctrine** - inspire non-violent civil rights movements and peace-building initiatives globally. Eg- LGBTQ movement
2. **Satya (Truthfulness)** - Speaking the truth in a way that does not harm others.
 - a. Ensures **integrity** in public and private life.
 - b. Helps in **combating misinformation and corruption**
 - c. Promoting the verifiable truth in digital and political discourse - antidote to the "Deepfake" and "Fake News"
3. **Asteya (Non-stealing)** - Not taking anything that is not willingly given.
 - a. Promotes **Ethical economy, responsible production and consumption**. Eg- **avoiding greenwashing**
 - b. Reduces crimes and theft
4. **Aparigraha (Non-possession)** - Renunciation of excessive accumulation and greed.
 - a. **Remedy for consumerism and climate crisis**. Encourages sustainable lifestyles and minimalism.
5. **Brahmacharya (Self-control)** - Discipline of mind and body for spiritual progress.
 - a. Self discipline and simple living **enhances mental well-being**.
 - b. Can help reduce **suicide and anxiety** issues among youth
6. **Anekantavada** - Acceptance of multiple perspectives of truth.
 - a. Helps in **managing ideological conflicts** in multicultural societies. Eg- Manipur violence
 - b. Promotes **tolerance, ideals of sarv dharma samabhav and vaisudhaiva kutumbkam**
7. **Equality of all life forms** - Every living being possesses a soul and deserves respect.
 - a. Compassion for all life supports ecological balance. Eg- Vegetarianism and vegan movements.
 - b. **Promotes active citizenship** - Encourages ethical decision-making in democracy and governance.

In an age of rapid technological and economic change, his message of **ethical self-transformation and harmony with all life forms** offers a timeless path for building a peaceful and sustainable world.

Case Studies

2025

[Case Study 1] Vijay is the Deputy Commissioner of a remote district of Himachal Pradesh. For the last two years, he has been in this region. In the month of August, heavy rains lashed the complete state followed by cloudbursts in the upper reaches of the said district. The damage was very heavy in the complete state, especially in the affected district. The complete road network and telecommunication were disrupted and the buildings were damaged extensively. People's houses have been destroyed and they were forced to stay in the open. More than 200 people have been killed and about 5000 were badly injured. The Civil Administration under Vijay got activated and started conducting rescue and relief operations. Temporary shelter camps and hospitals were established to provide shelter and medical facilities to the homeless and injured people. Helicopter services were pressed in for evacuating sick and old people from remote areas. Vijay got a message from his hometown in Kerala that his mother was seriously sick. After two days, Vijay received the unfortunate message that his mother had expired. Vijay has no close relative except one elder sister who is a US citizen and has been staying there for the last several years. In the meantime, the situation in the affected district deteriorated further due to resumption of heavy rains after a gap of five days. At the same time, continuous messages were coming on his mobile from his hometown to reach at the earliest for performing the last rites of his mother.

- (a) What are the options available with Vijay?
- (b) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by Vijay?
- (c) Critically evaluate and examine each of these options identified by Vijay.
- (d) Which of the options, do you think, would be most appropriate for Vijay to adopt and why?

This case presents a conflict between **personal duty** (performing last rites of his mother) and **public duty** (leading disaster relief operations).

Guiding Principle - Maxim of Utilitarianism - Greatest happiness of greatest number

Options Available to Vijay

1. Immediately leave for Kerala to perform last rites
2. Stay in the disaster zone and postpone personal rituals
3. Seek short emergency leave for 24-48 hours
4. Participate in the funeral ceremonies via video conferencing while continuing to lead the rescue operations.

Ethical Dilemmas Faced by Vijay

1. **Personal vs Public Duty** - Family obligation vs responsibility to 5000+ victims.
2. **Compassion vs Professionalism** - Emotional grief vs administrative duty.
3. **Individual rights vs Collective welfare** - Right to mourn vs duty to save lives.
4. **Administrative Responsibility vs. Religious Obligation**- Performing last rites is considered a sacred duty, especially for an only son.
5. **Deontology vs Consequentialism** - Moral duty to mother vs consequences for disaster victims.



6. **Leadership vs Personal responsibility** - Staying strong as a leader while personally grieving.
7. **Duty of care vs Emotional burnout** - Risk of poor decision-making due to distress.
8. **Public trust vs Personal need** - Leaving may erode confidence in administration.
9. **Equity vs Privilege** - Other families have also lost loved ones but cannot leave.
10. **Legal duty vs Moral duty** - Civil service rules vs ethical obligation to family.

Critical Evaluation of Each Option

1. Leave immediately

Pros	Cons
Respects cultural and emotional duty.	Risk to lives due to leadership vacuum.
Allows personal closure.	May be seen as dereliction of duty .

2. Stay and postpone rites

Ensures continuity of command.	Emotional trauma may affect decision-making.
Saves more lives, aligns with public interest .	Personal guilt and long-term psychological distress.

3. Short emergency leave (24-48 Hrs)

Balances personal and public duty.	Travel may be risky.
Allows minimal cultural rituals.	May affect coordination.
Maintains administrative stability with temporary delegation.	Weakens public trust during crisis.

4. Participate in the funeral ceremonies via video conferencing while continuing to lead the rescue operations.

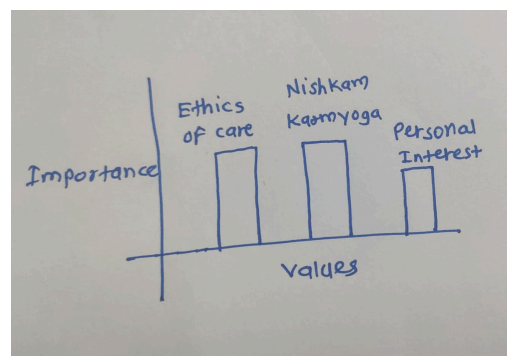
Upholds professional integrity.	May be perceived as "cold" by family
fulfilling the ritualistic requirement.	lacks the traditional closure of physical presence.

Most appropriate course of Action

Option 4 - participate in the funeral ceremonies via video conferencing while continuing to lead the rescue operations.

Justification

1. **Upholding "Social Contract"** - Vijay's presence is critical for coordinating life-saving operations.
2. **Continuity of command in crisis** reduces confusion, delays, and operational risks.
3. **Fulfil emotional and ritual obligations** without abandoning duty
4. **Ethics of care in both directions** - compassion to victims and love for mother.
5. **Utilitarian balance** - well-being of the greatest number while preserving personal dignity.
6. **Prevention of administrative breakdown** - Avoids last-minute delegation to an unfamiliar officer during a deteriorating disaster.
7. **Nishkam Karmayoga** - performing one's Dharma (duty) in a selfless manner is the highest form of spiritual practice.



8. **Team Morale** - The ground staff will be inspired to work with unprecedented dedication, seeing their leader's sacrifice.
9. **Role model leadership** - Sets ethical precedent for administrators.

Case Study - Mohammad Siraj continued representing India in Australia despite death of his father in 2021.

Vijay's choice reflects the ancient wisdom that "**Service to Humanity is the highest form of worship.**"

[Case Study 2] In line with the Directive Principles of State Policy enshrined in the Indian Constitution, the government has a constitutional obligation to ensure basic needs - Roti, Kapda aur Makan (Food, Clothes and Shelter) - for the under-privileged. Pursuing this mandate, the district administration proposed clearing a portion of forest land to develop housing for the homeless and economically weaker sections of the society. The proposed land, however, is an ecologically sensitive zone densely populated with age-old trees, medicinal plants and vital biodiversity. Besides, these forests help to regulate micro-climate and rainfalls, provide habitat for wildlife, support soil fertility and prevent land/soil erosion and sustain livelihoods of tribal and nomadic communities. In spite of the ecological and social costs, the administration argues in favour of the said proposal by highlighting that this very initiative addresses fundamental human rights as a critical welfare priority. Besides, it fulfils the government's duty to uplift & empower the poor through inclusive housing development. Further, these forest areas have become unsafe due to wild-animal threats and recurring human-wildlife conflicts. Lastly, clearing forest-zones may help to curb anti-social elements allegedly using these areas as hideouts, thereby enhancing law and order.

- (a) Can deforestation be ethically justified in the pursuit of social welfare objectives like housing for the homeless?
- (b) What are the socio-economic, administrative and ethical challenges in balancing environmental conservation with human development?
- (c) What substantial alternatives or policy interventions can be proposed to ensure that both environmental integrity and human dignity are protected?

The case presents a conflict between Articles 38, 39, 41 and 47 under **DPSP** and the **constitutional duty of environmental protection** under Articles 48A and 51A(g).

Guiding Principle - "Sustainable Justice with Least Ecological Harm."

1. Ethical Justification for deforestation

Justification

- a. **Last-resort necessity** - Eg- Rehabilitation housing after **Uttarakhand floods (2013)** used limited forest fringes.
- b. **Right to shelter priority** - Eg- **PM Awas Yojana (PMAY)** sites in semi-forested areas for landless poor.
- c. **Human Safety**- Eliminating "unsafe" zones reduces human-wildlife conflict and crime.
- d. **Minimal clearance principle** - Eg- Eco-hamlets in **Sikkim** with limited tree felling.
- e. **Compensatory afforestation** - Equal or greater reforestation elsewhere.
- f. **Prior informed consent of tribals** - Respect for forest rights under **FRA, 2006**.
- g. **Net social benefit test** - If homelessness harm outweighs ecological loss.
- h. **Eco-sensitive construction** - Green housing rather than concrete sprawl.

Argument against

- a. **Inter-generational injustice** - Future generations lose ecological assets.

- b. **Intrinsic Value of Nature**- Biodiversity has a "Right to Exist" independent of human utility
- c. Loss of **Ecosystem Services** like rain, clean air that is more valuable than a house.
- d. **Displacement without consent** violates **tribal rights**
- e. **Non-Sustainability** - Eg- **Amazon Rainforest** clearing has led to decline in rainfall
- f. **Availability of alternatives** - If other land exists, forest clearance is unethical.
- g. **Disaster risk** - Eg- Landslides in **Himachal and Uttarakhand** after forest clearing

2. Challenges in balancing environmental conservation with human development

Socio-economic challenges

1. **Displacement of tribal communities** - Loss of livelihoods and culture.
2. **Human-wildlife conflict escalation** - Habitat fragmentation increases clashes.
3. **Livelihood Displacement**- Losing minor forest produce. Eg- Kendu leaf collectors in Odisha).
4. **Cultural Loss**- Destruction of "Sacred Groves" and medicinal knowledge.

Administrative challenges

1. **Weak land-use planning** - Poor zoning leading to forest encroachment.
2. **Siloed Governance** - Lack of synergy between forest, housing and revenue departments.
3. **Law Enforcement**- Eg- Naxal-affected Red Corridor areas.
4. **Corruption/land mafia** - Eg- Encroachments in **Aravalli range (Haryana-Rajasthan)**.
5. **Land Scarcity**- Lack of non-forest government land in hilly or tribal districts. Eg- Land constraints in Sikkim or Nagaland.
6. **Implementation Gaps**- Under utilization of CAMPA funds. (CAG report).

Ethical challenges

1. **Development vs Conservation** - Welfare of today vs rights of tomorrow.
2. **Anthropocentrism vs Ecocentrism** - Human priority vs nature's intrinsic value.
3. **Rights-based dilemma** - Right to housing vs right to clean environment.
4. **Utilitarian vs Deontological ethics** - Maximum good vs moral duty to nature.
5. **Justice as Fairness**- Is it fair to house the homeless by displacing the tribals?
6. **Rights of animals** - further fragmentation of habitats

Policy interventions for balancing environmental integrity and human dignity

- a. **Use degraded non-forest land first** - Brownfield sites over pristine forests.
- b. **Vertical affordable housing** - Eg- **Mumbai SRA model** for EWS housing.
- c. **In-situ slum redevelopment** - Eg- **Delhi JJ cluster redevelopment**.
- d. **Agro-Forestry Housing** and "Eco-Villages." Eg- Auroville, Pondicherry.
- e. **Use idle government land** - Railways/Defence/Revenue land.
- f. **Satellite town planning** - Planned peri-urban expansion. Eg- **Navi Mumbai model**.
- g. Use of **sustainable materials** (bamboo, recycled waste) to reduce construction impact. Eg- Kerala's Laurie Baker style.
- h. **Strict FRA, 2006 compliance** - Prior informed consent of tribals mandatory.
- i. **Robust EIA + public hearings** for transparent decision-making.
- j. **Human-wildlife conflict mitigation** - Solar fencing, corridors, early warning.
- k. Implement "**Zoning**" where "Ecologically Sensitive Area 1" is strictly off-limits. (Gadgil Committee)

As the **Supreme Court** noted in the **T.N. Godavarman** case, the "Precautionary Principle" must prevail. True social welfare lies in **Sustainable Habitat**, not just concrete blocks.

[Case Study 3] Subhash is Secretary, PWD in the State Government. He is a senior officer, known for his competence, integrity and dedication to work. He enjoys the trust and confidence of Minister incharge of PWD and Programme Implementation. As a part of his job profile, he is responsible for policy formulations, execution of projects relating to infrastructure initiatives in the State. Besides, he oversees the technical and administrative aspects relating to planning, designing and construction etc. Subhash's Minister is an important Minister in the state and significant growth in urban infrastructure development and road network has been registered during his tenure. He is very keen for launching of ambitious road construction project in the near future. Subhash is in regular touch with the Minister and is working various modalities of road construction project. Regular meetings, interactions and presentations are made by him to the Minister based on a formal public announcement of the project is made by the Minister. Subhash's only son Vikas is in real estate business. His son from his own sources is aware that a mega road project is on the anvil and announcement in this regard is expected anytime. He is very keen to know from his father the exact location of the upcoming project. He knows that there would be quantum jump in the prices of land in the vicinity. Buying land at this stage at cheaper prices would pay him rich dividends. He is pleading with him (his father) day in and day out to share him location of the proposed project. He assured him that he would handle the matter discreetly as it would not attract any adverse notice as he in the normal course, keeps on buying land as a part of his business. He feels pressurised because of constant pleadings by his son. Another significant aspect of the matter pertained to the extra/undue interest in the above project by the Minister PWD. His nephew was also having big infrastructure project company. In fact, the Minister has also introduced his nephew to him and indicated to him to take care of his nephew's business interest in the forthcoming project. The Minister encouraged him to act fast in the matter as early announcement and execution of mega road project would enhance his status in the party and public life. In the above backdrop, Subhash is in a fix as to the future course of action.

(a) Discuss the ethical issues involved in the case.

(b) Critically examine the options available to Subhash in the above situation?

(c) Which of the above would be most appropriate and why?

"Public office is a public trust. When private interest prevails over public duty, governance fails."

The above case highlights the tension between **public duty**, **political pressure**, and **familial loyalty**, placing Subhash at the crossroads of ethics, legality, and administrative propriety.

Guiding Principles

- **Public interest supremacy.**
- **Integrity and neutrality.**
- **Transparency and fairness.**
- **Rule of law and due process**

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Conflict of Interest-** duty to maintain official secrecy conflicts with his son's commercial interests
2. Using "insider information" for private gain violates **CCS (Conduct) Rules** and **Public Trust Doctrine**
3. **Crisis of Conscience** for subhash - managing expectations of son, minister and duty
4. **Nepotism and Cronyism-** Minister pushing his nephew's company threatens fairness.
5. The Minister's pressure to "act fast" threatens **objective planning and due process.**
6. **Personal vs. Professional Ethics-** test of Subhash's **Fortitude** and professional detachment.

7. **Procedural injustice** - Favouring one firm undermines competitive bidding.
8. Any **wrongdoing** can damage **citizens' faith** in infrastructure governance.
9. Favouring Minister's nephew may lead to corruption and increase project cost - violation of **resource stewardship**

Critical Examination of Options

Option 1- Yield to both the Son and the Minister.

Merit	Demerits
Maintains domestic peace	Criminal Offense - Liable under the Prevention of Corruption Act.
Secures the Minister's continued trust.	Vulnerability - Opens doors for future blackmail.
Ensures rapid project launching.	Moral Decay - Destroys his lifelong reputation for integrity.

Option 2- Refuse information to son, ensure transparent process and seek written directions if pressured

Merit	Demerit
Upholds integrity and legality	Psychological Stress - Facing isolation from both family and the boss.
Protects him from future allegations	Possible transfer or sidelining
Maintains bureaucratic neutrality	Delays decision-making process

Option 3 - Seek Transfer citing potential conflict of interest

Merit	Demerit
Professional prudence	Abdication of responsibility (Escapism)
Set ethical benchmark for other officers	Successor's Burden - He may be replaced by a "pliable" officer
Preserves Relationships	Loss of opportunity to safeguard public interest within the system

Most appropriate course of action - Option 2

Action	Justification
Firmly refuse to share any confidential details with his son.	Prioritises public interest over private gain .
Politely resist any attempt to favour the Minister's nephew.	Upholds rule of law and constitutional morality . Protects Subhash legally and ethically.
Insist on open competitive bidding , independent technical evaluation, and clear eligibility norms.	Ensures value for public money and fair competition.
Seek written instructions if political pressure continues	Preserves credibility of the civil service .

A transparent, rule-based process combined with principled resistance to undue pressure represents the highest standard of ethical public administration.

[Case Study 4] “Rajesh is a Group A officer with nine years of service. He is posted as Administrative Officer in an Oil Public Sector undertaking. As an Administrative Officer he is responsible for managing and coordinating various administrative tasks to ensure smooth functioning of office. He also manages office supplies, equipment etc. Rajesh is now sufficient senior and is expecting his next promotion in JAG (Junior Administrative Grade) in the next one or two years. He knows that promotion is based on examination of ACRs/Performance Appraisal of last few years (5 years or so) of an officer by a DPC (Departmental Promotion Committee) and an officer lacking requisite grading of ACRs may not be found fit for promotion. Consequences of losing promotion may entail financial and reputational loss and set-back for career progression. Though he also puts his best efforts in official discharge of his duties, yet he is unsure of assessment by his superior officer. He is now putting extra efforts so that he gets a thumping report at the end of the financial year. As Administrative Officer, Rajesh is regularly interacting with his immediate boss, who is his reporting officer for writing his ACR. One day he calls Rajesh and wants him to buy computer-related stationery on priority from a particular vendor. Rajesh instructs his office to initiate action for procuring these items. During the day, the dealing Assistant brings an estimate of Rupees Thirty Five Lakhs covering all stationery items from the same vendor. It is noticed that as per delegated financial powers, as provided in the GFR (General Financial Rules) as applicable in that Organisation, expenditure for office items exceeding Rupees Thirty Lakhs requires sanction of the next higher authority (boss in the present case). Rajesh knows that immediate superior would expect all these purchases should be done at his level, and may not appreciate such lack of initiative on his part. During discussions with office, he learns that common practice of splitting of expenditure (where large order is divided into a series of smaller ones) is followed to avoid obtaining sanction from higher authority. This practice is against the rules and may come to the adverse notice of Audit. Rajesh is perturbed. He is unsure of taking decision in the matter.”

- (a) What are the options available with Rajesh in the above situation?
- (b) What are the ethical issues involved in this case?
- (c) Which would be the most appropriate option for Rajesh and why?

This case study illustrates the classic "**Seniority-Integrity Trap**." Rajesh faces a dilemma between **career security** and **rule compliance**.

Guiding principle - “Integrity is doing the right thing, even when no one is watching.”

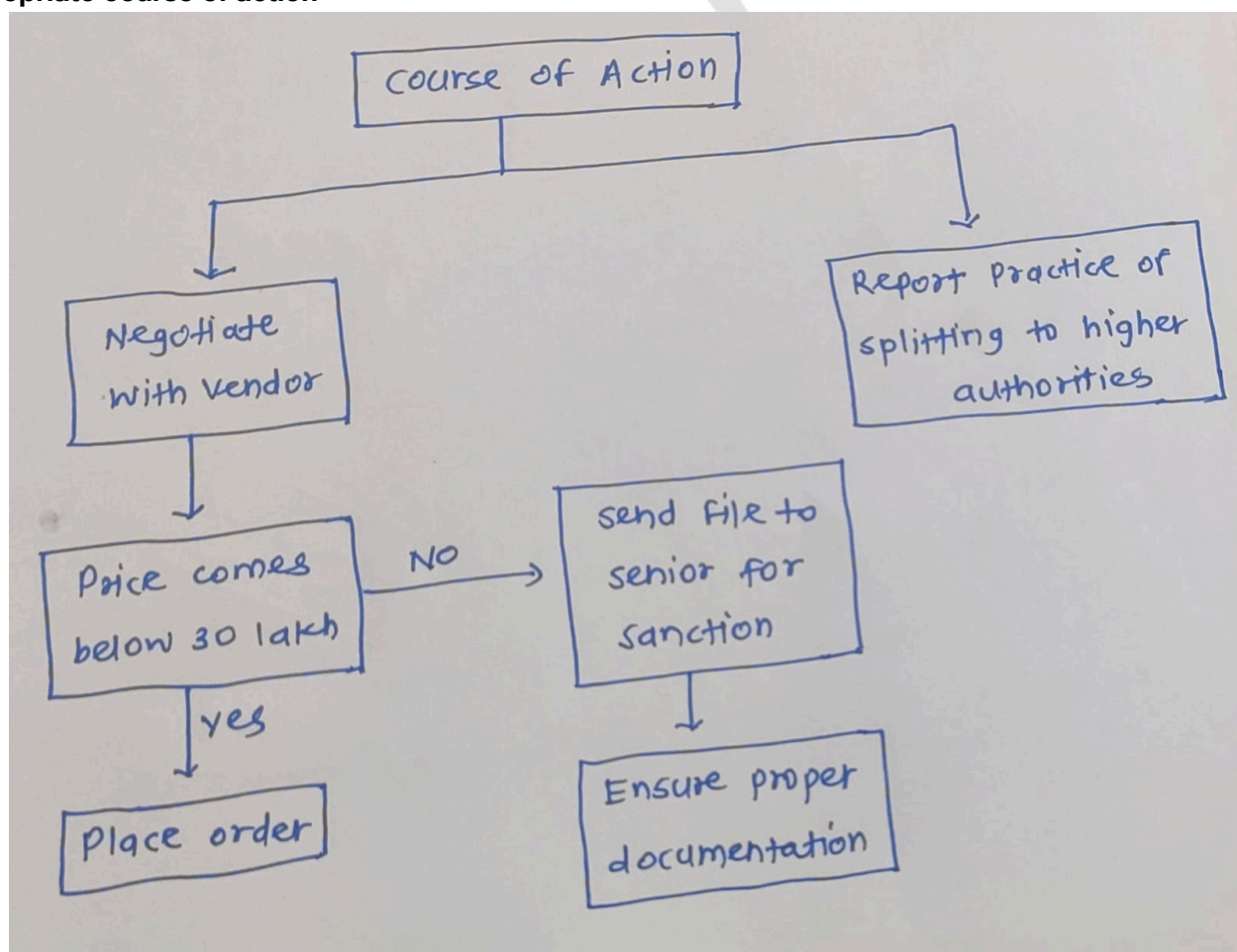
Options available to Rajesh

1. **Proceed with splitting** the purchase into smaller orders to keep each below Rs 30 lakh.
2. Consolidate the purchase and place the file before the competent authority for **prior sanction as per GFR**.
3. Explain the GFR limits to his boss and **request permission** to follow the prescribed procedure.
4. **Seek written instructions** from his boss if he insists on immediate purchase without higher approval.
5. **Negotiate with the Vendor** to bring the total estimate below ₹30 Lakhs
6. **Keep the file pending** under the guise of "technical evaluation" to avoid **adverse notice of Audit**

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Conflict of Interest**- A clash between personal career aspiration and professional duty to follow financial rules.
2. The superior officer's "suggestion" to use a specific vendor hints at **cronyism or potential kickbacks**.
3. **Integrity vs. Expediency**- temptation to take the "easy path" to please the boss versus the harder path of rule compliance.
4. Allowing "common practices" of rule-breaking erodes the **ethical work culture**.
5. **Violation of GFR** - Splitting expenditure deliberately circumvents **financial propriety**.
6. **Integrity vs obedience** - Tension between obeying the boss and upholding **institutional integrity**.
7. **Transparency deficit** - Single-vendor purchase threatens **fair and open procurement**.
8. Potential audit objection raises concerns of **administrative probity**.
9. **Public trust** - Rule violation can erode citizens' faith in a **public sector undertaking**.
10. **Fiduciary Duty**- obligation to protect public funds from potentially overpriced or biased procurement
11. **Professional courage** - Test of Rajesh's **moral courage** to stand by rules despite career risk.

Most appropriate course of action



Ethical principle	How the action satisfies it
Resource Stewardness	Safeguards public money from misuse
Rule of law	Strict compliance with GFR provisions
Integrity	Refuses to manipulate financial procedures
Transparency and Accountability	Creates a written audit trail

Probity	Prevents suspicion of favouritism, cartelisation or kickbacks.
Professional courage	Stands by rules despite ACR risk

Case Study - In **Common Wealth Games Scam**, CBI found "**procedural irregularities**," including splitting contracts to avoid higher-level scrutiny and favoring specific vendors.

By standing firm on the GFR, he demonstrates the **Fortitude**. True competence lies in managing administrative tasks within the boundaries of the law, not in bypassing them.

[Case Study 5] “Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Program, MGNREGA was earlier known as National Rural Employment Scheme, NREGA. It is an Indian Social Welfare Program that aimed at fulfilling the ‘Right to Work’ provisions made in the Constitution. MGNREGA was launched in 2006 under Rural Employment Sector by the Ministry of Rural Development. Main objective of the program is to give legal guarantee of wage employment to the adult members of rural households who are willing to do unskilled manual labour work subject to a maximum of 100 days per year for every household. Every rural household has the right to register under the scheme, job card is issued to the registered, Job Card holder can seek employment. State government shall pay 25% of minimum wage for the first 30 days as compensatory daily unemployment allowance to the families and of wage for remaining period of the year. MGNREGA work was undertaken by various Gram Panchayats. You have been appointed as an Administrator Incharge of the District. You have been given the responsibility of monitoring MGNREGA work undertaken by various Gram Panchayats. You are also given the authority to give technical sanctions to all MGNREGA works. In one of the Panchayats in your jurisdiction, you notice that your predecessor has mismanaged the Program in terms of- (i) Money not disbursed to actual job-seekers. (ii) Muster Rolls of the Labourers not properly maintained. (iii) Mismatch between the work done and payments made. (iv) Payments made to fictitious persons. (v) Job Cards were given without looking into the need of person. (vi) Mismanagement of funds & to the extent of siphoning of funds. (vii) Approved works that never existed.

(a) What is your reaction to the above situation and how do you restore the proper functioning of MGNREGA Program in this regard?

(b) What actions would you initiate to solve the various issues listed above?

(c) How would you deal with the above situation?

This case involves a systemic failure of administrative oversight and a blatant violation of the "**Public Trust Doctrine**."

Guiding Principles - Gandhian Talisman and Probity in governance

Reaction to the above situation

1. I would treat this as a case of **systemic corruption and institutional failure**, not mere procedural lapse.

- I would express my dissatisfaction over the functioning of the scheme in the Gram Sabha meeting. It is a clear violation of **Right to Work and Right to Wages**.
- I will pledge **restorative justice** for beneficiaries and **accountability of officials**.

Restoring proper functionality

- I would shift the administrative culture from "**Opacity and Discretion**" to "**Transparency and Accountability**."
- Zero Tolerance Policy**- Clearly communicate that any further leakages will result in immediate suspension and criminal prosecution.
- Technological Intervention**- Rapidly deploy the **NMMS (National Mobile Monitoring System)** for real-time attendance to prevent fake muster rolls.
- Social Empowerment**- Re-activate the Social Audit units to involve the community in monitoring.

Actions to solve the various issues listed above

Issue	Specific Action Initiated
Fictitious Persons & Fake Payments	Aadhaar Seeding - Mandatory 100% Aadhaar-Based Payment System to ensure "Money to the Right Hand."
Improper Muster Rolls	Digital Attendance - Enforce geo-tagged, time-stamped photos of workers twice a day via the NMMS app.
Non-existent/Paper Works	Geo-MGNREGA - Use satellite imagery to verify the physical existence of assets.
Siphoning of Funds	Commission a third-party forensic audit of the previous two years' accounts to trace the money trail.
Job Card Mismanagement	Conduct a " Jan Sunwai " to verify active job-seekers
Work-Payment Mismatch	Deploy a team of independent engineers to measure work done vs. funds released and recover excess payments.

Dealing with above situation

Immediate Measures

- I will **suspend** further MGNREGA payments in the concerned Panchayat pending inquiry.
- Seize and secure** muster rolls, job cards, measurement books, and bank records for investigation
- Show-Cause Notices** to the concerned Gram Rozgar Sahayak or Panchayat Secretary.
- FIR Filing** for cheating and forgery.
- Recovery**- Initiate proceedings to seize assets of those found guilty of embezzlement.
- I will submit a **detailed "Special Report"** to the State Government and the Lokayukta regarding the predecessor's negligence or complicity.

Long term measures

- Conduct training for Gram Panchayats on the **Social Audit** and mandatory audit every six months
- Asset Quality**- Focus on creating "Productive Assets" (like ponds or wells) - harder to fake their existence.
- Ensure 100% of payments go directly into the bank accounts of workers through **DBT**
- Grievance Redressal**- Set up a dedicated 24/7 District Helpline for workers who have not received payments.
- I will create a district-level **third-party technical review panel** for high-value works.

By integrating **technological transparency** with **social accountability**, I will move the district from a state of "Administrative Paralysis" to one of "**Pro-active Transparency**."

[Case Study 6] "Ashok is Divisional Commissioner of one of the border districts of the North East State. A few years back, Military has taken over the neighbouring country after overthrowing the elected civil government. Civil law situation is prevailing in the country especially in last two years. However, internal situation further deteriorated due to rebel groups taking over control of certain populated areas near own border. Due to intense fight between military and rebel groups, civilian casualties has increased manifold in recent past. In the meantime, in one night Ashok, got 200-250 people, mainly women and children trying cross over to our side of the border. There are also about 10 children with their weapons in military uniform part of this group who wants to cross over. Women and children are also crying and begging for help. A few of them are injured and bleeding profusely need immediate medical care. Ashok tried to contact Home Secretary of the State but failed to do so due to poor connectivity mainly due to inclement weather."

(a) What are the options available with Ashok to cope with the situation?

(b) What are the ethical and legal dilemmas being faced by Ashok?

(c) Which of the options, do you think would be more appropriate for Ashok to adopt and why?

(d) In the present situation, what are the extra precautionary measures to be taken by the Border Guarding Police in dealing with soldiers in uniform?

The situation mirrors the **humanitarian spillover of the Myanmar crisis** following the military coup, which has generated internal conflict, displacement, and cross-border refugee flows (ethnic Chin and Rohingya communities) into India's North-East.

Options Available to Ashok

1. **Deny entry** entirely and push the group back across the border to uphold territorial sovereignty.
2. **Open the gates** for all 250 individuals, including the armed child soldiers, without delay.
3. Allow civilians inside while disarming and isolating armed minors.
4. **Triage-Based Entry**- Admit only the "bleeding profusely" and critically injured for medical care
5. Provide **food, blankets, and medical aid** at the border line without allowing a formal crossing.
6. **Reach out to the UNHCR or Red Cross** (if accessible) to take over the humanitarian aspect.
7. **Wait for Orders**- Keep the group in a "no-man's land" until communication with the Home Secretary is restored.
8. Involve **local village heads** or NGOs to help manage the crowd and provide temporary subsistence.

Ethical and Legal Dilemmas

Ethical Dilemmas

1. **Humanity vs. Security**- "Right to Life" (Article 21) vs risk of infiltration by militants.
2. **Child Protection vs. Combatant**- Treating the 10 armed children as victims of war or as security threats.
3. **Compassion vs Sovereignty** - Moral duty to help refugees versus territorial integrity.
4. **Empathy vs. Rule-Following**- The emotional toll of seeing "bleeding children" vs border protocols
5. **Moral Hazard**- The fear that helping this group will encourage thousands more to cross
6. **Conscience vs Procedure** - Acting morally without formal approval.
7. **Speed vs Due process** - Urgency of medical aid versus legal formalities.

Legal Dilemmas

1. **Foreigner Act vs Right to Life (Article 21)** - Detain/turn back illegal entrants **vs** allow entry to save lives.
2. **Arms Act, 1959 vs Juvenile Justice (JJ) Act, 2015**

3. Seizure and prosecution under the **Arms Act, 1959** versus protection and rehabilitation under **Juvenile Justice Act, 2015**
4. **Non-refoulement Principle vs India's sovereign right to regulate entry.**
5. **Right of Border Police to use force versus duty to avoid harm to unarmed civilians and minors.**

Course of action

Course of Action	Justification
allow entry to injured persons, women and children	Right to Life (Article 21) - Saving life takes precedence over procedural barriers in an emergency.
Provide urgent medical treatment at once	Humanitarian Duty & Public Health Obligation
Disarm all children in military uniform at the border itself	Ensures Rule of Law
4Separate armed minors from civilians in a secure facility	Balancing Child Protection + National Security
Conduct rapid biometric registration and screening	Maintains record, prevents infiltration, and ensures traceability.
Inform State Government, MHA, and Border Security agencies at earliest	Adherence Due Process and accountability

Ashok must strike a balance between **humanitarian compassion and national security.**

"Borders must guard the nation, but humanity must guard the vulnerable."

2024

[Case Study 1] “There is a technological company named ABC Incorporated which is the second largest worldwide, situated in the Third World. You are the Executive Officer and the majority shareholder of this company. The fast technological improvements have raised worries among environmental activists, regulatory authorities, and the general public over the sustainability of this scenario. You confront substantial issues about the business’s environmental footprint. In 2023, your organization had a significant increase of 48% in greenhouse gas emissions compared to the levels recorded in 2019. The significant rise in energy consumption is mainly due to the surging energy requirements of your data centers, fuelled by the exponential expansion of Artificial Intelligence (AI). AI-powered services need much more computational resources and electrical energy compared to conventional online activities, notwithstanding their notable gains. The technology’s proliferation has led to a growing concern over the environmental repercussions, resulting in an increase in warnings. AI models, especially those used in extensive machine learning and data processing, exhibit much greater energy consumption than conventional computer tasks, with an exponential increase.

Although there is already a commitment and goal to achieve net zero emissions by 2030, the challenge of lowering emissions seems overwhelming as the integration of AI continues to increase. To achieve this goal, substantial investments in renewable energy use would be necessary. The difficulty is exacerbated by the competitive environment of the technology sector, where rapid innovation is essential for preserving market standing and shareholders worth. To achieve a balance between innovation, profitability and sustainability, a strategic move is necessary that is in line with both, business objectives and ethical obligations

- (a) What is your immediate response to the challenges posed in the above case?
- (b) Discuss the ethical issues involved in the above case.
- (c) Your company has been identified to be penalized by technological giants. What logical and ethical arguments will you put forth to convince about its necessity?
- (d) Being a conscience being, what measures would you adopt to maintain balance between AI innovation and environmental footprint?”

“We do not inherit the earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children.”

As the Executive Officer and majority shareholder, I find myself at the intersection of the most significant technological revolution in history (AI) and the most pressing ecological crisis (Climate Change).

My vision - Responsible innovation as commerce without morality is a sin

Immediate Response to the Challenges

1. **Transparency and Disclosure**- Publish a full "Carbon Gap Report."
2. **Immediate Expansion**- Sign long-term **PPA (Power Purchase Agreements)** to fund new solar/wind farms in the local "Third World" region.
3. Transition to **liquid cooling or natural cooling** methods. Eg- **Facebook (Meta)** located data centers in Sweden, to use sub-arctic air for natural cooling.
4. Announce a binding 2030 **decarbonisation** plan with interim milestones (2025, 2027). Eg- **Google's "24/7 Carbon-Free Energy" roadmap.**
5. Invite **third-party experts** to assess data-centre emissions.
6. **Freeze new fossil-powered facilities** until clean power is secured.
7. **Invest in energy-efficient AI architecture** - Shift to lighter, modular AI models.

8. **Engage stakeholders proactively** - Consult regulators and shareholders before scaling AI.

Ethical issues involved

1. **Profit vs planet** - Pursuit of market dominance increases emissions.
2. **Intergenerational injustice** - Current benefits impose climate costs on future generations.
3. **Environmental injustice** - Third-world communities bear pollution while users are global.
4. **Greenwashing Risk**- Claiming a 2030 Net-Zero goal while actual emissions are skyrocketing.
5. **Shareholder vs. Stakeholder Conflict**- Prioritizing quarterly stock value over the survival of the biosphere.
6. **Competition** among tech giants for AI development
7. **Precautionary principle violation** - Scaling AI despite known ecological risks.
8. **Corporate accountability deficit** - Externalising environmental costs to society.
9. Violation of **duty of care to ecosystems** - Biodiversity loss from land, water, and energy extraction.
10. **Energy Poverty**- AI data centers competing with local hospitals or schools for limited electricity in a developing nation.

Arguments Against Penalties by Technological Giants

Logical Arguments

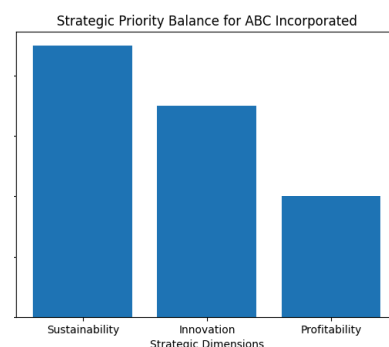
1. Penalizing a "Third World" giant **hurts the global supply chain**.
2. **Need for "grace period"** to transition, similar to the CBDR in the Paris Agreement.
3. **Net-Positive Potential**- Our AI can provide climate solutions (crop yield, grid optimization) which offsets the training cost.
4. Penalties can create a **Western monopoly** on AI, stifling innovations in developing economies.
5. **Investment over Penalty**- Capital can be better used for renewable infrastructure than for paying fines to competitors.
6. **Data Sovereignty**- need for local data storage and processing

Ethical Arguments

1. **Fairness principle** - Punishing one firm while others expand is inequitable.
2. **Eco-Colonialism**- First World giants polluted for 100 years to get ahead.
3. **The Right to Development**- Access to AI is a modern human right for developing nations to escape poverty.
4. **Good-faith effort** - ABC has a net-zero pledge and credible investments.
5. **Restorative over punitive** - Support transition rather than impose crippling fines.
6. **Global equity** - Developing-world firms need flexibility compared to rich-world giants.
7. **Distributive Justice**- AI can democratize education/medicine in the Third World
8. **Vulnerability**- Penalizing a major Third World employer causes local economic and job losses.

Measures for Balance

1. **Green AI R&D**- Mandate that 20% of compute goes toward environmental research. Eg- NVIDIA's Earth-2 digital twin.
2. **Circular Economy for E-Waste**- 100% recycling of hardware. Eg- Apple's Daisy robot.
3. **Water Stewardship**- Use closed-loop cooling and grey water for cooling. Eg- Microsoft's goal to be "Water Positive" by 2030.
4. **Renewable Energy Co-location**- Build solar farms on-site. Eg- Tesla's Gigafactories.
5. Locate facilities near **clean-energy hubs**. Eg- near wind rich sites
6. Adherence to principle of **environmental stewardship** by investing in carbon sequestration. Eg- compensatory afforestation
7. **AI for climate optimisation** - Use AI to stabilise grids and cut cooling energy. Eg- DeepMind cut Google data-centre cooling energy by ~30%.
8. **Annual verified sustainability reporting** - Independent audits with public dashboards.
9. **Ethical AI Filtering**- Refuse AI projects that facilitate fossil fuel extraction. Eg- Google's pledge to stop building custom AI for oil/gas.



Innovation without sustainability is not progress. It is an "accelerated debt." ABC Incorporated must shift from **growth at any cost** to **responsible growth with conscience**.

[Case Study 2] “Raman is a senior IPS officer and has recently been posted as D.G. of a state. Among the various issues and problems/challenges which needed his immediate attention, the issue relating to recruitment of unemployed youth by an unknown terrorist group, was a matter of grave concern. It was noted that unemployment was relatively high in the state. The problem of unemployment amongst graduates and those with higher education was much more grave. Thus they were vulnerable and soft targets. In the review meeting taken by him with senior officers of DIG Range and above, it came to light that a new terrorist group has emerged at the global level. It has launched a massive drive to recruit young unemployed people. Special focus was to pick young people from a particular community. The said organisation seemed to have the clear objective of utilizing/using them for carrying out militant activities. It was also gathered that the said (new) group is desperately trying to spread its tentacles in his state. A definite/reliable intelligence tip was received by the State CID and Cyber Cell that a large number of such unemployed youth have already been contacted by the terrorist outfit/group through social media and local communal organisations and other contacts. The need of the hour was to act swiftly and to check these elements/designs before they assume serious proportions. Discrete inquiries made by the police, through the Cyber Cell revealed that good numbers of unemployed youth are very active on Facebook, Instagram and Twitter. On an average, many of them were spending 8 hours each day, using electronic devices/internet, etc. It also came to light that such unemployed youth were showing sympathy and endorsing the messages received from certain persons, allegedly the contact persons of that global terrorist group. Their social media accounts revealed their strong affinity for such groups as many of them started forwarding anti-national tweets on their WhatsApp and Facebook, etc. It seemed that they succumbed to their ploy and started propagating secessionist ideology. Their posts were hyper-critical of the government's initiatives, policies and subscribing to extreme beliefs and promoting extremism.

- (a) What are the options available to Raman to tackle the above situation?
- (b) What measures would you suggest for strengthening the existing set-up to ensure that such groups do not succeed in penetrating and vitiating the atmosphere in the state?
- (c) In the above scenario, what action plan would you advise for enhancing the intelligence gathering mechanism of the police force?”

This scenario highlights a **"New Age" security threat** where socioeconomic grievances are weaponized through digital radicalization. As the DGP, Raman faces the challenge of protecting the state's security while preventing the criminalization of its youth.

Guiding Principles

1. **Rashtra-raksha dharma sarvopari**
2. **Corrective Policing**
3. **"Hearts and Minds"** approach

Options Available to Raman

1. **Legal Action-** Arresting key influencers under the **UAPA** or **NSA**.
2. **Account Takedowns-** Coordination with tech platforms to suspend handles propagating extremism. (**Section 69A of the IT Act**)
3. **Counter-Narrative Campaigns-** Eg- Kerala Police's Cyberdome counter-extremism initiative.
4. **Employment-Security Linkage-** Collaborating with the government to launch skill development for "at-risk" youth. Eg- **Project 'Himayat'** in Jammu & Kashmir.

Strengthening the Existing Set-Up

Short-Term Measures

1. **Targeted intelligence-led action** against recruiters, handlers, and financiers based on verified evidence. Eg- **NIA precision strikes against PFI modules**
2. **Special Deradicalization Cells-** Establish district-level units comprising psychologists and moderate clerics. Eg- Kerala's 'Operation Pigeon'
3. **Social Media Monitoring Labs** to identify hotspots. Eg- UP Police's 'Social Media Command & Control Centre'
4. **Quick Response Teams (QRTs)-** For neutralizing physical recruitment meetings identified via cyber-surveillance.
5. **Helplines for Parents-** Anonymous portals where parents can report signs of radicalization in their children.
6. **Fact-Checking Units-** Immediate debunking of fake news used to incite communal passions.
7. **Targeted Skill Workshops-** Short-term certification courses for the youths
8. **Public Awareness Ads-** "Stay Safe Online" campaigns targeted at the specific vulnerable demographic.
9. **Surveillance of Communal Organizations-** Discrete monitoring of NGOs/local groups acting as recruitment fronts.

Long-Term Measures

1. **Institutionalized Community Policing-** Eg- 'Friends of Police' in Tamil Nadu
2. **Vulnerability Mapping-** Creating a database of districts with high unemployment and high internet penetration.
3. **Capacity building** of police officers as suggested in **Prakash Singh Case**
4. **Employment generation for graduates** - Targeted internships, apprenticeships, start-ups.
5. **Youth Mentorship Programs-** Pairing successful professionals from the same community with at-risk youth.
6. **Community-Led Deradicalization-** Engaging parents and religious elders. Eg- The **"Maharashtra Model"** - ATS officers successfully deradicalized over 100 youth without filing FIRs.
7. **Education reform** - Teach constitutional values, media literacy, and civic ethics.
8. **Inclusive development** - Focus on backward districts and minority communities. Eg- **Aspirational Districts Programme**.
9. Promoting **Religious harmony platforms** - Eg- Inter-faith dialogues and youth peace clubs.

Action Plan for Enhancing Intelligence Gathering

1. **Strengthening State Intelligence Bureau (SIB)-** Increasing the human intelligence (HUMINT) footprint in sensitive areas. Eg- J&K police village defence committees.
2. **Open Source Intelligence (OSINT)-** Leveraging AI to scan public platforms for "Red Flag" keywords.
3. **Digital Human Intelligence (D-HUMINT)-** Planting discrete "undercover" digital personas in private groups/servers to identify recruiters. Eg- operation chakravyuh by IB
4. **Financial Intelligence (FININT)-** Tracking small, suspicious UPI/crypto transactions linked to local organizations.
5. **Big Data Analytics-** Mapping the "Social Network" of contact persons to find the "Hubs" of the network.

6. Integrating data from the **NATGRID** and **CCTNS** for a 360-degree view of suspects.
7. **Incentivized Informant Networks-** Providing rewards for "Intelligence on Radicalizers" within communal organizations.
8. **Inter-State Intelligence Sharing** to track the movement of "travelling recruiters."
9. **Community Feedback Loops-** Using local "Peace Committees" as "Human Sensors" for subtle shifts in the communal atmosphere.

In the war of ideologies, the most powerful weapon is not a gun, but a **Better Alternative**. This can be ensured by addressing the root cause (unemployment) of alienation.

CIVILSDAILY IAS



[Case Study 3] “With a multipronged strategy of the Central and State Governments specially in the last few years, the naxalite problem has been resolved to a large extent in the affected states of the country. However, there are a few pockets in certain states where the naxalite problem still persists, mainly due to involvement of foreign countries. Rohit is posted as SP (Special Operations) for the last one year, in one of the districts which is still affected by the naxalite problem. The district administration has taken a lot of developmental works in the recent past in the naxalite affected areas to win the hearts and minds of the people. Over a period of time, Rohit has established an excellent intelligence network to get the real time information regarding the movement of naxalite cadres. To instill confidence in the public and have moral ascendancy over the naxalites, a number of cordons and search operations are being conducted by the police. Rohit, who himself was leading one of the contingents got a message through his intelligence source that about ten hard core naxalites were hiding in a particular village with sophisticated weapons. Without wasting any time, Rohit reached the target village with his team and laid out a foolproof cordon and started carrying out a systematic search. During the search, his team managed to overpower all the naxalites along with their automatic weapons. However, in the meantime, more than 5 hundred tribal women surrounded the village and started marching towards the target house. They were shouting and demanding the immediate release of insurgents since they are their protectors and saviours. The situation on the ground was becoming very critical as the tribal women were extremely agitated and aggressive. Rohit tried to contact his superior officer, IG (Special Operations) of the state on the radio set and on mobile phone, but failed to do so due to poor connectivity. Rohit was in great dilemma since out of the naxalites apprehended, two were not only hard core top insurgents with prize money of 7 ten lakhs on their heads, but were also involved in a recent ambush on the security forces. However, if he did not release the naxalites, the situation could get out of control since the tribal women were aggressively charging towards them. In that case, to control the situation Rohit might have to resort to firing which may lead to valuable loss of lives of civilians and would further complicate the situation.

(a) What are the options available with Rohit to cope with the situation ?

(b) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by Rohit ?

(c) Which of the options, do you think, would be more appropriate for Rohit to adopt and why?

(d) In the present situation, what are the extra precautionary measures to be taken by the police in dealing with women protesters?”

Due to efforts by centre and state governments, Naxal-affected districts have come down from **126 (2014) to only 11 (2025), with most-affected districts down from 36 to just 3**

The above case study is a classic example of "**Asymmetric Warfare**," where insurgents use the local population, specifically women, as a human shield and a psychological weapon against the state. Rohit must ensure success of a high-value operation without causing a public relations disaster.

Options available with Rohit

1. **Release all apprehended naxalites** to defuse tension immediately.
2. **Refuse release and use force if required**
3. **Partial release** - Release lower-level cadres but retain the two high-value insurgents.
4. **Temporary standoff** - Hold position, avoid confrontation, and wait for reinforcements or superior orders.

5. Negotiation with women leaders to calm the crowd while keeping custody.

Ethical dilemmas faced by Rohit

1. **Duty vs. Consequence** - His duty is to arrest criminals who killed security forces, but the consequence of doing so might be the death of innocent tribal women.
2. **Use of force vs right to life** - Firing could save police lives but risk civilian deaths.
3. **Rule of law vs community pressure** - Law demands arrest but community demands release.
4. **Short-term peace vs long-term security** - Immediate release may calm crowd but embolden naxalites.
5. **Professional courage vs compassion** - Holding firm may provoke violence but yielding may weaken rule of law.
6. **Operational success vs moral legitimacy** - A tactical win could turn into a public-relations and ethical disaster.

Course of action

1. **Immediate de-escalation** - Use loudspeakers to reassure women that no harm will come to them
2. **Negotiate with trusted tribal leaders**- Request 5-7 respected women elders to mediate.
3. **Maintain custody of high-value insurgents**- Do **not** release the two top cadres.
4. **Create a human buffer zone**- Deploy female police personnel and barriers to avoid confrontation
5. **Call reinforcements and medical teams**- Prepare for safe, controlled extraction.
6. **Gradual withdrawal under protection**- Move out in a disciplined formation without firing.
7. **Post-operation dialogue**- Hold a peace meeting with the village to explain legal necessity.

Justification

Principle	How it is satisfied
Right to life	Avoids firing and civilian casualties
Rule of law	Retains custody of dangerous criminals
Proportionality	Uses minimum necessary force
Public trust	Respects tribal concerns through dialogue
National security	Prevents escape of hardcore insurgents
Ethical policing	Balances firmness with compassion

Extra precautionary measures for police while dealing with women protesters

1. The police should treat them as "**Misguided Civilians**" rather than "Combatants."
2. **Deploy female police personnel (Mahila Battalion)** - Reduces tension and avoids allegations of harassment.
3. **No firearms use as first resort** - Follow **minimum force doctrine** strictly.
4. **Use non-lethal crowd control** - Water cannons, barriers, and tear gas only if unavoidable.
5. **Maintain safe distance buffer zone** to prevent physical contact or stampede.
6. **Continuous public communication** - Use loudspeakers to explain actions calmly.
7. **Identify and speak to community leaders**. Eg- local teacher, health worker (ASHA), or neutral village elder
8. **Provide medical support on-site** - Keep ambulances ready in case of injuries.
9. **Video documentation of operations** to protect police from false allegations.
10. **Post-incident grievance redressal** - Set up dialogue forum to rebuild trust.

In counter-insurgency, the "Moral High Ground" is the most important territory to hold. **"A successful operation is not only one that arrests criminals, but one that preserves public trust."**

[Case Study 4] “Sneha is a Senior Manager working for a big reputed hospital chain in a mid-sized city. She has been made in charge of the new super specialty center that the hospital is building with state-of-the-art equipment and world-class medical facilities. The building has been reconstructed and she is starting the process of procurement for various equipment and machine. As the head of the committee responsible for procurement, she has invited bids from all the interested reputed vendors dealing in medical equipment. She notices that her brother, who is a well-known supplier of this domain, has sent his expression of interest. Since the hospital privately not mandatory for her to select only the lower bidder. Also, she is aware that her brother’s company has been facing some financial difficulties and a big supply order will help him recover. At the same time, allocating the contract to her brother might bring charges of favouritism against her and tarnish her image. The hospital management trusts her fully and would support any decision of hers.

(a) What should be Sneha’s course of action?

(b) How would she justify what she chooses to do ?

(c) In this case, how is medical ethics compromised with vested personal interest ?”

This case highlights the "Conflict of Interest" in private sector procurement. While Sneha has the administrative freedom to choose any vendor, she is bound by **Fiduciary Duty** to the hospital and the **Principle of Public Trust**.

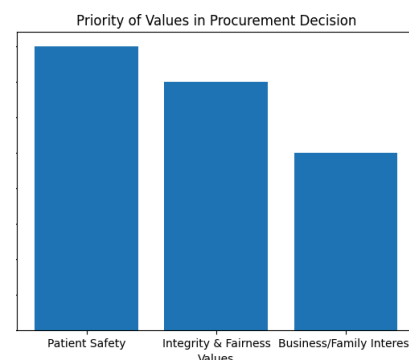
Guiding principle - The "Caesar’s Wife" Principle- A person in high office must not only be honest but must also be seen to be honest.

Sneha’s Course of Action

1. **Formal Disclosure-** She must immediately write to the Hospital Board or her superior, formally disclosing that one of the bidders is her brother.
2. **Recusal from Decision-Making-** She should voluntarily step down as the head of the procurement committee for this specific contract.
3. **Setting Benchmarks-** Before stepping down, she should ensure that the technical specifications and quality benchmarks are clearly defined.
4. She should request the management to appoint an independent **third party or another senior manager** to oversee the selection process. This ensures **meritocracy** in selection while preserving **integrity** of Sneha
5. She should **respect the committee’s verdict** even if her brother loses.
6. **Audit Trail-** Ensure every step of the vendor evaluation is documented, ensuring that if her brother wins, it is purely on **Merit** and **Price**.

Justification

1. **Fiduciary Duty-** Her primary loyalty is to the hospital's stakeholders and patients, not her family’s business.
2. **Integrity of process -** By recusing herself, she protects the **credibility of procurement** and her own reputation.
3. **Fairness to all vendors -** Every bidder gets an **equal opportunity**, avoiding allegations of nepotism.
4. **Patient-first principle -** Hospital equipment procurement must prioritise **quality and safety**, not personal relationships.
5. **Institutional trust and reputation -** Her transparency strengthens **management and public confidence** in the hospital.
6. **Legal protection -** Clear disclosure shields her from future complaints, audits, or litigation.
7. **Professional ethics -** She upholds **conflict-of-interest norms** expected from senior leadership.



8. **Compassion without corruption** - She helps her brother **only through fairness**, not by bending rules.

Vested interest compromising medical ethics

If Sneha favours her brother's company, it may lead to

1. **Violation of non-maleficence** - A financially struggling vendor might cut corners on the quality of sensors, parts, or installation to save costs, leading to poor quality of care and harm to patients.
2. **Erosion of trust** - Patients may lose faith in the hospital if procurement appears biased.
3. **Undermining justice** - Other vendors are unfairly excluded, violating **equitable treatment and fairness**
4. **Slippery slope** - Favouritism could set a precedent for kickbacks or quid-pro-quo dealings.
5. **Conflict of interest** - Personal gain overriding professional duty.
6. **Dilution of professional integrity** - The hospital's ethical standards get weakened for future decisions.
7. Funds wasted on overpriced favored vendors could have been used to **subsidize** life-saving surgeries for the poor.

"The strength of a nation derives from the integrity of the home." - Confucius

This should guide Sneha that true family loyalty lies in maintaining the family's honor through honest conduct.

[Case Study 5] "With the summer heat being exceptionally severe this year, the district has been facing severe water shortage. The District Collector has been mobilizing his subordinate officials to conserve the remaining water reserves for preventing the district from plunging into acute drinking water crisis. Along with an awareness campaign for conserving water, strict measures have been taken for stopping the over-exploitation of ground-water. Vigilance teams have been deployed to tour the villages and find the farmers who are drawing water from deep borewells or from the river reservoir for irrigation. The farmers are agitated by such action. A delegation of farmers meets the District Collector with their issues and complains that while they are not being allowed to irrigate their crops, big industries located near the river are drawing huge amounts of water through deep borewells for their industrial processes. The farmers allege that their administration is anti-farmer and corrupt, being bribed by the industry. The district needs to placate the farmers as they are threatening to go on a prolonged protest. At the same time, the District Collector has to deal with the water crisis. The industry cannot be closed as this would result in a large number of workers being unemployed.

- (a) Discuss all options available to the District Collector as a District Magistrate.
- (b) What suitable actions can be taken in view of mutually compatible interests of the stakeholders?
- (c) What are the potential administrative and ethical dilemmas for the District Collector?"

According to the **Central Ground Water Board (CGWB)**, nearly **17%** of India's groundwater units are "over-exploited," and approximately **60%** of districts face issues related to the availability or quality of groundwater.

The above case study highlights the conflict between **resource scarcity**, **livelihood security**, and **administrative distributive justice**.

Options available to the District Collector

- Strict enforcement against farmers** while allowing industries to operate as earlier.
 - Pros-** Immediate conservation, protects jobs
 - Cons-** perception of bias, social unrest.
- Blanket restriction on all users (farmers + industries)**
 - Pros-** Appears fair and legally defensible.
 - Cons-** Could disrupt industrial production and employment.
- Tight cap on industrial extraction and crop-based allowance to farmers.**
 - Pros-** Addresses equity concerns; protects livelihoods.
 - Cons-** Administrative complexity.
- Call tripartite talks with farmers, industry, and water experts to arrive at a consensus based decision.**
 - Pros-** Builds trust and reduces protest.
 - Cons-** Delays action during crisis.
- Technological Intervention-** Mandate that industries switch to treated sewage water or recycled water for their processes, freeing up groundwater/river water for rural needs.

Suitable actions for mutually compatible interests

Immediate crisis management

- Declare water as priority public resource** - Legally prioritise **drinking water > agriculture > industry** during drought.
- Tripartite committee** - Collector + farmer leaders + industry + hydrogeologists to review weekly.
- "Warabandi" (Rotational) System-** Allow irrigation only during specific night hours to reduce evaporation
- Industrial water cap** - Impose strict extraction limits and require **at least 50-70% water recycling** by industries.
- Tanker supply for drinking water** - Ensure zero household water shortage during peak summer.

Long-term cooperative measures

- Transparent water audit** - Publish data on water use of villages and industries to counter corruption allegations.
- Crop diversification** - Encourage less water-intensive crops like millets, pulses, and oilseeds.
- Community water budgeting** - Gram Panchayat-level water allocation plans with farmer participation.
- Use MGNREGA labor to immediately desilt village ponds and create "Recharge Pits" near borewells to capture any unseasonal rain or runoff
- Industrial responsibility** - Industries to fund local recharge projects under CSR.
- Technology support** - Promote drip irrigation, sprinkler systems, and soil moisture sensors.
- Grievance redressal cell** - Dedicated helpline for farmers to report unfair enforcement.

Potential administrative and ethical dilemmas

Administrative dilemmas

- Law vs livelihoods** - Enforcing bans may protect water but devastate farm incomes.
- Revenue vs. Livelihood-** Closing industries hurts state revenue and causes unemployment, but allowing them to run starves the farmers

3. **Immediate crisis vs long-term sustainability** - Tanker supply relieves today but worsens dependency tomorrow.
4. **Enforcement capacity** - Monitoring thousands of borewells is difficult. It risks selective action.
5. **Employment vs environment** - Closing industries saves water but creates unemployment.

Ethical dilemmas

1. **Justice vs utility** - Should water go to food production (farmers) or factories (economic growth)?
2. **Intergenerational justice** - Over-extraction today harms future generations.
3. **Trust vs authority** - Heavy-handed action may secure water but destroy public trust.
4. **Equity vs efficiency** - Industries use water more "productively" per unit of output, but farmers need it to survive.
5. **Right vs Right** - Both the farmer and the industrial worker have a right to earn a living.

Case Study- Jalyukta Shivar Abhiyan (Maharashtra)

1. **Decentralized water conservation** - catching rain where it falls.
 - Significantly increased the groundwater level Marathwada and Vidarbha.
 - **Key aspects** - "Shramdaan" (voluntary labor) and Community Monitoring

"The earth, the air, the land, and the water are not an inheritance from our forefathers but on loan from our children. So we have to hand over to them at least as it was handed over to us." - **Mahatma Gandhi**

[Case Study 6] "Dr. Srinivasan is a senior scientist working for a reputed biotechnology company known for its cutting-edge research in pharmaceuticals. Dr. Srinivasan is heading a research team, working on a new drug aimed at treating a rapidly spreading variant of a new viral infectious disease. The disease has been rapidly spreading across the world and the cases reported in the country are increasing. There is huge pressure on Dr. Srinivasan's team to expedite the trials for the drug as there is a significant market for it, and the company wants to get the first-mover advantage in the market. During a team meeting, some senior team members suggest some shortcut for expediting the clinical trials for the drug and for getting the requisite approvals. These include manipulating data to exclude some negative outcomes and selectively reporting positive results, foregoing the process of informed consent and using compounds already patented by a rival company, rather than developing one's own component. Dr. Srinivasan is not comfortable taking such shortcuts, at the same time he realises meeting the targets is impossible without using these means.

(a) What would you do in such a situation?

(b) Examine your options and consequences in the light of the ethical questions involved.

(c) How can data ethics and drug ethics save humanity at large in such a scenario?"

"Relativity applies to physics, not ethics." - Albert Einstein

Dr. Srinivasan is at the center of the **"Efficiency-Ethics Paradox."** The rush for a "first-mover advantage" creates a high-pressure environment where scientific rigor is viewed as a hurdle rather than a safeguard.

Guiding Principles

1. **"Primum non nocere" (First, do no harm).**
2. **Nuremberg Code** and **Declaration of Helsinki**
3. **Intellectual Honesty**

Course of action

1. **Reject unethical shortcuts** - Clearly refuse data manipulation, skipping consent, or patent violation.

2. **Document objections in writing** - Record concerns in official minutes to create an audit trail.
3. **Seek independent ethics review** - Refer the matter to the **Institutional Ethics Committee (IEC)** and **Data Safety Monitoring Board (DSMB)**.
4. Instead of stealing a rival's compound, I would initiate a **"Cross-licensing" or "Emergency Compulsory Licensing"** request
5. **Propose lawful fast-track alternatives**
 - **Adaptive clinical trials**
 - **Emergency Use Authorisation (EUA)** if evidence is strong
 - **Parallel Phase II-III designs**
6. **Engage senior management transparently** - Explain legal, reputational, and patient risks of shortcuts.
7. **Use whistleblower channel** if pressure persists.

Key Ethical Questions

1. **The Conflict of Duty (Teleology vs. Deontology)**
2. **The Principle of Informed Consent and Autonomy**
3. **Intellectual Property (IP) vs. The Common Good** - When does the "Right to Health" override the "Right to Property"?
4. **Transparency and the "Publicity Test"** - Would I be comfortable if my decision was published on the front page of a national newspaper?
5. **Fiduciary Duty**- Does a manager's loyalty to shareholders override their duty to patient safety?
6. **Speed vs Safety** - Can a life-saving drug be rushed at risk to patients?
7. **Truth vs Profit** - Is data manipulation ever justified for market advantage?

Examination of options and consequences

1. **Accept shortcuts**

Merit

- Speedy approval
- Profit for company

Consequences

Dimension	Impact
Patients	High risk of adverse effects or death
Science	Loss of credibility and reproducibility
Law	Violations of Drugs & Cosmetics Act, patent law
Company	Fines, lawsuits, recall, reputational collapse
Ethics	Violation of autonomy, justice, beneficence

2. **Slow but fully compliant trials**

Merits

- Protects patients
- Legally safe
- Maintains scientific integrity

Demerits

- Delayed drug availability
- Loss of first-mover advantage

3. **Compliant fast-track pathway**

Consequences

Dimension	Impact
-----------	--------

Patients	Safety preserved
Science	Reliable evidence
Company	Legal protection + credibility
Society	Faster access without ethical compromise

data ethics & drug ethics can save humanity in following ways

Role of Data Ethics

1. **Prevents harmful drugs from reaching the market** by exposing negative results.
2. **Ensures reproducibility** of scientific findings.
3. **Enables evidence-based regulation** by authorities.
4. **Builds public trust** in science and medicine.
5. **Avoids false hope and misinformation.**

Role of Drug Ethics

6. **Protects patient lives** through rigorous safety standards.
7. **Respects human dignity** via informed consent.
8. **Prevents exploitation** of vulnerable populations.
9. **Ensures equitable access** to life-saving drugs.
10. **Balances innovation with responsibility**, preventing reckless experimentation.

Pfizer-BioNTech COVID-19 Vaccine Trials

- **Conducted large-scale, transparent, placebo-controlled trials.**
- **Published full data in peer-reviewed journals.**
- **Respected informed consent and safety monitoring.**
- **Result- Rapid approval without compromising ethics, saving millions of lives.**

"Science without conscience is but the ruin of the soul." By standing firm on ethics, Dr. Srinivasan protects not only the patients but also the very soul of scientific inquiry.

2023

[Case Study 1] "At 9 pm on Saturday evening, Rashika, a Joint Secretary, was still engrossed in her work in her office. Her husband, Vikram, is an executive in an MNC and frequently out of town in connection with his work. Their two children aged 5 and 3 are looked after by their domestic helper. At 9-30 pm her superior, Mr. Suresh calls her and asks her to prepare a detailed note on an important matter to be discussed in a meeting in the Ministry. She realises that she will have to work on Sunday to finish the additional task given by her superior. She reflects on how she had looked forward to this posting and had worked long hours for months to achieve it. She had kept the welfare of people uppermost in discharging her duties. She feels that she has not done enough justice to her family and she has not fulfilled her duties in discharging essential social obligations. Even as recently as last month she had to leave her sick child in the nanny's care as she had to work in the office. Now, she feels that she must draw a line, beyond which her personal life should take precedence over her professional responsibilities. She thinks that there should be reasonable limits to the work ethics such as punctuality, hard work, dedication to duty and selfless service.

- (a) Discuss the ethical issues involved in this case.
- (b) Briefly describe at least four laws that have been enacted by the Government with respect to providing a healthy, safe and equitable working environment for women.
- (c) Imagine you are in a similar situation. What suggestions would you make to mitigate such working conditions?"

The above case highlights the challenge of **Work-Life Balance** in high-pressure administrative roles, where the "Ethical Ideal" of selfless service is clashing with the fundamental "Moral Duty" towards family.

Guiding Principles

1. **Ethics of Care**
2. **Respect for personal time**
3. **Gender-sensitive workplaces**
4. **Shared caregiving responsibility**

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Conflict of Duties-** The tension between Fiduciary Duty (motherhood/care) and Professional Duty.
2. **Crisis of Conscience-** guilt of leaving a sick child.
3. **Lack of organizational empathy-** superior's 9-30 PM call reflects a culture that devalues the personal time of subordinates.
4. **Gendered Expectations-** Society judges working mothers harsher than fathers.
5. **Right to Rest and Leisure** to prevent burnout.
6. Ethical question of **how much personal sacrifice** is reasonable in public service.
7. **Overwork risks burnout, reducing the quality of public decision-making.**
8. **The "Ideal Worker" Norm-** assumption that a "dedicated" officer must be available 24/7.
9. The failure of the Ministry to create a **predictable workflow**

Laws for a Healthy and Equitable Working Environment

1. **Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017**
 - a. Increases paid maternity leave to **26 weeks**.
 - b. Mandates **Crèche facilities** in establishments with 50+ employees.
 - c. Provides for **"Work from Home"** after the leave period, if nature of work permits.
2. **Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (POSH) Act, 2013**
 - a. Mandatory **Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)** in workplaces.
 - b. Time-bound inquiry and confidentiality of complaints.

c. Protection against retaliation and victimisation.

3. Factories Act, 1948

- Regulation of **working hours and night shifts** with safeguards.
- Mandatory **health and safety standards**.
- Provision of welfare amenities like restrooms and sanitation.

4. Equal Remuneration Act, 1976

- Equal pay for equal work** irrespective of gender.
- Prohibition of discrimination in recruitment.
- Obligation to employers to maintain wage records.

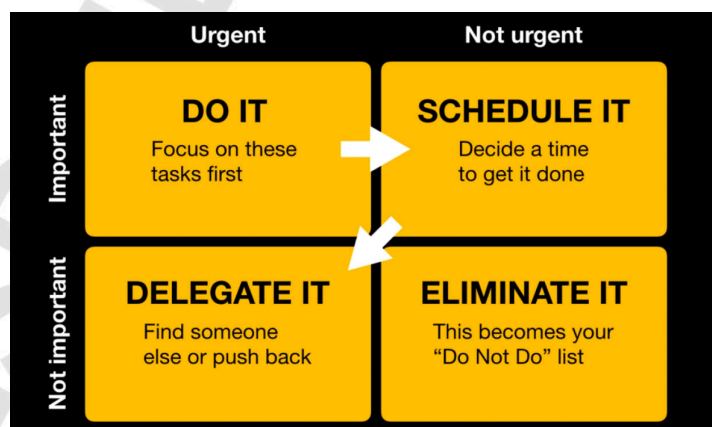
Suggestions to mitigate such working conditions

Personal strategies

- Set clear professional boundaries** - Politely communicate limits on late-night/weekend work except for emergencies.
- Reserve protected family hours as non-negotiable.
- Shared caregiving** - Negotiate greater involvement of spouse and extended family.

Organisational reforms

- Flexible work arrangements** - Introduce **hybrid work and staggered hours**. Eg- using e-Office
- Norm against non-emergency late calls**. Eg- passing recently introduced **Right to Disconnect Bill**.
- Fair workload rotation** - Distribute urgent assignments across teams. Eg- UK Civil Service uses rotational duty rosters.
- Crèche and childcare support** for senior officers.
- Mental health support** - Regular counselling and stress-management programmes.
- Gender-sensitive leadership training** - Sensitise seniors to caregiving responsibilities.
- Shift from hours to outcomes** - Measure performance by quality, not time spent in office. Eg- Best Buy's ROWE initiative
- Eisenhower Matrix** to distinguish between "Urgent" tasks and "Important" tasks.
- Adopting "**Swedish Model**" of Shared Parental Leave



Case study- Google's Work-Life Balance Model

- Flexible work hours and remote work.
- On-site childcare facilities.
- Mental health counselling and wellness programmes.
- Parental leave policies for both men and women.
- Generous vacation policy of three paid weeks.

"You cannot pour from an empty cup."

Thus, ethical institutions must value **care, equity, and well-being** alongside efficiency.

[Case Study 2] “You have just been appointed as Additional Director General of the Central Public Works Department. The Chief Architect of your division, who is to retire in six months, is passionately working on a very important project, the successful completion of which would earn him a lasting reputation for the rest of his life. A new lady architect, Seema, trained at Manchester School of Architecture, UK joined as Senior Architect in your division. During the briefing about the project, Seema made some suggestions which would not only add value to the project, but would also reduce completion time. This has made the Chief Architect insecure and he is constantly worried that all the credit will go to her. Subsequently, he adopted a passive and aggressive behaviour towards her and has become disrespectful to her. Seema felt it embarrassing as the Chief Architect left no chance of humiliating her. He would very often correct her in front of other colleagues and raise his voice while speaking to her. This continuous harassment has resulted in her losing confidence and self-esteem. She felt perpetually tense, anxious and stressed. She appeared to be in awe of him since he has had a long tenure in the office and has vast experience in the area of her work. You are aware of her outstanding academic credentials and career record in her previous organisations. However, you fear that this harassment may result in compromising her much needed contribution in this important project and may adversely impact her emotional well-being. You have also come to know from her peers that she is contemplating tendering her resignation.

- (a) What are the ethical issues involved in the above case?
- (b) What are the options available to you in order to complete the project as well as to retain Seema in the organization?
- (c) What would be your response to Seema’s predicament? What measures would you institute to prevent such occurrences from happening in your organization ?

“Leadership is not about being in charge. It is about taking care of those in our charge.” - Simon Sinek
In this scenario at the CPWD, a clash between **Institutional Seniority** and **Modern Innovation** has escalated into a case of workplace harassment.

Guiding principles

1. **Dignity at Work**
2. **Zero tolerance for harassment**
3. **Merit over seniority**
4. **Psychological safety at work**
5. **Accountability of leadership**
6. **Public interest above personal ego**

Ethical issues involved in the case

1. **Workplace harassment** - Chief Architect’s behaviour violates **respect for human dignity** and creates a hostile work environment.
2. **Abuse of authority** to intimidate a junior colleague.
3. **Gender bias and discrimination** against Seema
4. **Professional jealousy vs public interest** - Personal insecurity is jeopardising a **public project of national importance**.
5. **Merit vs seniority conflict** - Resistance to Seema’s ideas undermines **merit-based decision-making**.
6. **Psychological harm** - Sustained humiliation is causing **emotional stress, anxiety, and loss of confidence**.
7. **Organisational justice** - Failure to address harassment reflects poor **fairness and accountability** in management.

8. **Integrity of public service** - Sabotaging collaboration for personal credit damages **institutional integrity**.
9. As ADG, ignoring the issue would **violate your ethical responsibility** to protect staff well-being.
10. Allowing harassment **risks losing talent and normalising unethical conduct**.

Options available

To complete the project

1. **Direct mediation with Chief Architect** - Firm but respectful conversation on conduct.
2. **Formal inquiry under POSH** through Internal Complaints Committee.
3. **Restructure project roles** - Make Seema **co-lead** with independent responsibilities.
4. **Create technical review panel** - to review all suggestions objectively - removes the personal friction

To retain Seema

1. **Assure protection and support** - Publicly value her contribution.
2. **Provide safe reporting channel** - Confidential grievance mechanism to build trust
3. **Reduce direct reporting to Chief Architect**
4. **Workplace counselling support** for stress management and psychological assistance.

Response to Seema's Predicament

1. **Private meeting with Seema**
 - Assure her that **harassment will not be tolerated** in the organisation.
 - Reaffirm that her contributions to the project are **valuable and needed**.
 - Promise **protection against retaliation** from the Chief Architect.
2. **Joint meeting with both officers**
 - Emphasise that the project is a **team effort in public interest**, not an individual legacy.
 - Set clear expectations of **respectful communication and zero tolerance for humiliation**.
3. If both agree to work constructively-
 - I would call a **team meeting**.
 - Publicly appreciate the **experience and leadership** of the Chief Architect.
 - Simultaneously acknowledge **Seema's technical talent and innovative inputs**.
4. **If the issue is NOT resolved**
 - (a) **Reassign and clearly define roles**
 - Reduce direct reporting between Seema and the Chief Architect.
 - Make Seema **co-lead or independent lead** for a key component of the project.
 - (b) **Ask Seema to document and file POSH complaint**
 - Encourage Seema to **document incidents factually** with dates, witnesses, and details.
 - Assist her in filing a formal complaint with the **Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)** under POSH Act, 2013.
 - (c) **Ensure implementation of ICC decision**
 - If the Chief Architect is found guilty, impose appropriate disciplinary action.
 - If counselling or training is recommended, ensure compliance.
 - Monitor the workplace climate to prevent recurrence.

Measures to prevent such occurrences

1. **Zero-tolerance harassment policy** - Strict enforcement of **POSH Act**. Eg- mandatory POSH training.
2. **Mandatory gender-sensitivity training** for all levels.
3. **Transparent credit-sharing system** - Document contributions in project reports.
4. **Independent grievance redressal** - Strengthen Internal Complaints Committee.
5. **Mentorship programme** - Pair juniors with supportive seniors.
6. **Psychological safety culture** - Encourage respectful disagreement.
7. **360-Degree Feedback-**
 - a. subordinates rating the "Behavioral Conduct" of their seniors.
 - b. Inclusion of Behavioural Metrics in performance reviews
8. **Innovation Boxes-** Anonymized digital submission of ideas
9. **Psychological Support Systems-** Providing access to professional counselors for stressed employees.

"The greatest leader is not necessarily the one who does the greatest things. He is the one that gets the people to do the greatest things." - Ronald Reagan

Protecting Seema while ensuring timely project completion will promote healthy, ethical and innovative work culture.

[Case Study 3] “You hold a responsible position in a ministry in the government. One day in the morning you received a call from the school of your 11-year-old son that you are required to come and meet the Principal. You proceed to the school and find your son in the Principal’s office. The Principal informs you that your son had been found wandering aimlessly in the grounds during the time classes were in progress. The class teacher further informs you that your son has lately become a loner and did not respond to questions in the class, he had also been unable to perform well in the football trials held recently. You bring your son back from the school and in the evening, you along with your wife try to find out the reasons for your son’s changed behaviour. After repeated cajoling, your son shares that some children had been making fun of him in the class as well as in the WhatsApp group of the students by calling him stunted, duh and a frog. He tells you the names of a few children who are the main culprits but pleads with you to let the matter rest. After a few days, during a sporting event, where you and your wife have gone to watch your son play, one of your colleague’s son shows you a video in which students have caricatured your son. Further, he also points out to the perpetrators who were sitting in the stands. You purposefully walk past them with your son and go home. Next day, you find on social media, a video denigrating you, your son and even your wife, stating that you engaged in physical bullying of children on the sports field. The video became viral on social media. Your friends and colleagues began calling you to find out the details. One of your juniors advised you to make a counter video giving the background and explaining that nothing had happened on the field. You, in turn posted a video which you have captured during the sporting event, identifying the likely perpetrators who were responsible for your son’s predicament. You have also narrated what has actually happened in the field and made attempts to bring out the adverse effects of the misuse of social media.

(a) Based on the above case study, discuss the ethical issues involved in the use of social media.

(b) Discuss the pros and cons of using social media by you to put across the facts to counter the fake propaganda against your family.”

India has close to 500 million social media users. While it has democratised the freedom of expression, it has simultaneously created an **eco chambers** and a platform for bullying and defamation.

The above case study highlights the ethical challenges in using social media responsibly, especially when children and reputations are involved.

Guiding principle - Digital Responsibility and Ethical Self-Restraint

Ethical issues in the use of social media

1. **Cyberbullying and harassment** - Mocking your son through memes and videos violates his **dignity and mental well-being**.
2. **Violation of privacy** - Recording and circulating videos of a minor without consent is unethical and harmful.
3. **Defamation and misinformation** - Viral video falsely accusing you of physical bullying damages reputation.
4. **Lack of accountability** - Anonymity on social media encourages irresponsible behaviour.
5. **Harm to children** - Psychological trauma to your son due to public ridicule.
6. **Weaponisation of technology** - Social media used as a tool for social exclusion rather than communication.
7. **Viral amplification of falsehood** - False narratives spread faster than factual clarification.
8. **Mob mentality** - Online crowd reinforces bullying instead of questioning facts.
9. **Digital vigilantism** - Your counter-video identifying perpetrators risks turning into public shaming.
10. **Erosion of trust** - Public institutions suffer reputational damage due to online misrepresentation.
11. **Accountability of Platforms** - failure of social media algorithms to filter out denigrating content involving minors before it goes viral.

Pros and cons of using social media to counter fake propaganda

Pros of your counter-video

1. **Restores truth** - Corrects false narrative with evidence. Eg- ALT news fact checking
2. **Protects family reputation** - Prevents long-term character damage.
3. **Deterrence** - Discourages future cyberbullying by exposing misuse.
4. **Awareness creation** - Highlights dangers of online harassment and fake news. Eg- #StopCyberBullying campaign
5. Helps your son feel supported rather than silenced.
6. **Transparency** - Shows you have nothing to hide.

Cons of your counter-video

1. **Escalation of conflict** - May provoke further online attacks.
2. **Risk of public shaming minors** - Identifying children publicly can be unethical.
3. **Loss of privacy** - Brings family matters into public domain.
4. **Legal risks** - Possibility of defamation claims.
5. **Emotional toll** - Increases stress for your son and family.
6. Instead of institutional resolution via school administration, the issue becomes a public drama.
7. **Precedent of vigilante justice** - Encourages others to bypass formal mechanisms.
8. As a government official, public digital outbursts may violate **Civil Services (Conduct) Rules**

Blue Whale Challenge in India - Lack of regulation, anonymity, and viral sharing led to psychological exploitation of minors.

Balanced ethical approach you should adopt

1. File a **formal complaint with the school** against bullying.
2. Request disciplinary action and counselling for perpetrators.
3. Report the viral video to social media platforms for takedown.
4. Provide emotional support and counselling to your son.

Social media is a **double-edged sword**. For a person in a responsible government position, **Institutional Redressal** should take precedence over **Digital Retaliation**.

"Character is like a tree and reputation like its shadow. The shadow is what we think of it; the tree is the real thing." - Abraham Lincoln

[Case Study 4] “A landslide occurred in the middle of the night on 20th July, 2023 in a remote mountain hamlet, approximately 60 kilometers from Uttarkashi. The landslide was caused by torrential rains and has resulted in large-scale destruction of property and life. You, as district magistrate of the area, have rushed to the spot with a team of doctors, NGOs, media and police along with numerous support staff to oversee the rescue operations. A man came running to you with a request for urgent medical help for his pregnant wife who is in labor and is losing blood. You directed your medical team to examine his wife. They return and convey to you that this woman needs blood transfusion immediately. Upon enquiry, you come to know that a few blood collection bags and blood group test kits are available in the ambulance accompanying your team. A few people on your team have already volunteered to donate blood. Being a physician who has graduated from AIIMS, you know that blood for transfusion needs to be procured only through a recognized blood bank. Your team members are divided on this issue; some favor transfusion while some others oppose it. The doctors in the team are ready to facilitate the delivery provided they are not penalized for transfusion. Now you are in a dilemma. Your professional training emphasizes prioritizing service to humanity and saving lives of individuals.

(a) What are the ethical issues involved in this case?

(b) Evaluate the options available to you, being District Magistrate of the area.”

The above case study highlights the **Ethical Dilemma** for DM where the **Deontological approach** (following strict medical/legal rules) clashes with the **Teleological approach** (saving a life in an extraordinary emergency).

Ethical issues involved in the case

1. **Right to Life vs. Standard Protocol** - Tension between **saving an immediate life** and following **standard medical protocol**.
2. **Beneficence vs non-maleficence** - challenge of balancing doing good (saving the mother and child) with avoiding potential harm (risk of infection, mismatched blood, transfusion reactions).
3. **Emergency ethics vs routine ethics** - Whether exceptional circumstances justify deviation from normal medical standards.
4. **Individual rights vs institutional rules** - The pregnant woman's **right to life and health** versus institutional regulations on safe blood supply.
5. **Professional integrity** - conflict between duty as a doctor and as a DM
6. **Accountability vs humanitarian action** - doctors may face legal or disciplinary action discourages.
7. **Risk management challenge** - Delay to arrange proper blood may cost a life, but hurried transfusion may also be dangerous.
8. Allowing an unofficial transfusion might **set a precedent** that compromises blood safety standards in future scenarios.

Evaluation of options available to you as District Magistrate

1. **Strict adherence to rules- No transfusion until recognized blood bank supply arrives**

Merits

1. Fully **legally compliant**.
2. Minimizes risk of transfusion-related complications.
3. Protects doctors from legal liability.
4. Maintains standard medical protocol.

Demerits

1. **High risk of maternal death** due to hemorrhage.
2. Seen as bureaucratic insensitivity.
3. Violation of **hippocratic oath**
2. **Immediate field transfusion using volunteer blood**

Merits

1. **Immediate life-saving action.**
2. Aligns with **humanitarian ethics** and professional medical duty.

Demerits

1. Risk of infection, mismatched blood, or adverse reaction.
2. Technically violates standard blood transfusion rules.
3. Doctors may face legal consequences.
4. Could set a risky precedent if misused elsewhere.

3. Transport to nearby hospital

Merits

- a. Ensures safe medical care
- b. Prevents doctors from legal risks
- c. Can focus on rescue of villagers

Cons

- a. Difficult terrain
- b. May lead to loss of life

Course of action

As the DM and a physician, I would choose this path, based on the "**Doctrine of Necessity.**"

1. Provide emergency care to control bleeding.
2. Use blood testing kits to confirm compatibility.
3. Coordinate with the Air Force or SDRF for an immediate heli-evacuation to a tertiary care center.
4. Proceed with transfusion **only if absolutely necessary.**
5. **Informed Consent-** Explicitly explain the risks (lack of advanced screening) to the husband and obtain written consent
6. As DM, I will issue a formal "Emergency Executive Order" under the **Disaster Management Act, 2005** to protect doctors from legal action
7. **Document the entire process** to justify the "Necessity" in any future inquiry.

"The safety of the people shall be the highest law." - Cicero

The DM should follow the "**Good Samaritan**" principle to save the lives of women and her child.

[Case Study 5] “You are working as an executive in a nationalized bank for several years. One day one of your close colleagues tells you that her father is suffering from heart disease and needs surgery immediately to survive. She also tells you that she has no insurance and the operation will cost about Rs. 10 lakh. You are also aware of the fact that her husband is no more and that she is from a lower middle class family. You are empathetic about her situation. However, apart from expressing your sympathy, you do not have the resources to fund her. A few weeks later, you ask her about the well-being of her father and she informs you about his successful surgery and that he is recovering. She then confides in you that the bank manager was kind enough to facilitate the release of Rs. 10 lakh from a dormant account of someone to pay for the operation with a promise that it should be confidential and be repaid at the earliest. She has already started paying it back and will continue to do so until it is all returned.

(a) What are the ethical issues involved?

(b) Evaluate the behavior of the bank manager from an ethical point of view.

(c) How would you react to the situation?

“Relativity applies to physics, not ethics.” - Albert Einstein

The case study reflects the conflict between **Humanitarian Compassion** and **Institutional Integrity**. While the motive behind the action is noble, the method used is illegal and unethical.

Guiding principle - Compassion with due process

Ethical Issues Involved

For You (The Executive)

- **Conflict of Loyalty**- Choosing between loyalty to a grieving colleague and loyalty to the bank's code of conduct.
- **Complicity through Silence**- staying quiet makes you an accessory to a financial crime
- **Moral Dilemma**- The struggle between the "Ethics of Care" and the code of conduct.

For the Bank Manager

- **Breach of Trust**- Violating the legal contract between the bank and the depositor.
- **Abuse of Authority**- Using administrative power to bypass formal credit channels.
- **Professional Integrity**- Undermining the "Standard Operating Procedures" (SOPs).

For the Customers and the Bank

- **Systemic Risk**- If such behavior is normalized, depositors may lose faith in fund safety.
- **Legal Liability**- The bank could face severe penalties from the RBI.
- The owner of the account has been deprived of his property without consent.

For the Colleague

- **Criminal Liability** if the fraud is exposed
- **Psychological Burden**- Living under the constant fear of discovery
- **Moral Hazard** - she may resort to same means in future

Evaluation of the Bank Manager's Behavior

Justifications

1. **Altruism**- He acted out of pure concern for a widow and her dying father.
2. **Urgency**- The "immediacy" of the surgery
3. **Utilitarianism**- He used "idle" money to create a "tangible good" (saving a life).
4. **Empathy** towards colleagues
5. **Restorative Intent**- He ensured the money would be repaid - no permanent loss to the bank

Ethical & Professional Issues

1. **Violates deontology**- Embezzlement is a crime, regardless of the motive.
2. **Lack of Transparency**- secret withdrawals.
3. **Violation of Fiduciary Duty**- He spent money that did not belong to him.

4. **Risk of** creating an unfair "**favoritism**" culture.
5. **Slippery Slope** and moral hazard - risk of embezzlement getting normalised
6. **Institutional Decay**- He has compromised the **Internal Control Systems** of the nationalized bank.

My reaction to the situation

1. **Meet both colleagues and manager to seek explanation** and ask them to come forward and report it.
2. **If they don't, then report the incident to higher authorities with a detailed note on**
 - The **circumstances of the medical emergency**,
 - The **method through which funds were released**,
 - The **manager's intention to help**,
 - The fact that the amount is being **repaid in instalments**, and
3. **Express empathy but explain the ethical problem to colleague**
4. **Explore lawful alternatives and regularize the transaction**
 - Converting it into a **formal personal/medical loan**.
 - Arranging support from-
 - Bank's **employee welfare fund**,
 - Government schemes like **Ayushman Bharat**, or
5. **Recommend long-term systemic measures**
 1. Creation of a **formal emergency medical loan window** for employees.
 2. Clear SOP for handling humanitarian crises within legal limits.
 3. Training for managers on **ethical decision-making in emergencies**.
 4. Faster processing of medical loans during crises.
 5. Establishment of an **employee hardship relief fund**.

"The end cannot justify the means." - Mahatma Gandhi

True ethical governance requires that **compassion be institutionalized through transparent, legal mechanisms**, so that **lives are saved without eroding public trust**.

[Case Study 6] “Vinod is an honest and sincere IAS officer. Recently, he has taken over as Managing Director of the State Road Transport Corporation, his sixth transfer in the past three years. His peers acknowledge his vast knowledge, affability and uprightness. The Chairman of the State Road Transport Corporation is a powerful politician and is very close to the Chief Minister. Vinod comes to know about many alleged irregularities of the Corporation and the high-handedness of the Chairman in financial matters. A Board Member of the Corporation belonging to the Opposition Party meets Vinod and hands over a few documents along with a video recording in which the Chairman appears to be demanding bribes for placing a huge order for the supply of QMR tyres. Vinod recollects the Chairman expediting clearing of pending bills of QMR tyres. Vinod confronts the Board Member as to why he is shying away from exposing the Chairman with the so-called solid proof he has with him. The member informs him that the Chairman refuses to yield to his threats. He adds that Vinod may earn recognition and public support if he himself exposes the Chairman. Further, he tells Vinod that once his party comes to power, Vinod’s professional growth would be assured. Vinod is aware that he may be penalized if he exposes the Chairman and may further be transferred to a distant place. He knows that the Opposition Party stands a better chance of coming to power in the forthcoming elections. However, he also realizes that the Board Member is trying to use him for his own political gains.

(a) As a conscientious civil servant, evaluate the options available to Vinod.

(b) In the light of the above case, comment upon the ethical issues that may arise due to the politicization of bureaucracy.

“Power without accountability breeds corruption and integrity without courage becomes silence.”

Vinod’s dilemma reflects the clash between **probity in public office and political pressure**, and tests the moral courage of a civil servant.

Guiding Principle - “Integrity is doing the right thing, even when no one is watching.”

Stakeholder	Interests involved
Vinod (MD, SRTC)	Professional integrity, career security, public interest
Chairman (Politician)	Power, personal benefit
Opposition Board Member	Political advantage, weakening ruling party
State Government/CM	Political stability, image management
Public/Commuters	Safe, affordable, corruption-free transport
Tyre Supplier (QMR)	Profit from government contracts

Evaluation of options

1. Publicly expose the Chairman through media

Merits

1. Signals **zero tolerance for corruption**.
2. Ensure public accountability.
3. Aligns with **public interest and transparency**.

Demerits

1. Violates **due process** and natural justice.



2. Risk of retaliatory transfer or victimisation.
3. Appears politically motivated, harming **bureaucratic neutrality**.

2. Anonymous Leak to the Media

Merits-

1. Exposes the corruption without immediate personal risk
2. Satisfies the **Ethics of Disclosure**.

Demerits-

1. Violates the **Central Civil Services (Conduct) Rules**
2. Evidence may be dismissed as a "political hit piece" without official backing.

3. Ignore the matter and stay silent

Merits

1. Protects Vinod from political backlash.
2. Ensures personal safety and stability.
3. Avoids confrontation with powerful elites.

Demerits

1. Complicity in corruption by silence.
2. Betrays **public trust** and constitutional duty.
3. Damages his **self-esteem** as an honest officer.

4. Use formal institutional mechanisms

Merits

1. Respects **rule of law and due process**.
2. Maintains **bureaucratic neutrality**.
3. Protects institutional credibility.
4. Ensures **probity and fairness**

Demerits

1. Inquiry may be delayed or diluted.
2. Possible indirect retaliation.
3. Requires patience and persistence.

Vinod should adopt **Option 4**, because it protects **public interest, integrity, due process, and neutrality** while ensuring accountability. He should,

1. Verify authenticity of documents/video.
2. Place matter before the **Board formally**.
3. Inform higher authorities in writing with facts only.
4. Recommend **independent vigilance inquiry**.
5. Refer evidence to **State Vigilance/ACB**.

Ethical Issues Arising from Politicization of Bureaucracy

1. **Insecurity of Tenure**- Lack of fixed tenure leads to short-termism instead of long-term planning.
2. **Erosion of Neutrality**- Bureaucrats become "committed" to parties rather than the Constitution. Eg- spoils system in the US
3. **Punitive Transfers**- Eg- Ashok Khemka was transferred over 50 times due to his integrity
4. **Clientelism**- The formation of "Politician-Bureaucrat-Contractor" Nexuses. (Vohra Committee Report).
5. Civil servants face **conflict of interest** - conflict between securing career and upholding neutrality and anonymity
6. Using bureaucrats for political ends **weakens of rule of law**
7. **Moral Dissonance**- Constant conflict between an officer's personal ethics and political orders.
8. **Administrative Paralysis**- Officers stop taking decisions for fear of future probes by a new government.
9. **Subversion of Meritocracy**- Loyalty is rewarded over competence, leading to **institutional decay**.
10. **Loss of Public Faith**- The common man views the bureaucracy as an extension of a political party rather than an impartial arbiter.
11. **Policy distortion** - Decisions favour political gain over development. Eg- loan waivers
12. **Corruption normalisation (slippery slope)**- Bribery becomes routine in contracts.

Vinod must resist political manipulation and act through **institutional channels**. A civil servant's strength lies not in publicity, but in **principled, lawful action**.

2022

[Case Study 1] “Prabhat was working as Vice President (Marketing) at Sterling Electric Ltd., a reputed multinational company. But presently the company was passing through the difficult times as the sales were continuously showing a downward trend in the last two quarters. His division, which hitherto had been a major revenue contributor to the company’s financial health, was now desperately trying to procure some big government order for them. But their best efforts did not yield any positive success or breakthrough. His was a professional company and his local bosses were under pressure from their London-based HO to show some positive results. In the last performance review meeting taken by the Executive Director (India Head), he was reprimanded for his poor performance. He assured them that his division is working on a special contract from the Ministry of Defence for a secret installation near Gwalior and tender is being submitted shortly. He was under extreme pressure and he was deeply perturbed. What aggravated the situation further was a warning from the top that if the deal is not clinched in favour of the company, his division might have to be closed and he may have to quit his lucrative job. There was another dimension which was causing him deep mental torture and agony. This pertained to his personal precarious financial health. He was a single earner in the family with two school-college going children and his old ailing mother. The heavy expenditure on education and medical was causing a big strain to his monthly pay pocket. Regular EMI for housing loans taken from banks is unavoidable and any default would render him liable for severe legal action. In the above backdrop, he was hoping for some miracle to happen. There was a sudden turn of events. His Secretary informed that a gentleman Subhas Verma wanted to see him as he was interested in the position of Manager which was to be filled by him in the company. He further brought to his notice that his CV has been received through the office of the Minister of Defence. During the interview of the candidate-Subhash Verma, he found him technically sound, resourceful and an experienced marketer. He seemed to be well-conversant with tendering procedures and having a knack of follow-up and liaising in this regard. Prabhat felt that he was a better choice than the rest of the candidates who were recently interviewed by him in the last few days. Subhash Verma also indicated that he was in possession of the copies of the bid documents that the Unique Electronics Ltd. would be submitting the next day to the Defence Ministry for their tender. He offered to hand over those documents subject to his employment in the company on suitable terms and conditions. He made it clear that in the process, the Sterling Electric Ltd. could outbid their rival company and get the bid and hefty Defence Ministry order. He indicated that it will be a win-win situation for both-him and the company. Prabhat was absolutely stunned. It was a mixed feeling of shock and thrill. He was uncomfortable. If accepted, all his problems would vanish instantly and he may be rewarded for securing the much awaited tender and thereby boosting the company's sales and financial health. He was in a fix as to the future course of action. He was wonder-struck at the guts of Subhash Verma in having surreptitiously removed his own company papers and offering to the rival company for a job. Being an experienced person, he was examining the pros and cons of the proposal/situation and he asked him to come the next day.

- (a) Discuss the ethical issues involved in the case.
- (b) Critically examine the options available to Prabhat in the above situation.
- (c) Which of the above would be the most appropriate for Prabhat and why?

The above case study highlights a conflict between **professional integrity and personal survival**. The situation is intensified by the "Pressure-Cooker" environment of corporate targets.

Guiding Principle

1. **Integrity in the face of adversity** based on the **Categorical Imperative** of Immanuel Kant

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Corporate espionage and intellectual property theft:** The offer involves using stolen trade secrets of a competitor, which is illegal and unethical.
2. **Breach of confidentiality** - Subhash's act violates trade secrecy and fiduciary duty.
3. **Conflict of Interest:** Prabhat's personal financial crisis (EMIs, medical bills) is interfering with his duty to the company's long-term reputation.
4. **Integrity vs. Expediency (means vs ends):** The temptation to choose a "quick fix" over a principled path.
5. **Professional Ethics:** Accepting a candidate solely because of "stolen data" undermines the **merit-based recruitment process**.
6. **Character of the Candidate:** Hiring a person who betrays their current employer.
7. Using a rival's bid documents destroys the **"Level Playing Field"** essential for fair government tendering.
8. **Political Pressure:** The candidate's CV coming from the Minister's office suggests a potential "Quid Pro Quo" or political interference in corporate hiring.
9. **Public interest vs private profit:** any fraudulent activity could be seen as compromising national security.
10. Corporate governance failure - If Prabhat accepts, it sets a **toxic precedent** that the company rewards "Guts" and "Theft" over honesty and hard work.
11. If exposed, both Prabhat and the company could face **legal and reputational risk**.

The Fraud Triangle Theory



Critical examination of options

1. **Accept Subhash Verma's offer and use rival's bid documents**

Merits

1. High chance of winning the tender quickly.
2. Saves Prabhat's job and division in the short term.
3. Immediate financial relief for Prabhat.
4. **Political Favor:** Pleases the Minister's office.

Demerits

1. **Illegal and unethical** under procurement law.
2. Risk of criminal prosecution and blacklisting of company.
3. Severe reputational damage and loss of public trust.
4. Violates the principle of **Incorruptibility**.

2. **Hire Subhash but refuse to use stolen documents**

Merits

1. Maintains formal legality if documents are not used.
2. Respects merit-based recruitment.
3. **Political Balance:** Honors the Minister's recommendation.

Demerits

1. Risk of future leaks or misconduct by Subhash.
2. Indirectly rewards unethical behaviour.
3. Hiring someone known to be a thief is a breach of **virtue ethics**

3. Reject the offer and report misconduct

Merits

1. Upholds **integrity and rule of law. (Deontological duty)**
2. Protects company from legal and reputational risk.
3. Serves **public interest and national security.**
4. Sets a strong ethical example for his subordinates.

Demerits

1. Risk to Prabhat's job in the short term.
2. Company may still lose the tender.
3. May annoy the Minister's office who recommended the CV.

4. Delay decision and seek internal guidance

Merits

1. Avoids impulsive wrongdoing.
2. Allows consultation with legal/compliance team.
3. Shares responsibility institutionally.

Demerits

1. Evidence may be destroyed or misused.
2. Appears indecisive.
3. Does not resolve dilemma unless followed by refusal.

Most appropriate option and why

Chosen option: Option 3 - Reject and report misconduct

Course of action

1. **Clearly refuse Subhash's proposal.**
2. **Document the meeting in writing.**
3. **Inform Executive Director and Compliance/Vigilance team.**
4. **Alert Defence Ministry about possible bid leakage.**

Justification

1. **Commerce without morality is a sin (Gandhiji)**
2. Upholds **Rule of law:** Defence procurement must be clean and transparent.
3. **Probity:** Integrity cannot be compromised for profit.
4. **Corporate governance:** Protects company from blacklisting.
5. **Public interest:** Safeguards national security.
6. **Professional ethics:** Rejects industrial espionage.
7. **Long-term reputation:** Ethical credibility outweighs one contract.
8. **Personal conscience:** Prabhat remains morally upright despite pressure.

“The ultimate measure of a man is not where he stands in moments of comfort and convenience, but where he stands at times of challenge and controversy.” - Martin Luther King Jr.

By choosing the ethical path, he protects the long-term existence of his company and his own dignity.

[Case Study 2] “You are appointed as an officer heading the section in the Environment Pollution Control Board to ensure compliance and its follow-up. In that region, there were a large number of small and medium industries which had been granted clearance. You learnt that these industries provide employment to many migrant workers. Most of the industrial units have got environmental clearance certificates in their possession. The environmental clearance seeks to curb industries and projects that supposedly hamper the environment and living species in the region. But in practice, Most of these units remain to be polluting units in several ways like air, water and soil pollution. As such, local people encountered persistent health problems. It was confirmed that the majority of the industries were violating environmental compliance. You issued notice to all the industrial units to apply for a fresh environmental clearance certificate from the competent authority. However, your action met with hostile response from a section of the industrial units, other vested interest persons and a section of the local politicians. The workers also became hostile to you as they felt that your action would lead to the closure of these industrial units, and the resultant unemployment will lead to insecurity and uncertainty in their livelihood. Many owners of the industries approached you with the plea that you should not initiate harsh action as it would compel them to sell their units, and cause huge financial loss, shortage of their products in the market. These would obviously add to the sufferings of the labourers and the consumers alike. The labour union also sent you a representation requesting against the closure of the units. You simultaneously started receiving threats from unknown corners. You however received support from some of your colleagues, who advised you to act freely to ensure environmental compliance. Local NGOs also came to your support and they demanded the closure of the polluting units immediately.

- (a) What are the options available to you under the given situation?
- (b) Critically examine the options listed by you.
- (c) What type of mechanism would you suggest to ensure environmental compliance?
- (d) What are the ethical dilemmas you faced in exercising your option?”

The above case reflects the tension between **public health, ecological protection and livelihood security.**

Guiding Principle -

1. **Triple bottom line - people, profit, planet**
2. **Just transition** - protect workers while enforcing environmental law.

Options available

1. **Shutting down all violating units until they obtain fresh clearances and install pollution control equipment.**
2. **Implementing a time-bound, phased-compliance model that provides technical support for upgrading**
3. **Selective Enforcement:** Targeting only the "heavy polluters" while ignoring smaller units to minimize social unrest.
4. **Maintain the status quo under political pressure**

Critical examination of options

1. **Immediate closure**

Merits

1. Strong signal of **zero tolerance to pollution.**
2. Immediate protection of public health.
3. Upholds **rule of law and precautionary principle**

Demerits

1. Massive unemployment for migrant workers.
2. Economic shock to local supply chains.
3. Likely political backlash and administrative pressure.

2. Phased compliance

Merits

1. Balances **public health, justice and economic stability**.
2. Gives industries realistic time to install pollution controls.
3. Reduces confrontation with workers and politicians.

Demerits

1. Risk of continued pollution if monitoring is weak.
2. Industries may delay compliance due to high cost
3. NGOs may perceive it as leniency.

3. Selective closure

Merits

1. Targets worst polluters first - principle of proportionality
2. Minimises overall job losses.

Demerits

1. Accusations of discrimination.
2. Potential political interference in classification.

4. Status quo

Merits

1. Avoids immediate conflict.
2. Protects jobs in the short term.

Demerits

1. Continues health damage.
2. Violates **constitutional duty to protect environment**.
3. Encourages impunity and corruption.

Mechanism to Ensure Environmental Compliance

Short-Term

1. **Time-bound compliance notices** with clear penalties.
2. **Color-Coded Categorization:** Publicly labeling units (Red/Orange/Green) based on compliance status.
3. **Third-Party Audits** to verify the "Actual vs. Reported" pollution levels.
4. **Real-time pollution monitoring sensors** in air and water outlets.
5. **Community Health Camps:** Using industrial CSR funds to treat locals' persistent health problems immediately.
6. **Direct Communication with Labor Unions** to convince them about need for pollution control for worker and community safety
7. **Joint inspections** with PCB, local administration and health dept.
8. **Public disclosure portal** of polluters with colour-coded ratings.
9. **Temporary production caps** for high-polluting units.

Long-Term

1. **Common Effluent Treatment Plants (CETP)** for small units that cannot afford individual plants.
2. **Industrial Relocation Policy:** gradual shift of high-pollution units to dedicated zones away from residential clusters.
3. Facilitating **low-interest bank loans** for installing zero-liquid discharge (ZLD) technologies. Eg- **Green technology transition fund** for MSMEs.
4. **Incentivising Circular Economy and waste to energy projects.**
5. **Polluter pays principle - Eg- environmental cess** for remediation.
6. **Stronger environmental courts/tribunals** for fast-track cases.
7. **Skill transition programmes** for workers into green jobs. Eg- "Suryamitra" Skill Development Program
8. **Community monitoring committees** with NGOs and residents.

Ethical dilemmas faced

1. **Environment vs livelihoods** - choosing between ecological preservation and industrial growth.
2. Right to Health of community vs. Right to Work of migrants
3. **Public health vs economic growth** - whose interest prevails?
4. **Administrative Autonomy vs. Political Interference:** Maintaining professional neutrality against political pressure.
5. **Justice vs pragmatism** - strict action or negotiated compromise?
6. **Intergenerational equity vs present employment** - future rights vs today's needs.
7. **Precaution vs practicality** - how fast to act?
8. **Integrity vs personal safety** - fear of threats and transfers.
9. **Short term needs vs long term impact** - lenient action to protect jobs may lead long term environmental and health hazards
10. **The "Polluter Pays" Dilemma:** Ensuring the owners pay for the damage without causing the unit to go bankrupt and hurt the consumers.

"The Earth provides enough to satisfy every man's needs, but not every man's greed." - Mahatma Gandhi
Strong enforcement, fair timelines and technological support can transform this crisis into a model of **sustainable and humane industrial governance.**

[Case Study 3] “Rakesh was working as a Joint Commissioner in the Transport department of a city. As a part of his job profile, among others, he was entrusted with the task of overseeing the control and functioning of the City Transport Department. A case strike by drivers’ union of the City Transport Department over the issue of compensation to a driver who died on duty while driving the bus came up before him for decision in the matter. He gathered that the driver (deceased) was driving Bus No. 528 which passed through busy and congested roads of the city. It so happened that near an intersection on the way, there was an accident involving a middle-aged man. It was found that there was an altercation between the driver and the car driver. Heated arguments between them led to a fight and the driver gave him a blow. A lot of passersby had gathered and tried to intervene but without success. Eventually, both of them were badly injured and profusely bleeding and were taken to the nearby hospital. The driver succumbed to the injuries and could not be saved. The middle-aged driver’s condition was also critical but after a day, he recovered and was discharged. Police had immediately come to the spot and an FIR was registered. Police investigation revealed that the quarrel was started by the bus driver and he had resorted to physical violence. There was an exchange of blows between them. The City Transport Department management is considering not giving any extra compensation to the driver’s (deceased) family. The family is very aggrieved, depressed and agitated against the discriminatory and non-sympathetic approach of the City Transport Department management. The bus driver (deceased) was 52 years of age, was survived by his wife and two school-college going daughters. He was the sole earner of the family. The City Transport Department workers’ union took up this case and when found no favourable response from the management, decided to go on strike. The union’s demand was two fold. First was full extra compensation as given to other drivers who died on duty and secondly employment to one family member. The strike has continued for 10 days and the deadlock remains.

- (a) What are the options available to Rakesh to meet the above situation?
- (b) Critically examine each of the options identified by Rakesh
- (c) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by Rakesh?
- (d) What course of action would Rakesh adopt to diffuse the above situation?

According to the **MoRTH 2024 report**, India witnesses over **4.6 lakh accidents annually**, resulting in approximately **1.68 lakh fatalities**. The above case reflects a conflict between **administrative justice and humanitarian compassion**. The prolonged strike has converted an individual grievance into a **public order and governance crisis**.

Guiding Principle - Justice as fairness (Rawls)

Stakeholders

1. Deceased driver’s family
2. Drivers’ union
3. Transport Department
4. Commuters/public
5. Rakesh (JC Transport)
6. Police
7. State government

Options available and critical examination

1. **Reject union demands completely** - No extra compensation, no compassionate job.

Merits

1. Upholds **Rule of Law** and **Zero-Tolerance** for violence

2. Prevents **moral hazard** of rewarding violence.
3. Maintains administrative discipline.

Demerits

1. Violates **Compassion and Humanitarian ethics**.
2. Likely to prolong strike, harming **public interest**.
3. Erodes **trust in government empathy**.
4. ignores the factor of "**occupational stress**."
2. **Accept union demands fully** - Grant full extra compensation + job to one family member.

Merits

1. Ends strike quickly.
2. Demonstrates **solidarity and empathy**.
3. prevents the family from falling into poverty

Demerits

1. Rewards misconduct, violating **accountability**.
2. Sets bad precedent for future cases.
3. Can be seen as a "surrender" of management
3. **Middle path** - Reject **compensation** but announce **employment** to family member after training.

Merits

1. Balances **justice with compassion**.
2. Recognises family's hardship without glorifying violence.
3. Likely to reduce industrial unrest.

Demerits

1. Union may still resist.
2. Family will not get compensation
3. Children may have to dropout from college
4. **Order inquiry, give immediate interim aid, and negotiate with union to end strike.**

Merits

1. Ensures **due process and fairness**.
2. Provides immediate humanitarian relief.
3. Builds legitimacy of final decision.

Demerits

1. Takes time and strike may continue.
2. Possible political pressure.

Ethical dilemmas faced by Rakesh

1. **Rule of law vs compassion** - punish wrongdoing or protect family?
2. **Neutrality vs Empathy**: Remaining objective despite the emotional plea of a grieving family.
3. **Individual fault vs family innocence** - driver made mistake, but family is blameless.
4. **Public interest vs workers' rights** - prolonged strike for compensation impacting public transport
5. **Discipline vs empathy** - maintaining order while being humane.
6. **Precedent vs exception** - challenge to avoid bad precedent and to take care of family.
7. **Justice vs pragmatism** - strict rule adherence may worsen strike.
8. **Short-term measures vs long-term impact** - compensation may end strike but can lead to similar behaviour by drivers in future
9. **Parens Patriae**: The duty of the state to act as a guardian for those who cannot help themselves (the minor daughters).

Course of action Rakesh should adopt

1. **Immediate Release of Statutory Dues**. Eg- PF, Gratuity, and Insurance
2. **Order independent fact-finding inquiry**
 - Include legal, transport, labour and police representatives.
 - Examine CCTV, witnesses, duty conditions, and driver's record.
3. **Structured dialogue with union**
 - Clarify that violence cannot be rewarded.
 - Assure that family hardship will be addressed.
4. Based on inquiry

- Grant or reject **compensation** and communicate the same to family and union with detailed facts
 - Make the report public
5. Offer **conditional compassionate employment** after training in a suitable role.
 6. Recommend **systemic reforms**
 - Anger Management and Stress Relief Workshops for drivers
 - Panic buttons and CCTV in buses.
 - Grievance helpline for drivers.

Justice must be firm, but governance must be humane.

By harmonising law and compassion, Rakesh can ensure protect the vulnerable family, and restore essential services without undermining discipline.

[Case Study 4] “Ramesh is a State Civil Services Officer who got the opportunity of getting posted to the capital of a border State after rendering 20 years of service. Ramesh’s mother has recently been diagnosed with cancer and has been admitted in the leading cancer hospital of the city. His two adolescent children have also got admission in one of the best public schools of the town. After settling down in his appointment as Director in the Home Department of the State, Ramesh got a confidential report through intelligence sources that illegal migrants are infiltrating in the State from the neighbouring country. He decided to personally carry out surprise checks of the border posts along with his Home Department team. To his surprise, he caught red-handed two families of 12 members infiltrated with the connivance of the security personnel at the border posts. On further inquiry and investigation, it was found that after the migrants from neighbouring countries infiltrate, their documentation like Aadhaar Card, Ration Card and Voter Card are also forged and they are made to settle down in a particular area of the State. Ramesh prepared the detailed and comprehensive report and submitted it to the Additional Secretary of the State. However, he was summoned by the Additional Home Secretary after a week and was instructed to withdraw the report. The Additional Home Secretary informed Ramesh that the report submitted by him has not been appreciated by the higher authorities. He further cautioned him that if he fails to withdraw the confidential report, he will not only be posted out from the prestigious appointment from the State capital but his further promotion which is due in near future will also get in jeopardy.

- (a) What are the options available to Ramesh as the Director of the Home Department of the bordering State?
- (b) What option should Ramesh adopt and why?
- (c) Critically evaluate each of the options.
- (d) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by Ramesh?
- (e) What policy measures would you suggest to combat the menace of infiltration of illegal migrants from the neighbouring country?”

As per **MHA**, illegal immigrants are those who enter the country without valid travel documents in a clandestine and surreptitious manner.

The above case study presents a dilemma between **National Security** and **Personal Welfare** for Ramesh.

Guiding Principle - Dharmo rakṣhati rakṣitah - Dharma protects those who protect it.

Options available to Ramesh and critical evaluation

1. Withdraw the report quietly

Merits

1. Saves his current posting in the capital.
2. Protects his upcoming promotion.
3. Avoids immediate conflict with seniors.

Demerits

1. Becomes **complicit in illegality** and corruption.
2. Undermines **national security** and border integrity.
3. Betrays **public trust and constitutional duty**.
4. Legally and morally unacceptable

2. Refuse to withdraw and stand by the report

Merits

1. Upholds **rule of law and integrity**.



2. Protects **national security and public interest**.
3. Sends a strong signal against corruption.

Demerits

1. High risk of transfer.
2. Possible career retaliation.
3. May face administrative isolation.

3. Modify or dilute the report

Merits

1. Partially appeases higher authorities.
2. Reduces personal risk somewhat.
3. Keeps some facts on record.

Demerits

1. Distorts truth and weakens accountability.
2. Enables continued infiltration.
3. Violates professional integrity.

4. Leak the report to media

Merits

1. Creates public pressure for action.
2. Exposes wrongdoing quickly.
3. May force government to act.

Demerits

1. Violates **confidentiality and service rules**.
2. potential legal action against him
3. May politicize the issue and harm state security.

Option to choose - Option 2

1. **Refuse to withdraw the report in writing.**
2. Submit a **formal dissent note** explaining his reasons.
3. Escalate the matter to:
 - o Home Secretary / Chief Secretary
 - o Chief Minister
 - o State Vigilance / Anti-Corruption Bureau
4. Keep records of all communications for protection.

Justification

1. **Deontological ethics** - duty over self
2. Upholds **rule of law**.
3. **Leadership by example**
4. Protects **national security** over personal career.
5. Maintains **professional integrity and probity**.
6. Uses **institutional channels**, not media or politics.
7. Creates an official record that cannot be erased.
8. Balances courage with procedural correctness.

Ethical Dilemmas Faced by Ramesh

1. **Personal vs. Professional Duty:** conflict between being a "Good Son/Father" and "Good Officer"
2. **Integrity vs. Survival:** Choosing between a "Clean Conscience" and a "Clean Career Record."
3. **Short-term Family Stability vs. Long-term National Security.**
4. **Obedience to Superiors vs. Obedience to Law**
5. **Whistleblower's Dilemma:** Whether to stay within the system and fight or go public.
6. **Social responsibility vs Career ambitions**

Suggested Policy Measures to Combat Infiltration

1. **Integrated Border Surveillance System** with drones, sensors, CCTV and AI analytics.
2. A dedicated **Infiltration Combat Cell** comprising BSF, RAW, IB, and State Police.
3. **Zero-Tolerance Corruption Policy:** Immediate dismissal and criminal prosecution for any security personnel found facilitating illegal crossings.
4. **Regular Audits of "New Settler" Clusters** where sudden demographic shifts are noted.

5. **Diplomatic repatriation treaties** with neighboring countries for the time-bound return of apprehended illegal migrants.
6. Strengthening the **Whistleblowers Protection Act** to ensure that officers like Ramesh are not transferred or harassed.

“The ultimate measure of a man is not where he stands in moments of comfort and convenience, but where he stands at times of challenge and controversy.” - Martin Luther King Jr.

Thus, Ramesh must stand firm on truth and legality, even at personal cost.

[Case Study 5] “The Supreme Court has banned mining in the Aravalli Hills to stop degradation of the forest cover and to maintain ecological balance. However, the stone mining is still prevalent in the border district of the affected State with connivance of certain corrupt forest officials and politicians. A young and dynamic SP who was recently posted in the affected district promised to himself to stop this menace. In one of his surprise checks with his team, he found a truck loaded with stone trying to escape the mining area. He tried to stop the truck but the truck driver overran the police officer, killing him on the spot and thereafter managed to flee. Police filed FIR but no breakthrough was achieved in the case for almost three months. Ashok who was the Investigative Journalist working with leading TV channel, suo moto started investigating the case. Within one month, Ashok got breakthrough by interacting with local people, stone mining mafia and government officials. He prepared his investigative story and presented it to the CMD of the TV channel. He exposed in his investigative report the complete nexus of the stone mafia working with the blessing of corrupt police and civil officials and politicians. The politician who was involved in the mafia was no one else but a local MLA who was considered to be very close to the Chief Minister. After going through the investigative report, the CMD advised Ashok to drop the idea of making the story public through electronic media. He informed that the local MLA was not only the relative of the owner of the TV channel but also had unofficially 20 percent share in the channel. The CMD further informed Ashok that his further promotion and hike in pay will be taken care of in addition the soft loan of 10 lakhs which he has taken from the TV channel for his son’s chronic disease will be suitably adjusted if he hands over the investigative report to him.

- (a) What are the options available with Ashok to cope up with the situation?
- (b) Critically evaluate/examine each of the options identified by Ashok.
- (c) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by Ashok?
- (d) Which of the options, do you think, would be the most appropriate for Ashok to adopt and why?
- (e) In the above scenario, what type of training would you suggest for police officers posted to such districts where stone mining illegal activities are rampant?

This case highlights the risks faced by honest officers due to **criminals-politicians nexus** and the pressure on the "Fourth Estate" to choose **profit over pursuit of truth**.

Guiding Principle for Ashok - "Satyameva Jayate" - Truth alone triumphs

Options available to Ashok and critical evaluation

1. Drop the report and accept CMD's offer

Merits

1. Protects his job and career advancement.
2. Secures financial relief for his son's medical treatment.
3. Avoids confrontation with powerful politicians and media owners.

Demerits

1. Betrays **journalistic ethics and public trust**.
2. Allows continued environmental destruction.
3. Encourages corruption and impunity.
4. Makes Ashok complicit in wrongdoing.

2. Resign from the channel and publish the story through another media house

Merits

1. Preserves **journalistic integrity**.
2. Maintains his conscience and his professional legacy.
3. Exposes environmental crime and political nexus.

Demerits

1. Risk of legal harassment, threats, or physical danger.
2. Financial insecurity due to resignation.
3. Possible blacklisting by other media houses.

3. Submit the report to CBI or police for formal investigation

Merits

1. Strengthens **rule of law and due process**.
2. Protects Ashok from direct political retaliation.
3. Triggers institutional accountability.

Demerits

1. Investigation may be delayed or sabotaged.
2. Risk of leak and intimidation.
3. Media exposure may still be suppressed

Ethical Dilemmas Faced by Ashok

1. **Truth vs. Loyalty:** Duty to tell the truth vs. loyalty to the CMD who provided him a "soft loan."
2. **Personal Interest vs. Public Interest:** Taking a stand against a powerful nexus vs. playing it "safe" for his family.
3. **Confidentiality vs. Disclosure:** Holding onto a secret report vs. the moral obligation to expose the truth.
4. **Journalistic independence vs corporate control of media**
5. **Whistleblowing vs personal safety**
6. **Duty to society vs loyalty to employer** - Right to clean environment of citizens clashing with right to life of his son.
7. **Conscience vs career advancement** - promotion by compromising on integrity

Most appropriate option and justification

Option 2 and 3 - Resigning and taking it to other media house while simultaneously submitting report to investigation agencies

Justification

1. **Protects truth and public interest** - ensures that **truth is not buried by corporate-political nexus**.
2. **Balances ethics with legality**
 - **Media exposure** protects the **right of the public to know**.
 - **Legal submission** respects **rule of law and due process**.
3. Strengthens environmental enforcement.
4. Ensures **personal safety**. (whistleblower protection)
5. **Prevents institutional cover-up** - Public exposure through another media house creates **pressure for transparent and timely action**.
6. **Safeguards journalistic integrity and professional credibility** of Ashok.

Training suggested for police officers in illegal mining areas

1. **Environmental law training** - Familiarity with SC rulings, Forest Act, Mining laws.
2. **Anti-corruption vigilance. Eg-** Periodic integrity checks at checkpoints.
3. **Digital surveillance skills** - Use drones, GPS tracking, and CCTV analytics.
4. **Conflict de-escalation training** for handling violent smugglers without excessive force.
5. **Inter-agency coordination** - Collaboration with Forest Dept, Pollution Board, Revenue officials.
6. **Forensic training** for proper documentation of seized trucks, stones, and equipment.
7. **Personal safety training and provision of protective gear. Eg-** High-visibility jackets, body cams.
8. **Ethics and probity training** - Emphasis on integrity and public duty.
9. **Training on whistleblower protection protocols** to ensure anonymity of whistleblowers
10. **Strengthening community policing** - Build trust with villagers to get intelligence

“The only thing necessary for the triumph of evil is for good men to do nothing.” - Edmund Burke

By choosing integrity Ashok can honor the sacrifice of the young SP and protect the ecological heritage of the nation.

[Case Study 6] “You have done MBA from a reputed institution three years back but could not get campus placement due to COVID-19 generated recession. However, after a lot of persuasion and a series of competitive tests including written and interview, you managed to get a job in a leading shoe company. You have aged parents who are dependent and staying with you. You also recently got married after getting this decent job. You were allotted the Inspection Section which is responsible for clearing the final product. In the first one year, you learnt your job well and was appreciated for your performance by the management. The company has been doing good business for the last five years in the domestic market and this year it is even decided to export to Europe and Gulf countries. However, one large consignment to Europe was rejected by their Inspecting Team due to certain poor quality and was sent back. The top management ordered that ibid consignment to be cleared for the domestic market. As a part of the Inspecting Team, you observed the glaring poor quality and brought to the knowledge of the Team Commander. However, the top management advised all the members of the team to overlook these defects as the management cannot bear such a huge loss. The rest of the team members except you promptly signed and cleared the consignment for the domestic market, overlooking glaring defects. You again brought to the knowledge of the Team Commander that such consignment, if cleared even for the domestic market, will tarnish the image and reputation of the company and will be counter-productive in the long run. However, you were further advised by the top management that if you do not clear the consignment, the company will not hesitate to terminate your services citing certain innocuous reasons.

- (a) Under the given conditions, what are the options available to you as a member of the Inspecting Team?
- (b) Critically evaluate each of the options listed by you.
- (c) What option would you adopt and why?
- (d) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by you?
- (e) What can be the consequences of overlooking the observations raised by the Inspecting Team?

The case highlights a conflict between **corporate profit, professional integrity, and consumer safety**. Here, a young professional is torn between his job security, personal responsibilities and his honesty.

Guiding Principle - “Satya, Seva and Uttardayitva” - Truth, Service and Accountability

Options available and critical evaluation

1. Sign and clear the defective consignment

Merits

1. Saves my job in the short run.
2. Avoids conflict with top management.
3. Prevents immediate financial loss to the company.

Demerits

1. Violates **consumer rights and product safety**.
2. Damages **company reputation in the long term**.
3. **Ethical Egoism**: Prioritizing personal survival over the collective good.
4. Sets wrong precedent for future.

2. Refuse to sign and blow the whistle externally

Merits

1. Protects **public interest and consumer safety**.

2. Exposes unethical corporate practice.
3. Forces accountability through regulators.

Demerits

1. "Innocuous" termination may tarnish future career prospects.
2. Possible legal harassment and defamation case.
3. Personal and family financial insecurity.

3. Persuade management internally; resign if it fails

Merits

1. **Virtue Ethics:** Seeking the "Golden Mean" between silence and rashness.
2. Uses **institutional channels first** (professional maturity)
3. Gives management a chance to act ethically.
4. Protects my conscience and professional credibility.
5. Resignation is a more "graceful" exit than termination.

Demerits

1. Management may still ignore concerns.
2. Finding a new job in a post-recession market is difficult
3. Financial strain on family

Option to choose and justification

I would choose option 3

1. **Document Technical Dissent** - Present technical evidence of defects
2. **Formal Persuasion**
 - a. **Explain potential impact on brand image**
 - b. Highlight potential financial loss in long term
3. **Propose Alternative Solutions** - selling the batch as "Factory Seconds" or through a "Discount Outlet"
4. **Principled Resignation** - If management reject the alternative then resign.

Justification

1. Upholds **corporate governance** - commerce with morality
2. Aligns with **professional integrity and Deontological Ethics**
3. **Moral peace and conscience**- I do not carry lifelong guilt of knowingly allowing substandard goods.
4. **Professional credibility** - Even if I resign, my ethical stand strengthens my reputation in the industry.
5. **Protection from being complicit**- I avoid becoming part of corporate wrongdoing.
6. **Protection of brand reputation and** company's credibility in domestic and international markets.
7. **Protection of consumer rights**- ensures **fair value for money**

Ethical Dilemmas Faced

1. **Integrity vs. Survival:** The struggle between professional honesty and the need to pay for a mother's medicine or a spouse's needs.
2. **Ethics of Care vs. Ethics of Justice:** Duty toward one's own family vs. the duty to be fair to the domestic consumers.
3. **Domestic vs. Global Standards:** The moral question of whether domestic (Indian) consumers deserve lower quality than European ones.
4. **Conscience vs. Collective pressure:** Being a "team player" vs. listening to the inner voice.
5. **Loyalty to employer vs duty to society**
6. **Long-term Brand vs. Short-term Profit:** Saving the company's "Face" (Reputation) vs. saving its "Balance Sheet" (Loss).
7. **The "Recession Trauma":** The psychological fear of returning to the days of "unemployment".
8. **Whistleblower's Fear:** The anxiety of being labeled a "troublemaker" in the industry.
9. **Moral Hazard:** Fear of management using this "leverage" to force me into bigger frauds later.

Consequences of overlooking defects

For consumers

1. Risk of injuries or health problems.
2. Loss of trust in the brand.
3. Financial loss due to poor quality.
4. **exploitation**- domestic consumers treated as dumping ground for rejected exports.

For company

4. Severe **reputation damage** in domestic market.
5. Legal action under **Consumer Protection Act**.
6. Loss of future export opportunities.
7. Product recall costs and penalties.
8. Decline in market share.

For me (Inspector)

9. Moral guilt and professional compromise.
10. Possible legal liability if harm occurs.

“It takes 20 years to build a reputation and five minutes to ruin it.” - Warren Buffett

By upholding **quality, integrity, and consumer safety** over short term profit, I can uphold my professional duty.

CIVILSDAILY IAS



2021

[Case Study 1] Pawan has been working as an officer in the State Government for the last ten years. As a part of the routine transfer, he was posted to another department. He joined a new office along with five other colleagues. The head of the office was a senior officer conversant with the functioning of the office. As a part of general inquiry, Pawan gathered that his senior officer carries the reputation of being a difficult and insensitive person having his own disturbed family life. Initially, all seemed to go well. However, after some time Pawan felt that the senior officer was belittling him and at times unreasonable. Whatever suggestions given or views expressed by Pawan in the meetings were summarily rejected and the senior officer would express displeasure in the presence of others. It became a pattern of the boss's style of functioning to show him in a bad light highlighting his shortcomings and humiliating him publicly. It became apparent that though there are no serious work-related problems/shortcomings, the senior officer was always on one pretext or the other and would scold and shout at him. The continuous harassment and public criticism of Pawan resulted in the loss of confidence, self-esteem and equanimity. Pawan realized that his relations with his senior officer are becoming more toxic and due to this, he perpetually tensed, anxious and stressed. His mind was occupied with negativity and caused him mental torture, anguish and agony. Eventually, it badly affected his personal and family life. He was no longer joyous, happy and content even at home. Rather without any reason, he would lose his temper with his wife and other family members. The family environment was no longer pleasant and congenial. His wife who was always supportive of him also became a victim of his negativity and hostile behaviour. Due to harassment and humiliation suffered by him in the office, comfort and happiness virtually vanished from his life. Thus, it damaged his physical and mental health.

- a) What are the options available with Pawan to cope up with the situation?
- b) What approach Pawan should adopt for bringing peace, tranquillity and a congenial environment in the office and home?
- c) As an outsider, what are your suggestions for both boss and subordinate to overcome this situation and for improving the work performance, mental and emotional hygiene?
- d) In the above scenario, what type of training would you suggest for officers at various levels in the government offices?"

"Leadership is not about being in charge. It is about taking care of those in our charge." - Simon Sinek
However, the above case of Pawan highlights the issue of **Workplace Bullying** and the **Spillover Effect**, where toxicity at the office seeps into personal life.

Options Available to Pawan

1. **Formal Grievance Redressal:** Report the behavior to the higher-ups or the HR/Administrative department citing harassment.
2. **Seek a Transfer** to another department or branch on personal/medical grounds. If not granted, consider resignation as a last resort to save his health.
3. **Professional Confrontation:** Request a one-on-one meeting with the boss to calmly discuss the impact of his communication style on work productivity.

4. **Counselling and Meditation:** Seek professional therapy to manage stress and start daily mindfulness practices to decouple his self-esteem from the boss's outbursts.
5. **Collective Confrontation:** Communicate with other colleagues who are facing similar issues and confront the boss in a meeting or submit a joint representation to higher management.

Approach for Peace and Tranquillity

At the Office

1. **Cognitive Reframing:** Realize that the boss's anger is a projection of his own disturbed family life, not a reflection of Pawan's competence.
2. **Meet with the boss** to communicate the concerns and understand his expectations.
3. **Emotional regulation** - Respond calmly, avoid reactive behaviour.
4. **Evidence Documentation:** Maintain records of all task submissions and irrational rejections to counter future performance allegations.
5. **Use the "Grey Rock" Method:** communication pattern to deliberately act unresponsive and uninterested to encourage disengagement with difficult people.
6. **Seek Mentorship:** Connect with other seniors in the department to gain perspective and validation.
7. **Setting Boundaries:** Strictly avoid work-related discussions during lunch or after-hours.
8. **Emotional Anchoring:** Use small triggers (like a photo on the desk) to remain calm.

At home

1. **Separation of roles** - Do not carry office stress home.
2. **Open communication with spouse**, apologize for the recent hostility, and explain the root cause.
3. **Self-reflection** - Acknowledge stress triggers.
4. **Family engagement** - Quality time with loved ones.
5. **Counselling support** - Seek help without stigma.
6. **Avoid work-related communication** during family hours to restore a safe psychological space - Exercise **Right to Disconnect**
7. **Regular physical activity** to deplete the **cortisol levels** generated by chronic workplace anxiety.

Suggestions as an outsider for boss and subordinate

For the Senior Officer (Boss)

1. Develop **Self-Awareness** through the **Johari Window** model to realize how his "disturbed family life" is blinding his leadership.
2. Seek **Professional Counseling** for his personal issues rather than using subordinates as psychological punching bags.
3. Implement a **"Zero-Shouting Policy"** in meetings to maintain a professional decorum.
4. **Participative management** - Encourage ideas, even when rejecting them.
5. **Emotional intelligence training** - Recognise impact of behaviour on staff.
6. Organise **Conflict Resolution Workshops** mediated by a neutral third party.
7. The boss should learn the **"Sandwich Method"** of feedback (Positive-Constructive-Positive).
8. **Mentorship approach** - Guide rather than intimidate.
9. **Feedback Loop:** Establish a safe, anonymous channel for "Reverse Feedback" where subordinates can evaluate the leadership style of seniors.
10. Ensuring **Psychological Safety for subordinates:** Eg- **Microsoft's "Growth Mindset" culture** encourages learning from failures rather than hiding them.

For Pawan (Subordinate)

1. **Assertive communication** - Firm yet respectful dialogue.
2. **Avoid victim mindset** - Focus on growth and learning.
3. **Preserve self-respect and dignity** - stand up against humiliation and abuse
4. Develop **Emotional Resilience** to ensure that his self-worth is internally validated, not externally dictated.

Suggested Training for Government Officers

1. **EI Workshops:** Training on self-regulation and empathy. Eg- **Search Inside Yourself** program by Google).
2. **Soft Skills:** Training on non-violent communication (NVC) for higher bureaucracy.
3. **Transformational Leadership Training:** Moving from "Boss" to "Coach" .
4. Training officers to **identify signs of burnout and stress** in themselves and their teams.

5. **360-Degree Feedback Mechanisms** and inclusion of **behavioural metrics** in performance reviews
6. **Conflict Management & Mediation** training for handling departmental friction without escalation
7. **Stress Management** by institutionalizing "Yoga Breaks". Use **AYUSH Ministry's 'Y-Break' app**.
8. **Diversity and Inclusion (D&I) Training**: Sensitizing seniors to the diverse backgrounds and psychological needs of their teams.
9. **Role playing training** to help understand perspectives, expectations and concerns of team members

"Happy Office" initiative - core pillars

1. **Purpose**: sense of meaningful work
2. **People**: Positive relationships
3. **Progress**: Opportunities for personal growth
4. **Positivity**: supportive and appreciative environment.

"A healthy workplace is not built by power, but by respect."

Pawan's situation highlights that **administrative competence is useless without emotional competence**. Thus, a "psychologically safe" environment is non negotiable for success of any organisation.

[Case Study 2] You are Vice Principal of a degree college in one of the middle-class towns. The principal has recently retired and management is looking for his replacement. There are also feelers that the management may promote you as Principal. In the meantime, during the annual examination, the flying squad which came from the university caught two students red-handed involving unfair means. A senior lecturer of the college was personally helping these students in this act. This senior lecturer also happens to be close to the management. One of the students was the son of a local politician who was responsible for getting the college affiliated to the present reputed university. The second student was the son of a local businessman who has donated maximum funds for running the college. You immediately informed the management regarding this unfortunate incident. The management told you to resolve the issue with the flying squad at any cost. They further said that such an incident will not only tarnish the image of the college but also the politician and the businessman are very important personalities for the functioning of the college. You were also given a hint that your further promotion to Principal depends on your capability in resolving this issue with the flying squad. In the meantime, you were intimidated by your administrative officer that certain members of the student union are protesting outside the college gate against the senior lecturer and the students involved in this incident are demanding strict action against defaulters.

- a) Discuss the ethical issue involved in the case.
- b) Critically examine the options available with you as Vice Principal.
- c) What option will you adopt and why?

Academic integrity is the cornerstone of the educational system. Recent incidents, like the **NEET-UG paper leaks**, have triggered a national debate on the erosion of merit and the deep-seated nexus between administrators, politicians, and the coaching mafia.

Stakeholders Involved

1. **The Vice Principal**
2. **The Two Students**
3. **The Senior Lecturer**
4. **The Management**
5. **The University Flying Squad**
6. **The Student Union & Honest Students**
7. **The Politician & Businessman**

Guiding Principle - Satyam Vada Dharmam Chara - Speak the truth and follow righteousness.

Ethical issues involved in the case

1. **Cheating in the exam** - Unethical and illegal means used for success (violates **deontology**)
2. Violation of **"ethical responsibility"** by teacher - helping in cheating rather than imparting honesty
3. **Institutional image** - Taking strict action can lead to reputational damage for college
4. **Conflict of interest** - Management's closeness to the accused lecturer and influential parents.
5. **Meritocracy vs nepotism** - Unfair advantage to students due to lineage and donations.
6. **Personal ambition vs professional ethics** - Vice Principal's promotion linked to unethical compromise.
7. **Student trust** - Credibility of examination system at stake.
8. **Injustice for other students** - inaction or cancellation of examination can cause waste of academic year
9. **Risk of slippery slope** - saving students and teacher can embolden criminals to continue malpractices

Options available and critical examination

1. **Comply with management and "settle" the issue with the flying squad (through bribe)**

Merits

1. Protects short-term image by suppressing the issue
2. Secures management goodwill and promotion
3. Continued funding and political support for college

Demerits

1. Complicity in wrongdoing
2. Violates academic ethics and university rules
3. High risk of exposure and legal consequences
4. Destroys institutional credibility
5. violates **integrity, justice, accountability**

2. **Escalate the matter formally to university authorities - recommend strict against students and suspend teacher**

Merits

1. Upholds **rule of law and fairness**
2. Aligns with **integrity, impartiality, courage**
3. Addresses student union's demand for justice
4. Protects long-term reputation of college
5. Shields administrator through due process

Demerits

1. Loss of management favour
2. Political pressure and career risk
3. Loss of funding for college

3. **Selective Action - Suspend Lecturer but take spare students by giving "strict warning"**

Merits

- a. Punishes the facilitator.
- b. Easier to convince management considering student union protest
- c. Can deter other teachers from participating in such malpractices
- d. Saves the career of students

Demerits

- a. Management may not be satisfied as teacher is "close"
- b. Student union's demand not met

Option adopted and justification - Option 2

Course of Action

1. Fully cooperate with the **flying squad**

2. Ensure **strict action** against students and lecturer as per university norms
3. **Document facts objectively**
4. **Formally inform university authorities**
5. Manage student unrest through **transparent communication**

Justification

1. **Preserves sanctity of examinations**
2. **Ensures equality before law** - no immunity for power or money
3. **Protects long-term institutional credibility**
4. **Aligns with public interest and meritocracy**
5. **Justice for other student - Ensures a level playing field**
6. **Prevents recurrence of malpractice**
7. **Provides legal and moral protection** through due process
8. **Demonstrates ethical leadership** expected of an academic head

“Short-term embarrassment is preferable to long-term institutional decay.”

By choosing transparency and rule-based action, the Vice Principal upholds the “true” values of education.

[Case Study 3] The coronavirus disease (COVID-19) pandemic has quickly spread to various countries. As of May 8th, 2020, in India 56342 positive cases of corona had been reported. India with a population of more than 1.35 billion had difficulty in controlling the transmission of coronavirus among its population. Multiple strategies became necessary to handle this outbreak. The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare of India raised awareness about this outbreak and to take all necessary actions to control the spread of COVID -19. Indian Government implemented a 55-day lockdown throughout the country to reduce the transmission of the virus. Schools and colleges had shifted to alternative modes of teaching-learning-evaluation and certification. Online mode has become popular these days. India was not prepared for a sudden onslaught of such a crisis due to limited infrastructure in terms of human resources, money and other facilities needed for taking care of this situation. This disease did not spare anybody irrespective of caste, creed, religion on one hand and ‘have and have not’ on the other. Deficiencies in hospital beds, oxygen cylinders, ambulances, hospital staff and crematorium were the most crucial aspects. You are a hospital administrator in a public hospital at the time when coronavirus had attacked a large number of people and patients were pouring into the hospital day in and day out.

- a) What are your criteria and justification for putting your clinical and non-clinical staff to attend to the patients knowing fully well that it is a highly infectious disease and resources and infrastructure are limited?
- b) If yours is a private hospital, whether your jurisdiction and decision would remain the same as that of a public hospital?”

The COVID-19 pandemic was an **unprecedented public health emergency** that exposed systemic vulnerabilities in healthcare infrastructure across the world. As a hospital administrator in a public facility, my primary challenge is to balance the **Duty to Treat** with the **Duty to Protect** healthcare workers (HCWs) while managing acute shortages in oxygen, beds, and PPE.

Stakeholders Involved

1. **COVID-19 Patients**
2. **Clinical Staff and Non-clinical Staff**
3. **Hospital Administration**

4. **Government**
5. **Families of Staff and Patients**
6. **Society at large**

Guiding principle - Karma Pradhanam Jagat - The world is driven by action

Criteria and justification for deploying clinical and non-clinical staff

Criteria for Deployment

1. **Medical urgency and patient load**- Priority deployment in emergency, ICU, oxygen wards, and triage areas.
2. **Skill-based allocation**
 - Trained clinicians for critical care
 - Non-clinical staff for logistics, sanitation, crowd management
3. **Risk stratification of staff**
 - Younger staff without comorbidities in high-risk zones
 - Pregnant, elderly, or comorbid staff reassigned to low-risk roles
4. **Availability of minimum safety gear**- Deployment only where **basic PPE and infection-control protocols** are ensured.
5. **Duty-hour regulation** - Short shifts, rotational postings to reduce exposure and burnout.
6. **Voluntarism and informed consent (as far as possible)**- Clear communication of risks and preference to volunteers for COVID wards.
7. **Availability of psychological and physical support**- Counselling, rest areas, accommodation, food, and transport.
8. **Legal and policy backing**- Actions aligned with **MoHFW guidelines, ICMR protocols, and Disaster Management Act**.

Ethical Justification

1. **Balancing utilitarianism and deontology** - ensuing "maximum welfare" as well as adherence to duty of care
2. **Principle of Beneficence**: Maximizes patient recovery rates by matching clinical skills with patient severity.
3. **Justice** - Equitable distribution of risk, not coercion
4. **Professional duty** - Core obligation of healthcare workers
5. **Reciprocity** - Hospital and state owe protection, insurance, and compensation
6. **Proportionality** - Risks imposed are necessary and minimized
7. **Solidarity** - Collective response to a common threat
8. **Transparency** - Builds trust and morale among staff

In a pandemic, **private hospitals function as public utilities**. Profit considerations **cannot override the right to life**. Thus, my approach will be ethically similar but operationally different.

Similarities

1. **Ethical duty to treat during a pandemic**
2. **Compliance with government directions** under Disaster Management Act
3. **Non-discrimination of patients**
4. **Obligation to ensure staff safety**
5. **Adherence to clinical and safety protocols**

Differences

Aspect	Public Hospital	Private Hospital
Primary mandate	Public welfare	Service + sustainability
Staff deployment	Mandatory service rules	Greater scope for consent
Financial flexibility	Budget-constrained	Relatively higher
Pricing autonomy	Free/subsidised	Regulated caps during pandemic

As a hospital administrator, decisions must balance **saving lives and safeguarding caregivers**, guided by **justice, reciprocity, and transparency**. Whether public or private, healthcare institutions carry a **shared moral responsibility to humanity**.



[Case Study 4] An elevated corridor is being constructed to reduce traffic congestion in the capital of a particular state. You have been selected as project manager of this prestigious project on your professional competence and experience. The deadline is to complete the project in the next two years by 30 June 2021, since the project is to be inaugurated by the Chief Minister before the elections are announced in the second week of July 2021. While carrying out the surprise inspection by the inspecting team, a minor crack was noticed in one of the piers of the elevated corridor possibly due to poor material used. You immediately informed the chief engineer and stopped further work. It was assessed by you that a minimum of three piers of the elevated corridor have to be demolished and reconstructed. But this process will delay the project minimum by four to six months. But the chief engineer overruled the observation of the inspecting team on the ground that it was a minor crack that will not in any way impact the strength and durability of the bridge. He ordered you to overlook the observation of the inspecting team and continue working with the same speed and tempo. He informed you that the minister does not want any delay as he wants the Chief Minister to inaugurate the elevated corridor before the elections are declared. Also informed you that the contractor is a distant relative of the minister and he wants him to finish the project. He also gave you a hint that your further promotion as an additional chief engineer is under consideration by the ministry. However, you strongly felt that the minor crack in the pier in the elevated corridor will adversely affect the health and life of the bridge and therefore it will be very dangerous not to repair the elevated corridor.

- a) Under the given conditions, what are the options available to you as a project manager?
- b) What are the ethical dilemmas being faced by the project manager and his response to overcome such challenges?
- c) What are the professional challenges likely to be faced by the project manager and his response to overcome such challenges?
- d) What can be the consequences of overlooking the observation raised by the inspecting team?

The collapse of **Majerhat Bridge in Kolkata** or **Morbi suspension bridge failure** highlight how **engineering negligence, political pressure, and compromised quality control** can result in **loss of innocent lives**. This case places the project manager at the intersection of **public safety, professional integrity, and political interference**.

Guiding Principle - "Karmanyeva Adhikaraste Ma Phaleshu Kadachana" (Perform your duty without attachment to the results)

Stakeholders Involved

1. **General Public / Commuters**
2. **Project Manager (You)**



3. **Chief Engineer**
4. **Contractor**
5. **Minister / Political Executive**
6. **State Government / CMO**
7. **Inspecting Team**

Options Available to the Project Manager

1. **Continue construction** to meet the June 2021 deadline. This secures personal promotion but risks a catastrophic structural failure.
2. Exercise executive power to **halt work and reconstruct the piers**. This upholds safety but invites professional retaliation and career jeopardy.
3. Submit a **detailed technical report to the Chief Minister's Office and the State Vigilance Commission**.
4. **Requests removal from the project**. This preserves personal "purity" but allows the defective bridge to be completed by a more compliant successor.
5. **Whistleblowing**: Leaks the inspection report to the media to generate public pressure for repairs. This ensures transparency but violates civil service conduct rules.

Ethical Dilemmas and Response

1. **Public Safety vs. Career Advancement**
2. **Loyalty to Superiors vs. Professional Duty**
3. **Rule of law vs abuse of authority**
4. **Costs of reconstruction vs. moral cost of a potential collapse**
5. **Truth vs. Silence**
6. **Obedience to superior vs moral courage**
7. **Conflict of interest (contractor-minister nexus)**
8. **Short-term political gains vs long-term public harm**
9. **Fear of retaliation vs ethical duty**

Professional challenges and responses

Professional Challenge	Response
Overruling by superior	Seek written instructions or add dissent note in written orders
Political interference	Escalate through formal channels. Eg- report to Lokayukta and CMO
Threat to promotion	Accept ethical cost. (Duty over promotion)
Contractor pressure	Enforce contract clauses. Eg- issue show cause notice for faults
Media scrutiny	Maintain transparency. Eg- making structural audit report public
Isolation in department	Seek help from private experts
Legal vulnerability	Preserve documentation
Public criticism for delay	Communicate safety rationale

Consequences of overlooking inspection observations

1. **Structural failure leading to loss of lives**
2. **Criminal liability under IPC (negligence, culpable homicide)** based on audit reports
3. **Permanent damage to public trust**
4. **Career-ending consequences for officials involved in case of exposure of corruption or structural faults**
5. **Massive financial losses due to reconstruction after collapse**
6. **Violation of engineering ethics and codes**
7. **Moral culpability for preventable tragedy**

"Integrity is doing the right thing, even when no one is watching." Thus, by upholding truth, integrity, I can ensure **quality** public infrastructure.

[Case Study 5] Sunil is a young civil servant and has a reputation for his competence, integrity, dedication and relentlessness in pursuit of difficult and onerous jobs. Considering his profile, he was picked up by his bosses to handle a very challenging and sensitive assignment. He was posted in a tribal-dominated district notorious for illegal sand mining. Excavating sand from river belts and transporting it through trucks and selling them in the black market was rampant. This illegal sand mining mafia was operating with the support of local functionaries and tribal musclemen who in turn were bribing selected poor tribals and had kept the tribals under fear and intimidation. Sunil being a sharp and energetic officer immediately grasped the ground realities and the modus operandi followed by the mafia through their devious and dubious mechanism. On making inquiries, he gathered that some of their own office employees are hand in glove with them and have developed a close unholy nexus. Sunil initiated stringent action against them and started conducting raids on their illegal operations of the movement of trucks filled with sand. The mafia got rattled as not many officers in the past had taken such strong steps against the mafia. Some of the office employees who were allegedly close to the mafia informed them that the officer is determined to clean up the mafia's illegal sand mining operations in that district and may cause them irreparable damage. The mafia turned hostile and launched a counter-offensive. The tribal musclemen and mafia started threatening him with dire consequences. His family (wife and old mother) were stalked and were under virtual surveillance and thus causing mental torture, agony and stress to all of them. The matter assumed serious proportions when a muscleman came to his office and threatened him to stop raids etc., otherwise, his fate will not be different than some of his predecessors (ten years back one officer was killed by the mafia)

- Identify the different options available to Sunil in attending this situation
- Critically evaluate each of the options listed by you.
- Which of the above, do you think, would be most appropriate for Sunil to adopt and why?

Illegal sand mining has emerged as one of the **most violent forms of environmental crime in India**. Incidents such as the **murder of IAS officer Narendra Kumar (Madhya Pradesh, 2012)** and Sunil's case reflects this harsh reality, where enforcing the rule of law becomes a **life-threatening challenge**.

Guiding Principle - Dharmo rakṣhati rakṣitah (Dharma protects those who protect it)

Options available to Sunil and their critical evaluation

1. Suspend raids to protect personal and family safety

Merits

- Immediate reduction in personal and family risk
- Mental peace and security
- Ensures a "peaceful" tenure

Demerits

- Strengthens mafia confidence
- Betrayal of public trust
- Environmental degradation continues
- Sets a precedent of fear-driven governance
- Violates **integrity, courage, and duty to public service**

2. Seek transfer citing threat perception

Merits

- Protects life of officer and family
- Reduces immediate stress

Demerits

- Avoids responsibility
- Demoralises honest officers
- Allows mafia to regroup and flourish
- Fails **leadership responsibility**

3. Escalate the matter institutionally and strengthen enforcement

Actions

- Inform District Magistrate, SP, and State Government
- Seek armed security for self and family
- Conduct joint operations with police and forest authorities
- Take disciplinary action against colluding staff
- Use technology (GPS tracking, drones, CCTV, check posts)

Merits

- Ensures safety through **institutional backing**
- Sustains crackdown legally and systematically
- Reduces personal targeting
- Protects environment and tribal livelihoods
- Strongly upholds **rule of law, justice, courage, and accountability**

Demerits

- Initial escalation of conflict
- Requires political will and coordination
- Tribals may face increasing violence and intimidation

4. Public exposure through media or whistleblowing

Merits

- Creates public and political pressure
- Brings visibility to issue
- Can expose nexus

Demerits

- May compromise operations
- Heightens personal risk
- Can be seen as breach of service discipline

Most appropriate option and justification

Adopt Option 3 - Institutional escalation with reinforced enforcement

Justification

1. **Deontological duty to maintain law and order**
2. **Balances courage with prudence** - Does not act alone, but through the system
3. **Protects right to life (Article 21)** - Of citizens and officer alike
4. **Ensures sustainability of action** - Mafia dismantled, not temporarily disrupted
5. **Safeguards family security** - Through official protection
6. **Protects tribal communities** - Frees them from coercion and exploitation.
7. **Sets ethical precedent** - That threats cannot dictate governance

“The ultimate measure of a man is not where he stands in moments of comfort and convenience, but where he stands at times of challenge and controversy.” - Martin Luther King Jr.

By showing courage, integrity and commitment to public service, Sunil can uphold the rule of law and tackle the forces of intimidation and corruption.

[Case Study 6] A reputed food product company based in India developed a food product for the international market and started exporting the same after getting necessary approvals. The company announced this achievement and also indicated that soon the product will be made available for domestic consumers with almost the same quality and health benefits. Accordingly, the company got its product approved by the domestic competent authority and launched the product in the Indian market. The company could increase its market share over a period of time and earned substantial profit both domestically and internationally. However, the random sample test conducted by the inspecting team found the product being sold domestically in variance with the approval obtained from the competent authority. On further investigation, it was also discovered that the food company was not only selling products that were not meeting the health standard of the country but also selling the rejected export products in the domestic market. This episode adversely affected the reputation and profitability of the food company.

- a) What action do you visualize should be taken by the competent authority against the food company for violating the laid down domestic food standard and selling rejected export products in the domestic market?
- b) What course of action is available with the food company to resolve the crisis and bring back its lost reputation?
- c) Examine the ethical dilemma involved in the case."

This case reflects "**Double Standards**" in food quality, where products sold in developing markets are inferior to those exported to developed nations. The **Nestlé "added sugar" allegations** in low-income countries and the **Maggi lead controversy (2015)** in India are similar to the above case.

Guiding Principle -

1. **Commerce without morality is a sin (Gandhiji)**
2. **"Caveat Venditor" (Let the seller beware)**

a) Actions by the Competent Authority

1. **Immediate Recall and Seizure** under Section 34 of the **FSS Act, 2006**.
2. **Public Disclosure** to inform consumers of the specific health risks associated with the non-compliant batches.
3. **Suspension** of the company's FSSAI license pending a comprehensive safety audit of all manufacturing units.
4. **Monetary Penalties** under Section 51 (Sub-standard food) and Section 52 (Misbranded food) of the FSS Act to serve as a financial deterrent.
5. **Filing criminal charges** against the Board of Directors for "Adulteration" and "Deceptive Practices" under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).
6. **Third-Party Surveillance:** Appointing an independent, accredited laboratory to conduct "Blind Audits" for the next 24 months at the company's expense.
7. **Compensation to affected consumers** as per **Consumer Protection Act, 2019** (product liability).
8. Strengthening surveillance and random sampling

b) Course of Action for the Food Company

1. Issue an **unconditional public apology accepting full responsibility** for the quality variance without shifting blame to technicalities.
2. **Total Transparency:** Publish the lab reports and the specific points of failure on a dedicated public portal.
3. Commit to a **"One Global Standard"** policy, ensuring that the domestic product is identical in formulation to the international export version.
4. **Leadership Overhaul:** Replace the heads of the Quality Assurance (QA) and Compliance departments to signal a fundamental shift in corporate culture.

5. Launch a **"Refund or Replace" scheme** for consumers holding the affected batches, demonstrating a commitment to the **Ethics of Care**.
6. **Independent safety audits and certification**- Engage NABL-accredited or international auditors.
7. **Compensation and redressal to consumers** - Voluntary refunds and health support.
8. **Transparent communication strategy** - Publish audit findings and corrective measures.
9. **Corporate ethics and compliance training** - Build ethical culture, not just regulatory compliance.
10. **Long-term CSR initiatives in nutrition and food safety** to rebuild trust.

Ethical dilemmas involved in the case

1. **Profit maximisation vs public health** - Company prioritised revenue over consumer safety.
2. **Export-quality standards vs domestic consumer dignity** - inferior products to domestic consumers violates equality.
3. **Short-term gains vs long-term trust** - Immediate profits resulted in lasting reputational damage.
4. **Corporate secrecy vs transparency** - Concealment of quality deviation undermined consumer trust
5. **Market dominance vs moral fairness** - Abuse of brand power to push substandard products.
6. Withholding true quality information deprived consumers of autonomy and **informed choice**
7. **Deceptive Marketing**: Promoting "same quality and health benefits" while knowingly delivering a sub-standard product.
8. **Corporate Greed vs. Social Responsibility**: violation of "trusteeship" principle for profits

"It takes 20 years to build a reputation and five minutes to ruin it." - Warren Buffett

Thus, authorities must act decisively to deter misconduct, while companies must realize that **sustainable success lies in ethical consistency, not selective compliance**.

2020

Rampura, a remote district inhabited by a tribal population, is marked by extreme backwardness and abject poverty. Agriculture is the mainstay of the local population, though it is subsistence due to the very small landholdings. There is insignificant industrial or mining activity. Even the targeted welfare programs have inadequately benefited the tribal population. In this restrictive scenario, the youth has begun to migrate to other states to supplement the family income. The plight of minor girls is that their parents are persuaded by labour contractors to send them to work in the Bt Cotton farms of a nearby state. The soft fingers of the minor girls are well suited for plucking the cotton. The inadequate living and working conditions in these farms have caused serious health issues for the minor girls. NGOs in the districts of domicile and the cotton farms appear to be compromised and have not effectively espoused the twin issues of child labour and development of the area. You are appointed as the District Collector of Rampura.

- a. Identify the ethical issues involved.
- b. Which specific steps will you initiate to ameliorate the conditions of minor girls of your district and to improve the overall economic scenario in the district?"

As the District Collector of Rampura, I am faced with a complex socio-economic crisis where systemic poverty has resulted into a cycle of exploitation of minor girls.

Stakeholders Involved

- The Minor Girls
- Tribal Parents
- Labor Contractors
- Bt Cotton Farm Owners
- District Administration
- Compromised NGOs
- State Government

Guiding Principle - Antyodaya (Upliftment of the last person in the social hierarchy)

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Child Labour** - Violation of **Article 24** and Child Labour Act.
2. **Exploitation of Tribal Vulnerability** - Abuse of **economic desperation**.
3. **Health Neglect** - Exposure to **pesticides and poor living conditions**.
4. **Gender Injustice** - **Young girls disproportionately affected**.
5. **Inter-generational Poverty Trap** - Loss of education perpetuates deprivation.
6. **Administrative Apathy and Failure of the Social Contract** - Failure of **welfare delivery systems**.
7. **NGO Ethical Compromise** - Erosion of **civil society accountability**.
8. **Inter-State Governance Failure** - Weak coordination against trafficking.
9. **Information Asymmetry** - Parents misled by contractors.
10. **Human Dignity Violation** - Treating children as **economic tools**.

Steps for ameliorating conditions of minor girls

1. **I will** launch a coordinated rescue mission (**Operation Muskaan**) with the police of the neighboring state.
2. **Register FIRs** against labor contractors and farm owners under the Child Labour Prohibition Act, 2016.
3. **I will** ensure 100% enrollment of rescued girls in **Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalyas** to prevent re-migration.

4. **Strengthening Anganwadi & ICDS** for nutrition support and monitoring of adolescent girls.
5. I will organise **specialized medical camps** for returning girls to treat respiratory and skin issues caused by cotton dust and pesticides.
6. Form **community vigilance committees** to monitor the movement of contractors.
7. Ensure all girl-child specific scheme Benefits (like **Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana**) are credited directly to verified accounts.
8. **Vocational training** with the support of NGOs for girls aged 15-18 in local crafts to provide dignified local alternatives.
9. Create a **"Migration Registry"** to track every minor moving out of the district.
10. **Social Awareness Campaigns:** Use "Nukkad Nataks" (street plays) in tribal dialects to highlight the health hazards of cotton plucking.
11. Blacklist compromised NGOs and invite reputable national-level organizations (like **Bachpan Bachao Andolan**) to set up local offices.

Action Plan: Improving the Economic Scenario

1. **MGNREGA Diversification:** focus on creating durable assets like farm ponds and check dams. Eg- Chhattisgarh's Narwa-Garwa-Ghurwa-Bari model.
2. **Promotion of FPOs** to increase bargaining power and eliminate middlemen.
3. Seek **GI Tagging for Tribal Art** to boost export value. Eg- Bastar Art in Chhattisgarh
4. **Micro-Irrigation Push:** Use PM-Krishi Sinchayee Yojana to maximize yield on small landholdings.
5. **Eco-Tourism:** Develop tribal circuits for sustainable tourism, providing employment to youth as guides and homestay owners.
6. **Value-Addition Centers** to process local forest produce locally under Van Dhan Vikas scheme .
7. **SHG Bank Linkage:** Empower women through Self-Help Groups to start poultry or goat farming. Eg- Kudumbashree model.
8. **Industrial Skill Centers:** Partner with nearby industries to train youth for formal employment.
9. **Last-Mile Connectivity:** Improve road infrastructure to enable farmers to reach markets directly, bypassing contractors.

"Kanyashree" model in West Bengal has successfully used conditional cash transfers to keep girls in school and prevent child marriage/labor.

Protecting minor girls from exploitation while creating **sustainable tribal livelihoods** ensures **justice today and empowerment tomorrow**. As **Amartya Sen** notes, **development is freedom**, and freedom begins with protecting the **most vulnerable child**.

[Case Study 2] Migrant workers have always remained at the socio-economic margins of our society, silently serving as the instrumental labour force of urban economics. The pandemic has brought them into national focus. On announcement of a countrywide lockdown, a very large number of migrant workers decided to move back from their places of employment to their native villages. The non-availability of transport created its own problems. Added to this was the fear of starvation and inconvenience to their families. This caused the migrant workers to demand wages and transport facilities for returning to their villages. Their mental agony was accentuated by multiple factors such as a sudden loss of livelihood, possibility of lack of food and inability to assist in harvesting their rabi crop due to not being able to reach home in time. Reports of inadequate response of some districts in providing the essential boarding and lodging arrangements along the way multiplied their fears. You have learnt many lessons from this situation when you were tasked to oversee the functioning of the District Disaster Relief Force in your district.

- a. In your opinion what ethical issues arose in the current migrant crisis?
- b. What do you understand by an ethical care giving state?
- c. What assistance can the civil society render to mitigate the sufferings of migrants in similar situations?

“The true measure of any society can be found in how it treats its most vulnerable members.” - Mahatma Gandhi

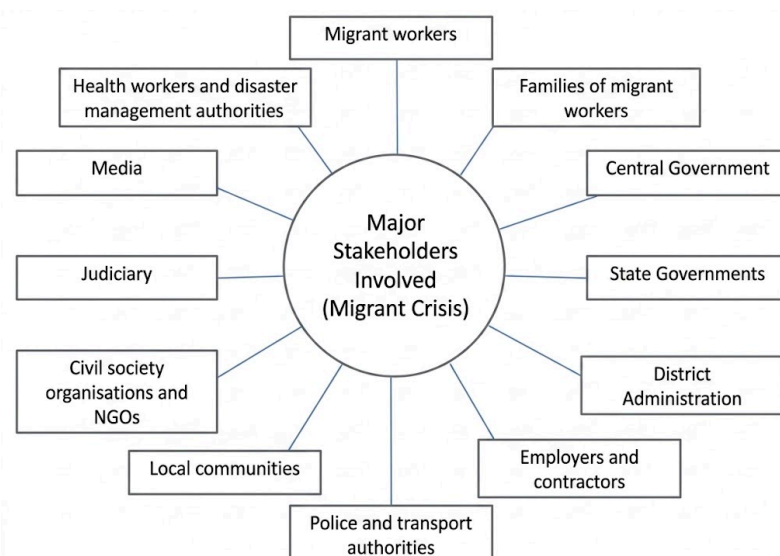
The **reverse migration during** COVID-19 lockdown exposed the structural vulnerabilities of India's informal workforce and raised profound ethical questions regarding governance, justice, human dignity, and social responsibility.

Fact File

- India has over **450 million** internal migrants (**37%** of the total population)
- Over **90%** of these casual laborers lack formal employment contracts, social security benefits, or stable housing.

Ethical Issues in the Current Migrant Crisis

- 1. Violation of Human Dignity** - Migrants walking hundreds of kilometres reflected erosion of basic human dignity and compassion.
- 2. Inequality and Social Exclusion** - Informal workers remained invisible despite sustaining urban economies.
- 3. Failure of Welfare Justice** - Lack of food, shelter, and income support violated principles of distributive justice.
- 4. Livelihood vs Life Dilemma** - Migrants faced ethical conflict between protecting health and preventing starvation.
- 5. Administrative Unpreparedness** - Absence of contingency planning exposed gaps in ethical governance and disaster preparedness.
- 6. Denial of Labour Rights** - Wage withholding and abrupt dismissals violated labour ethics and employer responsibility.
- 7. Breakdown of Federal Coordination** - Poor coordination between states created confusion regarding transport and relief measures.



8. **Digital and Documentation Exclusion** - Many migrants lacked ration cards, IDs, or digital access required for availing relief.
9. **Lack of empathy and compassion** - Migrants were treated as virus carriers, facing social ostracisation.
10. **Mental Health and Emotional Trauma** - Anxiety, uncertainty, and separation from families highlighted neglect of emotional well-being.

Ethical Care Giving State

It is a welfare-oriented, empathetic, accountable, and inclusive state that prioritises the dignity, safety, and well-being of vulnerable citizens through compassionate governance and equitable public policy.

1. **Compassion-Centred Governance** - Eg- Community kitchens during lockdown in Kerala.
2. **Protection of Human Dignity** - Eg- Free transport arrangements under Shramik Special trains.
3. **Universal Access to Basic Needs** - Eg- Expansion of PMGKAY food distribution scheme.
4. **Responsive and Timely Administration** - Eg- Helpline systems and migrant registration portals.
5. **Inclusive Welfare Architecture** - Eg- One Nation One Ration Card (ONORC).
6. **Transparency and Accountability** - Public communication and data-driven governance reduce panic and misinformation. Eg- Daily health briefings and relief dashboards.
7. **Participatory Governance** - Collaboration with NGOs, SHGs, community leaders, and volunteers.

Role of Civil Society in Mitigating Sufferings of Migrants

1. **Rapid Needs Assessment** Civil society organisations reach communities faster than government machinery and can identify needs accurately.
2. **Food and Nutrition Distribution** NGOs and community kitchens filled the gap where government PDS could not reach.
3. **Legal Aid and Rights Awareness** - Eg- Human Rights Law Network filed PILs ensuring Shramik Special Trains were made free
4. **Mental Health Support** - Eg- iCall (TISS) and Vandrevala Foundation ran 24-hour mental health helplines specifically for migrant workers during COVID
5. **Information Dissemination in Local Languages**- Eg- Aajeevika Bureau distributed COVID safety and relief information in Odia, Bengali, and Telugu.
6. **Shelter and Transit Camp Management**- Eg- Goonj set up 17 relief stations along major highway routes providing meals, footwear, and first aid kits to walking migrants in UP and Bihar.
7. **Coordination with Government** Eg- Stranded Workers Action Network (SWAN) tracked over 16,000 distress calls and shared data with state governments.
8. **Long-Term Livelihood Rehabilitation** - Eg- Professional Assistance for Development Action (PRADAN) linked returned migrants in Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh with MGNREGA work and SHG-linked microfinance within weeks of their return.

The deepest lesson from the migrant crisis is structural: India needs portable entitlements, a national migrant worker registry, and an integrated disaster response framework

[Case Study 3] Parmal is a small but underdeveloped district. It has a rocky terrain that is not suitable for agriculture, though some subsistence agriculture is being done on small plots of land. The area receives adequate rainfall and has an irrigation canal flowing through it. Amaria, its administrative centre, is a medium-sized town. It houses a large district hospital, an Industrial Training Institute and some privately owned skill training centres. It has all the facilities of a district headquarters. A trunk railway line passes approximately 50 kilometers from Amaria. Its poor connectivity is a major reason for the absence of any major industry therein. The state government offers a 10 year tax holiday as an incentive to new industry. In 2010 Anil, an industrialist decided to take benefits to set up Amaria Plastic Works (APW) in Noora village, about 20km from Amaria. While the factory was being built, Anil hired the required key labour and got them trained at the skill training centres at Amria. This act of his made the key personnel very loyal to APW. APW started production in 2011 with the labour drawn fully from Noora village. The villagers were very happy to get employment near their homes and were motivated by the key personnel to meet the production targets with high quality. APW started making large profits, a sizable portion of which was used to improve the quality of life in Noora. By 2016, Noora could boast of a greener village and a renovated village temple. Anil liaised with the local MLA to increase the frequency of the bus services to Amria. The government also opened a primary health care centre and primary school at Noora in buildings constructed by APW. APW used its CSR funds to set up women's self-help groups, subsidize primary education to the village children and procure an ambulance for use by its employed and the needy. In 2019, there was a minor fire in APW. It was quickly extinguished as fire safety protocols were in place in the factory. Investigations revealed that the factory had been using electricity in excess of its authorized capacity. This was soon rectified. The next year, due to nationwide lockdown, the requirement of production fell for four months. Anil decided that all employees would be paid regularly. He employed them to plant trees and improve the village habitat. APW had developed a reputation of high-quality production and a motivated workforce.

- a. Critically analyse the story of APW and state the ethical issues involved.
- b. Do you consider APW as a role model for the development of backward areas? Give reasons.

The case of **Amaria Plastic Works (APW)** illustrates how **private enterprise** can act as a catalyst for development in a **backward, low-connectivity district**.

Ethical positives in the story of APW

1. **Inclusive Employment Generation** - Local recruitment reduced migration and ensured **livelihood security**.
2. **Human Capital Development** - Investment in **skill training** enhanced employability and dignity of labour.
3. **Stakeholder-Oriented Business Ethics** - Profit-sharing through social investment reflects **stakeholder capitalism**.
4. **Ethical use of CSR beyond tokenism**- SHGs, education subsidy, ambulance, habitat improvement
5. **Virtue ethics** - Ethical leadership during lockdown by prioritising **human well-being over profit**.
6. **Rule compliance** - Fire incident managed due to **prior safety compliance**.
7. **Public-Private Collaboration** - Constructive engagement with the state for connectivity, PHC, school support.

Ethical issues (critical analysis)

1. Excess electricity usage reflects **procedural impropriety**, even if later corrected.

2. **Dependence on a Single Employer** creates **economic vulnerability**.
3. **Plastic manufacturing** inherently raises **long-term ecological concerns**
4. Risk of **substituting state obligation with corporate benevolence (Philanthropy vs Rights)** - Welfare delivered through CSR rather than institutional entitlements.
5. **Unequal Spatial Development** - Benefits concentrated in Noora, rest of Parmal district remains underdeveloped.
6. **Paternalism**: The village's heavy reliance on Anil for healthcare, education, and transport creates a "Company Town" dynamic where the benefactor has disproportionate power.
7. **Cronyism Risks**: Liaising with an MLA for specific bus routes might raise questions of whether public resources were diverted to benefit a private entity's logistics.

b) **Yes, APW can be considered as a role model for rural development.** Despite the minor regulatory lapse, its blueprint offers a sustainable path for "backward" regions.

Reasons

1. **Adherence to principle of Triple Bottom Line** - people, profit and planet
2. **Inclusive Growth**: integrating tribal or rural populations into high-tech manufacturing through training.
3. **Ethical Entrepreneurship** - Profit combined with **social conscience**.
4. **Crisis Ethics** - Lockdown response exemplifies **compassionate capitalism**.
5. **Trust-Based Industrial Relations** - Loyalty built through **investment in people**, not coercion.
6. **Demonstration Effect** - Shows how **industry can thrive even in low-connectivity regions**.
7. **Social Capital Building**: It revitalized community spaces (temples, schools), fostering social cohesion.
8. **PPP (Public-Private Partnership) at Grassroots**
9. **Market-Linked Skill Development**: It utilized existing local institutions (ITIs) to create industry-ready talent.
10. **Health as a Priority**: The provision of an ambulance and a primary health center addressed the most critical vulnerability of rural life.
11. **Financial Independence for Women**: Through SHGs, it diversified the village's income sources beyond the factory floor.
12. **Altruistic Management**: Anil's "Loyalty First" approach is a model for modern HR practices in volatile markets.

The story of APW is a triumph of **"Profits with Purpose."** Anil proved that with local capacity building and ethical treatment of labor, social and economic progress can be achieved in backward districts.

[Case Study 4] The Chairman of Bharat Missiles Ltd (BML) was watching a program on TV wherein the Prime Minister was addressing the nation on the necessity of developing a self-reliant India. He subconsciously nodded in agreement and smiled to himself as he mentally reviewed BML's journey in the past two decades. BML had admirably progressed from producing first-generation anti-tank guided missiles (ATGMs) to designing and producing state of the art ATGM weapon systems that would be the envy of any army. He sighed in reconciliation with his assumptions that the government would probably not alter the status quo of a ban on the export of military weaponry. To his surprise, the very next day he got a telephone call from the Director-General, Ministry of Defence, asking him to discuss the modalities of increasing BML production of ATGMs as there is a probability of exporting the same to a friendly country. The Director-General wanted the Chairman to discuss the details with his staff in Delhi next week. Two days later, at a press conference, the Defence Minister stated that he aims to double the current weapons export levels within five years. This would give an impetus to financing the development and manufacturing of indigenous weapons in the country. He also stated that all indigenous arms manufacturing nations have a very good record of the international arms trade. As the Chairman of BML, what are your views on the following points?

- a. As an arms exporter of a responsible nation like India, what are the ethical issues involved in arms trade?
- b. List five ethical factors that would influence the decision to sell arms to foreign governments.

"A nation that stands for peace must also be prepared to protect it. However, a nation that profits from the tools of war must carry the heavy burden of conscience."

As the Chairman of BML, I see the government's shift toward arms exports as a double-edged sword. While it fulfills the vision of **Atmanirbhar Bharat**, it also transitions BML to a global weapon-supplier.

Ethical issues involved in arms trade by a responsible nation like India

1. **Right to Life vs National Interest** - Weapons enhance security but also possess inherent **lethality**, raising moral concerns over loss of civilian life.
2. **Just War Ethics** - Risk of arms being used for **unjust aggression**, repression, or violation of humanitarian law. Eg- Genocide in Rwanda
3. **End-use dilemma** - Difficulty in ensuring weapons are used **only for legitimate defence purposes**.
4. **Regional Destabilisation** - Arms exports can **fuel arms races** and escalate regional conflicts.
5. **Moral Complicity** - Exporting state may be ethically implicated in atrocities committed using supplied weapons.
6. **Diversification Risk** - Possibility of weapons falling into **non-state actors or terrorist groups**. Eg- US-origin arms captured from Iraqi forces later used by **ISIS**
7. **Profit vs Peace** - Tension between **economic gains** and **ethical responsibility**.
8. **Dual-Use Technology Concerns**: sensitive technology can be reverse-engineered or adapted for offensive purposes beyond the original agreement.
9. **Global Image and Credibility** - India's identity as a **peace-oriented democracy** may be affected by reckless exports.
10. **Accountability and Transparency** - Arms trade is often opaque, raising concerns of **corruption and lack of oversight**. Eg- Bofors scam
11. If the regime is overthrown by a hostile or radical group, arms may fall into wrong hands.

Ethical Factors Influencing Decision to Sell Arms to Foreign Governments (5 Factors)

1. **Human Rights Record of the Recipient State** - Arms should not be sold to regimes with a history of **systematic human rights violations**. Eg- Germany suspended arms exports to **Saudi Arabia** after the Jamal Khashoggi killing.
2. **Purpose and End-Use Assurance** - Clear commitment that weapons will be used **only for defensive and legitimate security needs**.
3. **Impact on Regional Peace** - Exports must not **exacerbate existing conflicts or destabilise regions**. Eg- no sale to Ukraine or Palestine
4. **Compliance with International Law** - The sale must comply with international arms control regimes (such as the **Wassenaar Arrangement** or the **Arms Trade Treaty**)
5. **Alignment with India's Strategic and Ethical Values** - Sale should reinforce India's image as a **responsible, rule-based, peace-oriented power**.

While doubling exports is a valid economic goal, it must be governed by a **National Export Ethics Code**. As Chairman of BML, I would support exports only when they align with **national security, global peace, and India's civilisational ethos of ethical power**.

[Case Study 5] Rajesh Kumar is a senior public servant, with a reputation of honesty and forthrightness, currently posted in the Finance Ministry as the Head of the Budget Division. His department is presently busy in organizing the budgetary support to the states, four of which are due to the polls within the financial year. This year's annual budget had allotted Rs 8300 crores for the National Housing Scheme (NHS), a centrally sponsored social housing scheme for the weaker sections of society. Rs 775 crores have been drawn for the NHS till June. The Ministry of Commerce had long been pursuing a case for setting up a Special Economic Zone (SEZ) in a southern state to boost exports. After two years of detailed discussion between the center and state, the Union Cabinet approved the project in August. The process was initiated to acquire the necessary land. Eighteen months ago a leading Public Sector Unit (PSU) had projected the need for setting up a large natural gas processing plant in a northern state for the regional gas grid. The land is already in possession of the PSU. The gas grid is an essential component of the national energy security strategy. After three rounds of global bidding, the project was allotted to an MNC, M/s XYZ Hydrocarbons. The first tranche of payment to the MNC is scheduled to be made in December. The Finance Ministry was asked for a timely allocation of an additional Rs 6000 crores for these two developmental projects. It was decided to recommend re-appropriation of this entire amount from NHS allocation. The file was forwarded to the Budget Department for their comments and further processing. On studying the case file, Rajesh Kumar realized that this re-appropriation may cause an inordinate delay in the execution of NHS, a project much publicized in the rallies of senior politicians. Correspondingly, the non-availability of finances would cause a financial loss in the SEZ and national embarrassment due to delayed payment in the international project. Rajesh Kumar discussed the matter with seniors. He was conveyed that this politically sensitive situation needs to be processed immediately. Rajesh Kumar realized that diversion of funds from the NHS could raise difficult questions for the government in the Parliament. Discuss the following with reference to this case-

- a. Ethical issues involved in re-appropriation of funds from a welfare project to the development projects.
- b. Given the need for proper utilization of public funds, discuss the options available to Rajesh Kumar.
- c. Is resigning a worthy option?

As the Head of the Budget Division, Rajesh Kumar is at the intersection of **distributive justice** (housing for the poor) and **national strategic interest** (energy security and exports).

Guiding Principle- Utilitarian Ethics - Maximising overall public good while minimising harm.

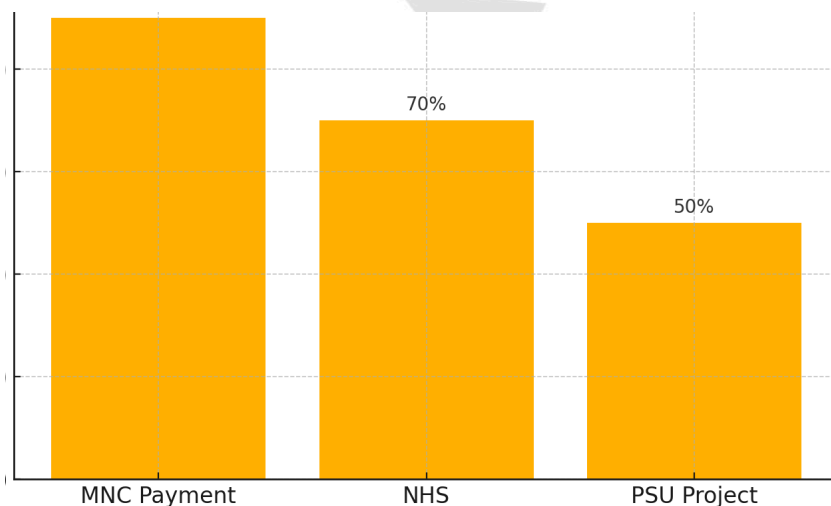
Ethical Issues Involved in Re-appropriation of Funds

1. From a Utilitarian **perspective**, the gas grid secures energy for millions. However, from a **Rights-based perspective**, homeless have a prior claim to the funds specifically marked for them.
2. **Equity vs Efficiency** - Diverting funds from **housing for the poor** to capital-intensive projects prioritizes efficiency over **social justice**.
3. **Violation of Welfare Commitment** - NHS was approved by Parliament and publicly promised, creating an ethical obligation of **policy fidelity**.
4. **Impact on Vulnerable Sections** - Delay in NHS disproportionately affects **economically weaker sections**, violating **distributive justice**.
5. **Parliamentary Accountability** - Re-appropriation without transparent disclosure may undermine **legislative oversight**.
6. Pressure to act swiftly due to elections risks **politicisation of financial decisions**.

7. **Opportunity Cost Ethics** - Using welfare funds for development projects raises questions on **prioritisation of scarce resources**.
8. **International Credibility** - Delay in payment to the MNC risks **national embarrassment** and reputational damage.
9. **Right vs Right dilemma** - choosing between **social justice or long-term strategic interests**.
10. **Administrative Integrity** - Challenge in balancing **obedience to authority** with **constitutional morality**.
11. Any perception of arbitrary diversion can erode **citizens' trust in governance**.

Options Available to Rajesh Kumar

1. **Process the Re-appropriation as directed** as energy security and India's reputation is at stake.
2. **Partial Re-appropriation:** Take only a small portion from the NHS that is unlikely to be spent in the current quarter.
3. **Formal Dissent** - record a detailed "Note on File" highlighting the impact on NHS
4. **Explore Alternative Fiscal Options** -
 - a. Propose **supplementary grants, contingency fund use** for payment to MNC
 - b. **Market borrowings** or PPP for PSU project
 - c. Using **crowdfunding or CSR funds** for NHS scheme by creating PM Housing Fund similar to PM-CARES fund



Resignation as an option

No, resignation is not the most ethical option

1. **Abdication of Responsibility** - highlights lack of courage of conviction in Rajesh as he adopts escapist route
2. **Loss of Institutional Corrective Voice** - Remaining in office allows Rajesh to **influence outcomes ethically**.
3. **Doctrine of Commitment** - Civil servants are expected to **resolve dilemmas within the system**, not exit at the first conflict.
4. **Availability of Ethical Alternatives** - Since lawful and ethical options exist, resignation is **disproportionate**.
5. **Public Interest Supremacy** - Ethical action lies in **harm minimisation**, not moral withdrawal.
6. **Resignation** is justified only if asked to do something **illegal, unconstitutional, or blatantly unethical**.
7. **Harm minimisation principle** - Staying allows Rajesh Kumar to **reduce damage to NHS beneficiaries**.

Rajesh Kumar's ethical responsibility lies in **balancing priorities transparently, safeguarding the vulnerable, and upholding national commitments**. True integrity in public service lies in principled decision-making, not principled exit.

[Case Study 6] You are a municipal commissioner of a large city, having the reputation of a very honest and upright officer. A huge multipurpose mall is under construction in your city in which a large number of daily wage earners are employed. One night, during monsoons, a big chunk of the roof collapsed causing instant death of four labourers including two minors. Many more were seriously injured requiring immediate medical attention. The mishap resulted in a big hue and cry, forcing the government to institute an inquiry. Your preliminary enquiry has revealed a series of anomalies. The material used for the construction was of poor quality. Despite the approved building plans permitting only one basement, an additional basement has been constructed. This was overlooked during the periodic inspections by the building inspector of the municipal corporation. In your enquiry, you noticed that the construction of the mall was given the green signal despite encroaching on areas earmarked for a green belt and a slip road in the Zonal Master Plan of the city. The permission to construct the mall was accorded by the previous Municipal Commissioner who is not only your senior and well known to you professionally, but also a good friend. Prima facie, the case appears to be of a widespread nexus between officials of the Municipal Corporation and the builders. Your colleagues are putting pressure on you to go slow in the enquiry. The builder, who is rich and influential, happens to be a close relative of a powerful minister in the state cabinet. The builder is persuading you to hush up the matter, promising you a fortune to do so. He also hinted that if this matter is not resolved at the earliest in his favour there is somebody in his office who is waiting to file a case against you under the POSH act.

- a. Discuss the ethical issues involved in the case.
- b. What are the options available to you in this situation?
- c. Explain your selected course of action.

This case presents an administrative and ethical crisis involving institutional corruption, structural negligence, safety failures, and direct threats to upright public oversight.

Guiding Principle - "Karmanye Vadhikaraste Ma Phaleshu Kadachana" (Your duty is to perform your prescribed action, never to look for rewards or fear the consequences).

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Corruption and Abuse of Public Office** - Nexus between builders and municipal officials for illegal approvals.
2. **Violation of Public Safety** - Use of substandard material endangered human lives.
3. **Negligence in Regulatory Oversight** - Failure of building inspections despite illegal additional basement.
4. **Exploitation of Labour** - Employment of daily wage workers and minors in unsafe conditions.
5. **Conflict of Interest** - Previous Municipal Commissioner being a friend and senior officer.
6. **Political Interference** - Influence of minister through relation with builder compromises impartiality.
7. **Attempted Bribery** - Builder offering financial inducement to suppress truth.
8. **Threat and Intimidation** - Misuse of POSH provisions as a coercive weapon.
9. **Environmental Ethics Violation** - Encroachment on green belt and slip road harms sustainable urban planning.
10. **Erosion of Public Trust** - Citizens lose faith in institutions due to collusion and impunity.

Options Available

1. **Conduct a Transparent, Evidence-Backed Investigation and Enforce the Law:** Exposes the full official-builder nexus, ensures immediate victim justice, and rejects all illegal threats.
2. **Accept the Bribe and Quietly Hush Up the Inquiry:** Compromises personal integrity completely, protects criminals, and fails the deceased victims.

3. **Yield to Peer Pressure and Deliberately Slow Down the Investigation:** Saves personal relations and career comfort but represents a surrender of administrative duty.
4. **Resign from the Post to Avoid Professional Stress:** Escapes personal accountability entirely while leaving systemic corruption and illegal structures unchecked.
5. **Recuse from the Inquiry Citing Personal Conflict of Interest:** Removes oneself due to friendship with the predecessor but delays immediate crisis resolution.
6. **file a Diluted Report Sacrificing Only Lower-Level Field Staff:** Protects senior bureaucratic friends and powerful builders while unfairly scapegoating lower-level inspectors.

Selected Course of Action and Justification

Course of Action	Ethical Justification
Ensure immediate medical treatment and compensation for victims	Compassion, welfare of vulnerable workers
Seal construction site and stop further work	Prevent further danger and preserve evidence
Request experts from premier institutions like the IITs to conduct scientific checks on the structural strength and material quality.	Secures objective scientific evidence that cannot be diluted by internal municipal corruption.
File FIR against builder, contractors, and responsible officials	Rule of law and deterrence
Document all proceedings and maintain transparency	Protects against political pressure and false allegations
Inform state vigilance/anti-corruption agencies about bribery attempt and intimidation	Moral courage and institutional accountability
Recommend systemic reforms in inspection, labour safety, and approval mechanisms	Preventive ethics and long-term governance reform

A civil servant's true test lies not in routine administration but in standing firm during moral crises. By acting transparently, lawfully, and compassionately, the Municipal Commissioner can uphold public trust, ensure justice for victims, and reinforce the foundational democratic principle that no individual is above the law.

2019

[Case Study 1] In recent times, there has been an increasing concern in India to develop effective civil service ethics, code of conduct, transparency measures, ethics and integrity systems and anti-corruption agencies. In view of this, there is a need to focus on three specific areas, which are directly relevant to the problems of internalizing integrity and ethics in the civil services. These are as follows- 1. Anticipating specific threats to ethical standards and integrity in the civil services, 2. Strengthening the ethical competence of civil servants and 3. Developing administrative processes and practices which promote ethical values and integrity in civil services.

a. Suggest institutional measures to address the above three issues.

The 2nd ARC (4th Report - 'Ethics in Governance') observed that ethics in public life cannot be sustained merely by punitive law. It requires institutional design that prevents wrongdoing, builds character, and rewards integrity.

Guiding Principle - "Probity in Governance is the bedrock of democracy." (2nd ARC)

Anticipating Specific Threats to Ethical Standards

1. **Strengthen the Central Vigilance Commission (CVC)** with statutory teeth and **predictive risk profiling** of corruption-prone posts (revenue, transport, mining, procurement).
2. Operationalise an **integrated Integrity Index** for every Ministry and Department, ranking institutions on transparency, complaint redressal, and audit compliance.
3. **Mandatory Asset & Liability Disclosure under Section 44 of the Lokpal Act, 2013**, with public dashboards for higher civil services.
4. **Beneficial Ownership Registry** to detect conflict-of-interest through shell entities and family-held assets.
5. Operationalise the **Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014** with anonymous, encrypted reporting channels and witness protection.
6. **Lateral Vigilance Audits** - random behavioural and decision-pattern audits, learning from the **UK's 'Nolan Principles' enforcement model**.
7. **Pre-emptive Conflict-of-Interest Declarations** before sensitive postings (procurement, regulatory clearances, judicial postings).
8. **Periodic Threat Assessment Reports**, like the FATF's risk-based approach, for emerging corruption typologies (cyber-bribery, cryptocurrency kickbacks etc).

Strengthening the Ethical Competence of Civil Servants

1. **Foundation-Level Ethics Modules** at LBSNAA, SVPNPA and central training institutes with case-based pedagogy, drawing from the Cadre Training Plan.
2. **Mid-Career Mandatory Refreshers** in ethics (Phase III, IV, V trainings) - proposed by **Baswan Committee (2016)**.
3. **Code of Ethics for Civil Servants** - distinct from the Conduct Rules - as recommended by **Hota Committee (2004)** and **2nd ARC**; aspirational, not merely prohibitive.
4. **Ethics Officers** in every Ministry/Department, drawn from senior civil servants of unblemished record, **for confidential guidance** - modelled on the **US Office of Government Ethics**.
5. **Mentorship Programmes** pairing new entrants with retired civil servants of integrity
6. **Behavioural Competency Assessment** as part of the 360-degree appraisal for empanelment under the Performance Appraisal Reports.
7. **Compulsory study of foundational texts** - Bhagavad Gita, Tirukkural, Arthashastra alongside Aristotle, Kant, Rawls - to root ethical reasoning in Indian philosophical traditions.
8. **Ethics Helpline** - a confidential advisory service for officers facing ethical dilemmas in real time.

Administrative Processes Promoting Ethical Values

1. **Citizen Charters & Service Delivery Guarantees** with penalty clauses - operational in Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka.
2. **e-Governance & Process Re-engineering to eliminate discretion** - DBT, PFMS, GeM portal have demonstrably reduced bribery touchpoints.
3. **Social Audits** as institutionalised in MGNREGA (Section 17) and PDS in Andhra Pradesh and Meghalaya.
4. **RTI Strengthening with proactive disclosure** under Section 4 and protection of RTI users.
5. **Performance-linked Rewards** - Eg- Civil Services Day Awards, PM's Excellence Awards.
6. **Independent Civil Services Boards** as directed in **T.S.R. Subramanian v. Union of India (2013)** for transparent postings and minimum tenure.
7. **Time-bound File Disposal & Digital Trail through e-Office** for accountability and traceability.
8. **Annual Ethics Audit** - independent third-party review of departmental processes (akin to ISO certification).
9. **Beneficiary Feedback Mechanism - Jan-Sunwai**, MyGov, social media grievance redressal closes the citizen-state loop.
10. **Sevottam Framework** for service quality and grievance redressal - institutionalising continuous improvement.

Innovative Measures

1. **Integrity Pacts** in public procurement, monitored by Independent External Monitors (IEMs) - already in use by ONGC, GAIL, NTPC.
2. **Behavioural Nudges** - disclosure boxes, transparency walls, public display of pendency, as piloted by Indian Bureaucracy Lab.
3. **Reputation Score** for departments based on grievance disposal, audit objection clearance, and public trust surveys.

"The price of greatness is responsibility." - Winston Churchill

Transition from 'punishment-centric' to 'character-centric' governance is the surest path to probity in public life.

[Case Study 2] An apparel manufacturing company having a large number of women employees was losing sales due to various factors. The company hired a reputed marketing executive, who increased the volume of sales within a short span of time. However, some unconfirmed reports came up regarding his indulgence in sexual harassment at the workplace. After sometime a women employee launched a formal complaint to the management against the marketing executive about sexually harassing her. Faced with the companies' indifference, in not taking cognizance of her grievances, she lodged an FIR with the police. Realizing the sensitivity and gravity of the situation, the company called the women employee to negotiate. In that she was offered a hefty sum of money to withdraw the complaint and the FIR and also give in writing that the marketing executive is not involved in the case.

- a. Identify the ethical issues involved in this case.
- b. What options are available to the women employee?

Workplace sexual harassment violates dignity, equality, and safety, undermining ethical organisational culture and women's constitutional rights.

Guiding principle - Deontological Ethics - Ends cannot justify the means

Stakeholders

- The complainant woman employee.

- Other women employees (current and potential future victims).
- The accused marketing executive.
- Company management and shareholders.
- The Internal Committee under POSH Act, 2013.
- Society at large - message on workplace safety.

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Violation of Bodily Integrity & Dignity** - sexual harassment offends Article 21 (right to live with dignity) as upheld in Vishaka v. State of Rajasthan (1997).
2. **Corporate Indifference to Statutory Duty** - failure to constitute or activate the Internal Committee violates Section 4 of the POSH Act.
3. **Commodification of Justice** - offering money to withdraw a criminal complaint treats justice as a tradeable commodity.
4. **Abuse of power & Suppression of Truth** - coercing a false written statement that the executive 'was not involved' is fabrication of evidence, attracting Sections 227-229 of BNS, 2023.
5. **Profit over People** - sales performance is being shielded at the cost of women employees' dignity.
6. **Power Asymmetry & Coercion** - the complainant is financially vulnerable; the company exploits this to silence her.
7. **Conflict between Individual Relief and Collective Justice** - settlement protects one victim but exposes others.
8. **Erosion of Workplace Trust** - silence sends a signal that harassment is tolerated if the perpetrator is 'productive'.
9. **Breach of Vicarious Responsibility** - Section 19 of POSH Act mandates the employer to provide a safe environment.
10. **Obstruction of Justice** - interference with an ongoing FIR can amount to a separate criminal offence.

Options Available to the Woman Employee

1. **Accept the Settlement and Withdraw the Complaint**
 - **Pros** - immediate financial security; avoids prolonged legal battle and possible victimisation.
 - **Cons** - enables a serial offender; legally questionable since criminal proceedings under BNS for sexual offences cannot be compounded by private settlement.
2. **Reject the Offer and Pursue the Complaint to its Logical Conclusion**
 - **Pros** - upholds rule of law; protects future victims; sets an institutional precedent.
 - **Cons** - possible workplace retaliation, social stigma, prolonged litigation, emotional toll.
3. **File a Formal Complaint with the Internal Committee under POSH Act, 2013**
 - **Pros** - confidential, time-bound (90 days for inquiry), lower threshold of proof than criminal trial.
 - **Cons** - limited remedy (transfer, suspension, compensation); does not replace criminal prosecution.
4. **Approach the Local Committee (if no ICC) or She-Box Portal of the Ministry of Women and Child Development**
 - **Pros** - independent of employer pressure.
 - **Cons** - may be slower; awareness limited.
5. **Seek Legal Counsel and NGO Support (e.g., Majlis, Lawyers Collective, NCW)**
 - **Pros** - informed decision-making; emotional and procedural support; protection from intimidation.
 - **Cons** - none significant; this is a complementary step.

Most Appropriate Course

Combine Options 2, 3, 4 and 5 - pursue the FIR, simultaneously file a POSH complaint, approach the She-Box and NCW for institutional protection, and seek counselling/NGO support.

Refuse the settlement, since

- a. Criminal sexual offences are non-compoundable and any 'settlement' has no legal force,
- b. Silence emboldens future harassment
- c. The integrity of the justice process cannot be auctioned.

Upholding dignity and justice is not merely a legal obligation but a moral imperative essential for creating safe and equitable workplaces.

[Case Study 3] In one of the districts of a frontier state, narcotics menace has been rampant. This has resulted in money laundering, mushrooming of poppy farming, arms smuggling and near stalling of education. The system is on the verge of collapse. The situation has been further worsened by unconfirmed reports that local politicians, as well as some senior police officers, are providing surreptitious patronage to the drug mafia. At that point of time a woman police officer, known for her skills in handling such situations is appointed as superintendent of police to bring the situation to normalcy.

- a. If you are the same police officer, identify the various dimensions of the crisis.
- b. Based on your understanding, suggest measures to deal with the crisis.

This case mirrors the 'Udta Punjab' phenomenon, where the narco-economy has hollowed out institutions, communities and an entire generation.

Guiding Principle - "The duty of the police is not merely to enforce the law but to keep peace with justice." (Padmanabhaiah Committee, 2000)

Ethical Principles Involved

1. Rule of Law
2. Integrity
3. Public Service
4. Courage of Conviction
5. Compassion and Rehabilitation
6. National Security Ethics

Dimensions of the Crisis

1. **Law and Order Dimension** - Expansion of organised crime networks, arms smuggling, and violent activities.
2. **National Security Dimension** - Frontier location increases risk of cross-border narco-terrorism and illegal trafficking.
3. **Political-Criminal Nexus** - Alleged patronage by politicians and senior police officers weakens governance legitimacy.
4. **Economic Dimension** - Money laundering and illegal economy distort legitimate local businesses and taxation systems.
5. **Agrarian Crisis** - Farmers shift to poppy cultivation due to poverty, debt, and high illegal profits.
6. **Educational Collapse** - Addiction and criminalisation among youth lead to school dropouts and declining human capital.
7. **Public Health Crisis** - Drug abuse causes mental illness, overdoses, HIV transmission, and family breakdown.
8. **Social and Ethical Breakdown** - Fear, corruption, and criminal influence erode community trust and moral values.
9. **Administrative Corruption** - Compromised officials obstruct fair policing and anti-drug operations.
10. **Gender Dimension** - Women and children suffer domestic violence, trafficking, and economic insecurity due to addiction.

Suggested Measures

Immediate (0-3 months)

1. **Launch Special Anti-Narcotics Operations** - Conduct intelligence-based raids against drug cartels, trafficking routes, and illegal warehouses.
2. **Target Financial Networks** - Coordinate with Enforcement Directorate and financial intelligence units to freeze assets and investigate money laundering.
3. **Strengthen Border Surveillance** - Increase coordination with Border Security Force and use drones, sensors, and checkpoints.

4. **Action against corrupt officials** - Remove compromised officers from sensitive postings and initiate vigilance inquiries.
5. **Drug De-Addiction and Emergency Health Support** - Establish temporary rehabilitation camps and counselling centres.
6. **Protection for Whistleblowers and Witnesses** - Encourage citizens to report drug activities without fear of retaliation.

Long-term measures

1. **Engage NGOs** (e.g., SPYM, Society for Promotion of Youth and Masses) and faith-based organisations for community sensitisation.
2. **Drug Free Campus campaign** in schools and colleges with parents, teachers and student councils.
3. **Open de-addiction and rehabilitation centres** under the National Action Plan for Drug Demand Reduction (NAPDDR).
4. **Alternative livelihood** - link poppy farmers to MGNREGA, PMKSY, FPO formation, horticulture, ODOP.
5. **Community policing** - Panchayat-level Drug Watch Committees with women, youth, ASHA workers.
6. **Data-driven enforcement** - integrated drug-crime dashboard with predictive analytics.
7. **Skill development** through PMKVY for rescued youth; livelihood with dignity is the long-run antidote.
8. **Education revival** - reopen schools, ensure mid-day meals, teacher attendance, scholarships.

Personal Conduct of the SP

1. **Lead from the front** - be visible at raids, hospitals, schools and de-addiction camps.
2. **Maintain meticulous documentation**; communicate with the DGP and CM's Office in writing on all sensitive decisions.
3. **Use the media judiciously** - transparency is the best armour against political pressure.
4. **Refuse all extra-legal directions**; record them; escalate to NHRC/CVC if necessary.
5. **Personal security protocol** - vary routes, secure family, use trusted PSOs.

A courageous and ethical police leadership must combine strict law enforcement with compassion, institutional reform, and community participation.

[Case Study 4] Honesty and uprightness are the hallmarks of a civil servant. Civil servants possessing these qualities are considered as the backbone of any strong organisation. In line of duty, they take various decisions, at times some become bonafide mistakes. As long as such decisions are not taken intentionally and do not benefit personally, the officer cannot be said to be guilty. Though such decisions may, at times, lead to unforeseen adverse consequences in the long-term. In the recent past, a few instances have surfaced wherein civil servants have been implicated for bonafide mistakes. They have often been prosecuted and even imprisoned. These instances have greatly rattled the moral fibre of the civil servants.

a. How does this trend affect the functioning of the civil services?

b. What measures can be taken to ensure that honest civil servants are not implicated for bonafide mistakes on their part? Justify your answer.

"The civil service is not a service of status, but a service of responsibility. It is a commitment to the conscience of the nation." - **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**

Sardar Patel envisioned the civil services as the "**Steel Frame**" of India. He held that this frame must be strong enough to withstand political pressure and independent enough to offer impartial advice. However, when honest officers are criminalized for **bonafide mistakes** the steel frame begins to rust.

Impact of this trend on functioning of civil service

1. **Decision Paralysis** - Officers delay files and avoid taking responsibility due to fear of future prosecution.

2. **Risk-Averse Bureaucracy** - Preference for **status quo** over innovation and reform-oriented decisions.
3. **Erosion of Moral Courage** - Officers hesitate to take bold decisions even when public interest demands it.
4. **Procedural Over-Compliance** - Excessive rule-following replaces **outcome-oriented governance**.
5. **Decline in Public Service Motivation** - Honest officers feel **demoralised and insecure**.
6. **Blame-Shifting Culture** - Decisions are pushed upwards or sideways to avoid personal accountability.
7. **Project Delays and Cost Overruns** - Infrastructure and welfare projects suffer due to administrative hesitation.
8. **Loss of Administrative Talent** - Officers seek "safe" postings or opt for premature retirement.
9. **Weakening of Ethical Climate** - Fear replaces **values-based decision-making**.
10. **Trust Deficit in Institutions** - Strained relations between civil servants, political executive, and investigative agencies.
11. **Erosion of public faith** in administration

Measures to protect honest civil servants from implication in bonafide mistakes

1. Ensuring **autonomy of civil servants** by establishing **civil services boards for transparent postings and transfers**. It can prevent **politicization** of bureaucracy
2. Establishing clear **Code of ethics** as suggested by 2nd ARC
3. Enhancing **public participation in decision making**. Eg- Kerala's people's plan campaign
4. **Clear Legal Distinction Between Error and Corruption**- Criminal liability should arise only when **mens rea or personal gain** is established.
5. **Mandatory Prior Sanction for Prosecution**- Acts as a **protective filter** against frivolous or motivated cases.
6. **Expert Advisory Committees**: Pre-investigation review by retired bureaucrats/domain experts.
7. **Statute of Limitations**: Setting a time limit (5-7 years) for reopening administrative files to prevent "witch-hunts"
8. **Time-Bound Investigation and Trial**- Prevents prolonged harassment and psychological pressure on officers.
9. **Strengthening Documentation and Reasoned Orders**- Well-recorded rationale demonstrates **absence of malafide intent**.
10. **Clear Guidelines on Use of Discretion**- Reduces ambiguity and arbitrary interpretation of administrative actions.
11. **Ethics and Risk-Assessment Training**- Helps officers anticipate consequences and take **ethically defensible decisions**.
12. **Training for Investigating Agencies**: Sensitizing the CBI/CVC/CAG on administrative realities.

Innovative methods

1. **Professional Indemnity Insurance (PII)** - If an officer is sued for a decision taken in their official capacity, the insurance covers legal costs.
2. **Business Judgment Rule (USA & Germany)** - Unless "gross negligence" or "bad faith" is proven, the official is immune from personal liability.

The strength of a democracy lies in the **courage of its public servants**. While there must be zero tolerance for corruption, there must be **maximum protection for conviction**. This requires an "Intelligent Accountability" framework that encourages officers to be bold, innovative, and decisive.

[Case Study 5] You are heading the rescue operations in an area affected by severe natural calamity, thousands of people are rendered homeless and deprived of food, drinking water and other basic amenities. Rescue work has been disrupted by heavy rainfall and damage to supply routes. The local people are seething with anger against the delayed limited rescue operations. When your team reaches the affected area, the people there heckle and even assault some of the team members. One of your team members is even severely injured. Faced with this crisis some team member pleads with you to call off the operations freeing threats to their life.

a. In such trying circumstances, what will be your response?

b. Examine the qualities of a public servant which will be required to manage the situations.

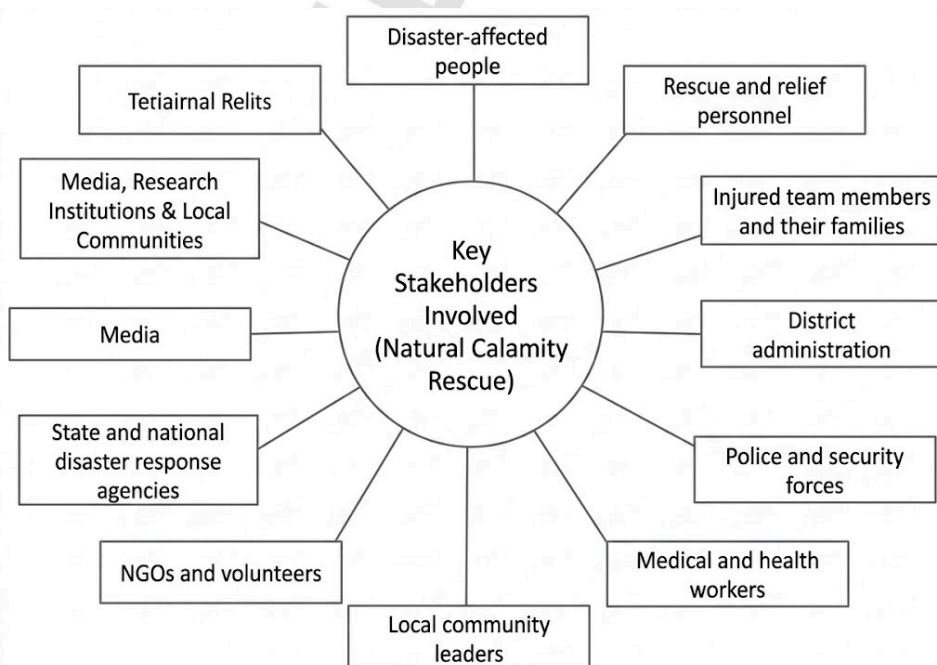
Natural disasters test not only administrative capacity but also the ethical commitment, courage, and compassion of public servants.

Guiding Principle - Seva

Paramo Dharma (Service is the highest duty).

My Response

- Evacuate and provide medical care** to the injured team member - life of the responder is non-negotiable.
- Reassure the team** - call a brief huddle; acknowledge their fear; affirm that abandoning the affected is not an option.
- Refuse to call off operations** - this would be (i) a dereliction of duty, (ii) a precedent inviting violence as a coercive tool, and (iii) catastrophic for the thousands still trapped.
- Empathic engagement** - meet the angry community leaders directly, listen without defensiveness.
- Transparent communication** - clearly explain the constraints (rainfall, blocked routes, equipment limits) and the action plan, with timelines.
- Engage community leaders**, sarpanchs, religious heads, school teachers - co-opt the angry crowd into the rescue effort.
- Restructure operations** - reorganise into smaller, dispersed teams escorted by local volunteers and police, prioritising the most vulnerable (children, elderly, pregnant women).
- Coordinate with district administration** for relief camps, dry rations, drinking water, mobile medical units.
- Request reinforcements** - call the NDRF, SDRF, paramilitary and Indian Army (HADR - Humanitarian Assistance & Disaster Relief) under the Disaster Management Act, 2005.
- File an FIR against the assailants** once the rescue stabilises.
- Single-window grievance redressal** with a dedicated officer and toll-free helpline.
- Counselling** for traumatised survivors and for the rescue team itself.



Qualities of a Public Servant Required

1. **Moral Courage** - the will to act rightly despite personal risk. Mahatma Gandhi called this the foundation of all virtues.
2. **Empathy & Compassion** - the ability to feel the survivor's grief and respond with care .
3. **Emotional Intelligence** - recognising one's own fear and the team's anxiety; converting fear into focus.
4. **Equanimity (Sthitaprajna)** - composure amidst chaos.
5. **Leadership by Example** - the leader must be physically present at the most dangerous point of operations.
6. **Communication Skills** - the ability to listen, explain, persuade and de-escalate.
7. **Resilience & Stamina** - physical, mental and ethical endurance over days of crisis.
8. **Decisiveness** - ability to take timely, decisive and bold decisions..
9. **Team Spirit & Care for Subordinates** - a leader who protects the team commands greater obedience than one who orders it.
10. **Constitutional Morality** - placing duty to citizens above hierarchical loyalty or self-preservation.
11. **Risk Management** - calibrated courage, not recklessness; protecting the team while serving the public.
12. **Foresight** - anticipating bottlenecks (logistics, communication, secondary disasters).

Real-World Parallels

- IPS officer Vinay Tiwari leading rescue in the 2011 Sikkim earthquake despite hostile terrain and crowds.
- Air Commodore Rajesh Isser commanding 'Operation Rahat' during the 2013 Kedarnath floods - over 23,000 evacuated.

"In the moment of crisis, the wise person builds bridges; the fool builds barriers." - **Nyaya Sutra**

A public servant in such a situation must remember that hostility is the language of grief. To answer grief with courage and compassion is the highest form of public service.

[Case Study 6] In a modern democratic polity, there is a concept of the political executive and permanent executive. Elected people's representatives form the political executive and bureaucracy form the permanent executive. Ministers frame policy decisions and bureaucrats execute these. In the initial decades after independence, the relationship between the permanent executives and the political executives were characterized by mutual understanding, respect, and cooperation, without encroaching upon each other's domain. However, in subsequent decades, the situation has changed. There are instances of the political executive insisting upon the permanent executives to follow its agenda. Respect for an appreciation of upright bureaucrats has declined. There is an increasing tendency among the political executive to get involved in routine administrative matters such as transfers, posting etc. Under this scenario, there is a definitive trend towards 'politicization of bureaucracy'. The rising materialism and acquisitiveness in social life has also adversely impacted upon the ethical values of both the permanent executive and the political executive.

a. What are the consequences of this 'politicization of bureaucracy? Discuss.

Sardar Patel described the civil services as the '**steel frame**' that holds India together. Articles 309-311 sought to insulate civil servants from political vagaries.

However, the **Hota Committee (2004)**, the **2nd ARC (10th Report)** etc have sounded the alarm on the corrosion of this frame through politicisation.

Consequences of Politicisation of Bureaucracy

Politicization of bureaucracy refers to a situation where civil servants act based on **political loyalty, partisan interests, or pressure from political executives** rather than constitutional values, neutrality, professionalism, and public interest.

1. Administrative Consequences

- **Distorted Policy Priorities** - schemes driven by electoral calculus (loan waivers, sub-quotas) over developmental rationality.
- **Decision Paralysis** - officers hesitate to take bold decisions, fearing punitive transfers.
- **Frequent Transfers** - undermining institutional memory and continuity of programmes; average tenure of an IAS officer in some states is under a year.
- **Erosion of Hierarchy** - junior officers bypass seniors using political channels.
- **Reduced Quality of Service Delivery** - particularly to weaker sections without political patronage.
- **Substitution of Merit with Loyalty** - postings driven by allegiance, not competence.
- **Demoralisation of Honest Officers** - talented officers seek deputation, foreign assignments, or premature retirement.
- **Risk Aversion** - preference for status quo over reform; the 'safe file' culture.

2. Ethical & Moral Consequences

- **Loss of Anonymity & Neutrality**
- **Compromise of Integrity** - officers willing to bend reward themselves; honest ones marginalised.
- **Normalisation of Corruption** - quid pro quo postings monetise public office.
- **Crisis of Conscience for Young Entrants** - IAS/IPS probationers learn early that integrity has institutional costs.
- **Erosion of Professional Pride** - civil service identity gives way to political identity.

3. Institutional Consequences

- **Politicised Investigation Agencies** - when CBI, ED, IT or police are perceived as partisan, public trust collapses (the 'caged parrot' observation by the Supreme Court).
- **Federalism Strain** - All-India Services officers caught between Centre-State conflicts.
- **Decline in Public Trust** - citizens see civil servants as agents of ruling parties, not of the Constitution.
- **Crony Capitalism Risk** - politicised regulators favour connected firms.

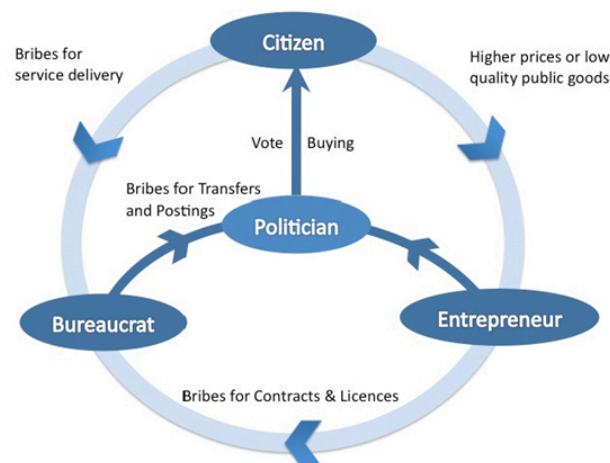
4. Constitutional & Legal Consequences

- **Breach of All-India Services (Conduct) Rules** - political activity by civil servants prohibited but often blurred.
- **Negation of T.S.R. Subramanian directions** - minimum tenure, Civil Services Boards, written instructions seldom honoured.

5. Internal Civil Service Culture

- **Factionalism** - officers cluster around political camps.
- **Erosion of Esprit de Corps** - solidarity replaced by individual survival strategies.
- **Brain Drain** - best minds choose international organisations or private sector.

THE WHEEL OF CORRUPTION



- **Ashok Khemka, IAS** - over 50 transfers in 30 years for resisting irregular land transactions.
- **Durga Shakti Nagpal** - suspended for cracking down on sand mafia.
- **Sanjiv Chaturvedi** - fought corruption at AIIMS despite repeated punitive transfers; awarded Magsaysay.
- **U. Sagayam, IAS** - punitive transfers for exposing granite mafia in Tamil Nadu.

Way Forward

1. **Operationalise Civil Services Boards (per T.S.R. Subramanian, 2013).**
2. **Minimum tenure of 2 years for sensitive posts.**
3. **Written instructions for all sensitive decisions (Hota Committee).**
4. **Independent Civil Services Authority for All-India Services.**
5. **Strengthening Conduct Rules and Code of Ethics.**
6. **Periodic 360-degree appraisal with civil-society input.**
7. **Reforming the political class** - internal democracy in parties, decriminalisation of politics.

"When the political executive treats the bureaucracy as a tool of governance rather than as a partner in governance, both suffer." - 2nd ARC

2018

[Case Study 1] A big corporate house is engaged in manufacturing industrial chemicals on a large scale. It proposes to set up an additional unit. Many states rejected its proposal due to the detrimental effect on the environment. But one state government acceded to the request and permitted the unit close to a city, brushing aside all opposition. The unit was set up 10 years ago and was in full swing till recently. The pollution caused by the industrial effluents was affecting the land, water and crops in the area. It was also causing serious health problems to human beings and animals. This gave rise to a series of agitation thousands of people took part, creating a law and order problem necessitating stern police action. Following the public outcry, the State government ordered the closure of the factory. The closure of the factory resulted in the unemployment of not only those workers who were engaged in the factory but also those who were working in the ancillary units. It also very badly affected those industries which depended on the chemicals manufactured by it.

a. As a senior officer entrusted with the responsibility of handling these issues, how are you going to address it?

This case mirrors the Bhopal Gas Tragedy aftermath, the Sterlite Copper closure in Tuticorin (2018) and the Vedanta-Niyamgiri controversy. As the senior officer, I face a classic ethical dilemma - environmental protection vs livelihood security

Stakeholders

1. Local community - health, environment, drinking water, agricultural livelihoods.
2. Factory workers - direct employment.
3. Ancillary unit workers and dependent industries - derived livelihoods.
4. Corporate house - investment, reputation.
5. State Government - revenue, political stability.
6. Environmental ecosystem - soil, groundwater, biodiversity.
7. Future generations - inter-generational equity.

Guiding Principle - Sustainable Development (Brundtland, 1987) and the Polluter-Pays Principle.

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Right to Life & Healthy Environment** - Article 21 (Subhash Kumar v. State of Bihar, 1991).
2. **Right to Livelihood** - Article 21 read with 39(a) (Olga Tellis v. BMC, 1985).
3. **Inter-generational Equity** - present prosperity vs future ecological inheritance.
4. **Regulatory Failure** - pollution boards either lacked capacity or were captured.
5. **Corporate Social Responsibility** - the principle of trusteeship (Gandhiji).
6. **Distributive Justice** - who bears the cost of industrialisation?
7. **Environmental Justice** - ecologically poor communities disproportionately harmed.
8. **Procedural Ethics** - EIA, public hearings, consent - were they conducted in spirit?

My Course of Action

Immediate (0-30 days)

1. **Independent Health & Environmental Audit** by NEERI, IIT or AIIMS - pollutant levels, soil and water contamination, disease burden.
2. **Emergency medical camps** - free testing, treatment and long-term monitoring for affected residents and livestock.
3. **Alternative drinking water supply** via tankers, reverse-osmosis units, deep tube-wells in unaffected aquifers.
4. **Interim relief & compensation** under the Public Liability Insurance Act, 1991 and 'Polluter Pays' doctrine - funded by the company, not the taxpayer.

5. **Wage support for workers** - emergency relief through state labour welfare board, ESIC.

Short-Term (1–6 months)

1. **Show-Cause to Company** - formal proceedings under Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974, Air Act, 1981, EPA, 1986 and Hazardous Wastes Rules, 2016.
2. Two-Track Approach
 - **Track 1 - Conditional Reopening** - only after the company invests in zero-liquid discharge, scrubbers, real-time emission monitoring, third-party certification, and an environmental bank guarantee.
 - **Track 2** - if pollution is irreparable, order complete closure.
3. **National Green Tribunal** - refer the matter to NGT for an independent expert determination.
4. **Worker Re-skilling** - Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY), DDU-GKY for ancillary unit workers.
5. **Bridge employment** - absorb skilled workers in nearby industrial corridors, MSMEs, MGNREGA for unskilled.
6. **Special Economic Package for the region** - incentives for clean industries (electronics, food processing, solar) to set up nearby.

Long-Term

1. **Strengthen Pollution Control Board** - additional staff, equipment, autonomy, transparent grievance portal.
2. **Ecological Restoration** - bioremediation, phytoremediation, afforestation; cost borne by the company under 'Polluter Pays'.
3. **Long-term Health Surveillance** - cohort study for 10 years to track delayed effects (cancer, kidney, respiratory).
4. **Diversified Industrial Base** - encourage green industries, agro-processing, IT-enabled services.
5. **Strengthening EIA Regime** - independent EIA consultants, public participation, social impact assessment.
6. **Industrial Township Reform** - green belts, buffer zones, evacuation drills, emergency response.
7. **Just Transition Fund** - modelled on the European Union's mechanism for fossil-fuel-dependent regions.

Real-World Parallels

1. **Sterlite Copper, Tuticorin (Tamil Nadu, 2018)** - closure upheld by Supreme Court (2024).
2. **Bhopal Gas Tragedy aftermath** - failure of just transition continues to haunt three generations.
3. **Bichhri Village (Rajasthan)** - Supreme Court ordered the polluter to bear full cost of remediation.
4. **Plachimada Coca-Cola Plant (Kerala)** - closure linked to groundwater depletion.

"Earth provides enough to satisfy every man's needs, but not every man's greed." - **Mahatma Gandhi**
As a senior officer, my duty is to ensure that development serves humanity, not the other way around.

[Case Study 2] It is a State where prohibition is in force. You are recently appointed as the Superintendent of Police of a district notorious for illicit distillation of liquor. The illicit liquor leads to many death, reported and unreported, and causes a major problem for the district authorities. The approach till now had been to view it as a law and order problem and tackle it accordingly. Raids, arrest, police cases, and criminal trials - all these had only limited impact. The problem remains as serious as ever. Your inspections show that the parts of the district where the distillation flourishes are economically, industrially and educationally backward. Agriculture is badly affected by poor irrigation facilities. Frequent clashes among communities gave boost to illicit distillation. No major initiatives had taken place in the past either from the government's side or from social organizations to improve the lot of the people.

a. Which new approach will you adopt to bring the problem under control?"

The case parallels Bihar's prohibition experience, and 2015 Malwani hooch tragedy in Maharashtra. It demands a fundamental shift from 'enforcement-only' to a 'development-policing' integrated model.

Operational Doctrine - Police as Catalysts of Development, not just Enforcers of Law (2nd ARC, 5th Report)

Why the Old Approach Failed

1. **Treated symptom (distillation) not the disease** (poverty, joblessness, social fragmentation).
2. **Police-centric** - ignored education, livelihood and gender dimensions.
3. **Adversarial - community saw police as the enemy, distillers as benefactors.**
4. **No long-term substitute economy** - every arrested distiller was replaced by another.
5. **Demand-side neglect** - consumers continued, and the supply chain regenerated.
6. **Weak inter-departmental coordination** - Excise, Health, Education, Rural Development worked in silos.

My New Approach -

Pillar 1 - Intelligence-Driven Enforcement

1. **Mapping** - GIS-based mapping of distillation hotspots, supply routes, financiers and consumption clusters.
2. **Choke the Supply Chain** - focus on financiers, large-scale brewers and wholesale suppliers, not petty vendors.
3. **Asset Attribution & Seizure** under PMLA and state Excise Acts - financial deterrent is sharper than imprisonment.
4. **Beat-Level Constable Engagement** - community-friendly, beat-bonded officers who know every household.
5. **Coordinated Action** - joint operations with Excise, GST Intelligence, Forest Department (for raw material sourcing) and SDRF.
6. **Withdraw Petty Cases** - selectively decriminalise small-time consumers; channel them to de-addiction.

Pillar 2 - Livelihood Substitution

1. **Convene a District Development Coordination Meeting with the Collector** - present the diagnosis and seek convergence.
2. **MGNREGA Push** - focus on water-harvesting structures, check dams, farm ponds to address the irrigation deficit identified.
3. **Skill Development** under PMKVY, DDU-GKY for youth - masonry, plumbing, electrical, IT, hospitality.
4. **One District One Product (ODOP)** - identify a niche product (e.g., honey, lac, minor forest produce) for branding and market linkage.

Pillar 3 - Education & Social Reform

1. **Re-energise Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan and Samagra Shiksha** - focus on school attendance, mid-day meals, female literacy.

2. **Skill Schools** - vocational training partnerships with ITIs and Polytechnics.
3. **Reconciliation Camps for inter-community clashes** - invoke Gram Nyayalayas, traditional panchayats and SP-led 'Aman Committees'.

Pillar 4 - De-addiction & Health

1. **Integrated Rehabilitation Centres for Addicts (IRCA's)** under NAPDDR, MSJE.
2. **Mobile De-addiction Units** in remote pockets.
3. **ASHA & ANM Sensitisation** - community-level identification and referral.

Pillar 5 - Community Ownership

1. **Gram Sabha Resolutions declaring villages liquor-free** - moral pressure beats moralising lectures.
2. **Mahila Mandals** as guardians of village ethics - **Andhra Pradesh's anti-arack movement** (early 1990s) was led by rural women.
3. **Youth Clubs / Nehru Yuva Kendra Sangathan** for awareness, sports, employment camps.
4. **Religious Leaders & Local Influencers** - engage them as moral campaigners.
5. **Reward & Recognition** - annually felicitate liquor-free villages and individual reformers.
6. **Citizen Charter for Excise & Police** - transparent grievance redressal.

Innovative Tools

1. **Predictive Policing** - data analytics to forecast brewing locations during festival seasons.
2. **Drone Surveillance** over inaccessible forested distillation zones.
3. **Public-Private Partnerships** with CSR funds of nearby industries for skill centres and clinics.
4. **Whistleblower Reward Scheme** - anonymous reporting with cash awards.

An **ethical and effective Superintendent** of Police must combine strict enforcement with **empathy, community participation, development initiatives, and rehabilitation**. Such a holistic approach transforms policing from a force of fear into an **instrument of social justice and human welfare**.

[Case Study 3] Dr X is a leading medical practitioner in a city. He has set up a charitable trust through which he plans to establish a super-speciality hospital in the city to cater to the medical needs of all sections of the society. Incidentally, that part of the State had been neglected over the years. The proposed hospital would be a boon for the region. You are heading the tax investigation agency of that region. During an inspection of the doctor's clinic, your officers have found some major irregularities. A few of them are substantial which had resulted in considerable withholding of tax that should be paid by him now. The doctor is cooperative. He undertakes to pay the tax immediately. However, there are certain other deficiencies in his tax compliance which are purely technical in nature. If these technical defaults are pursued by the agency, considerable time and energy of the doctor will be diverted to issues which are not so serious, urgent or even helpful to the tax collection process. Further, in all probability, it will hamper the prospects of the hospital coming up. There are two options before you-

1. Taking a broader view, ensure substantial tax compliance and ignore defaults that are merely technical in nature.
 2. Pursue the matter strictly and proceed on all fronts, whether substantial or merely technical.
- a. As the head of the tax agency, which course of action will you opt and why?

As the head of the tax investigation agency, I am faced with an administrative dilemma of **Strict Legalism vs. Purposeful Governance**. While the law demands absolute compliance, the spirit of public service requires an assessment of the "greater good."

Stakeholders and Their Interests

1. **Citizens in neglected region**
2. **Dr. X**
3. **The State/Tax Administration**
4. **Wider Society**

Guiding principle - Sarve Bhavantu Sukhinah - May all beings be happy.

Evaluation of the Two Options

Option 1: Ensure Substantial Compliance and Ignore Merely Technical Defaults

Merits

1. **Public Interest Maximisation** - Facilitates establishment of a **super-speciality charitable hospital**, benefiting underserved populations.
2. **Proportionality** - Focuses enforcement on **material tax evasion**, not procedural lapses.
3. **Administrative Efficiency** - Saves scarce investigative resources for **serious violations**.
4. **Encourages Voluntary Compliance** - Doctor's cooperation and immediate payment indicate **good faith**.
5. **Utilitarian Justification** - Greater overall societal benefit with minimal ethical cost.

Concerns

- Risk of **perceived leniency**.
- Possibility of **precedent misuse** if discretion is not well documented.

Option 2: Strict Action on Both Substantial and Technical Defaults

Merits

1. **Rule-Based Equality** - Upholds **formal equality before law**.
2. **Deterrence Value** - Signals zero tolerance for any non-compliance.

Demerits

1. **Disproportionate Response** - Treats minor technical lapses on par with substantive evasion.
2. **Public Interest Harm** - Likely delay or derailment of a **critical healthcare project**.
3. **Inefficient Governance** - High administrative cost with low revenue gain.
4. **Ethical Myopia** - Focus on procedure over outcomes.

I Would Opt for Option 1 as it leads to "greatest happiness of greatest number"

Ethical Justification for the Chosen Option

1. **In line with doctrine of proportionality** - Punishment and enforcement correspond to **gravity of offence**.
2. **Intent-Based Ethics** - technical lapses lack **malafide intent**.
3. **Public Welfare Priority** - Health infrastructure in a neglected region serves **constitutional goals under Article 47**.
4. **Trusteeship Model of Governance** - State acts as a **facilitator of social good**, not an obstacle.
5. **Utilitarian Ethics** - Maximises net social benefit without compromising revenue.
6. **Administrative Discretion within Law** - Tax laws allow **compounding, warnings, and rectification windows**.
7. **Moral Legitimacy of the State** - Citizens perceive the State as **fair and humane**, not mechanical.
8. **Encouragement of Philanthropy** - Signals that ethical, cooperative taxpayers are treated reasonably.
9. **Fulfills core mandate** - Revenue collection, not procedural perfection, is the agency's primary objective.

Further safeguards

- Record a **reasoned written order**.
- Ensure **full recovery** of substantial dues.
- Issue **time-bound compliance directions** for technical lapses.
- Apply **uniform standards** in similar cases.

Ethical governance lies in **wise discretion**, not rigid formalism. By choosing option 2, I can uphold **Dharma, Nyāya, and Lokasaṅgraha** (public welfare)

[Case Study 4] Rakesh is a responsible district level officer, who enjoys the trust of his higher officials. Knowing his honesty, the government entrusted him with the responsibility of identifying the beneficiaries under a health care scheme meant for senior citizens. The criteria to be a beneficiary are the following- 1. 60 years of age or above. 2. Belonging to a reserved community. 3. Family income of less than 1 Lakh rupees per annum. 4. Post-treatment prognosis is likely to be high to make a positive difference to the quality of life of the beneficiary. One day, an old couple visited Rakesh's office with their application. They have been the residents of a village in his district since their birth. The old man is diagnosed with a rare condition that causes obstruction in the large intestine. As a consequence, he has severe abdominal pain frequently that prevents him from doing any physical labour. The couple has no children to support them. The expert surgeon whom they contacted is willing to do the surgery without charging any fee. However, the couple will have to bear the cost of incidental charges, such as medicines, hospitalization, etc., to the tune of rupees one lakh. The couple fulfils all the criteria except criterion 'b'. However, any financial aid would certainly make a significant difference in their quality of life.

a. How should Rakesh respond to the situation?

Rakesh is caught between the letter of the rule (rigid eligibility) and the spirit of the rule (welfare of vulnerable senior citizens). This is a classic Niti vs Nyaya dilemma - Amartya Sen's distinction between procedural justice and substantive justice.

Stakeholders

1. The elderly couple (immediate beneficiaries).
2. Other potential beneficiaries from the reserved community (precedential impact).
3. The State / Scheme administrators.
4. The wider taxpaying public.
5. Rakesh himself - career, conscience.

Guiding Principle - "Antyodaya" (welfare of the last person)

Ethical Issues Involved

1. **Rule of Law vs Substantive Justice** - strict compliance vs welfare outcome.
2. **Compassion vs Equality** - emotion vs equality before law (Article 14).
3. **Discretion vs Discipline** - extent of bureaucratic discretion.
4. **Public Trust vs Personal Risk** - favouring one couple may invite charges of arbitrariness.
5. **Distributive Justice** - diverting scheme funds may deny equally deserving reserved-community beneficiaries.
6. **Dignity of the Elderly** - Article 41 obligates state assistance to the aged and infirm.
7. **Moral Hazard** - informal exception-making may corrode rule-based governance.

Options Available to Rakesh

1. **Sanction Aid by Stretching the Rules**
2. **Strict Rejection - Strict Compliance**
3. **Reject under this Scheme but Mobilise Alternative Resources**
4. **Personal Charity (Rakesh pays from own pocket)**

Most Appropriate Course - Options 3

Immediate Action (within days)

1. **Politely explain** to the couple that this specific scheme cannot cover them due to criterion (b), without dismissing their plight.
2. **Map alternative resources** promptly:
 - a. Rashtriya Arogya Nidhi (RAN) / Health Minister's Discretionary Grant - for catastrophic illness of BPL patients.
 - b. State-level Chief Minister's Relief Fund.
 - c. District Mineral Foundation Fund / DM's Discretionary Welfare Fund (where applicable).
 - d. CSR funds of local industries / hospital trusts / Lions/Rotary clubs.
 - e. Crowdfunding platforms (Milaap, Ketto) with district administration endorsement
3. **Coordinate with the surgeon** - explore further concessions on hospitalisation and medicines.
4. **Mobilise Community and CSR Support** - Coordinate with NGOs, charitable trusts, philanthropists, CSR initiatives, or local donors for incidental expenses.
5. Connect the couple with a **District Social Welfare Officer** who can navigate paperwork for elderly applicants.
6. **Track progress personally** - assign a designated official to ensure follow-through as the couple has no children to advocate for them.

Systemic Action

1. **Document the case** in a written note to the District Collector and State Department, recommending **review of the eligibility criteria** to include all economically and medically vulnerable senior citizens.
7. Propose a '**general category EWS senior citizen**' sub-component within the scheme.
8. Suggest a '**Discretionary Reserve**' (10% of scheme funds) for hardship cases under written, recorded justification.
9. **Maintain a register** of similar applicants denied on technicalities - evidence for future reform.

Such **balanced action** reflects the essence of ethical governance - combining legality with humanity and procedure with empathy.

[Case Study 5] As a senior officer in the Ministry, you have access to important policy decisions and upcoming big announcements such as road constructions projects before they are notified in the public domain. The Ministry is about to announce a mega road project for which the drawings are already in place. Sufficient care was taken by the planners to make use of the government land with the minimum land acquisition from private parties. Compensation rate for private parties was also finalized as per government rules. Care was also taken to minimize deforestation. Once the project is announced, it is expected that there will be a huge spurt in real estate prices in and around that area. Meanwhile, the Minister concerned insists that you realign the road in such a way that it comes closer to his 20 acres farmhouse. He also suggests that he would facilitate the purchase of a big plot of land in your wife name at the prevailing rate which is very nominal, in and around the proposed mega road project. He also tries to convince you by saying that there is no harm in it as he is buying the land legally. He even promises to supplement your savings in case you do not have sufficient funds to buy the land. However, by the act of realignment, a lot of agricultural lands has to be acquired, thereby causing a considerable financial burden on the government, and also the displacement of the farmers. As if this is not enough, it will involve cutting down of a large number of trees denuding the area of its green cover.

a. Faced with this situation, what will you do?

b. Critically examine various conflicts of interest and explain what your responsibilities are as a public servant."

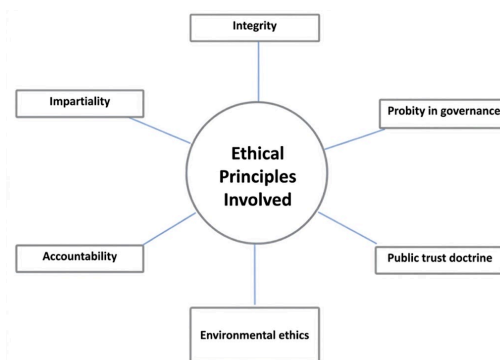
This case echoes the **Adarsh Society scam and the Karnataka mining cases** - situations where insider information and political position created irresistible private-gain opportunities, with public cost.

Stakeholders

- Farmers facing displacement and agricultural-land acquisition.
- Taxpayers (additional financial burden from realignment).
- Future generations (loss of tree cover, ecological cost).
- The Minister (political/personal interest).
- My family - wife (implicated in the offered transaction).
- Me - the public servant.
- Wider public - quality of governance, faith in institutions.

My Course of Action

Action	Ethical Basis
Politely but Firmly Refuse the Offer	Integrity and avoidance of corruption.
Maintain Original Alignment Based on Technical Merit	Objectivity and evidence-based governance.
Explain Legal and Financial Implications to the Minister. Highlight • Increased compensation burden • Environmental clearances • Public backlash • Litigation risks • Ethical impropriety	Speaking truth to power with professionalism.



Record All Directions in Writing	Administrative accountability and self-protection.
Protect Confidential Information - Do not share project details with family members, brokers, or private individuals.	Fiduciary responsibility and public trust doctrine.
Escalate Matter if Pressure Persists	Inform higher administrative authorities/cabinet secretary/vigilance mechanisms if unethical pressure continues.
Ensure Transparent Decision-Making - independent technical review and environmental impact assessment.	Transparency and fairness.

Various Conflicts of Interest Involved

- 1. Public Interest vs Private Gain** - Road alignment is sought not for public utility but for enhancing value of Minister's farmhouse.
- 2. Official Duty vs Political Pressure** - Officer is expected to obey lawful authority but resist unethical interference.
- 3. Integrity vs Personal Financial Benefit** - Offer of land in wife's name and financial assistance amounts to inducement and corruption.
- 4. Transparency vs Insider Information Misuse** - Using confidential project information for land purchase amounts to abuse of privileged information.
- 5. Development vs Environmental Sustainability** - Realignment would increase deforestation and ecological degradation.
- 6. Public Exchequer vs Political Patronage** - Additional land acquisition would impose unnecessary burden on taxpayers.
- 7. Rights of Farmers vs Elite Interests** - Farmers would face displacement for private enrichment of influential individuals.
- 8. Professional Ethics vs Fear of Reprisal** - Officer may face transfers, harassment, or political retaliation for resisting pressure.

Responsibilities as a Public Servant

- 1. Uphold Constitution and Rule of Law** - Loyalty must be toward constitutional values, not individuals.
- 2. Act in Public Interest** - Infrastructure decisions should maximize social welfare and minimize harm.
- 3. Maintain Integrity and Probity** - Avoid corruption, nepotism, and conflict of interest.
- 4. Protect Public Resources** - Prevent unnecessary expenditure and misuse of taxpayers' money.
- 5. Ensure Environmental Stewardship** - Development should align with sustainability principles.
- 6. Remain Politically Neutral** - Bureaucratic decisions must be impartial and evidence-based.
- 7. Maintain Confidentiality** - Sensitive information should not be used for personal enrichment.
- 8. Demonstrate Moral Courage** - resisting powerful interests. Eg- Ashok Khemka resisting politically influenced land dealings

"In matters of style, swim with the current; in matters of principle, stand like a rock." - Thomas Jefferson
By remaining impartial, transparent, and constitutionally committed, a public servant preserves both democratic accountability and the moral legitimacy of the state.

[Case Study 6] Edward Snowden, a computer expert and former CIA administrator, released confidential Government documents to the press about the existence of Government surveillance programmes. According to many legal experts and the US Government, his action violated the Espionage act of 1971, which identified the leak of State secrets as an act of treason. Yet, despite the fact that he broke the law, Snowden argued that he had a moral obligation to act. He gave a justification for his “whistle blowing” by stating that he had a duty “to inform the public as to that which is done in their name and that which is done against them.” According to Snowden, the Government’s violation of privacy had to be exposed regardless of legality since more substantive issues of social action and public morality were involved here. Many agreed with Snowden. Few argued that he broke the law and compromised national security, for which he should be held accountable.

- a. Do you agree that Snowden’s actions were ethically justified even if legally prohibited? Why or why not? Make an argument by weighing the competing values in this case.

The case of **Edward Snowden** raises a profound ethical dilemma between **obedience to law** and **obedience to conscience**. It raises a question of whether **moral responsibility to society** can justify actions that are legally prohibited.

Competing Values Involved

1. **Rule of Law vs Moral Conscience** - Legal obedience versus ethical responsibility.
2. **National Security vs Individual Privacy** - State safety versus civil liberties.
3. **Secrecy of State vs Transparency** - Classified governance versus democratic openness.
4. **Public Interest vs State Interest** - Citizens’ rights versus governmental authority.
5. **Institutional Loyalty vs Constitutional Values** - Duty to employer versus duty to society.
6. **Collective Security vs Individual liberty** - Surveillance for safety versus autonomy.
7. **Means vs Ends** - Illegality of action versus nobility of outcome.
8. **Authority vs Accountability** - Power of the state versus citizen oversight.

Arguments Supporting Snowden’s Actions

1. Snowden exposed **mass surveillance**, which is violating fundamental **privacy rights** without informed public consent.
2. **Whistleblower Ethics** - exposing **systemic wrongdoing** and **institutional abuse of power**.
3. Snowden argued that internal mechanisms were ineffective, leaving **public disclosure as the last resort**.
4. **Democratic Transparency** - citizens' right to know if the state is acting **against constitutional values**.
5. **Civil Disobedience Tradition** - breaking an unjust law is ethically justified to **awaken public conscience**.
6. **Utilitarian Perspective** - The disclosures triggered global debate and reforms on surveillance leading to recognition of the right **to privacy of citizens**.
7. **Proportional Response** - The scale of privacy violation justified extraordinary action.

Arguments Against Snowden’s Actions

1. **Violation of Rule of Law** - Ethical governance requires adherence to law. Selective disobedience risks **anarchy**.
2. **National Security Risks** - Disclosure of classified information endangers **intelligence operations and personnel**.
3. **Violation of deontological ethics** - Even noble ends do not automatically justify **illegal means**.
4. **Lack of Democratic Mandate** - Snowden acted unilaterally without public or institutional authorization.
5. **Undermining Trust in Institutions** - Breaches weaken public trust on government
6. **Precedent for Reckless Leaks** - Justification could encourage irresponsible disclosures by others.
7. **Legal Accountability Principle** - Breaking law demands **consequences**, regardless of motive.

Ethical Evaluation - Snowden's actions can be considered ethically justified but legally culpable

1. His **intent** was not personal gain but **public good**.
2. The issue involved **fundamental rights**, not policy disagreement.
3. **Catalyst for Institutional Reform - His actions strengthened oversight of intelligence agencies worldwide.**
4. Programs he exposed were found by subsequent courts to be unconstitutional and exceeded the authority granted by Congress.

Snowden's actions highlight the need for **stronger institutional oversight, robust whistleblower protections, and transparent governance**, so individuals are not forced to choose between **silence and illegality**.

CIVILSDAILY IAS



**CIVILSDAILY IAS**

Smash Mains 2026

*A focused Mentorship to improve your GS Mains Score **from 300 to 450+***

TARGET: UPSC CSE MAINS 2026

Starts: 7 JUNE

1:1 Personalized Mentorship

Weekly mentor calls, tailored study plans & post-test course correction

12 GS FLT's + 10 Sectional Tests

70% Mains Hit Ratio, Model Answers & All India Rankings

X-Factor Classes + Notes

Smash Essay + Smash PYQ Enriched GS notes and strategy classes the topper-level edge

X-Factor Classes & Notes



1:1 Mentorship & Tests

For Smash Mains Enrollment



WhatsApp Over

80765 17832

Scan QR to know more about Smash Mains 2026

